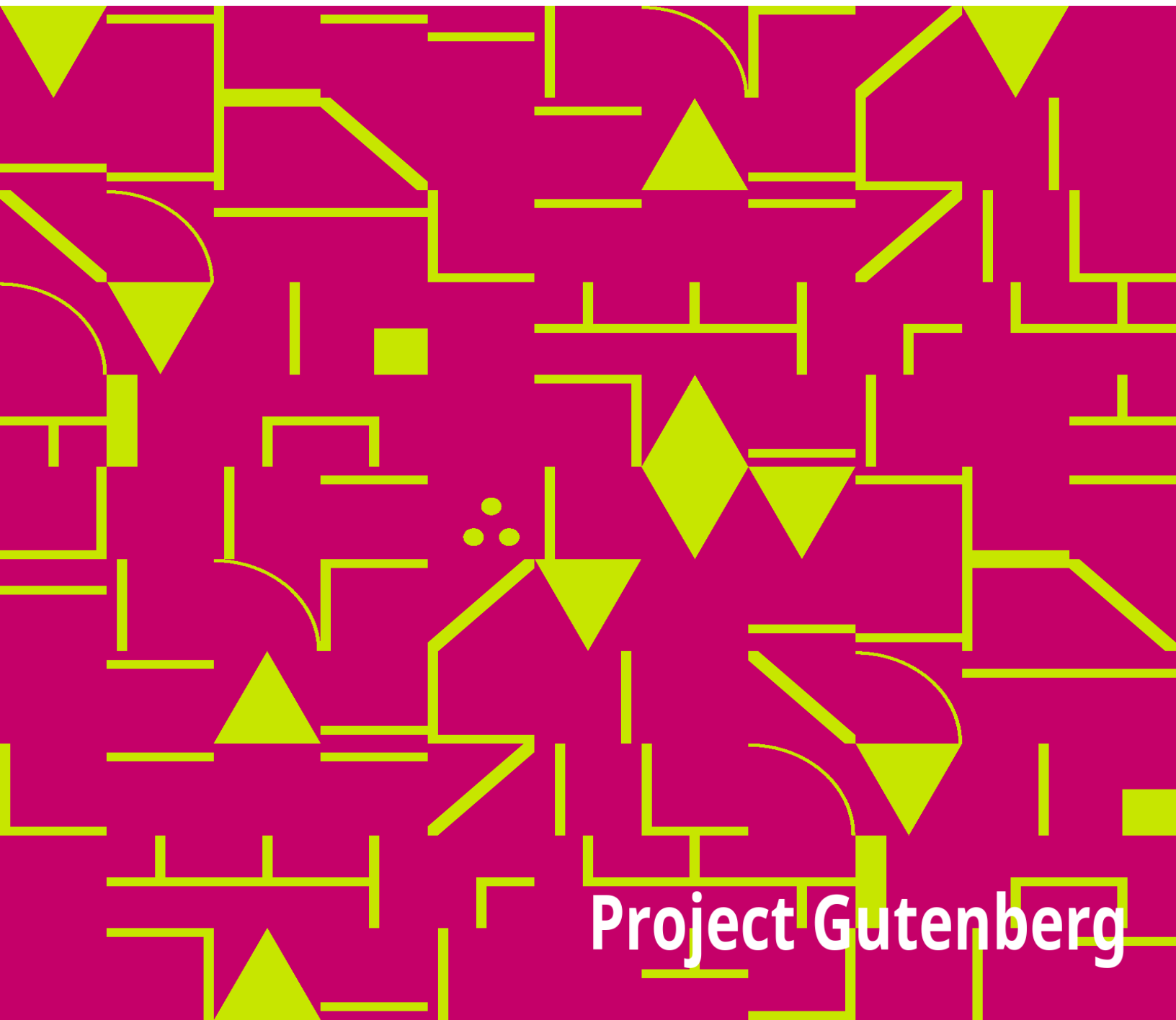


Selections from Early Middle English, 1130-1250. Part 1: Texts

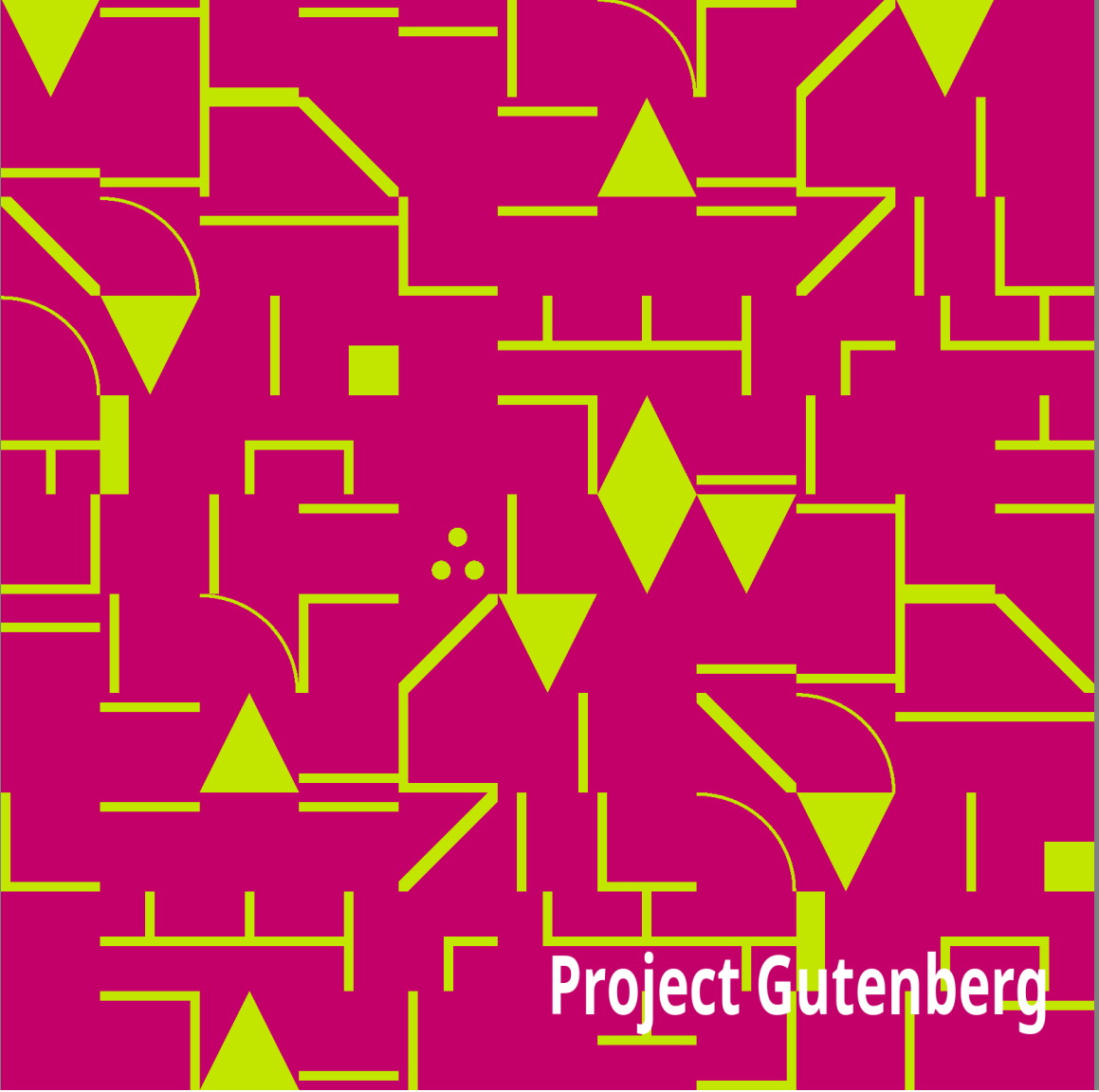
Joseph Hall

An abstract geometric pattern consisting of various yellow shapes (triangles, squares, rectangles, lines, and arcs) scattered across a solid magenta background.

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Selections from Early Middle English, 1130-1250. Part 1: Texts

Joseph Hall

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FROM EARLY MIDDLE ENGLISH, 1130-1250. PART 1: TEXTS *****

This e-text includes characters that will only display in UTF-8 (Unicode) file encoding, including but not limited to:

ȝ, ȝ (yogh)
⁊ (Tironian ampersand)

þ (thorn with stroke—also see below)
ȝ (e with tail, “e caudata”)
ȝ (y with over-dot)

All but the first three are rare, or occur only in notes.

If any of these characters do not display properly, or if the apostrophes and quotation marks in this paragraph appear as garbage, make sure your text browser’s “character set” or “file encoding” is set to Unicode (UTF-8). You may also need to change your browser’s default font.

The inverted semicolon  is represented as an oversized semicolon ;. A half-width space—shown here in red— | was used in some selections to separate a main word from its prefix. It may not display accurately in all browsers. Note that because of font availability, “thorn with stroke” is shown as separate characters, þ or Þ with combining -. If your browser can display the single-character forms Þ and þ (hex A764 and A765), and you are comfortable editing html files, feel free to replace them globally.

A few selections use additional, very unusual letters that will be explained as they appear.

The Notes were published in a separate volume, in preparation at the time this e-text was produced (August 2008). For each selection, the paragraph describing the MSS. has been summarized from these Notes; additions or omissions shown by ellipses or brackets according to the usual rules for academic quotation.

Errors are marked with mouse-hover popups. Further details about the format of this e-text and the original book, including handling of parallel texts, are at the [end of the e-text](#).

SELECTIONS FROM EARLY MIDDLE ENGLISH 1130-1250

EDITED WITH INTRODUCTIONS AND NOTES

BY

JOSEPH HALL

M.A., HON. D.LITT., Durham University

PART I: TEXTS

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PREFACE

SOME of the texts in this book have already appeared in the *Specimens of Early English* edited by the Rev. Richard Morris. But Nos. i, ii, iv, vii, xiii and xv are new, the important shorter pieces, Nos. vi, viii, xvi, xviii, xxi and xxiii, are printed in full, and some, as Nos. viii and ix, are taken from additional or better manuscripts. The pieces are arranged tentatively in what appears to be the chronological order of their composition, but Nos. xix and xvii should have come before the *Ancrene Wisse*, and No. vii has been placed next to the *Proverbs of Alfred*, from which it appears to be derived. It is hoped that those who study the older book will find in the present one a useful supplement.

The texts follow the manuscripts in all details. The syntax being comparatively simple, there is not much to be gained by modern punctuation, and that of the manuscripts has gained a fresh importance from theories which have been founded upon it. Where obvious mistakes have been corrected in the text, notice is always given in the footnotes. Additions are made within square brackets, and interlineations are printed between accents.

My best thanks are due to the custodians of the libraries for the facilities which with uniform kindness they extended to me in the collation of the manuscripts.

J. H.

WOODSTOCK,
January, 1920.

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CORRIGENDA

The listed corrections have been made in the text and marked with mouse-hover popups like this.

1/17	[nu beoþ]
2/30	[fei]ʒe
11/1	þurh MS kurh
12/15	alisendnesse
14/58	filio
17/162	descendi
83/32	For <i>viam pro</i> read <i>vestimenta prosternebant</i>
85/79	secla
87/161	Omit words in brackets at beginning of line
150/16	þat
152/57	wit
154/104	bysemar
160/183	nyht
160/185	vych
160/191	quaþ
166/289	In footnote, Ðule
167/289	<u>In footnote, Ðule</u>
167/310	eue
168/336	Murehþe ilyche
168/339	holy
221/248	iheed <i>for</i> ihee[r]d

I. WORCESTER FRAGMENTS

“Worcester Cathedral Library, 174.... Its contents are ... (2) the scrap here marked A; (3) the pieces B and C with five more fragments of the same poem. A completes the page on which the glossary ends, and B is on the verso of the leaf. The leaves have been slightly shorn at one side and reduced at top and bottom, but probably to no great extent: the conjectural complement, which is here printed within square brackets, is for the most part fairly obvious, the more so as portions of the lost letters often remain. The whole MS. is in the same large square hand, but the pieces in verse, which are written continuously, like prose, are less carefully executed. The handwriting is of the second half of the twelfth century, perhaps about 1180 A.D. The Latin headings are not in the MS.”

A. SICUT OUES ABSQUE PASTORE

[S]anctus beda was iboren her on breotene mid us ·

7 he wisliche [writen] awende

2. *writen*] [*bec*]

þ þeo englisc leoden þurh weren ilerde ·

Varnhagen.

7 he þeo c[not]ten unwreih · þe questiuns hoteþ ·

3. *englisc*] *englise*
MS.

5 þa derne dizelnesse · þe de[or]wurpe is ·

ælfric abbod þe we alquin hoteþ ·

he was bocare · 7 þe [fif] bec wende ·

7. [*fif*] V.

Genesis · Exodus · Vtronomius · Numerus · Leuiticus

.

þ[urh] þeos weren ilærde ure leoden · on englisc ·

10 þet weren þeos biscop[es þeo] bodeden cristendom

wilfrid of Ripum · Johan of beoferlai · Cupb[ert] of

11. *Ripum*] *Sipum*
MS.

Dunholme · Oswald of wireceastre · Egwin of heoueshame

· æl[dhelm] of malmesburi · Swiþþun · æpelwold · Aidan ·

13. *Paulin*]
[*Cwiche*] *lm* Wright.

Biern of wincæstre · [Pau]lin of rofecæstre · S. Dunston · 7

S. ælfeih of cantore · buri ·

15 þeos læ[rden] ure leodan on englisc ·

næs deorc heore liht · ac hit fæire glod ·

[nu is] þeo leore forleten · 7 þet folc is forloren ·

[nu beoþ] oþre leoden · þeo læ[reþ] ure folc ·

7 feole of þen lorþeines losiaþ · 7 þ-folc forþmid

20 Nu sæiþ [ure] drihten þus · Sicut aquila prouocat

pullos suos ad uolandum · 7 super eo[s] uolitat ·]

þis beoþ godes word to worlde asende ·
þ we sceolen fæier feþ [festen to him] ·

22. *þis] þus V.*

B. HOMO PUTREDO ET FILIUS HOMINIS VERMIS

en earde ·
7 alle þeo isceæftan · þe him to [s]cu[l]en ·
7 mid muchele cre[fte · þe]ne mon he idihte ·
7 him on ileide · lif 7 soule ·
5 Softliche he heo isom[nede] · ac þær biþ sor idol ·
þ bodeþ þ bearn : þonne hit iboren biþ ·
hit [woan]eþ 7 mænet þeo weowe ·
7 þene seoruhfule siþ · 7 þ sori idol ·
þ soule schal [7 li]came · sorliche idælen ·
10 forþon hit cumeþ weopinde · 7 woniende iwiteþ ·
[swo D]eaþ mid his pricke · pineþ þene licame ·
he walkeþ 7 wendeþ 7 woneþ [oftes]iþes ·
he sæiþ on his bedde · wo me þ ic libbe ·
þ æffre mine lif dawes · þus [lon]ge me ilesteþ ·
15 for heui is his greoning · 7 seorhful is his woaning ·
7 al [biþ] his siþ · mid seorwe biwunden ·
him deaueþ þa æren : him dimmeþ [þa] iþen ·
him scerpeþ þe neose · him scrinckeþ þa lippen ·
him scorteþ [þe] tunge · [him starkeþ his skin ·]
20 him trukeþ his iwit · him teoreþ his miht ·
him coldeþ his [siden ·] liggeþ þe ban stille ·
þonne biþ þ soulehus · seoruhliche bereaued ·
[at] also muchele wunne · þe þerinne wunede ·
þus biþ þæs bearnes · [bod]unge ifulled ·
25 þeo moder greoneþ · 7 þ bearn woaneþ ·
So biþ þeo [bu]rðtid · mid ba`le`wen imenged ·
so biþ eft þe feorþsiþ · Mid seoruwen al bewunden ·
þonne þe licame 7 þe sowle · soriliche to[dæl]eþ :
þonne biþ þ wræcche lif · iended al mid sori siþ ·
30 þonne biþ þe [fei]ze · iflut to þen flore ·

3. *[þe]ne Buchholz.
[þon]ne Haufe.*

7. *hit [greoneþ ond
woan]eþ B.*

9. *[7 li]came H.
[hire li]came
Singer.*

11. *[D]eaþ H., B.
[thonne D]eath S.*

13. *wome MS.*

19. *[him ... skin] no
gap in MS.*

21. *þe ban] perhaps
he stan.*

23. *[at] B., [of] H.*

27. In MS. the
second half of this
line is *sorhliche to
dæl...* copied by
mistake from the
next line.

he biþ eastward istreihþ · he biþ sone stif ·	30. [fei]ge Zupitza,
he [col]deþ also clei · hit is him ikunde ·	[bodi]ge S.
Mon hine met mid one 3erde · 7 þa mol[de] seopþen ·	32. [col]deþ Z.,
ne mot he of þære molde · habben nammore ·	[hear]deth S.
35 þonne þ-rihte imet · [rih]tliche tæcheþ ·	
þonne liþ þe clei clot · colde on þen flore ·	
7 him sone from [fleop] · þeo he ær freome dude ·	
nulleþ heo mid honden · his heafod riht wen[den] ·	
heom þuncheþ þ-hore honden · swuþe beoþ ifuled ·	
40 Gif heo hondleþ þe[ne d]eade · seopþen his deazes beoþ igon ·	
sone cumeþ þ-wrecche wif · þe [forh]oweþ þene	41. The last half of
earfeþ siþ ·	this line is due to
forbindeþ þæs dædan muþ · 7 his dimme e3en ·	l. 43.
[þon]ne þet riche wif · forhoweþ þene earueþ siþ ·	43. [þonne] H.
for ufel is þeo wrecche lufe · [þari]nne þeo unblisse	[Ec] B.
cumaþ ·	44. þarinne]
45 þonne besihþ þeo soule · sorliche to þen lich[ame ·]	[þon]ne S., [In]ne
	H., B.

C. CONFABULABOR CUM AMARITUDINE ANIMAE MEAE

[	]	þu me · þeo hwule þet ic wunede inne þe ·	
for þu were leas 7 lutiz · 7 u[n]riht lufedest ·			
Godnesse 7 riht · æfre þu onscunedest ·			
hwar is nu þe[o mo]dinesse · swo muchel þe þu lufedæst ·			
5 hwar beoþ nu þeo pundes · þurh [pa]newes igædered	5. [pa]newes		
.	Holthausen.		
heo weren monifolde · bi markes itolde ·			
hwar beoþ [nu] þeo Goldfæten · þeo þe Guldene ·	7. þe] e in darker		
comen to þine honden ·	ink.		
þin blisse is [nu] al agon · min seoruwe is fornnon ·			
hwar beoþ nu þine wæde · þe þ[u] wel lufedest ·			
10 hwar beoþ [sibbe ·] þe seten sori ofer þe ·	10. [sibbe] no gap		
beden swuþe 3eorne · [þet] þe come bote ·	in MS.		
heom þuþte alto longe · þ-þu were on liue ·			
for heo [we]ren grædie · to gripen þine æihþe ·			

nu heo hi dæleþ heom imong · [heo] doþ þe wiþuten ·
 15 ac nu heo beoþ fuse · to bringen þe ut of huse,
 b[rin]gen þe ut æt þire dure · of weolen þu ært bedæled ·
 hwui noldest þ[u be]þenchen me · þeo hwile ic was innen þe ·
 ac semdest me mid sunne · fo[rþon] ic seoruhful eam · 18. *semdest]*
 weile þ-ic souhte · so seoruhfulne · buc · *scendest S.*
 20 noldest þ[u lo]kien lufe · wiþ ilærede men · 20. *[lo]kien S.,*
 3iuen ham of þine Gode · þ-heo þe fo[re] beden · *[ma]kien H., [þe*
 heo mihten mid salm songe · þine sunne acwenchen · *ma]kien B.*
 Mid [ho]re messe · þine misdeden fore biddan ·
 heo mihten offrian loc · leofli[che] for þe · 24. *leofli[c] B.*
 25 swuþe deor wurþe lac · licame cristes ·
 þurh þæne þu were · alese[d] from hellewite · 26. *þæne Z., in MS.*
 7 mid his reade blode · þ-he 3eat on rode · *þære.*
 þo þu we[re] ifreoed to farene into heouene ·
 ac þu fenge to þeowdome · þurh þæs de[ofles] lore ·
 30 Bi þe hit is iseid · 7 soþ hit is on boken ·
 Qui custodit diuitias ser[uus] est diuitiis
 þu were þeow · þines weolan ·
 noldest þu nouht þærof d[ælen ·] for drihtenes willæn ·
 ac æfre þu grædiliche · gæderedest þe more ·
 35 lu[þer]liche eart þu forloren · from al þ-þu lufedest ·
 7 ic scal wræcche soule [· weo]we nu driæn · 36. *[weo]we H.,*
 eart þu nu loþ 7 unwurþ · alle þine freonden · *[ece] we S.*
 nu ham [þun]cheþ alto long · þ-þu ham neih list · 38. *nu ham] nu han*
 ær þu beo ibrouht · þær þu be[on] scalt · *MS.*
 40 on deope sæþe · on durelease huse ·
 þær wurmes wældeþ · al [þet þe] wurþest was ·
 fūweles quale holde · þe þu icwemdest ær ·
 Mid alre [þære] swetnesse · þeo þu swuþe lufedest · 43. *þære] [kunde]*
 þeo swetnesse is nu al agon · þ-b[ittere] þe biþ fornnon · *S., H., B.*
 45 þ-bittere ilæsteþ æffre · þ-swete ne cumeþ þe [næffre ·]

II. SAINT GODRIC'S HYMNS

"Royal 5 F vii, British Museum ... apparently an inserted leaf. This leaf ... belongs to the beginning of the thirteenth century...."

A

S ainte marie uirgine
moder ihesu cristes nazarene
onfo schild help þin godric ·
onfang bring hezilich wið þe in godes riche ·

3. Over *onfo*,
onfong in later
hand.

4. *wið*] *w* corr. out
of *p*.

S 5 ainte marie xpistes bur
maidenes clenhad moderes flur ·
dilie min sinne rix in min mod ·
bring me `to´ winne wið þe selfd God.

6. *maidenes*] *id*
corr. out of *rd*.

B

Crist and sainte marie swa on scamel me iledde
10 þat ic on þis erðe ne silde wid mine bare fote i tredie ·

C

S ainte Nicholaes godes druð ·
tymbre us faire scone hus ·
At þi burth at þi bare.
Sainte nicholaes, bring vs wel þare.

III. THE PETERBOROUGH CHRONICLE

"Laud Misc. 636, Bodleian Library (MS. E).... A new hand begins with 1132 and continues to the end in 1155 A.D."

f. 88 v]

M·C·XXXII.

Ðis gear com henri king to þis land. þa com henri abbot 7 uureide þe muneces of burch to þe king forþi ð he uuolde underþeden ð mynstre to clunie. sua ð te king was wel neh be paht. 7 sende efter þe muneces. 7 þur`h´ godes milce 7 þur`h´ þe *biscop* of Seresberi 7 te *biscop* of lincol 7 te oþre ricemen þe 5 þer wæron þa wiste þe king ð he feorde mid suicdom. Ða he nan mor ne mihte. þa uuolde he ð his nefe sculde ben abbot in burch. oc xpist it ne uuolde. Was it noht suite lang þerefter þatte king sende efter him. 7 dide him gyuen up ð abbotrice of burch. 7 faren ut of lande. 7 te king iaf ð abbotrice an prior of S' neod Martin was 10 gehaten. he com on S' petres messedei mid micel wurscipe into the minstre.

M·C·XXXV.

On þis gære for se king henri ouer sæ æt te lammasse. 7 ð oþer dei þa he lai an slep in scip. þa þestrede þe dæi ouer al landes 7 uuard þe sunne suilc als it 15 uuare thre niht ald mone. an sterres abuten him at middæi. Wur`þ´en men suiðe ofuundred 7 ofdred 7 sæden ð micel þing sculde cumen herefter. sua dide. for þat ilc gær warth þe king ded. ð oþer dæi efter S' Andreas massedæi · on *normandi*. Ða wes treson a þas landes. for æuricman sone ræuede oþer þe mihte. 20 Ða namen his sune 7 his frend 7 brohten his lic to *englelande* 7 bebiriend in Redinge. Godman he wes 7 micel æie wes of him. durste nanman misdon wið oðer on his time. Pais he madeðe men 7 dær. Wuasua bare his byrthen gold 7 sylure. durste nan man sei to him naht bute god. 25

20. þa wes treson a Emerson, in MS. þa westre sona.

Enmang þis was his nefe cumen to *englelande* Stephne de blais. 7 com to lundene. 7 te lundenisce folc him underfeng. 7 senden efter þe ærcebiscop *Willelm* curbuil. 7 halechede him to kinge on midewintre dæi. On þis kinges time wes al unfrið 7 yfel 7 ræflac. for agenes him risen sona þa ricemen þe wæron swikes. alre fyrst Balduin 30 de Reduers 7 held Execestre agenes him. 7 te king it besæt. 7 siððan Balduin acordede. Ða tocan þa oðre 7 helden her castles agenes him. 7 dauid king of scotland toc to uuerrien him · þa þohuuethere þat here sandes feorden betwyx heom. 7 hi togædere comen 7 wurðe sæhte. þop it litel forstode. 35

M·C·XXX·VII. **Ð**is gære for þe `king' Stephne ofer sæ to normandi 7
ther wes underfangen forþi ð hi uuenden ð he
sculde ben alsuic alse the eom wes. 7 for he hadde get his tresor. ac he
todeld it 7 scatered sotlice. Micel hadde henri king gadered gold 7
syluer. 7 na god ne dide me for his saule tharof. 40

Þa `þe' king Stephne to englalande com þa
macod he his gadering æt Oxeneford. 7 þar he
nam þe biscop Roger of Sereberi 7 Alexander
biscop of lincol 7 te canceler Roger hise neues. 7
dide ælle in prisun. til hi iafen up here castles. Þa
the suikes undergæton ð he milde man was 7
softe 7 god. 7 na iustise ne dide. þa dide`n' hi alle 45 wunder. Hi
hadden him manred maked 7 athes suoren. ac hi nan treuthe ne
heolden. alle he wæron forsworen and here treotthes forloren. for æuric
riceman his castles makede 7 agænes him heolden. 7 fyl登en þe land ful
of castles. Hi suencten suyðe þe uureccemen of þe land mid castel
weorces. þa þe castles uuaren 50 maked þa fyl登en hi mid deoules 7
yuelemen. Þa namen hi þa men þe hi wenden ð ani god hefde`n'. bathe
be nihtes. 7 be dæies. carlmen 7 wimmen. 7 diden heom `in prisun'
after gold 7 syluer. 7 pined heom; untellendlice pining. for ne uuæren
nære nan martyrs swa pined alse hi wæron. Me henged up bi the fet 7
smoked heom · mid 55 ful smoke. Me henged bi the pumbes other bi
the hefed. 7 hengen bryniges on `her' fet. Me dide cnotted strenges
abuton here [f. 89 v] hæued. 7 uurythen to ð it gæde to þe `h'ærnes. Hi
diden heom in quarterne þar nadres 7 snakes 7 pades wæron inne. 7
drapen heom swa. Sume hi diden in crucethus ð is in an ceste þat was
scort 7 nareu. 7 60 undep. 7 dide scærpe stanes þerinne. 7 þrengde þe
man þærinne. ð him bræcon alle þe limes. In mani of þe castles wæron
lof 7 grim. ð wæron rachenteges ð twa oþer thre men hadden onoh to
bæron onne. þat was sua maced. ð is fæstned to an beom. 7 diden an
scærp iren abuton þa mannes throte 7 his hals. ð he `ne' myhte
nowiderwardes. 65 ne sitten ne lien ne slepen. oc bæron al ð iren. Mani
þusen hi drapen mid hungær. J ne can ne i ne mai tellen alle þe wunder
ne alle þe pines ð hi diden wreccemen on þis land. 7 ð lastede þa ·xix·
wintre wile Stephne was king 7 æure it was uuerse 7 uuerse. Hi læiden

41. *Þa*] no paragraph in MS.

46. After *maked* erasure of two letters.

56. After *pumbes*, 7 deleted.

gæildes o`n` the tunes æure umwile 7 clepeden it tenserie. þa 70 þe
 uureccemen ne hadden nan more to gyuen. þa ræueden hi 7 brendon
 alle the tunes. ð wel þu myhtes faren al a dæis fare sculdest thu neure
 finden man in tune sittende. ne land tiled. Ða was corn dære. 7 flec 7
 cæse 7 butere. for nan ne wæs o þe land. Wrecce men sturuen of
 hungær. sume ieden on ælmes þe waren sum wile 75 ricemen. sume
 flugen ut of lande. Wes næure gæt mare wre`c`ched on land. ne næure
 hethen men werse ne diden þan hi diden. For ouersithon ne forbaren
 `hi` nouthen circe ne cyrceiærd. oc namen al þe god ð þarinne was. 7
 brenden sythen þe cyrce 7 alte gædere. Ne hi ne forbaren *biscop*es land
 ne abbotes ne preostes. ac ræueden 80 muneke 7
 clerekes. 7 æuricman oðer þe ouer myhte. Gif
 twa men oþer ·iii· coman ridend to an tun. al þe
 tunscepe flugæn for heom. wenden ð hi wæron
 ræueres. Ðe *biscop*es 7 leredmen heom cursede
 æure. oc was heom naht þarof. for hi uueron al
 forcursæd 7 forsuoren 7 forloren. War sæ me tilede. þe erthe ne bar
 nan corn. for þe land 85 was al fordon. mid suilce dædes. 7 hi sæden
 openlice ð xpist slep. 7 his halechen. Suilc 7 mare þanne we cunnen
 sæin. we þolenden xix· wintre for ure sinnes. [f. 90 r] On al þis yuele
 time heold Martin abbot his abbotrice ·xx· wintre 7 half gær 7 viii·
 dæis. mid micel suinc. 7 fand þe muneke 7 te gestes al þat heom be
 houed 7 heold mycel 90 carited in the hus. 7 þopwethere wrohte on þe
 circe 7 sette þarto landes 7 rentes. 7 goded it suythe. 7 læt it refen 7
 brohte heom into þe neuuæ mynstre on S' PETRES mæsse dæi mid micel
 wurtscepe. ð was · anno ab incarnatione domini · M·c·xl. a
 combustione loci ·xxiii· 7 he for `to` Rome. 7 þær wæs wæl under
 fangen fram þe pape 95 Eugenie. 7 begæt thare priuilegies. an of alle
 þe landes of þabbotrice. 7 an oþer of þe landes þe lien to þe
 circewican. 7 gif he leng *moste* liuen also he mint to don of þe
 horderwycan. And he begæt in landes þat ricemen hefden mid
strengthe. Of Willelm malduit þe heold Rogingham þæ castel. he wan
 Cotingham 7 Estun. 7 Of hugo of 100 Walteuile he uuan hyrtlingberi · 7
 Stanewig. 7 lx · sol. of Aldewingle `ælc gær`. And he makede manie
 muneke 7 plantede winiærd. 7 makede mani weorkes. 7 wende þe tun

81. *þe ouer*] *þeouer*
MS.

97. After *moste*, also
erased.

99. *strengthe* corrected
out of *strengthre*.

betere þan it ær waes. 7 waes god munec 7 god man. 7 forþi him
luueden god 7 gode men. 105

Nu we willen sægen sumdel wat belamp on Stephnes kinges time. On
his time þe iudeus of Noruic bohton an xpisten cild be foren estren 7
pineden him alle þe ilce pining ð ure drihten was pined. 7 on
langfridæi him on rode hengen for ure drihtines luue. 7 sythen
byrieden him. wenden ð it sculde ben forholen. oc ure dryhtin 110
atywede ð he was hali martyr. 7 to muneke him namen. 7 bebyried
him hegllice in þe minstre. 7 he maket þur[h] ure drihtin wunderlice 7
manifældlice miracles. 7 hatte he S' Willelm.

M·C·XXXVI^{II}. **O**n þis gær com dauid king of Scotland mid ormete
færd to þis land. wolde winnan þis land. 115 7 him
com togænes Willelm eorl of Albamar þe þe king adde beteht euorwic
7 to other æuez men mid fæumen 7 fuhten wid heom. 7 flemden þe
king æt te Standard. 7 sloghen suite micel of his genge. [f. 90 v]

M·C·XL. **O**n þis gær wolde þe king Stephne tæcen Rodbert eorl 120
of gloucestre þe kinges sune · Henries. ac he ne myhte
for he wart it war. Þerefter in þe lengten þestrede þe sunne 7 te dæi.
abuton non tid dæies. þa men eten. ð me lihtede candles to æten bi. 7
þat was ·xiii· kalend. April'. wæron men suythe of wundred. Þerefter
fordfeorde Willelm ærcebiscop of cantwarberi. 125 7 te king made
Teodbald ærcebiscop þe was abbot in the bec. Þer efter wæx suythe
micel uerre betuyx þe king 7 Randolf eorl of cæstre noht forþi ð he
ne iaf him al ð he cuthe axen him. also he dide alle othre. oc æfre þe
mare he iaf heom. þe wæse hi wæron him. Þe eorl heold lincol agænes
þe king. 7 benam him al ð he 130 ahte to hauen. 7 te king for þider 7
besætte him 7 his brother Willelm de R[om]are in þe castel. 7 te æorl
stæl ut 7 ferde efter Rodbert eorl of gloucestre. 7 brohte him þider mid
micel ferd. 7 fuhten suythe on Candel masse dæi agenes heore lauerd.
7 namen him for his men [h]im suyken 7 flugæn. 7 læd him to
Bristowe 7 135 diden þar in prisun 7 [fe]teres. þa
was al engleland styred mar þan ær wæs. 7 al
yuel wæ[s i]n lande. Þerefter com þe kinges
dohter henries þe hefde ben emperi[ce] i[n A]lmanie. 7 nu wæs

135-45. MS. rubbed
here.

cuntesse in Angou. 7 com to lundene 7 te lundenissce folc hire wolde
 tæcen. 7 scæ fleh 7 forles þar mic[el.] Ðer efter þe biscop of Wincestre
 henri 140 þe kinges brother Stephnes spac wid Rodbert eorl 7 wyd
 þemperice 7 suor heom athas ð he neure ma mid te king his brother
 wolde halden. 7 cursede alle þe men þe mid h[im] heoldon. 7 sæde
 heom ð he uuolde íuen heom up Wincestre. 7 dide heom cumen þider.
 Ða hi þær inne wæren. þa com þe kinges cuen [mid al]hire strengthe.
 145 7 besæt heom. ð þer wæs inne micel hungær. Ða hi ne leng ne
 muhten þolen þa stali hi ut 7 flugen. 7 hi wurthen war widuten 7
 folecheden heom. 7 namen Rodbert eorl of gloucestre. 7 ledden him to
 Rouecestre. 7 diden him þare in prisun. 7 te emperice fleh into an
 minstre. [f. 91 r] Ða feorden þe wisemen betwyx þe kinges 150 freond 7
 te eorles freond 7 sahtlede sua ð me sculde leten ut þe king of prisun
 for þe eorl. 7 te eorl for þe king. 7 sua diden. Sithen þerefter sa`t
 `hleden þe king 7 Randolf eorl at Stanford. 7 athes suoren 7 treuthes
 fæston ð her nouper sculde besuiken other. 7 it ne forstod naht. for þe
 king him sithen nam in hamtun. þurhc wicci 155 ræd. 7 dide him in
 prisun. 7 efsones he let him ut þurhc wærese red. to ð forewarde ð he
 suor on halidom 7 gysles fand. þat he alle his castles sculde íuen up.
 Sume he iaf up 7 sume ne iaf he noht. 7 dide þanne wærese þanne he
 hær sculde. Ða was engleland suythe todeled. sume helden mid te king.
 7 sume mid þemperice. for þa þe 160 king was in prisun þa wenden þe
 eorles 7 te ricemen þat he neure mare sculde cumen ut. 7 sæh`t`leden
 wyd þemperice. 7 brohten hire into Oxenford. 7 iauen hire þe burch.
 Ða þe king was ute þa herde ð sægen. 7 toc his feord 7 besæt hire in þe
 tur. 7 me læt hire dun on niht of þe tur mid rapes. 7 stal ut. 7 scæ fleh 7
 iæde on fote to 165 Walingford. Ðær efter scæ ferde ouer sæ. 7 hi of
 normandi wenden alle fra þe king. to þe eorl of Angæu. sume here
 þankes 7 sume here unþankes. for he besæt heom til hi aiauen up here
 castles. 7 hi nan helpe ne hæfden of þe kinge. Ða ferde Eustace þe
 kinges sune to france 7 nam þe kinges suster of france to wife. wende
 to bigæton 170 normandi þær þurh. oc he spedde litel. 7 be gode rihte
 for he was an yuel man. for ware se he [com he]
 dide mare yuel þanne god. he reuede þe landes 7
 læide mic[ele gilde]s on. He brohte his wif to
 engleland. 7 dide hire in þe caste[l of Can]teberi. God wimman scæ

172. MS. mutilated
 here.

wæs. oc scæ hedde litel blisse mid him. 7 xpist ne wolde ð he sculde
 175 lange rixan. 7 wærd ded 7 his moder beien. 7 te eorl of Angæu
 wærd ded. 7 his sune henri toc to þe rice. 7 te Cuen of france todælde
 fra þe king. 7 scæ com to þe iunge eorl henri. 7 he toc hire to wiue. 7 al
 [f. 91 v] peitou mid hire. Ða ferde he mid micel færd into engle[la]nd.
 7 wan castles. 7 te king ferde agenes him mid 180 micel mare ferd. 7
 þopwæthere fuhtten hi noht. oc ferden þe ærcebiscop 7 te wise me`n`
 betwux heom. 7 makede ð sahte ð te king sculde ben lauerd 7 king wile
 he liuede. 7 æfter his dæi ware henri king. 7 he held`e` him for fader 7
 he him for sune. 7 sib 7 sæhte sculde ben betwyx heom. 7 on al
 engleland. Ðis 7 te othre foruuardes 185 þet hi makeden. suoren to
 halden þe king 7 te eorl 7 te biscopes & te eorles 7 ricemen alle. Ða
 was þe eorl underfangen æt Wincestre 7 æt lundene mid micel
 wurtscipe. 7 alle diden him manred. 7 suoren þe pais to halden. 7 hit
 ward sone suythe god pais. sua ð neure was here. Ða was þe king
 strengere þanne he æuert her was. 7 te eorl 190 ferde ouer sæ. 7 al folc
 him luuede for he dide god iustise 7 makede pais.

M·C·LIIII. **O**n þis gær wærd þe king Stephne ded 7 bebyried þer his
 wif `7 his sune` wæron bebyried æt fauresfeld. þæt
 minstre hi makeden. Ða þe king was ded. þa was þe eorl 195 beionde
 sæ. 7 ne durste nan man don oþer bute god for þe micel eie of him. þa
 he to engleland com. þa was he underfangen mid micel wurtscipe. and
 to king bletcæd in lundene on þe sunnen dæi beforen midwinter dæi. 7
 held þær micel curt.

Ðat ilce dæi þat Martin abbot of burch sculde
 þider faren. þa 200 sæclede he 7 ward ded ·iiii· Ñ.
 iañ. 7 te munekes innen dæis cusen oþer of heom
 sælf. Willelm de Walteuile is gehaten. god clerc
 7 god man. 7 wæl luued of þe kinge 7 of alle
 godemen. and o[n cyric]en byrieden þabbot hehlice 7 sone þe cosan
 abbot ferde 7 te muneces [mid him to] oxenforde to þe king [7 he] iaf
 him þat abbotrice. 7 he 205 ferde him son[e to linc]ol 7 was þ[ær
 bletcæd to] abbot ær he ham come. 7 [sithen] was under fangen [mid
 mic]el [wurtscipe at] burch. mid [mice]l processiu. 7 sua he was alsua
 at Ramesæie. 7 at Torney. 7 at . . n 7 Spallding 7 at S. l. bares. 7 . . . 7

203. MS. mutilated and
 defaced from this place
 onward.

204. *byrie*^d in MS.

[he nu is] abbot. 7 fa[ire] haued begunnon. xp[ist] him un[ne gode endinge]. 210

IV. CHARTER OF HENRY THE SECOND

“Harleian Charter III B. 49, British Museum.... The document is in a French record hand, and the writer was evidently little versed in the insular script. He uses both þ and th, p and w.”

H’ [b]urh godes 3efu ænglelandes king gret
ealle mine bissceopas 7 ealle mine eorlas 7
ealle mine scirereuan 7 ealle mine þeinas
frencisce 7 englisce · on þan sciran þe teobalt
ercebisceop 7 se hiret æt xpistes chyrchen on
Cantuarabir3 habbad land inne freondlice 7 ic
keþe eow þ-ic hebbe heom geunnon þ-hi beon
ælc þare lande wurþa 5 þe hi eafdon en Edwardes kinges de3e · 7 on
Willelmes kinges mines furþur ealdefader · 7 on Henrices kinges
mines ealdefader · 7 saca 7 Socne · on strande 7 on Streame. On
wudan · 7 on feldan · tolles 7 theames · grithbriches · 7 hamsocne · 7
forstalles · 7 infangenesthiefes · 7 fleamene frimtha · ofer heore agene
men · binnan Burgan 7 butan · 10 swa ful 7 swa ford swa mine agene
Wicneres hit sechan scolden · 7 ofer swa fele þeinas swa ich heom to
leten habban. And ic nelle þ-eniman enigþing þeron theo · butan hi 7
heara wicneras · þe hi hit bitechan · willað · ne frencisce ne englisce ·
for þan þingan þe ich habbe criste þas gerichtan forgifan minre Saule
to echere alisendnesse 7 ic 15 nelle gepauian þ-enigman þis abrece bi
minan fullen frencipian. God geau gehealde.

1. MS kurh
4. Cantuarabir3] last
letter 3 or g; the one
has been corrected out
of the other: so too in
de3e, l. 6.
14. þingan] þimgan
MS.

V. A PARABLE

"Cotton Vespasian A 22, British Museum. It is composite; a second MS., 224 × 153 mm. in two columns, begins at f. 54 with the pieces printed in OEH i. 217-45. It is written in a small and crabbed hand unlike that of a professed scribe. The use of the contraction marks is unsystematic and the readings are sometimes uncertain."

REX SUOS IUDICANS

[H]it 3elamp þan rice king wes. strang 7
 mihū. his `land' gélest wide 7 side. his folc was
 `swiðe' ærfeðtelle. his underþéoden 3éwer on his
 cynerice wuneden. Ða befel hit swa þan him a
 þance beféll · to under3eíte wá an alle his cyne
 rice him were frend oðer fend. hold oðer fá. 7 he
 nam him tó rede þheom wolde 5 3earceon anæ
 grate laðienge. 7 þider 3eclepíen all his
 underþéod. þhi bi éne féce to his curt `berie'
 come sceolde 7 sette ænne dé3ie. þhi alle be þe
 látst to þa de3`i`e. þer were. Ac þis 3esceod he
 hadde isétt bitweone frend 7 fend. þþan hi come
 mistlice to bérie. 3ef he frend wére. me hine
 sceolde derewrlice forðclepien. 7 do hine wasse.
 10 7 3iéfe him hís formemete. þhim to lang ne þuhte to abiden of se
 laford to þe none inn come. Gief he fend wére. me sceolden ánon eter
 gat 3emete mid gode repples 7 stiarne swépen. 7 stiarne híne besíe. 7
 binde him hand 7 fétt. 7 do hine into þiesternesse. 7 þer abide of all his
 3eferen were 3egadered. þhi alle clone. símlē 15 belócen were. Ða
 sende se king his ærndraches of fif ceðen to alle his underþeoden. to
 3elaðie þis folc. hwet bute ícome súm cófer sum láter`sum frend sum
 fend'. 7 was idon bí ham al swá ær cweðe [we] þisett was. Ða hit þer
 to com. þse hlaford into þar halle come. mid his dierewurð 3eferede.
 mid árlen 7 aldren. mid cn`i`hten 20 mid þeínen. þa cweð se hlafor to
 his. Æér þann we mid ure frienden toðe mete gó. scewie we þes
 uncoðe mæn ur 3efó. þa hi to for him cóme. þa wénte he hin to ham 7
 þus cweð. Un [f. 56 v²] wraste man wat lacede 3éu an alle míre rice þat

- 11. se] *fe* MS.
- 18. *sum ... fend* added on margin. Printed as shown in text, without leading space.
- 20. *dierewurð]* *dierewurd* MS.
- 7 *aldren* over an erasure.
- 21. *þeínen* over an erasure.
- 22. *scewie]* *scepie* MS.
- 28. *wiðinne]* *hit hī* MS.
- 29. 7 *þer ... sandon* added lengthwise on margin.

3íe hatrede 7 widerwardnesse a3énes me 3e win[ne] sceolde. 7 to mine
`fá' 3ebugon. Swá ibrúce ic mine 25 rice ne scule 3íe mine mete ibite.
ac scule þa þe hit mid mire lufe 3eardede. Ða þis was iségd. þa were
cofe abruden into þesternesse. þe hi sturfe hungre. 7 se hlaford nam
wiðinne to is frenden 7 et 7 dranc 7 macede hine wel bliðe mid his `7
þer hi hadden brad 7 win. 7 vii. sandon'. 30

¶[N]u gode menn understandeð þis bispel. Ðes
king is ure hlaford almihti god þe is king ofer
alle kingen. 7 hlaford ofer alle hlafordé. S[t]rang
he his 7 michti. for he 3esceop alle þing of nahte.
7 na þing ne mázi ázenes his wille. ne him
wiðstande. forþan him séigd se wítí3e. Qu i
celorum contines tronos 7 c. þis.
hlaford `of mihte' 35 þe halst hefenen þrimsettles.
7 tó neowelnes`se' þe under eorðe is belocést.
·iii· prou. þe dunan þu a`wiðst' mid þina hand;

35. of mihte added on margin.

36. halst] MS. alste.

37. awiðst] the last six letters on margin. At beginning of following line hst eorðe belucst mid.

38. þan] MS. þ= þat.

44. his] he MS.

48. sielfe] sielfe MS.

50. chereð] cheteð MS.

he is íwiss mihti forþan þe non mihté nis buton fram him. His land is
all þes middenard. for he alle 3esceop. 7 all dihte wið ute swince. He
us is · king · 7 sceppend. 7 fader. 7 hlaford. King for he mid
rihtwisnesse 40 diht `man 7 engel god 7 euel'. sceppende. for he us
machede lichame 7 sawle ableow. feder for he us fett 7 scred. 7 forðteh
alse is cyldren. hlaford forþan þe is 3éie 7 drednesse is ofer hus. 7 `þas'
áh to bienne. He is hure fader. he lenð us his eorðe tó tolie. his corn to
sawe. his eorðe us werpð corn 7 westm. níatt. 7 dierchin. his loht
leóem 7 lif. 45 his wáter · drench 7 fiscýnn. his fér manifeald þenínge.
his sónne. mone. sterren. rien. dáw. wind. wude. `unitald fultume' al þ
we habbeð of þése feder we habbeð. of wam we alle 7 us sielfe habbeð.
Mú3e we ahct clepeien hine moder wene we. 3íe mu3e we. hwat deð si
moder hire bearn. formes[t] hi hit chereð 7 blissið be þe lichte. 7 50
seþe hi dieð under hire árme [f. 57 r¹] oðer hi`s' hafed heleð to don
him slepe. 7 reste. Ðis deð all 3íure drihte. he blisseð hus mid d3éies
licht. h[e] sweueð hus mid þiestre nicht. Gíet for an oðre þing god
3escop þa niht. He wat wel þ-maní3e men bieð sa ful of 3éscung. mihti
efre ísí. Ná 3ewóld ham selfe. to bigeten wrldlic échte. þer for 55 god
hafð 3escepe ham reste. súde `wile' hare`s' unþances. 3éiet he cweð a

wunder word to þar sawle bi þa witie ysaia*m*.
Numquid potest mulier obliuisci
infantem suum ut non misereatur
filio uteri sui. þis la líef mazíe wiman
forzeten his oge cild. þ-hi ne milsi. hire bárn of
hire ogen innoð. 7 zief hi forziet þahhwéðer nell
íc 60 forzete þe cweð drihte. be þam þe he fader is 7 lafórd he him self
cweð be þe witie. Si ego pater ubi est honor meus. si
dominus ubi est tim`or` meus. þis. gif ic fader ham. wer
his mi manscipe. 3if ic. hlaford wer hís mine azéie? þerfore. G. m. ure
king. we o3eð wr`h`mint. hur sceappend al þat we bieð. ure fader soðe
lufe. ur h`l`aford 65 drednesse. 7 þis is séo king þe wile wíte an alle his
underþeode wá hine lufeð 7 hwa hine hateð. hwá him is frend oðer
fend. 7 þerfor he hað 3elaðed alle fol[c]. to ane d3éie. þis dome`s`
d3éie. þ-hi alle þer beon be þe latst. hwé seden ærst þ-þes ærndraces
wer isent of fif cheðen. swa ibeoð. þas fif cheðen beoð fif lágan. for
þan þe god is 70 þurh þesen 3ecnówé. Si forme lage þis si 3écénde
lage. þe god sett formest an þes mannes heorte. þis þat non man ne
don oðere. buton þ-þe he wolde þ-me ded[e] him. 7 don his nixtan al þ-
he wolde þ-me ded[e]him. Wiðute þeser láge ni`s` man þe 3escod
habbe. Ærndraces of þisser lage wer abel. Seth. enoc. Nóe. 7 swíce
gode 75 man. Seðe þes middenard was 3estabeled fram þa forme man
to þa latst þe wrð ét þes [f. 57 r²] wrldes ende. nas tid ne týme ne ne
wrð. þ-god ne send gode mænn his folc forte 3elaðie to his rice. Ac si
láge sóne adiligde. þurh unwreaste leahtrum 7 manifald sénne. Þerefter
arerde god þas lage þurh moýsen þe heretoche of his 80 folce þe he þa
3ecás. 7 wráte his him self in stanene waxbr`e`dene. 7 si 3eleste sume
wíle. 7 þerof were larþawes 7 3elaðieres Moises 7 aaron. 7 samuel. 7
fele oðre. Swa lange þ-si alswa swið[e] abreað. 7 adilizede. þurh
unhersamnesse. wat hit com to þa time þe god sende þe halie witíge. 7
hi þa arérdon mid hare wríte þurh þes halíe gastes 85 gífe `þa` god lage.
7 rihtleceden þ-folc swa se hi mihten. 7 bodeden ure`s` hlafordes to
cýme ses helendes ihesu cristes. þe sceolde his azén wille. þurh his
gastes 3ífe in ure heorte wríte. 7 don ús mid his mihte þ-stefcreft ne
mihte. 7 an þesser lá3e of þe wit3in. wer laðieres móche. Eft bine fece

56. hafð] hafð MS.

57. word] worder MS.

61. self cweð] selþ
cweð MS.

71. þesen] þ corr. out
of p.

7 þes lare 7 lage swiðe acoledede þurh manifea[l]d
90 sénne. 7 hur 7 hur þurh false gódes þe ælc
þiode ham selfe macéde. sume of golde. súm of
silure. of treowe. of stane. 7 awente godes lof 7
wrhminte fram þe sceappende to þare zesceafte.

89. *ne* corr. out of *na*.
90. *manifeald sénne*] *manifead fénne* MS.
98. *þurh*] *þurl* MS.
100. *ur*] *un* MS.

swa þ-þa ure halende wes accenned of þam unwemmede mede sante
Marie. al se middennard was mid senne begripe. 7 al fol`c` zede into
þe`s` diefles muðe. buton 95 wel feáwe of wam his lefe moder wes
istriened. he þa arerd alle godnisse. 7 sette his halíe láge. 7 þat þe móre
his. ziaf miht 7 strençþe þurh þe gief of his gaste his hesne to fulforðie.
þ-non oðre laze ne mihte. 7 understandeð hwu. Þri ampres were an
mancyn ær his to cyme. Ure acenneng wes ful. ur lif unwreast. ur deað
grislic. he 100 com 7 brochte þri þin[g] þer azén. he wes acénde of þe
clene mede. þe efer þurh lefede mede. hi`s` lif was halize. his deað ful
of milce. his clene acennende clénséde ure fule acennende. his hali lif
rihtlecede ure unwreaste lif. his admoded deað ofercom. 7 fordede ure
sorize 7 zelice deað. þís is [f. 57 v¹] si fierðe láge. An þisser were
ærndraces 7 105 zelaðieres þa apostles 7 þe leorninch[n]ihtes. þerefter
ures helendes upstíze to heuene. þa apostles 7 hare íunglenges þe[r]
efer come halíe men 7 þe hafedmen þe nu beoð in halíe cyrce. 7
wrðeð of domes déze. þurh þes hali gastes zífe. 7 alswa ure helende
ham leórde. maníze þing [t]ehten þa folce to freme. 7 þis is si fifte lage.
An þisser beoð bedeles 110 7 laðieres to berie archebiscopes. 7
biscopes. prestes. 7 hare zegeng. Ac þah we fif næmmíe. alle hi [beoð
an] on godes wille. 7 élc of ham zestrenð 7
fulfellþ oðre. Of þeses fif ceþen 7 of hare bedeles
we habbeð zéu zéséd. Of þe folce we siggeð þ-hit
cump fastlice. fram middenardes anginn alse fele
alse deade beoð alse fele beoð to berie ícóme.
wat frend. 115 wat fá. 7 elce dézíe þícce þringeð.

112. *hi*] *hit* MS.
118. *þan*] *þ*-MS.
oðre] *ooðre* MS.
121. *þan*] *þ*-MS.
witerlice] *witetlice* MS.
124. *þan*] *þ*-MS.

Ac zief zé habbeð understande þ-we zíu er séde. eter gate me his scýft.
7 þer me hi to zesceodeð. Si gate þ-is elces mannes endedeíe. þan he
stepð ut of þese life into þan oðre. Ac we sede zehw. þ-zief he frend
were me sceolde zief him his mórze mete þ-he þe bet mihte abide þann
more mete. Swa hit is here. 120 þan se gode man þe godes lufe hað

3éfolged to is ende cump. witerlice wiðut uúantruce þer cumeð þe hali
 engles him tó. 7 3éf hað ahte uniwasse oðer hit wrð 3ewasse iþer pine
 of þe deaðe þe he her þáleð. oðer efter mid eðelice lette. 7 þan lat me
 þa sawle to merchestowe. þ his se mor3emetete si blisse þe he hað an þar
 sawle. þat wite 3e wel. 125 nan halege nað his fulle blisse er he underfó
 adomes deíe his licame. þ wrð se fulle mete. þan se mann mid sawle 7
 mid licame under-fangð sicernesse of écer blisse. 7 wat belimpð hit
 3ief he fend his `þe´ to þare gate cump? God þurh his [f. 57 v²] mucele
 milce ne letes us nefer fandie. Ac napeles 3ief he fend his an unwreast
 mann þer beoð 130 anú 3eréd`i`e. þe weregede gastes þe hine uniredlice
 underfangeð mid stiarne swupen. Also fele
 unþeawes also hade upe him 7 sennenn. al swa
 fendes he þer 3emet. hīne to underfó. 7 to don
 hīne into þiesternesse. oft a domes d3éi alle
 godes fend simle fram his 3esecðe abroden bienn
 7 hi[n] to hare lean ham þe lange scel 3eleste.
 Þus hit hað íbí 7 135 is. 7 wrð oft domesdei. Ac
 þann hit þer to cump þ se hlaford á þe mucele
 deíe. cump forté ísí 7 frend 7 fend. þann cump all his underþiede him
 tofore. þer he sit mid his derewrþe 3efered mid nizen anglene had. mid
 þer unwēmmed meide his moder. mid his apostlen. mid þa
 hágefaderen. 7 þo halí3e wítien. mid martiren. mi[d] hali 140
 confessoren mid halie meiden. mid al þan þe þer midenarde for his lufe
 werpeð abéc. 7 lagelice her him þenið. wic 3eíe. wic drednesse wurð
 þer. þan þat fer to for him abernð þ middenard. þan si eorðe alle
 cwaceð þan þe sterren falleð. si sunne 7 se mone aþestreð for godes
 brictnesse. þe wlcne to gað. and si hali rode tacne mid þe 145 spere 7
 mid þe neiles þurh angles beoð forð ibrocht. þann þe angles cwaciað. 7
 tó richtwíse ham adredeð. wat sceol se senfulle don. þe isecgð þer his
 richtwise deme. þe non ne maíe bechece. non beswice. he his him self
 witnisse 7 deme. Wat sceol se wrecce don. þe bufon isé3ð his hlaford
 þe he 3egremed áfeð. under him helle muð open. 150 abuuten him all
 folc. him selfe bi s`c`a[n]dlice senne beswapen. þer ne mái non frend
 oðre helpe. ælc had innóh to donne an him selfe.
 Þan seieð ham god þe geltý mannen 3e

131. mid] min MS.
 140. þo corr. out of to |
 hali 3ewitien MS.
 143. þan] þ-MS.
 middenard] middernad
 MS. þan] þ-MS.
 144. cwaceð] cwaced
 MS.
 149. self] selþ MS.

153. seieð] seied MS.
 160. 3rod MS.
 162. þe] qþe MS.

senezeden. an 3eur écenisse. 7 3e scule [f. 58 r¹]

birne an mire écenisse. 3e senezden else lange

else 3é lefede 7 3e scule birne else longe as íc lefie. Witeð into éce fer.

þe is ¹⁵⁵ ʒ́ærced mine fó 7 his 3egen. Son[e] hi wrðeð abroden of his

3esecþe. 7 þan sone geð se hlaford mid his frenden to his mete. þ-his to

is esten. þe seið an þan hali write *Delicie méé sunt esse cum*

filiis hominum. þat is. Mine esten beoð wunian mid mannen

bearnen. Ac we sed[en] 3íu litl her þ-hi sceolden abben god brad 7 uin.

7 vii ¹⁶⁰ sonden. hi sculen habe þ-brad þeseið iþe godspel. *Ego sum*

panis uiuus qui de celo descendi. Þet is. Ic ám cwuce

bread þe astah fram hefene. se3ð ure helende. Se þe of þese brad ett. ne

sterfeð he nefer. Þis bread was ímaced of ane `h´wete corne. alswa se

he cweð 3eðe godspelle. *Nisi granum frumenti*. 7 c. þis corn

was 3esawen ¹⁶⁵ þurh þes ængles muð into ðes meidenes ære Marie. in

þare burh of nazareth. þis corn *cóm* fer`s´t inne bethléem. þ-cweð us of

breade. hit wex 7 bleówu. in iudea. hit rípede in ierusalem. Judas 7 þat

leoðre folc hit répén. 7 deden hit an þar rode alswa else betwene

melstanent. *Seðe* hit was idon into þer berient alswa into hófne. þanen

¹⁷⁰ hit was ibroht up into heofene to þes hahes hlafordes borde. þer hit

fet. 7 engles. 7 mancinn in écenisse. 7 þis is hare b`r`ead. hwer scule

we win finden? Al swa se he cweð. *Ego sum uitis uera*. 7 c.

167. *cóm*] *cón* MS.

170. *Seðe*] *sede* MS.

VI. THE PROVERBS OF ALFRED

“Jesus College, Oxford, E 29, formerly Arch. i. 29 (J)... written not long after 1276 (Anglia xxx, 222)... Our piece is written continuously as prose, each stanza forming a paragraph, but iv and v are in one without l. 54, which is here supplied, while l. 43 is written at the end of the preceding paragraph and similarly the lines beginning viii-xvii, xix-xxiii. The scribe was evidently struggling with an original which he could not always read; see [footnote to l. 105](#).

“... the copy of the [Poema Morale](#) in the same MS. has undergone a drastic revision which sets it apart among the versions of that poem, and the version of the [Owl and Nightingale](#) has suffered, though not to the same extent. On

the other hand MS. T was copied by a man who was incapable of remodelling it; though a ruin, it often preserves in details the original."

INCIPIUNT DOCUMENTA REGIS ALURED.

QUEÞ ALURED

AT Seuorde sête þeynes monye.
fele Biscopes. and feole. bok iléred.
Eorles prute. knyhtes egleche.
þar wes þe eorl Alurich.
5 of þare lawe swiþe wis.
And ek Ealured englene hurde.
Englene durlyng ;
on englene londe he wes kyng.
Heom he bigon lére.
10 so ye mawe ihure.
hw hi. heore lif lede scholden.
Alured. he wes in englene lond.
and king. wel swiþe strong.
He wes king. and he wes clerek.
15 wel he luuede godes werk.
He wes wis on his word. and war. on his werke.
he wes þe wysuste mon ;
þat wes englelonde on.

ii

Þvs queþ Alured englene frouer.
20 wolde ye mi leode. lusten éure louerde.
he óu wolde wyssye. wisliche þinges.
hw ye myhte worldes. wrþsipes welde.
and ek eure saule. somnen to criste.
wyse were þe wordes. þe seyde þe king Alured. |
Mildeliche ich Munye. myne leoue freond.

36. þe] wc MS.

26 poure and riche. leode myne
 þat ye alle adrede. vre dryhten crist.
 luuyen hine and lykyen. for he is louerd of lyf.
 He is one. god ; ouer alle godnesse.
 30 He is one gleaw. ouer alle glednesse.
 He is one. blisse. ouer alle blissen.
 He is one monne. Mildest mayster.
 He is one. folkes fader. and frouer.
 He is one. rihtwis. and so riche king.
 35 þat him ne schal beo wone. nouht of his wille.
 þe hine her on worlde. wrþie þencheþ.

iii

Ðvs queþ alured. englene urouer.
 Ne may non ryhtwis king. vnder criste seoluen.
 Bute if he beo in boke ilered.
 40 And he. his wyttes swiþe wel kunne.
 And he cunne lettres. lokie himseolf one.
 hw he schule his lond laweliche holde.

iv

Ðus queþ Alured.
 Ðe eorl and þe eþelyng.
 45 ibureþ vnder góðne. king.
 þat lond to leden.
 myd lawelyche deden.
 And þe clerek and þe knyht.
 he schulle démen euelyche riht.
 50 þe poure. and þe ryche.
 démen ilyche.
 Hwychso þe mon soweþ ;
 al swuch he schal mowe.

52. After *mon*,
 erasure of two
 letters.

And eueruyches monnes dom. to his owere dure churreþ.

v

[Þus queþ Alured.]

55 þan knyhte bihoueþ. kenliche on to fóne.
forto werie þat lond. wiþ hunger and wiþ herivnge.
þat þe chireche habbe gryþ.
And þe cheorl beo in fryþ.
his sedes to sowen.
60 his medes to mowen.
And his plouh beo idryue.
to vre alre bihoue.
þis is þes knyhtes lawe.
loke he þat hit wel fare.

vi

65 **Þ**us queþ Alured.
þe mon. þe on his youhþe. yeorne leorneþ.
wit and wisdom. and i writen reden ;
he may beon on elde. wenliche lorþeu.
And þe þat nule one youhþe yeorne leorný.
70 wit and wysdom. and i writen rede.
þat him schal on elde. sore rewe.
þenne cumeþ elde.
and vnhelþe.
þenne beoþ his wéne
75 ful wroþe isene.
Boþe heo beoþ biswike. and eke hi beoþ aswunde.

vii

þus queþ Alured.
Wyþvte wysdome is weole wel vnwurþ.

85. After *wismon*, *ut*
deleted.

for þey o mon ahte. huntseuenti Acres.
 80 and he hi hadde isowen. alle myd reade golde.
 And þ| gold greowe. so gres doþ on eorþe.
 nere he for his weole. neuer þe furþer.
 Bute he him of frumþe. freond iwrche.
 for. hwat is gold. bute ston.
 85 bute if hit haueþ wismon.

viii

þus queþ Alured.
 Ne scolde neuer yongmon howyen to swiþe.
 þeih him his wyse wel ne lykie.
 Ne þeih he ne welde. al þat he wolde.
 90 for god may. yeue god after vuele.
 weole after wowe. þenne he wule.
 wel is him þat hit ischapen is.

91. *þenne he wule*
 after *yeue* in l. 90.

ix

þus seyþ Alured.
 Strong hit is to reowe.
 95 ayeyn þe séé þat floweþ.
 so it is to swynke.
 ayeyn vnylimpe.
 þe mon. þe on his youhþe.
 swo swinkeþ.
 100 and worldes weole her iwinþ.
 þat he may on elde.
 idelnesse holde.
 And ek myd his worldes weole.
 god iqueme er he quele.
 105 youþe and al þat he haueþ idrowe.
 is þenne wel bitowe.

105. *youþe* in
 darker ink in a
 space too large for
 it; similarly
doweþes, l. 118;
wlonk, l. 124; *vouh*,
 l. 129; *Mayþenes*,
 l. 130.

x

þus queþ Alured.
Monymon wenep þat he wene neþarf.
longes lyues. ac him lyep þe wrench.
110 for þanne his lyues alre best luuede.
þenne he schal léten ; lyf his owe.
for nys no wrt uexynde a wude. ne a velde.
þat euer mwwe þas feye furþ vpholde.
Not no mon þene tyme.
115 hwanne he schal. heonne turne.
Ne nomon þene ende.
hwenne he schal heonne wende.
Dryhten hit one wot. dowepes louerd.
hwanne [we] vre lif leten schule.

xi

120 þus queþ Alured.
Yf þu seoluer and gold.
yetst and weldest in þis world.
Neuer vpen eorþe.
to wlonk. þu ny wrþe.
125 Ayhte nys non ildre istreon ;
ac hit is godes lone.
hwanne hit is his wille. þarof we schulle wende.
And vre owe lyf. myd alle forleten.
þanne schulle vre ifon. to vre vouh. gripen.
130 welden vre Mayþenes. and leten vs byhinde.

122. *yetst*] *yefst*
MS.

xii

þus queþ Alured.
Neilef þu nouht to fele. uppe þe sée þat flowep.
If þu hafst madmes monye and inowe.

gold and seoluer. hit schal gnyde to nouht.
to duste hit schal dryuen. Dryhten schal | libben euere.
136 Monymon for his gold. haueþ godes vrre.
And for his seoluer. hymseolue foryemeþ. foryetep and forleseþ.
Betere him by come iboren þat he nére.

xiii

þus queþ Alured.
140 Lvsteþ ye me leode.
ower is þe neode.
And ich eu wille lére. wit and wisdom.
þat alle þing ouergoþ.
syker he may sitte. þe hyne haueþ to i vere.
145 For þeyh his eyhte him ago.
his wit ne agoþ hym neuermo.
for ne may he forvare.
þe hyne haueþ to vere.
þe wile his owe lyf. ileste mote.

149. After *þe*, *þ*
erased.

xiv

150 þus queþ Alured.
If þu hauest seorewe.
ne seye þu hit nouht þan arewe.
seye hit þine sadelbowe. and ryd þe singinde forþ.
þenne wile wene. þet þine wise ne con ;
155 þat þe þine wise wel lyke.
serewe if þu hauest. and þe erewe hit wot ;
byfore. he þe meneþ ;
byhynde he þe teleþ.
þu hit myht segge swyhc mon.
160 þat þe ful wel on.
wyþvte echere ore.

he on þe Muchele more.
Byhud hit on þire heorte ;
þat þe eft ne smeorte.
165 Ne let þu hyne wite.
al þat þin heorte bywite.

xv

þus queþ Alured.
NE schal tu neuere þi wif. by hire wlyte cheose.
for neuer nône þinge. þat heo to þe bryngeþ.
170 Ac leorne hire custe. heo cuþeþ hi wel sone.
For mony mon for ayhte. vuele iauhteþ.
And ofte mon of fayre. frakele icheoseþ.
wo is him þat vuel wif.
bryngeþ to his cotlyf.
175 So him is alyue ;
þat vuele ywyueþ.
For he schal vppen eorþe.
dreori i wurþe.
Monymon singeþ.
180 þat wif hom bryngeþ.
wiste he hwat he brouhte.
wepen he myhte.

xvi

þus queþ Alured.
NE wurþ þu neuer so wod. ne so wyndrunke.
185 þat éuere segge þine wife. alle þine wille.
For if þu iseye þe bivore. þine ivo alle.
And þu hi myd worde iwreþþed heuedest.
Ne scholde heo hit lete. for þing lyuyinde.
þat heo ne scholde þe forþ vpbreyde. of þine baleusypes.

190 wymmmon is word. wop. 7 haueþ tunge to swift.
þeyh heo wel wolde.
nemay heo. hi nowiht welde.

xvii

þus queþ Alfred. |
Idelschipe and ouerprute.
195 þat lereþ yong wif vuele þewes.
And ofte þat wolde.
do. þat heo ne scholde.
þene vnþev lihte.
leten heo myhte.
200 If heo ofte a swóte forswunke were.
þeyh hit is vuel to buwe.
þat beo nule treowe.
For ofte Museþ þe kat. after hire moder.
þe mon þat let wymmmon his mayster iwurþe.
205 Ne schal he neuer beon ihurd.
his wordes louerd.
Ac heo hine schal steorne
totrayen. and toteóne.
And selde wurþ he blyþe and gled.
210 þe mon þat is his wiues qued.
Mony appel is bryht wiþvte. and Bitter wiþinne.
So is mony wymmmon. on hyre fader bure.
Schene vnder schete. and þeyh heo is schendful.
So is mony gedelyng. godlyche on horse.
215 and is þeyh lutel wurþ.
wlonk bi þe glede.
and vuel at þare neode.

xviii

þus queþ. Alured.

219. *Eure* MS.
224. *mod*] first

[N]eure þu bi þine lyue.
 220 þe word of þine wyue.
 to swiþe þu. ne aréde.
 If heo beo iwreþþed
 myd worde. oþer myd dede.
 wymmon wepeþ for mod.
 225 oftere þan for eny god.
 And ofte lude 7 stille.
 for to vordrye hire wille.
 Heo wepeþ oþerhwile.
 for to do þe gyle.
 230 Salomon hit haueþ ised.
 þat wymmon can wel vuelne red.
 þe hire red foleweþ.
 heo bryngeþ hine to seorewe.
 for hit seyþ in þe loþ.
 235 as scumes forteoþ.
 hit is i furn i seyd.
 þ-cold red is quene red.
 hu he is vnlede.
 þat foleweþ hire rede.
 240 Ich hit ne segge nouht for þan.
 þat god þing. ys god wymmon.
 þe mon þe hi may icheose. and icouere over oþre.

stroke of *m* erased.

xix

þus queþ Alured.
Monymon wenep þat he weny ne þarf.
 245 Freond þat he habbe. þar me him vayre bi hat.
 Seyþ him vayre bivore. and frakele bihynde.
 so me may þane loþe lengust lede.
 Ne ilef þu neuer þane mon.
 þat is of feole spechen.
 250 Ne alle þe þinge.

þat þu iherest singen.
Mony mon haueþ swikelne muþ.
milde and monne forcuþ.
Nele he þe cuþe. hwenne he þe wule bikache.

xx

255 þus queþ Alured.
Þvrh sawe mon is wis. And þurh hiselþe. glev.
þurh lesinge mon is loþ. and þurh luþre wrenches.
And | vnwurþ.
And þurh hokede honde. þat he bereþ.
260 him seolue he forvareþ.
From lesynge þu þe wune.
And alle vnþewes þu þe bischune.
so myht þu on þeode.
leof beon in alle leode.
265 And luue þyne nexte. he is at þe neode gód.
At chepynge. and at chyreche.
freond þu þe iwurche.
wyþ pouere and wiþ riche.
wiþ alle monne ilyche.
270 þanne myht þu sikerliche. sely sytte.
And ek faren ouer lond le
hwider so beoþ þi wille.

256. *his elþe. mon
is glev MS.*

xxi

þus queþ Alured.
Alle worldayhte
275 schulle bicumen to nouhte.
And vycles cunnes madmes. to mixe schulen i Multen.
And vre owe lif. lutel hwile ileste.
for þeyh o mon. wolde al þe worlde.
And al þe wunne. þe þarinne wunyep.

280 Ne myhte he þarmyde his lif. none hwile holde.
Ac al he schal forleten. on a litel stunde.
And schal vre blisse ; to balewe us iwurpe.
Bute if we wurcheþ. wyllen cristes.
Nu biþenche we þanne vs sulue.
285 vre lif to leden. so crist vs gynneþ lere.
þanne mawe we wenen. þat he wule vs wrpie.
for so seyde salomon. þe wise.
þe mon þat her wel deþ.
he cumeþ þar he lyen foþ.
290 on his lyues ende.
he hit schal avynde.

xxii

þus queþ Alured.
NE gabbe þu ne schotte.
ne chid þu wyþ none sotte.
295 ne myd manyes cunnes tales.
ne chid þu wiþ nenne dwales.
Ne neuer þu ne bigynne.
to telle þine tyþinges.
At nones fremannes borde.
300 ne haue þu to vale worde.
Mid fewe worde. wismon
fele biluken wel con.
And sottes bolt is sone iscohte.
forþi ich holde hine for dote.
305 þat sayþ al his wille.
þanne he scholde beon stille.
For ofte tunge brekeþ bon ;
þeyh heo seolf nabbe non.

xxiii

þus queþ Alured.
310 **W**is child is fader blisse.
Jf hit so bitydeþ þat þu bern ibidest.
þe hwile hit is lutel. ler him monþewes.
þanne hit is | wexynde ; hit schal wende þarto.
þe betere hit schal iwurþe
315 euer buuen eorþe.
Ac if þu him lest welde. werende on worlde.
lude and stille.
his owene wille.
hwanne cumeþ ealde.
320 ne myht þu hyne awelde.
þanne deþ hit sone.
þat þe biþ vnyqueme.
Oferhoweþ þin ibod.
and makeþ þe ofte sory mod.
325 *Betere þe were.*
iboren þat he nere.
for betere is child vnbore. þane vnbusum.
þe mon þe spareþ yeorde. and yonge childe.
and let hit arixlye. þat he hit areche ne may.
330 þat him schal on ealde ; sore reowe. *Amen.*

Expliciunt dicta Regis Aluredi.

VII. MEMENTO MORI

“As for [no. vi.](#)”

Mon may longe lyues wene.
Ac ofte him lyep þe wrench.
feyr weder turneþ ofte in to reyne.

7 wunderliche makeþ his blench.
5 þarvore mon. þu þe byþench.
Al schal falwy þi grene.
waylaway. nys king ne quene.
þat ne schal drynke of deþes drench.
Mon er þu falle of þi bench.
10 þyne sunne þu aquench.

Nis non so strong. ne sterk. ne kene.
þat may ago deþes wyþer blench.|
Yung and olde. briht and schene.
Alle he ryueþ on o streng.
15 Fox and ferlych is his wrench.
Ne may no mon þartoyeynes.
waylaway þreting ne bene.
Mede. liste. ne leches drench.
Mon let sunne and lustes þine.
20 wel þu do 7 wel þu þench.

Do bi salomones rede.
Mon. 7 þenne þu schalt wel do.
Do as he þe tauhte and seyde.
þat þin endinge þe bringeþ to.
25 þenne ne schaltu neuer mysdo.
Ac sore þu myht þe adrede.
waylaway such weneþ to lede.
Long lif. and blysse vnderfo.
Ac deþ luteþ in his scho.
30 Hym stilliche. to fordo.

Mon hwi nultu þe biknowe.
Mon hwi nultu þe biseo.
of fule fulþe þu art isowe.
wurmes fode. þu schalt beo.
35 her nauestu blisse dayes þre.
Ac þi lif al þu last in wowe.

weylawey deþ þe schal adun þrowe.
þer þu wenest heyust to steo.
In deþ schal þi lyf endi.
40 And in wop al þi gleo.

World and weole. þe biswikeþ.
Iwis heo beoþ þine ifo.
If þe world wiþ weole þe slykeþ
þat is for to do þe wo.
45 þarefore. let lust ouergo.
And eft hit þe likeþ. |
weylawey. sore he him biswikeþ.
þat for one stunde oþer two.
wurcheþ him pyne. euermo.
50 Mon. ne do þu nouht swo.

VIII. POEMA MORALE

(LAMBETH MS.)

"i. Lambeth 487 (L), a small quarto, 177 × 135 mm., of 67 leaves, written towards the end of the twelfth century... nos. x, xi. of this book are also taken from it. The words printed in clarendon in these three pieces are written in red, not inserted afterwards by a rubricator but done at the same time as the rest of the text. The PM ends with *fordemet*, l. 270, in the middle of a page; the final *t* has a flourish for its cross stroke; the copyist had apparently no knowledge of any more.

"ii. iii. Egerton 613, B. M.... has two copies of the PM: the second (e) furnishes here a complement to the Lambeth MS. as far as l. 370, with which it ends; the first (E) is used to complete the text. e was written in the first quarter of the thirteenth century, E is somewhat later; the former has accents, the latter none.

"iv. Trinity College, Cambridge, B. 14. 52 (T), on vellum, 135 × 105 mm.; written early in the thirteenth century.... A leaf is lost after f 8, and a new hand begins with f 9; the PM appears to be a distinct MS. (*Anglia*, iv. 408). The initials of each line are capitals and written apart from their words. A later hand

has glossed aihte 42, goodes; ore 53, favour, grace; lean 64, deserving; manke 70, Manca, Mancus.”

In the Lambeth MS, passages “printed in clarendon” are shown here in dark-red boldface.

Trinity MS
Parallel Texts

Indentation in the [Egerton MSS](#). (lines 271-end) is as in the original.

ich em nu alder þene ich wes awintre 7 a lare.

**Ich welde mare þene ich dede mi `wit´ ahte bon
mare.**

2. *iḥ ich MS. mi
iḥ ahte; wit in
margin MS.*

**Wel longe ich habbe child ibon a worde 7 a dede
þa`h´ ich bo a wintre ald to zung ich em on rede.**

5 vnnet lif ich habbe iled. 7 3et me þingþ ilede.

þenne ich me biþenche wel ful sare ich me adrede.

mest al þ-ich habbe idon bi fealt to childhade.

Wel late ich habbe me biþocht ; bute God me nu rede.

Fole idel word ich habbe iqueðen soððen ich speke kuðe.

10 fole zunge dede idon ; þe me ofþinchet nuðe.

Mest al þ-me likede er nu ; hit me mislikeð

þa muchel fulieð his wil ; hine solf he biswikeð.

Ich mihte habbe bet idon. hefde ich þe iselþe.

Nu ich walde ah ich ne mei ; for elde 7 for unhelþe.

14. *unheleþe MS.*

15 Elde me is bistolen on. er ich hit wiste.

ne michte ich seon bi fore me. for smike ne for miste.

Er3e we beoð to done god. 7 to ufele al to þriste.

Mare eie stondeð men of monne þanne hom do of criste.

þe wel ne doð þe hwile þe ho mu3en. wel oft hit schal rowen ;

20 þenne 3e mawen sculen 7 repen þ-ho er sowen.

Do he to gode þ-he mu3e þe hwile þ-he bo aliue.

ne lipnie na mon to | muchel to childe ne to wiue.

þe him solue for3et for wiue ne for childe ;

he scal cumen in uel stude bute him God bo milde.

25 **Sendeð** sum god biforen eow. þe hw[i]le þ 3e muzen to houene.

for betere is an elmesse biforen ; þenne boð efter souene.

Alto lome ich habbe igult a werke 7 o worde.

27. *ilich* MS.

Al to muchel ich habbe ispent. to litel ihud in horde.

28. *ih ich* MS.

Ne beo þe loure þene þe solf ; ne þin mei. ne þin mæze.

30 Soht is þ-is oðer`s monnes frond betre þen his azen.

Ne lipnie wif to hire were. ne were to his wiue

bo for him solue ech .Mon. þe `h`wile þ-he bo aliue.

Wis is þe to him solue þench þe hwile þe mot libben.

for sone wule hine forzeten þe fremede 7 þe sibbe.

35 þe wel ne deð þe hwile he mai ; ne scal wenne he walde.

Monies monnes sare iswinc habbeð oft unholde.

Ne scal na mon don afirst. ne slawen wel to done.

for moni mon bihateð wel þe hit forzeteð sone.

Þe .Mon. þe wule siker bon to habben Godes blisse.

40 do wel him solf hwile þ-he mai ; þenne haueð he his mid iwise.

þes riche .Men. weneð bon siker þurh walle 7 þurh dicke.

þe deð his echte on sikere stude he hit sent to heueneriche.

for þer ne þerf he bon of dred of fure ne of þoue

þer ne | þerf he him binimen þe laðe ne þe loue.

45 þer ne þerf he habben kare of 3eve ne of 3elde.

45. *3eve*] v corr. out
of *f* MS.

þider he sent. 7 solf bereð to lutel 7 to selde.

þider we sculen drazen 7 don wel ofte 7 ilome.

for þer ne scal me us naut binimen mid wrangwise dome.

þider 3e sculen 3orne drazen. walde 3e god ileue.

50 for ne mei þer hit ou binimen king ne reue.

50. *þer*] *þ*-MS.

Al þ-beste þ-we hefden þider we hit solde senden

for þer we hit michte finden eft. 7 habben buten ende.

Þo þe er doð eni God for habben godes are.

al he hit scal finden eft þer 7 hundred fald mare.

55 Þe þet echte wile halden wel hwile þe he muze es welden.

Giue hies for godes luue ; þenne deþ hes wel ihalden.

Vre swinc 7 ure tilþe is ofte iwoned to swinden.

Ach þ̅þe we doð for godes luue ; eft we sculen al finden.
Ne scal nan ufel bon unbocht. ne nan god unforzolden.
60 vfel we doþ al to muchel. 7 god lesse þenne we sculden.
þo þe mest doð nu to gode. 7 þe lest to laðe.
Eiðer to lutel 7 to muchel scal þunchen eft hom baþe.
þer me scal ure werkes weien bi foran þe heuen king.
and zeuen us ure swinkes lan efter ure erninge.

65 **Ech mon mid þ̅he hauet. mei buggen houene riche.**

þe mare haueþ 7 þe þe lesse ; baþe hi | muzen iliche.
Alse mid his p`e`nie alse oðer mið his punde.
þ̅is þe wunderlukeste chep ; þ̅eni mon efre funde.
7 þe ðe mare ne mai don ; do hit mid his gode þonke.
70 Alse wel se þe þe haueð golde fele manke.
7 oft god kon mare þonc þen þe him zeueð lesse.
7 his werkes 7 his wezes his milce. 7 rihtwisnesse.

lutel lac is gode lof ; þ̅kumeð of gode wille.

7 eclete muchel zeue of þan þe herte is ille.
75 Houene 7 horþe he ouer sich. his ezen boð swa brichte.
Sunne 7 mone 7 houen fur boð þestre azein his lihte.
Nis him noht forholen ni hud. swa muchele boð his mihte.
nis hit ne swa derne [idon] ne [a] swa þostre nihte.
he wat wet þenkeð 7 hwet doð alle quike wihte.
80 **Nis na lauerd swich se is crist.** ne king swuch ure drihten.
houene 7 orðe 7 al þ̅is biloken is in his honde.

he deð al þ̅his wil is ; a wettre 7 alonde.
He made fisses in þe se 7 fuzeles in þe lifte.
he wit 7 waldeð alle þing 7 scop alle scefte.
85 he is hord buten horde 7 ende buten ende.
he ane is eure an ilche stude wende þer þu wende.
he is buuen us 7 binopen. bi foren 7 bi hinden.
þe þe deð godes wille uwer he mei him finden.

Helche rune he iherð 7 wat alle deden.

82. *iþ* his MS.

83. After *fuzeles* in,
k deleted.

90 he þurþsicheþ uches monnes þonc. Wi hwat scal us to rede.
We þ-brokeð godes hese 7 gulteð swa ilome.
hwet scule we seggen oðer don et þe muchele dome.
Þa þe luueden unriht 7 ufel lif | leden.

Wet sculen ho seggen oðer don ; þen þe engles bon of dred.

95 **hwet sculen we beren** biforen us mid hom scule we iquemen.
þo þe neure god ne dude þe hounliche deme.
þer sculen bon doule swa fole þ-wulleð us forwreien.
7 nabbeð hi naþing forȝeten of al þ-ho iseȝen.

Al þ-we misduden her ; ho hit wulleð kuðe þere.

100 [buten wé habbe hit íbét. ðe hwile wé her wére]

100. Supplied from
MS. e.

Al ho habbeð in hore write ; þ-we misduden here.

þach we nusten ne niseȝen. ho weren ure ifere.

Hwet sculen ordlinghe`s don. þa swicen 7 ta forsworene
hwi boð fole iclepede. 7 swa lut icorene.

105 wi hwi weren ho biȝeten to hwon weren ho
iborene.

105. w hwon MS.

þ-sculen bon to deþe idemet. 7 eure ma forlorene.

Ech .Mon. scal him solue þer biclepie 7 bidemen.

his aȝen werch 7 his þonc te witnesse he scal temen.
ne mei him na .Mon. alsa wel demen ne alswa rihte

108. temen] demen
MS.

110 for nan ne knauð him ase ȝere ; buten ane drihte.

Ech .Mon. wat him solue best ; his werkes. 7 his wille.

111. before werkes,
werhes deleted.

Þe ðe lest wat biseiþ ofte mest ; þe hit al wat is stille.

nis nan witnesse alse muchel se monne`s aȝen horte.

Wa se seið þ-he bo hal. him solf wat best his smirte.

115 **Ech .Mon. scal h[i]m solf demen** to deðe oðer to liue.

þa witnesse of his aȝen werch ; hine þerto scal driue.

Al þet ech .Mon haueð idon soððen he com to monne

sculde he | hit sechen o boke iwwiten he scal iþenchen þenne.

Ah drihten ne demeð nenne .Mon. efter his biginnigge.

120 ah al his lif scal bon suilch boð his endinge.

ȝef þ-his uuel al hit is uuel 7 God ȝefe god his ende.

God 3eue þ ure ende bo god. 7 wite þ he us lende.
þe .Mon. þ uuel don na god. ne neure god lif leden.
er deð 7 dom come to his dure he mei him sare adreden.
125 þ he ne mu3e þenne biden are. for þ itit ilome.
forþi he is wis þe biet 7 bit 7 bet bi fore dome.

Wenne deð is attere dure wel late he biddeþ are.

Wel late he latheð uuel werc ; þe ne mei hit don ne mare.
þ achten we to leuen wel. for ure drihten solf hit seide.

130 A hwilke time se eure .Mon. of þinchþ his mis dede. 130. *þingchþ* MS.

Oþer raþer oðer later ; milce he scal imeten.

Ac þe þ þer naf[ð] nocht ibet ; wel muchel he haueð to beten. 132. *þe]* we MS.

Monimon seit hwa rechð of pine þe scal hebben þende.

Ne bidde ich na bet bo alesed a domes dei of bende.

135 lutel he wat wet is pine. 7 lutel he hit scaweð
hwice hete is þer þa saule wuneð hu biter wind þer blaweð.

hefde he bon þer enne dei oðer twa bare tide ;
nolde he for al middenerd þe þerdde þer abiden.
þet habbeð iseid þ[e] comen þonen þa hit wisten mid iwissen.
140 wa wurð sor3e seue3er. for souenihte blisse.

In hure blisse þe | þe ende haueð. for endelese pine.

betere is wori water drunch ; þen atter meind mid wine.

Swines brede is swiðe swete. swa is of wilde dore.

alto dore he is abuh ; þe 3efð þer fore his swore. 144. *abuh]* *abuṭeḥ* MS.

145 Ful wombe mei lihtliche speken of hunger. 7 of
festen ;

swa mei of pine þe ne cnauð þe scal a ilesten.

Hefð he ifonded summe stunde ; he wolde al seggen oðer.

Et lete him were wif. child. suster. feder 7 broðer.

Al he walde 7 oðerluker don 7 oðerluker þenchen

150 Wenne he biþohte on helle fur þe nawiht ne mei quenchen.

Eure he walde her inne wawe 7 ine wene wunien ;

Wið þ-þe mihte helle pine bi flien 7 bisunien

152. Before *þe*, *me*
deleted.

Et lete him were al world wele 7 orðliche blisse.

for to þ-muchele blisse cumen is murþe mid iwise.

155 **Iwule nu cumen eft to þe dome þ-ich er ow of sede**

A þa dei 7 at ta dome us helpe crist 7 rede.

þer we muzen bon eþe offerd 7 herde us adreden.

þer he scal al son him bi foren his word 7 ec his deden.

Al scal þer bon þenne cud þer men luzen her ent stelen.

160 Al scal þer bon þanne unwron ; þ-men wruzen her 7 helen.

We sculen alre monne lif iknauwen alse ure ahen.

þer sculen eueningges bon þe riche 7 þe laze.

Ne scal na mon skamie þer ne þerf he him adreden.

163. *skamie*] *smakie*
MS.

Gif him her ofþincþ | his gult 7 bet his misdede.

165 for him ne scameþ ne ne gromeð þe sculen bon iborzen.

Ach þoþre habbeþ scome 7 grome 7 oft fele sorze.

Þe dom scal sone bon idon ne lest he nawiht longe.

ne scal him na mon mene þer of strengþe ne of wronge.

þe sculen habbe herdne dom þa her weren herde.

170 þa þe uuele holden wreche men 7 uuele laze redde.

Ec efter þ-he eþf idon sal þer þenne [beon] idemet.

[bliðe mei hé ðenne beon. þe god háfð wel icwemed]

172. Supplied from
MS. e.

Alle þa þi sprunge boþ of adam 7 of eue.

Alle hi sculen cumen þider for soðe we hit ileueð.

175 þa þe habbeð wel idon efter hore mihte.

to houene riche hi sculen faren forð mid ure drihte.

þa þe habbeð doules werc idon. 7 þer inne bo ifunde.

hi sculen faren forð mid him in to helle grunde.

178. *mid mīd* MS.

þer hi sculen wunien a buten are 7 ende.

180 Ne brekeþ neure drihte helle gate for lesen hi of bende.

Nis na sullic þech hom bo wa 7 hom bo uneade.

Ne scal neure eft crist þolie deþ for lesen hom of deaþe.

Enes drihten helle brec his frond he ut brochte.

him solf he þolede deð for him . wel dore he hom bohte.

185 Nalde hit mei do for mei. ne suster for broðer.

nalde hit sune do for fader. ne na mon for oðer.

Vre alre lauerd for his þrelles ipined wes a rode.

vre bendes he unbon[d] 7 bohte us mid his blode.

We 3eueð | uneðe for his luue a stuche of ure brede.

190 Ne þenke we noht þ he scal deme þa quike 7 þa dede.

Muchele luue he us cudde. walde we hit understonde

þ ure eldre misduden ; we habbeð uuele on honde.

Deþ com in þis middenerde þurh þes doules honde.

7 sake 7 sor3e 7 swinc a watere 7 a londe.

195 **Vre forme fader** gult. we abu3eð alle.

[eal his óf spring efter him. en hearne is bi fealle.]

þurst 7 hunger. chele 7 hete. helde 7 unhelðe.

þurh him deð com in þis middenerd 7 oðer uniselðe.

Nere namon elles ded ne sec ne nan unsele.

200 ac mihten libben eure ma a blisse 7 a hele.

lutel hit þuncheð moni mon. ac muchel wes þa sunne.

for hwam alle þolieð deð þe comen of hore cunne.

Hore sunne 7 ec ure a3en sare us mei ofþinche.

þurh sunne we libbeð alle in sor3e 7 in swinke.

205 Suððen God nom swa muchele wrake for are misdede ;

We þe swa muchel 7 swa ofte misdoð. we mu3en eðe us adrede.

Adam and his ofsprung for are bare sunne.

Wes fele undret wintre an helle pine 7 an unwunne.

þa þe ledden hore lif mid unriht 7 mid wrange.

210 buten hit gode`s´ milce do ho sculen bon þer wel

longe.

Godes wisdom is wel muchel 7 alswa is his mihte

7 nis his milce naut lesse. ac bi þan ilke iwichte.

Mare he ane mei for3euen. þen | al folc gulte cunne.

Sulf douel mihte habben milce. 3if he hit bigunne.

215 Þa þe godes milce secheð ; he iwis mei ha ifinden.

Ac helle king is areles with þa þe he mei binden.

þe þe deþ is wille mest ; he haueð wurst mede.

His baþ scal bon wallinde. his bað scal bon berninde glede.

196. Supplied from
MS. e.

203. *hore* ure MS.

207. *bare*] *þare* MS.

210. *do*] *don* MS.

Wurst he deð his gode frond ; þenne his fulle fond ; 218. *baþ*-MS. *scal*
scab MS.

220 God scilde alle godes frond. a wih swilche freonde.

Neure in helle hi com. ne þer ne come reche.

þach ich elches worldes wele. þer me mahte feche

þ-his wulle seggen on þat wise men us seiden.

7 aboken hit writen þer [me] mei hit reden.

225 Ich hit wille seggen þan þe hit hom solf nusten.

warni hom wið hore unfrome. 3if ho me wulleð lusten.

vnderstondeð nu to me edi men 7 arme.

Ich wulle tellen of helle pin ; 7 wernin ow wið herme.

In helle his hunger 7 þurst ; twa uuele iuere.

229. *is* his MS.

230 þas þolieð þa [þe] weren maket niþinges here.

Þer is waning 7 wow. efter eche streche.

ho fareð from hete to hete. 7 hech to frure þe wreche.

þenne hi bið in þere hete ; þe chele him þunchet blisse.

þenne hi cumeð eft to þe chele ; of hete hi habbeð misse.

235 hi hem deð wa inoch nabbeð hi nane blisse.

Nute hi hweþer hem deþ wurs mid neure nane wisse. 236. *wurs*] *þurs*
hi walkeð eure 7 secheð reste | ac `ho´ ne muzen MS.

imeten. 237. *mouzen* MS.

forþi þe ho nolden þe hwile þ-ho mihten here sunne beten.

ho secheð reste þer nis nan. forþi ne muzen hi es finden.

240 Ac walkeð weri up 7 dun ; se water deþ mid winde.

þo boð þa þe weren her a þanke unstedefeste.

7 þa þe gode biheten heste 7 nolden hit ileste.

þa þe god werc bigunnen 7 ful enden hit nolden.

Nu witen her. 7 nuðe þer. 7 nusten hwat hi wolden.

245 þer is bernunde pich hore saule to baþien inne.

þa þe ledden here lif in werre 7 in winne.

þer is fur þ-is undret fald hattre. þene bo ure.

Ne mei quenchen salt weter ne uersc of þe burne.

þis is þ-fur þ-efre bernd ne mei nawiht hit quenchen ;

250 Þer inne boð þa þe was to lof wreche men to swenchen.

þa þe weren swikelemen 7 ful of uuel wrenchen.
 þa þe mihten uuel don. þe þe lef hit wes to þenchen.
 Þe luueden tening 7 stale. hordom 7 drunken.
 7 a doules werche bliþeliche swunken.
 255 Þa þe weren swa lese þ me hom ne mihte ileuen. 255. *lese*] *lele* MS.
 Medierne domes men. 7 wrongwise reuen.
 þ oðer monnes wif lof. his azen etlete.
 þo þe sungede muchel ; a drunke 7 an ete.
 þe wreche mon binom his ehte. 7 leide his on horde.
 260 þ lutel let of godes borde. 7 godes worde.
 7 þo þe his azen nalde 3euen þer he isech | þe node
 Ne nalde iheren godes sonde. þenne he hit herde bode.
 Þe þ is oðers monnes þing. loure þene hit sculde.
 7 weren to gredi of solure 7 of golde.
 265 7 þa þe untrownesse duden þon þe ho scu`l`den bon holde.
 7 leten þet ho sculden don. 7 duden þ ho wolden.
 Þa þe weren eure abuten þisse worldes echte. 267. *wenren* MS.
 7 duden al þ þe laþe gast hechte to 7 tachte. 269. *iquemde*]
 7 alle þe þen anigewise doulen iquende MS.
 270 Þa boð nu mid him in helle fordon 7 fordemet.

(EGERTON MS., SECOND COPY.)

Bute þá þe ófðufte sare heore misdede.
 7 gunne heore gultes beten 7 betere líf læde.
 Þer beoð neddren 7 snaken. éuete 7 frute.
 þa tereð. 7 freteð. þe uuele speke. þe nið fulle. 7 te prute.
 275 Neure sunne ðer ne scínð. ne mone ne steorre.
 þer is muchel godes hate. 7 muchel godes eorre.
 Æure ðer ís uuel sméch. ðusternesne 7 eie.
 nis ðer neure oðer líht. ðene þe swierte leie.
 Þer ligget ladliche fund. in strange rakete3e.
 280 þ beoð þa ðe wére mid gode on heuene wel he3e.
 Þer beoð ateliche fund. 7 eisliche wihte.
 þas scule þa wrecche ífon. þe sune3ede ðurh sihte.

Þer is ðe laðe sathanas. 7 belzebud sé ealde. 283. *is iſ* MS.
 eaðe hi mužen beo ófdréd. þe híne scule bihealde.
 285 Ne mei nan heorte hit iðenche. ne tunge ne can telle.
 hu muchel píne na hu uele sunden ínne helle.
 Wið þa pine ðe þer beoð. nelle ich eow naht leozen.
 nis hit bute gamen 7 gléo. eal þ-man mei hér dreozen.
 End ȝut ne deð heom naht sa wá. ín ða laðe bende. |
 þ-hí witeð þ-heore píne sceal neure habbe ende. 290. After *habbe*, *l* erased.
 291 Þar beoð þa heðene men. þé wære laȝeliese.
 þe nes naht óf godes bibode. ne óf godes hése.
 [U]uele cristene men. hí beoð heore ifere.
 þa ðe heore cristendom. uuele heo`l`de hére.
 295 [Ȝ]ut hí beoð á wurse stede. on ðeré helle grunde.
 ne sculen hí neure cumen út. for marke ne for punde.
 [N]e mei heom naðer helpen þer. íbede ne elmesse.
 for nis naðer inne helle. áre ne forȝiuenesse.
 Sculde him éch man ðe hwile hé muȝe óf ðas helle píne.
 300 7 werni ech hís freond þer wið swa ich habbe mine.
 Þá ðe sculden heom ne cunne. ich heom wulle teche.
 ich kan beon ȝief ich sceal. lichame 7 sawle leche.
 Léte wé þ-god forbut. ealle manne cunne.
 7 do wé þ-hé us hét. 7 sculde wé us wið sunne.
 305 Luuie we god mid ure heorte. 7 mid al ure mihte.
 7 ure émcristen eal us sulf. swa us larde drihte.
 Eal þ-me ráet 7 eal þ-me singð. bi fore godes borde.
 eal hít hanget 7 bihalt. bi ðisse twam worde. 308. *eal*] *Eeal* MS.
 Ealle godes laȝe he fulð. ðe níwe 7 ða ealde. 309. *Ealle*] *alle* MS.
 310 þe ðe ðas twá luue háfð. 7 wel hí wule healde. *níwe*] *n* corr. out of *r*.
 Ac hí beoð wunder earueðhealde. swá ófte gulteð
 ealle.
 Fór hít ís strang to stande lange. 7 líht ís to fealle.
 [A]ac drihte crist hé ȝíue us strengðe. stande þ-wé mote.
 7 óf ealle ure gultes `unne` us cume to bote.
W 315 é wilnieð éfter woruld wéle. ðe lange ne mei leste.
 7 leggeð eal ure iswinch. ón ðinȝe unste`de` feste. |
 Swunche wé for godes luue. healf þ-wé doð for æhte.

ne béo wé naht swá óf bicherd. ne sa uuele bi kehte.
 3if wé serueden gode swa wé doð ermínges.
 320 mare wé hedden en héuene. ðenne eorles hér 7 kinges.
 Né mužen hí werien heom wið chele. wið þurste ne wið hunger.
 ne wið ulde. ne wið deaðe. þe uldre ne ðe 3eonger.
 Ac ðer nis hunger ne ðurst. ne dieð. ne unhelðe ne elde.
 of þisse riche wé ðencheð ófte. 7 of þere to selde.
 325 Wé scolden ealle us biðenche ófte. 7 wél ilome.
 hwét wé beoð to whán wé scule. 7 óf hwán wé come.
 Hú litle hwíle wé beoþ hér. hú lange elle`s´ hwáre.
 hwét wé muze habben hér. 7 hwét finde þere.
 3íef wé were wise men. ðis wé scolde ðenche.
 330 bute wé wurðe us íwer. ðeos woruld wule us fordrenche.
 Mest ealle men he 3íueð drinche. óf ane deofles scenche.
 hé sceal him cunne sculde wél. 3íf hé híne nele screnche.
Mid ealmihtiges godes luue. ute wé us bi werien.
 wið ðises wrecches woreldes luue. þ-hé maze us derien.
 335 Mid festen ælmes 7 ibede. werie wé us wið sunne.
 Mið ða wepne ðe god haueð. bi 3íten man cunne.
 Léte wé þe brade strét. 7 ðene wei bene.
 þe let þ-nizeðe dël to helle of manne. 7 ma ich wéne. 338. *let] lec* MS.
 Gá wé ðene nærewne wei. 7 ðene wei grene.
 340 ðer forð fareð litel folc. ac hit is feir 7 scéne.
 Þe brade strét is ure íwill. ðe ís us lað to forláte.
 þa ðe eal folzeð hís íwill. fareð bi ðusse stréte.
 Hí mužen lihtliche gán mid ðere underhulde.
 ðurh ane godlíese wude `into´ ane bare felde. 344. *wude] wade*
 345 [Þ]e nærewi ís godes hése. ðer forð fareð wél MS.
 fiewe.
 þ-beoð ða ðe heom sculdeð 3eorne wið áche unðeawe.
 [Þ]as gað uníeðe 3eanes ðe clíue. a3ean þe heaze hulle.
 ðas leteð eal heore a3en wíll. for godes hése to fulle.
 [G]a wé alle þene wei. for he us wule bringe.
 350 mid te feawe feire men. be foren heuen kinge.
 Þer is ealre murhðe mest. mid englene sange.
 ðe ís a þusend wintre ðer. ne ðincð him naht to lange.

Ðe ðe lest haueð. hafð swa michel þ-hé ne bit namare.
 þe ða blisse for ðas forlét hít him mei reowe sare.
 355 [N]e mei nan uuel ne na wane beon inne godes riche.
 ðeh þer beoð wununges fele. æch oðer uniliche.
 Sume ðer habbeð lesse murhðe. 7 sume habbeð mare.
 æfter ðan þe dude her. efter ðan þ-he swanc sare.
 [N]e sceal ðer beon ne bried ne wín. ne oðer cunnes éste.
 360 god ane sceal beo eche líf. 7 blisse. 7 éche reste.
 [N]é sceal ðer beo fah ne græi. ne kuning ne `er´ míne.
 ne aquierne. ne martres cheole. ne beuer né sabelíne.
 [N]e sceal ðer beo sciet ne scrud. ne woruld wele nane.
 eal þe murhðe þe me us bihat. al hít sceal beo god ane.
 365 [N]e mei na murhðe. beo swa muchel. se is godes sihte.
 [H]e ís soð sunne 7 briht. 7 dei ábuten nihte.
 [H]e is ælches godes ful. nis him na wiðuten.
 na god nis him wane þe wunieð him abuten.
 Ðer is wéle ábute gane. 7 reste abuten swinche.
 370 þe mei 7 nele ðider cume. sare hit him sceal óf ðinche.

(EGERTON MS., FIRST COPY.)

Ðer is blisse abuten treze. 7 lif abuten deape
 þe eure scullen wunien þer. bliþe muwen ben eþe
 Ðer is zeoþeðe bute ulde. 7 hele abuten vnhelðe
 nis þer so`re´we ne sor. ne neure nan vnsealþe
 375 Ðer me scal drihte sulf iseon. swa he is mid iwisse
 he one mai 7 scal al beo. engle 7 manne blisse
 And ðeh ne beod heore eze naht. alle iliche brihte
 ði nabbed hi nouht iliche. alle of godes lihte
 On þisse `liue´ hi neren nout. alle of one mihte
 380 ne þer ne scullen hi habben god. alle bi one zihte
 Ðo scullen more of him seon. þe luuede him her more
 7 more icnawen 7 iwiten. his mihte 7 his ore
 On him hi scullen finden alþat man mai to lesten
 hali boc hi sculle iseon. al þat hi her nusten

385 Crist scal one beon inou. alle his durlinges
 he one is muchele mare 7 betere. þanne alle oþere þinges
 Inoh he haued þe hine haueð. þe alle þing wealded
 of him to sene nis no sed. wel hem is þe hine bi
 healdeð 388. *hem]* *e* above *i*
MS.
 God is so mere 7 swa muchel. in his godcunnesse
 390 þ al þ is. 7 al þat wes is wurse. þenne he 7 lesse
 Ne mai it neure no man oþer segge mid iwise
 hu muchele murhðe habbet þo. þe beod inne godes blisse
T o þere blisse us bringe god. þe rixlet abuten ende
 þenne he vre soule vnbint. of licames bende
 395 Crist 3yue us leden her swilc lif. 7 habben her swilc ende
 þat we moten þuder come. wanne we henne wende. AmeN.

POEMA MORALE

(TRINITY MS.)

Lambeth MS (above)
Parallel Texts

I ch am nu elder þan ich was a wintre 7 a lore.
 Ich wealde more þan idude mi wit oh to be more
 To longe ich habbe child iben a worde 7 a dade.
 Þeih ibie a winter eald to jung ich am on rade.
 5 Vnnet lif ich habbe ilad 7 3iet me þincheð ilade
 Þan ibiðenche me þaron wel sore ime adrade.
 Mast al ich habbe idon is idelnesse 7 chilce.
 Wel late ich habbe me biþoht bute me god do milce.
 Fele idel word ich habbe ispeken seðen ich speken cuðe.
 10 7 fele 3eunge dade idon þe me ofðinkeð nuðe.
 Alto lome ich habbe igult a werke 7 a worde.
 Alto muchel ic habbe ispend to litel ileid on horde.
 Mast al þat me likede ar nu hit me mislicað.

Þe mu[c]hel folʒeð his iwil him selfen he biswicað.
 15 Ich mihte habben bet idon. hadde ich þo iselðe
 Nu ich wolde ac ine mai for elde 7 for unhalðe.
 Elde me is bistolen on ar ich hit iwiste
 Ne mai ich isien bifore me for smeche ne for miste.
 Arʒe we beð to don god to juel al to þriste 19. *Ar 3e MS. juel]*
 20 More eie stondeð man of man þan him do of criste. *j corr. out of 3.*
 Þe wel ne deð þe hwile he mai wel ofte hit sal him rewen.
 Þan alle men sulle ripen þat hie ar sewen.
 Do al to gode þat he muʒe ech þe hwile he beð aliue. 23. *hebeð MS.*
 Ne lipne noman to muchel to childe ne to wiue. |
 Þe þe him selfe forʒiet for wiue oðer for childe
 26 He sal cumen on euel stede bute him god be milde.
 Sende god biforen him man þe hwile he mai to heuene
 For betre is on almesse biforen þan ben after seuene.
 Ne bie þe leuere þan þe self ne þi mæi ne þi mowe
 30 Sot is þe is oðer mannes frend betere þan his owen.
 Ne hopie wif to hire were ne were to his wiue 31. *After hire were,*
 Be for him self afric man þe hwile he beð aliue. *ac erased.*
 Wis þe him selue biðencheð þe hwile he mót libben
 For sone willeð him forʒiete þe fremde 7 þe sibbe.
 35 Þe wel ne doð þe hwile he mai ne sal he þan he wolde.
 For manimannes sore iswinc habbeð ofte unholde.
 Ne solde noman don a furst ne laten wel to done
 For maniman bihoteð wel þat hi forʒieteð sone. 38. *bihoteð] o*
 Þe man þe wile siker ben to habben godes blisse. *above a MS.*
 40 Do wel him self þe hwile he mai þanne haueð hes mid iwisse.
 Þe richemen weneð siker ben þu`r`ch wallen 7 thurh dichen.
 He deð his aihte an siker stede þe hit sent to heueriche.
 For þar`f he` ben ofdrad of fure ne of þieue.
 Þar ne mai hit him binime þe loðe ne þe lieue.
 45 Þar ne þarf he habben care of here ne of ʒielde
 Þider we sendeð 7 ec bereð to litel 7 to selde.
 Þider `we solden` drawen 7 don wel ofte 7 ilome.
 For þar ne sal me us naht binime mid wrong wise dome. |
 Þider we solde ʒierne drawen wolde ʒie me ileuen.

50 For ne mai hit us binime no king ne no sýrreue.
Alþat beste þat we habbeð her þider we solde sende.
For þar we mihte finden eft. 7 habben abuten ende.
Se þe her doð ani god for`to´ haben godes ore.
Al he hit sal eft finde þar 7 hundredfealde more.

55 Se þe aihte wile holde wel þe hwile hes muze
wealden.

55. *holde*] *o* above
q MS.

56. *zieue*] *3* corr. out
of *G*.

3ieue hes for godes luue þanne doð hes wel ihealden.
For ure swinch 7 ure tilðe is ofte wuned to swinde.
Ac al þat we 3ieueð for godes luue al we hit sulen eft finden.
Ne sal þar non euel ben unboht ne god unfor3olden.
60 Euel we doð alto muchel 7 god lasse þan we solden.
Se þe mast doð nu to gode 7 se last to lothe.
Eiðer to litel 7 to muchel hem sal þunche boðe.
Þar me sal ure werkes wei3en bifore þan heuen kinge.
7 3ieuen us ure werkes lean after ure erninge.
65 Africh man mid þat he haueð mai bugge heueriche
þe þe more haueð 7 þe þe lasse boðe iliche.
Alse on mid his peni se oðer mid his punde
Þis is þet wunderlukeste ware þat animan funde.
7 se þe more ne mai don mid his gode iþanke.
70 Alse wel se þe þe haued goldes fele manke.
And ofte god can more þanc þan þe him 3ieueð lasse.
Al his werkes 7 his weies is milce 7 rihtwi[s]nesse. |
Litel lóc is gode lef þe cumeð of gode wille
7 eðlate muchel 3ieue þan his herte is ille.
75 Heuene 7 erðe he ouer sihð his eien beð ful brihte.
Nis him no þing forholen swo muchel is his mihte.
Ne bie hit no swo derne idon ne on swo þuster nihte.
He wot hwat þencheð 7 hwat doð alle quike wihte
Nis louerd swilch is *crist* ne king swilch ure drihte
80 Boðe 3iemeð þe his bien bi daie 7 bi nihte.
Heuene 7 erðe 7 al þat is biloken is in his honden
He doð al þat his wille is awatere 7 alonde.
He makeð þe fisses in þe sa þe fueles on þe lofte.
He wit 7 wealdeð alle þing 7 he sop alle safte.

85 He is ord abuten ord 7 ende abuten ende
 He is one afre on eche stede wende þar þu wende.
 He is buuen us 7 bineðen biforen 7 bihinde
 Þe godes wille doð aihware he maiȝ him finde 88. *godeswille* MS.
 Elche rune he hereð 7 he wot alle dade
 90 He þurhsihð elches mannes þanc wi hwat sal us to rade.
 We þe brekeð godes has 7 gulteð swo ilome
 Hwat sulle we seggen oðer don áte muchele dome 92. After *don*, an
 We þe luueden unriht 7 euel lif ladden erasure of about ten
 Hwat sulle we seggen oðer don þar ængles beð letters.
 ofdradde 93. *unriht*] *r* corr.
 out of *l* MS.
 95 Hwat sulle we beren us biforen mid hwan sulle we
 iqueme
 We þe nafre god ne duden þan heuenliche deme. |
 Þar sulle ben deflen swo fele þat willeð us forwreien.
 Nabbeð hie no þing forȝieten of þat hie her iseien.
 Alþat hie iseien her hie willeð cuðen þare
 100 Bute we haben hit ibet þe hwile we here waren.
 Al hie habbeð on here write þat we misduden here.
 Þeih we hes ne niseien hie waren ure iferen.
 Hwat sullen horlinges don þes wichen 7 þe forsworene
 Wi swo fele beð icleped swo fewe bed icorene
 105 Wi hwi waren hie biȝiete to hwan waren hie iborene.
 Þe sulle ben to deaðe idemd 7 afremo forlorene.
 Elch man `sal´ þar biclepien himselfen 7 ec demen.
 His oȝen werc 7 his þanc to witnesse he sal temen. 108. *His*] *Hic* MS.
 Nemai him noman alse wel demen ne alse rihte
 110 For non ne cnoweð hine alse wel buten one drihte.
 Man wot him self best his werkes 7 his wille.
 Se þe last wot he seið ofte mast se þit al wot is stille
 Nis no witnesse alse muchel se mannes oȝen hierte
 Hwo se seið þat hie beð hol him self wot his smierte.
 115 Elch man sal him selfen demen to deaðe oðer to liue.
 Þe witnesse of his oȝen werc to oðer þan hine sal driue.
 Alþat afri man haueð idon seðen he cam to manne
 Swo he hit iseie abóc iwrite he sal hit þenche þanne.

Ac drihte ne demeð noman after his biginninge
120 Ac al his lif sal ben teald after his endinge. |
Zief þe endinge is god al hit is god· 7 euel zief euel is þe ende.
God zieue þat ure ende be god 7 zieue þat he us lende.
Se man þe nafre nele don god ne nafre god lif lade.
Are deað 7 dom cumeð to his dure he maiȝ him sore adrade
125 Þat he ne muȝe þanne bidden ore for þat itit ilome.
Forþi he wis þe bit 7 biȝiet 7 bet bifore dome.
Þanne þe deað is ate dure wel late he biddeð ore.
Wel late he lateð euel werc þan he hit ne mai don no more.

Senne lat þe 7 þu nah him þan þu hit ne miht do no more ;

130 Forþi he is sot þe swo abit to habben godes ore.
Þeih hweðere we hit leueð wel for drihte self hit sade.
Elche time sal þe man ofþunche his misdade
Oðer raðer oðer later milce he sal imete.

133. After *imete*,
acþ erased.

Ac þe þe her naueð ibet muchel he haued to bete
135 Maniman seið hwo reche pine þe sal habben ende
Ne bidde ich no bet bie ich alesed a domesdai of bende.
Litel wot he `h'wat is pine 7 litel he cnoweð
Hwilch hit is þar sowle wunieð hwu biter wind þar
bloweð.

137. *his* MS. After
cnoweð, erasure of
hwil.

Hadde he ben þar on oðer two bare tiden.

140 Nolde he for al middeneard þe þridde þar abiden.
Þat habbed isaid þe come þanne þit wiste mid iwise.
Wo wurðe soreȝe seue zier for seue nihte blisse.

140. After *Nolde*
erasure of two
letters. *almidden*
MS.

7 ure blisse þe ende haueð for endelease pine
Betere is wori water þan atter imengd mid wine.

145 Swines brade is wel swete swo is of wilde diere.
Ac al to diere he hit abuið þe ziefð þarfore his swiere.
Ful wombe mai lihtliche speken of hunger 7 of fasten
Swo mai of pine þe not hwat is pine þe sal ilasten. |
Hadde fonded sume stunde he wolde seggen oðer
150 Eðlate him ware wif 7 child suster 7 fader 7 broðer.
Al he wolde oðerluker don 7 oðerluker þenche
Þan he biðohte an helle fur þat nowiht ne mai quenche.

Afre he wolde her in wo 7 in wane wunien
 Wið þan he mihte helle fur biflen 7 bisunien.
 155 Eðlate him ware al wele 7 erðeliche blisse
 For to þe muchele blisse cume þis murie mid iwisse.
 ¶ Ich wulle nu cumen eft to þe dome þe ich eow ar of
 sade. 153. After *wunien*,
 157. *eft eft* MS.
 On þe daie 7 on þe dome us helpe crist 7 rade
 Þar we mužen ben sore offerd 7 harde us ofdrade.
 160 Þar elch sal al isien him biforen his word 7 ec his dade.
 Al sal þar ben þanne cuð þat men lužen her 7 halen.
 Al sal þar ben þanne unwrien þat men her hudden 7 stalen.
 We sullen alre manne lif icnowen else ure ožen
 Þar sullen efninges ben to þe heie 7 to þe loze.
 165 Ne sal þeih no man samie þiar ne þarf he him
 adrade. 165. *þiar*] *a* corr.
 out of *e*.
 Ȝief him her ofþincheð his gult 7 bet his misdade.
 For hem ne sameð ne ne grameð þe sulle ben iboreȝe
 Ac þoðre habbeð same 7 grame 7 oðer fele soreȝe.
 Þe dom sal ben sone idon ne last hit nowiht longe
 170 Ne sal him noman mene þarof strençðe ne of
 wronge 169. *sal*] *þal* MS.
 Ðo sulle habben hardne dom þe here waren hardde
 Ðo þe euel hielden wreche men 7 euel laȝe arerde.
 Elch after þat he haueð idon sal þar ben þanne idemð
 Bliðe mai he þanne ben þe god haueð wel iquemð.
 175 Alle þo þe sprunge beð of adam 7 of eue
 Alle hie sulle þider cume for soðe we hit ileued. |
 Ðo þe habbed wel idon after here mihte
 To heueriche hie sulle fare forð mid ure drihte.
 Ðo þe deueles werkes habeð idon 7 þarinne beð ifunde
 180 Hie sulle fare forð mid hem into helle grunde.
 180. After *fare*, *þ*
 elided.
 Þar hie sulle wunien abuten ore 7 ende.
 Brecð nafre eft crist helle dure for lesen hem of bende
 Nis no sellich þeih hem be wo 7 þeih hem be uneaðe
 Ne sal nafre eft crist þolien deað for lesen hem of deaðe.
 185 Ænes drihten helle brac his frend he ut brohte

Him self he þolede deað for hem wel diere he hes bohte.
 Nolde hit moȝe don for mai ne suster [for] broðer
 Nolde sune don for fader ne no man for oðer.
 Vre alre louerd for his þralles ipined he was arode
 190 Ure bendes he unbond 7 bohte us mid his blode.
 We ȝieueð uneaðe for his luue a steche of ure breade
 Ne þenche we naht þar þat sal deme þe *quica* 7 þe deade.
 Muchel luue he us kedde wolde we hit understonde.
 Þat ure elderne mi`s´duden we habeð euel an honde.
 195 Deað cam in þis middenærd þurh ealde deueles
 onde

194. *misduden*] *u*
 over *e* MS.

7 senne 7 soreȝe 7 iswinch awatere 7 [a]londe.
 Vre foremes faderes gult we abugeð alle
 Al his ofsprung after him in harem is biualle
 Þurst 7 hunger. chele 7 hete 7 alle unhalðe.
 200 Þurh deað cam in þis middeneard 7 oðer unisalðe.
 Nare noman elles dead ne sic ne unsele
 Ac mihte libbe afremo ablisse 7 an hale. |
 Litel lac is gode lief þe cumeð of gode wille.
 7 eðlate muchel ȝieue þan his herte is ille
 205 Litel hit þuncheð maniman ac muchel was þe senne
 For hwan alle þolieð deað þe comen of here kenne
 Here senne 7 ec ure oȝen us muȝe sore ofþunche
 For senne we libeð alle her in soreȝe 7 in swunche.
 Seðen god nam swo mukel wrache for one misdede
 210 We þe swo ofte misdoð we muȝen us eaðe ofdrade.
 Adam 7 al his ofspreng for one bare senne.
 Was fele hundred wintre an helle a pine 7 unwenne.
 Þo þe ladeð here lif mid unrihte 7 mid wronge
 Bute hit godes milce do hie sulle wunie þar longe.
 215 Godes wisdom is wel muchel 7 alsse is his mihte
 Ac nis his mihte nowiht lasse ac biðer ilke wihte.
 More he one maiȝ forȝieue þan alle folc gulte cunne
 Self deuel mihte habben milce ȝief he hit bigunne.
 Þeþe godes milche secð iwis he mai hes finden
 220 Ac helle king is oreleas wið þo þe he mai binden.

207. After *muȝe*,
rewen deleted MS.

210. *þo* altered to
þe.

213. After *lif*, an
 erasure, on which
mid.

214. *do* corr. out of
to.

215. *mulchel* MS.
 After 7, an erasure.

Se deð his wille mast he sal habbe werest mede
His bað sal be wallinde pich his bed barnende glede.
Werse he doð his gode wines þan his fiendes
God silde alle godes friend wið swo euele friende.

225 Nafre an helle ine cam ne cumen ich þar ne reche
Þeih ich aches woreldes wele þare mihte feche.

225. Before *reche*,
þ erased MS.

Þeih ich wille seggen eow þat wise men us saden
7 [a] boc hit is write þar me hit mai rade. |

Ic wille seggen hit þo þe hit hem self nesten

230 7 warnin hem wið here unfreme 3ief hie me willeð
hlestē.

230. After *here*, an
erasure of one letter
MS.

Vnderstondeð nu to meward eadimen 7 arme

Ich wille tellen eow of helle pine 7 warnin eow wið harme.

An helle hunger 7 þurst euel two iferen.

Þos pine þolieð þo þe ware meteniðinges here.

235 Þar is woning 7 wop after ache strate

Hie fareð fram hate [to] chele fram chele to hate.

[Þ]an hie beð in þe hate chele hem þuncheð blisse

[Þ]an hie cumeð eft to chele of hate hie habbeð misse.

[E]iðer doð `hem´ wo inoh nabbeð none lisse.

240 [N]iten hweðer hem doð wers to nafre none wisse.

[H]ie walkeð afre 7 secheð reste ac hie hes ne mužen imeten.

[F]orþi þe hie nolde þe hwile hie mihten here senne beten.

[H]ie sec`h´eð reste þar non nis ac hie hies ne mužen ifinden.

[A]c walkeð weri up 7 dun se water doð mid winde

245 [Þ]at beð þo þe waren her an þanc unstedefaste

[7] þo þe gode biheten aihte 7 hit him ilaste.

[7] þo þe god werc bigunnen 7 ful endin hit nolden.

[N]u waren her 7 nu þar 7 nesten hwat he wolden

248. *mesten* MS.

[Þ]ar is pich þat afre walleð þar sulle wunien inne

250 [Þ]o þe ladeð here lif on werre 7 an unwinne.

250. After 7, *h*
erased MS.

[Þ]ar is fur þis hundredfeald hatere þan be ure.

[N]e mai hit quenche salt water ne auene stream ne sture.

[Þ]is is þat fur þat afre barneð ne mai no wiht [hit] quenche.

[Þ]arinne beð þe was to lef wreche men to swenche. |

Þo þe [waren] swikele men 7 ful of euele wrenchen.

256 7 þo þe mihten euel don 7 lief hit was to þenchen.

þe luueden rauing 7 stale hordom 7 druken

7 an defles werkes bliðeliche swunken.

þo þe waren swo lease men þat mes ne mihte leuen

260 Medzierne domes men 7 w`r`ongwise reuen.

þo þe oðer mannes wif was lief her oʒen eðlate

7 þo þe sunegeden muchel on druken 7 on ate.

þe wreche men binomen here aihte 7 leide his on
horde.

þe litel lete of godes bode 7 of godes worde.

265 7 þe his oʒen nolde ʒieue þar he iseih þe niede

Ne nolde ihere godes men þan he sat at his biede.

þo þe was oðer mannes þing leuere þan hit solde

7 waren alto gradi of siluer 7 of golde.

þo þe untrewnesse deden þan þe he solden ben holde.

270 7 leten al þat hie solden don 7 deden þat hie wolden.

þo þe waren ʒietceres of þis wereldes aihte

7 dude al þat þe loðe gost hem tihte to 7 taihte.

7 Al `þo` þe aniwise deuel iquemde

þo beð mid him in helle fordon 7 demde.

275 Bute þo þe ofðuhte sore here misdade

7 Gunne here gultes bete 7 betere lif lade.

þar beð naddren 7 snaken. eueten 7 fruden

þe tereð 7 freteð þo euele swiken þe niðfule 7 þe prude

Nafre sunne þar ne sineð ne mone ne storre.

280 þar is muchel godes hete 7 muchel godes oerre. |

Afre þar is euel smech þiesternesse 7 eie

Nis þar nafre oder liht þan þe swarte leie.

þar ligeð ateliche fiend in stronge raketeie

þat beð þo þe waren mid god angles swiðe heie.

285 þat beð ateliche fiend 7 Eiseliche wihten

þo sulle þe wreche sowle isien þe sinegeden þurh sihte

þar is se loðe sathanas 7 belzebub se ealde

Eaðe he muʒen ben sore ofdrad þe sullen hes bihealde.

Nemai non herte hit þenche ne tunge hit ne mai telle

290 Hwu muchele pine ne hwu fele senden in helle

258. *bliðeliche*] second *i* corr. out of *l*.

261. After *was*, erasure of three letters MS.

263. After *men*, one letter erased.

274. *hem* MS.

277. *fruden*] *d* corr. out of *ct* MS.

Of þo pine þe þar bieð nelle ich eow naht lie
 Nis hit bute gamen 7 glie of þat man mai here drie.
 7 3iet ne doð hem naht alse wo in þe loðe bende
 Swo þat he witen þat here pine sal nafre hebben ende
 295 Þar beð þe haðene men þe waren lazelease.
 Þe nes naht of godes bode ne of godes hease.
 Euele cristene men hie beð here iferen
 Þo þe here cristendom euele hielden here.
 7 3iet he beð awerse stede aniðer helle grunde
 300 Ne sullen nafre cumen út for peni ne for punde.
 Ne mai hem noðer helpe þar ibede ne almesse
 For naht solden bidde þar ore ne for3ieuenesse.
 Silde him elch man þe hwile he mai wið þos helle pine.
 7 warnie his frend þar wið swo ich habbe ido mine.
 305 Þo þe silde hem ne cunnen ich hem wille tache
 [I]ch can ben aiðer 3ief isal lichame 7 sowle lache. |
 Late we þat god forbet alle mankenne
 7 do we þat he us hat 7 silde we us wid senne.
 Luue we god mid ure herte 7 mid al ure mihte
 310 7 ure emcristen alse us self swo us tached drihte.
 Al þat me radeð 7 singed bifore godes borde
 Al hit hangeð 7 halt bi þese twam worde
 Alle godes lazes hie fulleð þe newe 7 þe ealde
 313. *godel* MS.
 Þe þe þos two luues halt 7 wile hes wel healde.
 315 Ac hie bieð wel arefeðheald swo ofte we gulteð
 alle
 315. *gulteð*] *t* over *ð*
 MS.
 For hit is strong te stonde longe 7 liht hit is to falle.
 Ac drihte *crist* 3eue us strengðe stonde þat we moten
 7 of alle ure gultes 3ieue us cume bote.
 We wilnieð after wereldes wele þe longe ne mai ilaste
 320 7 legeð mast al ure swinc on þing unstedefaste.
 Swunke [we] for godes luue half þat we doð for eihte.
 Nare we naht swo ofte bicherd ne swo euele bikeihte
 3ief we serueden god half þat we doð for erminges
 We mihten hebben more an heuene þa[n] 3ierles 7 kinges
 325 Ne muze we werien naðer ne wið þurst ne wið hunger

292. *mai* corr. out
 of *marg* MS.

307. After *þat*, w
 erased.

313. *godel* MS.

315. *gulteð*] *t* over *ð*
 MS.

Ne wid elde ne wið deað þe elder ne þe zeunger
 Ac þar nis hunger ne þurst. deað ne unhalðe ne elde. 326. After *elde*, *ne*
 Of þesse riche we þencheð to ofte of þare alto selde. *wið elde* MS.
 We solden biþenchen us wel ofte 7 ilome 329. *ilomo* MS.
 330 Hwat we beð to hwan we sullen 7 of hwan we
 come.
 Hwu litle hwile we bieð her hwu longe elles hware
 Hwat we mužen habben her 7 hwat we findeð þare. |
 Zief [we] waren wise men þus we solden þenchen
 Bute we wurðen us iwar þis wereld us wile drenchen
 335 Mast alle men hit zieueð drinken of on euele senche
 He sal him cunnen silde wel zief hit him nele screnche.
 Mid almihtin godes luue úte we us biwerien
 [W]ið þesses wreches woreldes luue þat hit ne muze us derien.
 Mid almesse. mid fasten 7 mid ibeden werie we us wid senne.
 340 Mid þo wapne þe god haued zieue alle mankenne.
 [L]ate we þe brode strate 7 þane weiȝ bene
 [Þ]e lat þe nieðe dal to helle of manne me mai wene.
 Go we þane narewe pað 7 þene wei grene 343. *Gowe* MS.
 [Þ]ar forð fareð wel litel folc 7 eche is fair 7 isene
 345 [Þ]e brode strate is ure wil. þe is loð te læte.
 [Þ]o þe folȝeð here iwil hie fareð bi þare strate.
 [H]ie mužen lihtliche cumen mid þare niðer helde
 [Þ]urh one godelease wude to one bare felde
 [Þ]a narewe pað is godes has · þar forð fareð wel feawe
 350 [Þ]at beð þo þe hem sildeð zierne wið achen unðeawe.
 [Þ]os goð uneaðe azien þe cliue 7 azien þe heie hulle 351. After *uneaðe*,
 [Þ]os leten al here iwil for godes luue to fulle. *cliue* deleted MS.
 [G]o we alle þane wei for he us wile bringe
 Mid þo feawe faire men bi fore þe heuen kinge
 355 [Þ]ar is alre blisse mast mid angles songe.
 [Þ]e is a þusend wintre þar ne þuncheð hit him naht longe. |
 Þe last haued blisse he haued sswo muchel þat he ne 357. After *haued*,
 bit no more *bli* deleted and *sse*
 Þe þat blisse forgoð hit sal him rewen sore. *corr.* into *sswo*.
 Ne mai non euel ne non wane ben in godes riche

360 Þeih þar ben wuniinges fele elch oðer uniliche
 Sume þar habbeð lasse blisse 7 sume þar habbeð more
 Elch after þat he dude her after þane þe swanc sore
 Ne sal þar ben bread ne win ne oðer kennes este
 God one sal ben ache lif 7 blisse 7 ache reste.
 365 Ne sal þar ben foh ne grai ne cunin ne ermine
 Ne aquerne ne metheschele ne beuer ne sabeline.
 Ne sal þar ben naðer scat ne srud ne wereldes wele none.
 Al þe blisse þe me us bihat al hit sal ben god one
 Ne mai no blisse ben alse muchel se is godes sihte.
 370 He is soð sunne 7 briht 7 dai abute nihte.
 He is aches godes ful nis him no wiht uten.
 Nones godes hem nis wane þe wunieð him abuten.
 Þar is wele abuten wane 7 reste abuten swunche.
 Þe mužen 7 nelleð þider cume hit hem mai ofþunche.
 375 Þar is blisse abuten treize 7 lif abuten deaðe
 Þo þe afre sulle wunie þar bliðe hie muze ben eaðe.
 Þar is ȝieuð abuten elde 7 hale abuten unhalðe
 Nis þar sareze ne sor non ne nafre unisalðe.
 Þar me drihte self isien swo se is mid iwisse
 380 He one mai 7 sal al ben angles 7 manne blisse. |
 7 þeih ne bed here eien naht alle iliche brihte
 Hi nabbeð naht iliche muchel alle of godes lihte
 On þesse liue he naren naht alle of ore mihte
 Ne þar ne sullen habben god. alle bi one wihte.
 385 Þo sullen more of him isien þe luueden hine more
 7 more icnowen 7 ec witen his mihte 7 his ore
 On him hie sulle finden al þat man mai to hleste
 On him he sullen ec isien al þat hie ar nesten.
 [C]rist sal one bien inoȝh alle his derlinges.
 390 [Þ]e one is muche more 7 betere þan alle oðer þinges.
 [I]noh he haueð þe hine haueð þe alle þing wealdeð
 [O]f him to isiene nis non sæd swo fair he is to
 bihelden
 [G]od is swo mere 7 swo muchel in his godcunnesse
 [Þ]at al þat elles was 7 is is fele werse 7 lasse.

381. *bed*, or *beð*:
 leaf pared away.

392. After *isiene*,
 erasure of one
 letter.

395 [Ne] mai hit nafre noman oðer seggen mid iwise
 [H]wu muchele murihðe habbeð þo þe beð in godes blisse
 [T]o þare blisse us bringe god þe rixleð a buten ende. 397. After *buten*,
 [Ð]ane he ure sowle unbint of lichamliche bende erasure of one
 [C]rist zieue us laden her swilch lif 7 habben her letter.
 swilch ende ;
 400 [Ð]at we moten þider cumen þane we henne wende.

A M E N.

POEMA MORALE:

PARALLEL TEXTS

Lambeth MS
Trinity MS

(LAMBETH MS.)

**ich em nu alder þene ich wes awintre 7 a
 lare.**
**Ich welde mare þene ich dede mi `wit`
 ahte bon mare.**
**Wel longe ich habbe child ibon a worde 7 a
 dede**
**þa`h` ich bo a wintre ald to zung ich em on
 rede.**
 5 vnnet lif ich habbe iled. 7 zet me þingþ ilede.
 þenne ich me biþenche wel ful sare ich me
 adrede.
 mest al þ-ich habbe idon bi fealt to childhade.
 Wel late ich habbe me biþocht ; bute God me
 nu rede.
 Fole idel word ich habbe iqueðen soððen ich
 speke kuðe.
 10 fole zunge dede idon ; þe me ofþinchet
 nuðe.

(TRINITY MS.)

Ich am nu elder þan ich was a wintre 7 a lore.
 Ich wealde more þan idude mi wit oh to be
 more
 To longe ich habbe child iben a worde 7 a dade.
 Þeih ibie a winter eald to jung ich am on rade.
 5 Vnnet lif ich habbe ilad 7 ziet me þincheð
 ilade
 Þan ibiðenche me þaron wel sore ime adrade.
 Mast al ich habbe idon is idelnesse 7 chilce.
 Wel late ich habbe me biþoht bute me god do
 milce.
 Fele idel word ich habbe ispeken seðen ich
 speken cuðe.
 10 7 fele zeunge dade idon þe me ofðinkeð
 nuðe.
 Alto lome ich habbe igult a werke 7 a worde.
 Alto muchel ic habbe ispend to litel ileid on
 horde.

Mest al þ me likede er nu ; hit me mislikeð
 þa muchel fulieð his wil ; hine solf he
 biswikeð.
 Ich mihte habbe bet idon. hefde ich þe iselþe.
 Nu ich walde ah ich ne mei ; for elde 7 for un
 helþe.
 15 Elde me is bistolen on. er ich hit wiste.
 ne michte ich seon bifore me. for smike ne for
 miste.
 Er3e we beoð to done god. 7 to ufele al to
 þriste.
 Mare eie stondeð men of monne þanne hom do
 of criste.
 þe wel ne doð þe hwile þe ho mu3en. wel oft
 hit schal rowen ;
 20 þenne 3e mawen sculen 7 repen þ-ho er
 sowen.
 Do he to gode þ-he mu3e þe hwile þ-he bo
 aliue.
 ne lipnie na mon to | muchel to childe ne to
 wiue.
 þe him solue for3et for wiue ne for childe ;
 he scal cumen in uuel stude bute him God bo
 milde.
 25 **Sendeð** sum god bi foren eow. þe hw[i]lle þ-
 3e mu3en to houene.
 for betere is an elmesse biforen ; þenne boð
 efter souene.
 Alto lome ich habbe igult a werke 7 o worde.
 Al to muchel ich habbe ispent. to litel ihud in
 horde.
 Ne beo þe loure þene þe solf ; ne þin mei. ne
 þin maze.
 30 Soht is þ-is oðer`s´ monnes frond betre þen
 his a3en.
 Ne lipnie wif to hire were. ne were to his wiue
 bo for him solue ech .Mon. þe `h´wile þ-he bo
 aliue.
Wis is þe to him solue þench þe hwile þe mot
 libben.
 for sone wule hine for3eten þe fremede 7 þe
 sibbe.

Mast al þat me likede ar nu hit me mislicað.
 Þe mu[c]hel fol3eð his iwil him selfen he
 biswicað.
 15 Ich mihte habben bet idon. hadde ich þo
 iselðe
 Nu ich wolde ac ine mai for elde 7 for unhalðe.
 Elde me is bistolen on ar ich hit iwiste
 Ne mai ich isien bifore me for smeche ne for
 miste.
 Ar3e we beð to don god to juel al to þriste
 20 More eie stondeð man of man þan him do of
 criste.
 Þe wel ne deð þe hwile he mai wel ofte hit sal
 him rewen.
 Þan alle men sulle ripen þat hie ar sewen.
 Do al to gode þat he mu3e ech þe hwile he beð
 aliue.
 Ne lipne noman to muchel to childe ne to
 wiue. |
 25 Þe þe him selfe for3iet for wiue oðer for
 childe
 He sal cumen on euel stede bute him god be
 milde.
 Sende god biforen him man þe hwile he mai to
 heuene
 For betre is on almesse biforen þan ben after
 seuene.
 Ne bie þe leuere þan þe self ne þi mæi ne þi
 mowe
 30 Sot is þe is oðer mannes frend betere þan his
 owen.
 Ne hopie wif to hire were ne were to his wiue
 Be for him self afric man þe hwile he beð aliue.
 Wis þe him selue biðencheð þe hwile he mót
 libben
 For sone willeð him for3iete þe fremde 7 þe
 sibbe.
 35 Þe wel ne doð þe hwile he mai ne sal he þan
 he wolde.

35 þe wel ne deð þe hwile he mai ; ne scal
 wenne he walde.
 Monies monnes sare iswinc habbeð oft un
 holde.
 Ne scal na mon don afirst. ne slawen wel to
 done.
 for moni mon bihateð wel þe hit forzeteð sone.
 Þe .Mon. þe wule siker bon to habben Godes
 blisse.
 40 do wel him solf hwile þ-he mai ; þenne
 haueð he his mid iwisse.
 þes riche .Men. weneð bon siker þurh walle 7
 þurh diche.
 þe deð his echte on sikere stude he hit sent to
 heueneriche.
 for þer ne þerf he bon ofdred of fure ne of þoue
 þer ne | þerf he him binimen þe laðe ne þe loue.
 45 þer ne þerf he habben kare of zeve ne of
 zelde.
 þider he sent. 7 solf bereð to lutel 7 to selde.
þider we sculen drazen 7 don wel ofte 7
 ilome.
 for þer ne scal me us naut binimen mid
 wrangwise dome.
 þider 3e sculen 3orne drazen. walde 3e god
 ileue.
 50 for ne mei þer hit ou binimen king ne reue.
 Al þ-beste þ-we hefden þider we hit solde
 senden
 for þer we hit michte finden eft. 7 habben buten
 ende.
 Þo þe er doð eni God for habben godes are.
 al he hit scal finden eft þer 7 hundred fald
 mare.
 55 Þe þet echte wile halden wel hwile þe he
 muze es welden.
 Giue hies for godes luue ; þenne deþ hes wel
 ihalden.
**Vre swinc 7 ure tilþe is ofte iwoned to
 swinden.**
 Ach þ-þe we doð for godes luue ; eft we sculen
 al finden.
 Ne scal nan ufel bon unbocht. ne nan god
 unforzolden.

For manimannes sore iswinc habbeð ofte
 unholde.
 Ne solde noman don a furst ne laten wel to
 done
 For maniman bihoteð wel þat hi forzieteð sone.
 Þe man þe wile siker ben to habben godes
 blisse.
 40 Do wel him self þe hwile he mai þanne
 haueð hes mid iwisse.
 Þe richemen weneð siker ben þu`r`ch wallen 7
 thurh dichen.
 He deð his aihte an siker stede þe hit sent to
 heueriche.
 For þar`f he´ ben ofdrad of fure ne of þieue.
 Þar ne mai hit him binime þe loðe ne þe lieue.
 45 Þar ne þarf he habben care of here ne of
 zielde
 Þider we sendeð 7 ec bereð to litel 7 to selde.

 Þider `we solden´ drawen 7 don wel ofte 7
 ilome.
 For þar ne sal me us naht binime mid wrong
 wise dome. |
 Þider we solde 3ierne drawen wolde 3ie me
 ileuen.
 50 For ne mai hit us binime no king ne no
 sýrreue.
 Alþat beste þat we habbeð her þider we solde
 sende.
 For þar we mihte finden eft. 7 habben abuten
 ende.
 Se þe her doð ani god for`to´ haben godes ore.
 Al he hit sal eft finde þar 7 hundredfealde
 more.
 55 Se þe aihte wile holde wel þe hwile hes
 muze wealden.
 3ieue hes for godes luue þanne doð hes wel
 ihealden.
 For ure swinch 7 ure tilðe is ofte wuned to
 swinde.
 Ac al þat we 3ieueð for godes luue al we hit
 sulen eft finden.
 Ne sal þar non euel ben unboht ne god
 unforzolden.

60 vfel we doþ al to muchel. 7 god lesse þenne
we sculden.

Þo þe mest doð nu to gode. 7 þe lest to laðe.
Eiðer to litel 7 to muchel scal þunchen eft hom
baþe.

Þer me scal ure werkes weien biforan þe heuen
king.

and 3euen us ure swinkes lan efter ure erninge.

**65 Ech mon mid þ-he hauet. mei buggen
houene riche.**

þe mare haueþ 7 þe þe lesse ; baþe hi | mu3en
iliche.

Also mid his p`e´nie also oðer mið his punde.

þ-is þe wunderlukeste chep ; þ-eni mon efre
funde.

7 þe ðe mare ne mai don ; do hit mid his gode
þonke.

70 Also wel se þe þe haueð golde fele manke.
7 oft god kon mare þonc þen þe him 3eueð
lesse.

7 his werkes 7 his we3es his milce. 7
rihtwisnesse.

lutel lac is gode lof ; þ-kumeð of gode wille.
7 eclate muchel 3eue of þan þe herte is ille.
75 Houene 7 horþe he ouer sich. his e3en boð
swa brichte.

Sumne 7 mone 7 houen fur boð þestre a3ein his
lihte.

Nis him noht forholen ni hud. swa muchele
boð his mihte.

nis hit ne swa derne [idon] ne [a] swa þostre
nihte.

he wat wet þenkeð 7 hwet doð alle quike wihte.

80 Nis na lauere swich se is crist. ne king
swuch ure drihten.

houene 7 orðe 7 al þ-is biloken is in his honde.

he deð al þ-his wil is ; a wettre 7 alonde.

He makede fisses in þe se 7 fu3eles in þe lifte.
he wit 7 waldeð alle þing 7 scop alle scefte.

85 he is hord buten horde 7 ende buten ende.
he ane is eure an ilche stude wende þer þu
wende.

he is buuen us 7 binopæn. biforen 7 bihinden.

60 Euel we doð alto muchel 7 god lasse þan we
solden.

Se þe mast doð nu to gode 7 se last to lothe.
Eiðer to litel 7 to muchel hem sal þunche boðe.
Þar me sal ure werkes weizen bifore þan heuen
kinge.

7 3ieuen us ure werkes lean after ure erninge.

65 Africh man mid þat he haueð mai bugge
heueriche

þe þe more haueð 7 þe þe lasse boðe iliche.
Also on mid his peni se oðer mid his punde
Þis is þet wunderlukeste ware þat animan
funde.

7 se þe more ne mai don mid his gode iþanke.
70 Also wel se þe þe haueð golde fele manke.
And ofte god can more þanc þan þe him 3ieueð
lasse.

Al his werkes 7 his weies is milce 7
rihtwi[s]nesse. |

Litel lóc is gode lef þe cumeð of gode wille
7 eðlate muchel 3ieue þan his herte is ille.
75 Heuene 7 erðe he ouer sihð his eien beð ful
brihte.

Nis him no þing forholen swo muchel is his
mihte.

Ne bie hit no swo derne idon ne on swo þuster
nihte.

He wot hwat þencheð 7 hwat doð alle quike
wihte

Nis louerd swilch is crist ne king swilch ure
drihte

80 Boðe 3iemeð þe his bien bi daie 7 bi nihte.
Heuene 7 erðe 7 al þat is biloken is in his
honden

He doð al þat his wille is awatere 7 alonde.
He makeð þe fisses in þe sa þe fueles on þe
lofte.

He wit 7 wealdeð alle þing 7 he sop alle safte.
85 He is ord abuten ord 7 ende abuten ende

þe þe deð godes wille uwer he mei him finden.

Helche rune he iherð 7 wat alle deden.

90 he þurþsicheþ uches monnes þonc. Wi hwat
scal us to rede.

We þ-brokeð godes hese 7 gulteð swa ilome.
hwet scule we seggen oðer don et þe muchele
dome.

Þa þe luueden unriht 7 ufel lif | leden.

Wet sculen ho seggen oðer don ; þen þe engles
bon ofdred.

95 **hwet sculen we beren** biforen us mid hom
scule we iquemen.

þo þe neure god ne dude þe houenliche deme.
þer sculen bon doule swa fole þ-wulleð us for
wreien.

7 nabbeð hi naþing forþeten of al þ-ho iseþen.

Al þ-we misduden her ; ho hit wulleð kuðe
þere.

100 [buten wé habbe hit íbét. ðe hwile wé her
wére]

Al ho habbeð in hore write ; þ-we misduden
here.

þach we nusten ne niseþen. ho weren ure ifere.

Hwet sculen ordlinghe`s don. þa swicen 7 ta
forsworene

hwi boð fole iclepede. 7 swa lut icorene.

105 wi hwi weren ho biþeten to hwon weren ho
iborene.

þ-sculen bon to deþe idemet. 7 eure ma for
lorene.

Ech .Mon. scal him solue þer biclepie 7
bidemen.

his aþen werch 7 his þonc te witnesse he scal
temen.

ne mei him na .Mon. alsa wel demen ne alswa
rihte

110 for nan ne knauð him ase 3ere ; buten ane
drihte.

Ech .Mon. wat him solue best ; his werkes. 7
his wille.

He is one afre on eche stede wende þar þu
wende.

He is buuen us 7 bineðen biforen 7 bihinde
þe godes wille doð aihware he mai3 him finde

Elche rune he hereð 7 he wot alle dade

90 He þurhsihð elches mannes þanc wi hwat
sal us to rade.

We þe brekeð godes has 7 gulteð swo ilome
Hwat sulle we seggen oðer don áte muchele
dome

We þe luueden unriht 7 euel lif ladden

Hwat sulle we seggen oðer don þar ængles beð
ofdradde

95 Hwat sulle we beren us biforen mid hwan
sulle we iqueme

We þe nafre god ne duden þan heuenliche
deme. |

þar sulle ben deflen swo fele þat willeð us
forwreien.

Nabbeð hie no þing forþieten of þat hie her
iseien.

Alþat hie iseien her hie willeð cuðen þare

100 Bute we haben hit ibet þe hwile we here
waren.

Al hie habbeð on here write þat we misduden
here.

Þeih we hes ne niseien hie waren ure iferen.

Hwat sullen horlinges don þes wichen 7 þe
forsworene

Wi swo fele beð icleped swo fewe bed icorene

105 Wi hwi waren hie biþiete to hwan waren
hie iborene.

þe sulle ben to deaðe idemd 7 afremo
forlorene.

Elch man `sal´ þar biclepien himselfen 7 ec
demen.

His oþen werc 7 his þanc to witnesse he sal
temen.

Nemai him noman alse wel demen ne alse rihte

110 For non ne cnoweð hine alse wel buten one
drihte.

Man wot him self best his werkes 7 his wille.

Se þe last wot he seið ofte mast se þit al wot is
stille

þe ðe lest wat biseiþ ofte mest ; þe hit al wat is stille.

nis nan witnesse alse muchel se monne`s´ azen horte.

Wa se seið þ-he bo hal. him solf wat best his smirte.

115 **Ech .Mon. scal h[i]m solf demen** to deðe oðer to liue.

þa witnesse of his azen werch ; hine þerto scal driue.

Al þet ech .Mon haueð idon soððen he com to monne

sculde he | hit sechen o boke iwwiten he scal iþenchen þenne.

Ah drihten ne demeð nenne .Mon. efter his biginnigge.

120 ah al his lif scal bon suilch boð his endinge.

3ef þ-his uuel al hit is uuel 7 God 3efe god his ende.

God 3eue þ-ure ende bo god. 7 wite þ-he us lende.

þe .Mon. þ-uuel don na god. ne neure god lif leden.

er deð 7 dom come to his dure he mei him sare adreden.

125 þ-he ne mu3e þenne biden are. for þ-itit ilome.

forþi he is wis þe biet 7 bit 7 bet bi fore dome.

Wenne deð is attere dure wel late he biddeþ are.

Wel late he latheð uuel werc ; þe ne mei hit don ne mare.

þ-achten we to leuen wel. for ure drihten solf hit seide.

130 A hwilke time se eure .Mon. of þinchþ his misdade.

Oþer raþer oðer later ; milce he scal imeten.

Ac þe þ-þer naf[ð] nocht ibet ; wel muchel he haueð to beten.

Nis no witnesse alse muchel se mannes o3en hierte

Hwo se seið þat hie beð hol him self wot his smierte.

115 Elch man sal him selfen demen to deaðe oðer to liue.

þe witnesse of his o3en werc to oðer þan hine sal driue.

Alþat afri man haueð idon seðen he cam to manne

Swo he hit iseie abóc iwrite he sal hit þenche þanne.

Ac drihte ne demeð noman after his biginninge

120 Ac al his lif sal ben teald after his endinge. |

3ief þe endinge is god al hit is god· 7 euel 3ief euel is þe ende.

God 3ieue þat ure ende be god 7 3ieue þat he us lende.

Se man þe nafre nele don god ne nafre god lif lade.

Are deað 7 dom cumeð to his dure he mai3 him sore adrade

125 þat he ne mu3e þanne bidden ore for þat itit ilome.

Forþi he wis þe bit 7 bi3iet 7 bet bi fore dome.

þanne þe deað is ate dure wel late he biddeð ore.

Wel late he lateð euel werc þan he hit ne mai don no more.

Senne lat þe 7 þu nah him þan þu hit ne miht do no more ;

130 Forþi he is sot þe swo abit to habben godes ore.

þeih hweðere we hit leueð wel for drihte self hit sade.

Elche time sal þe man ofþunche his misdade Oðer raðer oðer later milce he sal imete.

Ac þe þe her naueð ibet muchel he haueð to bete

**Monimon seit hwa rechð of pine þe scal
habben þende.**

Ne bidde ich na bet bo alesed a domes dei of
bende.

135 lutel he wat wet is pine. 7 lutel he hit
scaweð

hwice hete is þer þa saule wuneð hu biter wind
þer blaweð.

hefde he bon þer enne dei oðer twa bare tide ;
nolde he for al middenerd þe þerdde þer
abiden.

þet habbeð iseid þ[e] comen þonen þa hit
wisten mid iwissen.

140 wa wurð sorþe seueþer. for souenihte
blisse.

**In hure blisse þe | þe ende haueð. for endelese
pine.**

betere is wori water drunch ; þen atter meind
mid wine.

Swines brede is swiðe swete. swa is of wilde
dore.

alto dore he is abuh ; þe 3efð þer fore his
swore.

145 Ful wombe mei lihtliche speken of hunger.
7 of festen ;

swa mei of pine þe ne cnauð þe scal a ilesten.

Hefð he ifonded summe stunde ; he wolde al
seggen oðer.

Et lete him were wif. child. suster. feder 7
broðer.

**Al he walde 7 oðerluker don 7 oðerluker
þenchen**

150 Wenne he biþohte on helle fur þe nawiht
ne mei quenchen.

Eure he walde her inne wawe 7 ine wene
wunien ;

Wið þ-þe mihte helle pine biflien 7 bisunien
Et lete him were al world wele 7 orðliche
blisse.

for to þ-muchele blisse cumen is murþe mid
iwise.

**155 Iwule nu cumen eft to þe dome þ-ich er
ow of sede**

A þa dei 7 at ta dome us helpe crist 7 rede.

135 Maniman seið hwo reche pine þe sal
habben ende

Ne bidde ich no bet bie ich alesed a domesdai
of bende.

Litel wot he `h´wat is pine 7 litel he cnoweð
Hwilch hit is þar sowle wunieð hwu biter wind
þar bloweð.

Hadde he ben þar on oðer two bare tiden.

140 Nolde he for al middeneard þe þridde þar
abiden.

Þat habbed isaid þe come þanne þit wiste mid
iwise.

Wo wurð soreþe seue þier for seue nihte blisse.

7 ure blisse þe ende haueð for endelease pine
Betere is wori water þan atter imengd mid
wine.

145 Swines brade is wel swete swo is of wilde
diere.

Ac al to diere he hit abuið þe 3iefð þarfore his
swiere.

Ful wombe mai lihtliche speken of hunger 7 of
fasten

Swo mai of pine þe not hwat is pine þe sal
ilasten. |

Hadde fonded sume stunde he wolde seggen
oðer

150 Eðlate him ware wif 7 child suster 7 fader
7 broðer.

Al he wolde oðerluker don 7 oðerluker þenche
þan he biðohte an helle fur þat nowiht ne mai
quenche.

Afre he wolde her in wo 7 in wane wunien
Wiðþan he mihte helle fur biflen 7 bisunien.

155 Eðlate him ware al wele 7 erðeliche blisse
For to þe muchele blisse cume þis murie mid
iwise.

¶Ich wulle nu cumen eft to þe dome þe ich eow
ar of sade.

On þe daie 7 on þe dome us helpe crist 7 rade

þer we mužen bon eþe offerd 7 herde us
 adreden.
 þer he scal al son him bi foren his word 7 ec his
 deden.
 Al scal þer bon þenne cud þer men lužen her
 ent stelen.
 160 Al scal þer bon þanne unwron ; þ-men
 wružen her 7 helen.
 We sculen alre monne lif iknauwen alse ure
 ahen.
 þer sculen eueningges bon þe riche 7 þe laze.
 Ne scal na mon skamie þer ne þerf he him a
 dreden.
 Gif him her ofþincþ | his gult 7 bet his
 misdede.
 165 for him ne scameþ ne ne gromeð þe sculen
 bon iboržen.
Ach þoþre habbeþ scome 7 grome 7 oft fele
 sorze.
Þe dom scal sone bon idon ne lest he nawiht
 longe.
 ne scal him na mon mene þer of strengþe ne of
 wronge.
 þe sculen habbe herdne dom þa her weren
 herde.
 170 þa þe uuele holden wreche men 7 uuele
 laze redde.
 Ec efter þ-he efp idon sal þer þenne [beon]
 idemet.
 [bliðe mei hé ðenne beon. þe god háfð wel
 icwemed]
Alle þa þi sprunge boþ of adam 7 of eue.
 Alle hi sculen cumen þider for soðe we hit
 ileueð.
 175 þa þe habbeð wel idon efter hore mihte.
 to houene riche hi sculen faren forð mid ure
 drihte.
 Þa þe habbeð doules werc idon. 7 þer inne bo
 ifunde.
 hi sculen faren forð mid him in to helle grunde.
 Þer hi sculen wunien a buten are 7 ende.
 180 Ne brekeþ neure drihte helle gate for lesen
 hi of bende.
**Nis na sullic þech hom bo wa 7 hom bo
 uneade.**
 Ne scal neure eft crist þolie deþ for lesen hom
 of deaþe.

Þar we mužen ben sore offerd 7 harde us
 ofdrade.
 160 Þar elch sal al isien him bi foren his word 7
 ec his dade.
 Al sal þar ben þanne cuð þat men lužen her 7
 halen.
 Al sal þar ben þanne unwrien þat men her
 hudden 7 stalen.
 We sullen alre manne lif icnowen alse ure ozen
 Þar sullen efniges ben to þe heie 7 to þe loze.
 165 Ne sal þeih no man samie þiar ne þarf he
 him adrade.
 3ief him her ofþincheð his gult 7 bet his mis
 dade.
 For hem ne sameð ne ne grameð þe sulle ben
 iboreze
 Ac þoðre habbeð same 7 grame 7 oðer fele
 soreze.
 Þe dom sal ben sone idon ne last hit nowiht
 longe
 170 Ne sal him noman mene þar of strençðe ne
 of wronge
 Þo sulle habben hardne dom þe here waren
 hardde
 Þo þe euel hielden wreche men 7 euel laze
 arerde.
 Elch after þat he haueð idon sal þar ben þanne
 idemd
 Bliðe mai he þanne ben þe god haueð wel
 iquemd.
 175 Alle þo þe sprunge beð of adam 7 of eue
 Alle hie sulle þider cume for soðe we hit
 ileued. |
 Þo þe habbed wel idon after here mihte
 To heueriche hie sulle fare forð mid ure drihte.
 Þo þe deueles werkes habeð idon 7 þarinne beð
 ifunde
 180 Hie sulle fare forð mid hem into helle
 grunde.
 Þar hie sulle wunien abuten ore 7 ende.
 Brecð nafre eft crist helle dure for lesen hem of
 bende
 Nis no sellich þeih hem be wo 7 þeih hem be
 uneaðe
 Ne sal nafre eft crist þolien deað for lesen hem
 of deaðe.

Enes drihten helle brec his frond he ut brochte.
him solf he þolede deð for him . wel dore he
hom bohte.

185 Nalde hit mei do for mei. ne suster for
broðer.
nalde hit sune do for fader. ne na mon for oðer.

Vre alre lauereð for his þrelles ipined wes a
rode.

vre bendes he unbon[d] 7 bohte us mid his
blode.

We 3eueð | uneðe for his luue a stuche of ure
brede.

190 Ne þenke we noht þ he scal deme þa quike
7 þa dede.

Muchele luue he us cudde. walde we hit
understonde

þ ure eldre misduden ; we habbeð uuele on
honde.

Deþ com in þis middenerde þurh þes doules
honde.

7 sake 7 sor3e 7 swinc a watere 7 a londe.

195 **Vre forme fader** gult. we abuzeð alle.
[eal his of spring efter him. en hearne is bi
fealle.]

þurst 7 hunger. chele 7 hete. helde 7 unhelðe.
þurh him deð com in þis middenerd 7 oðer
uniselðe.

Nere namon elles ded ne sec ne nan unsele.

200 ac mihten libben eure ma a blisse 7 a hele.

lutel hit þuncheð moni mon. ac muchel wes þa
sunne.

for hwan alle þolieð deð þe comen of hore
cunne.

Hore sunne 7 ec ure a3en sare us mei of
þinche.

þurh sunne we libbeð alle in sor3e 7 in swinke.

205 Suððen God nom swa muchele wrake for
are misdede ;

We þe swa muchel 7 swa ofte misdoð. we
mu3en eðe us adrede.

Adam and his ofspring for are bare sunne.

Wes fele undret wintre an helle pine 7 an
unwunne.

þa þe ledden hore lif mid unriht 7 mid wrange.

185 Ænes drihten helle brac his frend he ut
brohte

Him self he þolede deað for hem wel diere he
hes bohte.

Nolde hit mo3e don for mai ne suster [for]
broðer

Nolde sune don for fader ne no man for oðer.

Vre alre louereð for his þralles ipined he was
arode

190 Ure bendes he unbond 7 bohte us mid his
blode.

We 3ieueð uneaðe for his luue a steche of ure
breaðe

Ne þenche we naht þar þat sal deme þe quica 7
þe deade.

Muchel luue he us kedde wolde we hit
understonde.

þat ure elderne mi` s`duden we habeð euel an
honde.

195 Deað cam in þis middenærd þurh ealde
deueles onde

7 senne 7 sore3e 7 iswinch awatere 7 [a]londe.

Vre foremes faderes gult we abugeð alle

Al his ofspring after him in harem is biualle
þurst 7 hunger. chele 7 hete 7 alle unhalðe.

200 þurh deað cam in þis middeneard 7 oðer
unisalðe.

Nare noman elles dead ne sic ne unsele

Ac mihte libbe afremo ablisce 7 an hale. |

Litel lac is gode lief þe cumeð of gode wille.

7 eðlate muchel 3ieue þan his herte is ille

205 Litel hit þuncheð maniman ac muchel was
þe senne

For hwan alle þolieð deað þe comen of here
kenne

Here senne 7 ec ure o3en us mu3e sore of
þunche

For senne we libeð alle her in sore3e 7 in
swunche.

Seðen god nam swo mukel wrache for one
misdede

210 We þe swo ofte misdoð we mu3en us eaðe
ofdrade.

Adam 7 al his ofspreng for one bare senne.

Was fele hundred wintre an helle a pine 7
unwenne.

þo þe ladeð here lif mid unrihte 7 mid wronge

210 buten hit gode`s´ milce do ho sculen bon
þer wel longe.

Godes wisdom is wel muchel 7 alswa is his
mihte

7 nis his milce naut lesse. ac bi þan ilke
iwichte.

Mare he ane mei forʒeuen. þen | al folc gulte
cunne.

Sulf douel mihte hebben milce. ʒif he hit
bigunne.

215 Ða þe godes milce secheð ; he iwis mei ha
ifinden.

Ac helle king is areles with þa þe he mei
binden.

þe þe deþ is wille mest ; he haueð wurst mede.
His baþ scal bon wallinde. his bað scal bon
berninde glede.

Wurst he deð his gode frond ; þenne his fulle
fond ;

220 God scilde alle godes frond. a wih swilche
freonde.

Neure in helle hi com. ne þer ne come reche.
þach ich elches worldes wele. þer me mahte
feche

þhis wulle seggen on þat wise men us seiden.
7 aboken hit writen þer [me] mei hit reden.

225 Ich hit wille seggen þan þe hit hom solf
nusten.

warni hom wið hore unfrome. ʒif ho me wulleð
lusten.

vnderstondeð nu to me edi men 7 arme.

Ich wulle tellen of helle pin ; 7 wernin ow wið
herme.

In helle his hunger 7 þurst ; twa uuele iuere.

230 þas þolieð þa [þe] weren maket niþinges
here.

Þer is waning 7 wow. efter eche streche.
ho fareð from hete to hete. 7 hech to frure þe
wreche.

þenne hi bið in þere hete ; þe chele him
punchet blisse.

þenne hi cumeð eft to þe chele ; of hete hi
habbeð misse.

Bute hit godes milce do hie sulle wunie þar
longe.

215 Godes wisdom is wel muchel 7 alsse is his
mihte

Ac nis his mihte nowiht lasse ac biðer ilke
wihte.

More he one maiʒ forʒieue þan alle folc gulte
cunne

Self deuuel mihte hebben milce ʒief he hit
bigunne.

Þeþe godes milche secð iwis he mai hes finden

220 Ac helle king is oreleas wið þo þe he mai
binden.

Se deð his wille mast he sal habbe werest mede
His bað sal be wallinde pich his bed barnende
glede.

Werse he doð his gode wines þan his fiendes
God silde alle godes friend wið swo euele
friende.

225 Nafre an helle ine cam ne cumen ich þar ne
reche

Þeih ich aches woredes wele þare mihte feche.
Þeih ich wille seggen eow þat wise men us
saden

7 [a] boc hit is write þar me hit mai rade. |
Ic wille seggen hit þo þe hit hem self nesten

230 7 warnin hem wið here unfreme ʒief hie
me willeð hlesten.

Vnderstondeð nu to meward eadimen 7 arme
Ich wille tellen eow of helle pine 7 warnin eow
wið harme.

An helle hunger 7 þurst euel two iferen.
Ðos pine þolieð þo þe ware meteniðinges here.

235 Ðar is woning 7 wop after ache strate
Hie fareð fram hate [to] chele fram chele to
hate.

[Ð]an hie beð in þe hate chele hem þuncheð
blisse

[Ð]an hie cumeð eft to chele of hate hie habbeð
misse.

[E]iðer doð `hem´ wo inoh nabbeð none lisse.

235 hi hem deð wa inoch nabbeð hi nane
blisse.

Nute hi hweþer hem deþ wurs mid neure nane
wisse.

hi walkeð eure 7 secheð reste | ac `ho´ ne
muzen imeten.

forþi þe ho nolden þe hwile þ-ho mihten here
sunne beten.

ho secheð reste þer nis nan. forþi ne muzen hi
es finden.

240 Ac walkeð weri up 7 dun ; se water deþ
mid winde.

þo boð þa þe weren her a þanke unstedefeste.
7 þa þe gode bihten heste 7 nolden hit ileste.
þa þe god werc bigunnen 7 ful enden hit
nolden.

Nu witen her. 7 nuðe þer. 7 nusten hwat hi
wolden.

245 þer is bernunde pich hore saule to bapten
inne.

þa þe ledden here lif in werre 7 in winne.
þer is fur þ-is undret fald hattre. þene bo ure.
Ne mei quenchen salt weter ne uersc of þe
burne.

þis is þ-fur þ-efre bernd ne mei nawiht hit
quenchen ;

250 Þer inne boð þa þe was to lof wreche men
to swenchen.

þa þe weren swikelemen 7 ful of uuel
wrenchen.

þa þe mihten uuel don. þe þe lef hit wes to
þenchen.

þe luueden tening 7 stale. hordom 7 drunken.
7 a doules werche bliþeliche swunken.

255 Þa þe weren swa lese þ-me hom ne mihte
ileuen.

Medierne domes men. 7 wrongwise reuen.
þ-oðer monnes wif lof. his azen etlete.

þo þe sungede muchel ; a drunke 7 an ete.
þe wreche mon binom his ehte. 7 leide his on
horde.

260 þ-lutel let of godes borde. 7 godes worde.

7 þo þe his azen nalde zeuen þer he isech | þe
node

240 [N]iten hweðer hem doð wers to nafre
none wisse.

[H]ie walkeð afre 7 secheð reste ac hie hes ne
muzen imeten.

[F]orþi þe hie nolde þe hwile hie mihten here
senne beten.

[H]ie sec`h´eð reste þar non nis ac hie hies ne
muzen ifinden.

[A]c walkeð weri up 7 dun se water doð mid
winde

245 [Þ]at beð þo þe waren her an þanc
unstedefaste

[7] þo þe gode bihten aihte 7 hit him ilaste.

[7] þo þe god werc bigunnen 7 ful endin hit
nolden.

[N]u waren her 7 nu þar 7 nesten hwat he
wolden

[Þ]ar is pich þat afre walleð þar sulle wunien
inne

250 [Þ]o þe ladeð here lif on werre 7 an
unwinne.

[Þ]ar is fur þis hundredfeald hatere þan be ure.

[N]e mai hit quenche salt water ne auene
stream ne sture.

[Þ]is is þat fur þat afre barneð ne mai no wiht
[hit] quenche.

[Þ]arinne beð þe was to lef wreche men to
swenche. |

255 Þo þe [waren] swikele men 7 ful of euele
wrenchen.

7 þo þe mihten euel don 7 lief hit was to
þenchen.

þe luueden rauing 7 stale hordom 7 druken
7 an defles werkes bliðeliche swunken.

þo þe waren swo lease men þat mes ne mihte
leuen

260 Medzierne domes men 7 w`r`ongwise
reuen.

þo þe oðer mannes wif was lief her ozen eðlate
7 þo þe sunegeden muchel on druken 7 on ate.
þe wreche men binomen here aihte 7 leide his
on horde.

þe litel lete of godes bode 7 of godes worde.

265 7 þe his ozen nolde zieue þar he iseih þe
niede

Ne nalde iheren godes sonde. þenne he hit
herde bode.
þe þ-is oðers monnes þing. loure þene hit
sculde.
7 weren to gredi of solure 7 of golde.
265 7 þa þe untrownesse duden þon þe ho scu`l
`den bon holde.
7 leten þet ho sculden don. 7 duden þ-ho
wolden.
þa þe weren eure abuten þisse worldes echte.
7 duden al þ-þe laþe gast hechte to 7 tachte.
7 alle þe þen anigewise doulen iquemde.
270 þa boð nu mid him in helle fordon 7
fordemet.

(EGERTON MS., SECOND COPY.)

Bute þá þe ofðufte sare heore misdade.
7 gunne heore gultes beten 7 betere líf læde.
þer beoð neddren 7 snaken. éuete 7 frute.
þa tereð. 7 freteð. þe uuele speke. þe nið
fulle. 7 te prute.
275 Neure sunne ðer ne scínð. ne mone ne
steorre.
þer is muchel godes hate. 7 muchel godes
eorre.
Æure ðer ís uuel sméch. ðusternesne 7 eie.
nis ðer neure oðer líht. ðene þe swierte leie.
þer ligget ladliche fund. in strange raketeze.
280 þ-beoð þa ðe wére mid gode on heuene
wel heze.
þer beoð ateliche fund. 7 eisliche wihte.
þas scule þa wrecche ífon. þe sunezede ðurh
sihte.
þer is ðe laðe sathanas. 7 belzebud sé ealde.
eaðe hi muzen beo ofdréd. þe híne scule bi
healde.
285 Ne mei nan heorte hit iðenche. ne tunge ne
can telle.
hu muchel píne na hu uele sunden ínne helle.
Wið þa pine ðe þer beoð. nelle ich eow naht
leozen.
nis hit bute gamen 7 gléo. eal þ-man mei hér
dreozen.
End 3ut ne deð heom naht sa wá. ín ða laðe
bende. |

Ne nolde ihere godes men þan he sat at his
biede.
þo þe was oðer mannes þing leuere þan hit
solde
7 waren alto gradi of siluer 7 of golde.
þo þe untrewnesse deden þan þe he solden ben
holde.
270 7 leten al þat hie solden don 7 deden þat
hie wolden.
þo þe waren zietceres of þis wereldes aihte
7 dude al þat þe loðe gost hem tihte to 7 taihte.
7 Al `þo´ þe ani wise deuel iquemde
þo beð mid him in helle fordon 7 demde.

275 Bute þo þe ofðuhte sore here misdade
7 Gunne here gultes bete 7 betere lif lade.
þar beð naddren 7 snaken. eueten 7 fruden
þe tereð 7 freteð þo euele swiken þe niðfule 7
þe prude
Nafre sunne þar ne sineð ne mone ne storre.
280 þar is muchel godes hete 7 muchel godes
oerre. |
Afre þar is euel smech þiesternesne 7 eie
Nis þar nafre oder liht þan þe swarte leie.
þar ligeð ateliche fiend in stronge raketeie
þat beð þo þe waren mid god angles swiðe
heie.
285 þat beð ateliche fiend 7 Eiseliche wihten
þo sulle þe wreche sowle isien þe sinegeden
þurh sihte
þar is se loðe sathanas 7 belzebub se ealde
Eaðe he muzen ben sore ofdrad þe sullen hes
bihealde.
Nemai non herte hit þenche ne tunge hit ne mai
telle
290 Hwu muchele pine ne hwu fele senden in
helle
Of þo pine þe þar bieð nelle ich eow naht lie
Nis hit bute gamen 7 glie of þat man mai here
drie.
7 ziet ne doð hem naht else wo in þe loðe bende
Swo þat he witen þat here pine sal nafre habben
ende

290 þ-hí witeð þ-heore pîne sceal neure
 habbe ende.
 Þar beoð þa heðene men. þe wære lazelese.
 þe nes naht of godes biþode. ne of godes
 hese.
 [U]uele cristene men. hí beoð heore ifere.
 þa ðe heore cristendom. ueele heo`l`de hère.
 295 [3]ut hí beoð á wurse stede. on ðeré helle
 grunde.
 ne sculen hí neure cumen út. for marke ne
 for punde.
 [N]e mei heom naðer helpen þer. íbede ne
 elmesse.
 for nis naðer inne helle. áre ne forziuenesse.
 Sculde him éch man ðe hwile hé muze of ðas
 helle pîne.
 300 7 werni ech hís freond þer wið swa ich
 habbe mine.
 Þá ðe sculden heom ne cunne. ich heom wulle
 teche.
 ich kan beon zief ich sceal. lichame 7 sawle
 leche.
 Léte wé þ-god forbut. ealle manne cunne.
 7 do wé þ-hé us hét. 7 sculde wé us wið
 sunne.
 305 Luue we god mid ure heorte. 7 mid al ure
 mihte.
 7 ure émcristen eal us sulf. swa us larde
 drihte.
 Eal þ-me ráet 7 eal þ-me singð. bi fore godes
 borde.
 eal hit hanget 7 bihalt. bi ðisse twam worde.
 Ealle godes laze he fulð. ðe níwe 7 ða ealde.
 310 þe ðe ðas twá luue háfð. 7 wel hí wule
 healde.
 Ac hí beoð wonder earueðhealde. swá ofte
 gulteð ealle.
 Fór hit ís strang to stande lange. 7 líht ís to
 fealle.
 [A]ac drihte crist hé zíue us strengðe. stande þ-
 wé mote.
 7 of ealle ure gultes `unne´ us cume to bote.
 315
Wé wilnieð éfter woruld wéle. ðe lange ne
 mei leste.
 7 leggeð eal ure iswinc. ón ðinze unste`de´
 feste. |

295 Þar beð þe haðene men þe waren lazelease.
 Þe nes naht of godes bode ne of godes hease.
 Euele cristene men hie beð here iferen
 Þo þe here cristendom euele hielden here.
 7 ziet he beð awerse stede aniðer helle grunde
 300 Ne sullen nafre cumen út for peni ne for
 punde.
 Ne mai hem noðer helpe þar íbede ne almesse
 For naht solden bidde þar ore ne forziuenesse.
 Silde him elch man þe hwile he mai wið þos
 helle pine.
 7 warnie his frend þar wið swo ich habbe ido
 mine.
 305 Þo þe silde hem ne cunnen ich hem wille
 tache
 [I]ch can ben aiðer zief isal lichame 7 sowle
 lache. |

 Late we þat god forbet alle mankenne
 7 do we þat he us hat 7 silde we us wid senne.
 Luue we god mid ure herte 7 mid al ure mihte
 310 7 ure emcristen alse us self swo us tached
 drihte.
 Al þat me radeð 7 singed bifore godes borde
 Al hit hangeð 7 halt bi þese twam worde
 Alle godes lazes hie fulleð þe newe 7 þe ealde
 Þe þe þos two luues halt 7 wile hes wel healde.
 315 Ac hie bieð wel arefeðheald swo ofte we
 gulteð alle
 For hit is strong te stonde longe 7 liht hit is to
 falle.
 Ac drihte crist zeue us strengðe stonde þat we
 moten
 7 of alle ure gultes zieue us cume bote.

 We wilnieð after wereldes wele þe longe ne
 mai ilaste
 320 7 legeð mast al ure swinc on þing
 unstedefaste.

Swunche wé for godes luue. healf þ-wé doð for
æhte.

ne béo wé naht swá óf bicherd. ne sa uuele
bikehte.

3if wé serueden gode swa wé doð ermínges.

320 mare wé hedden en héuene. ðenne eorles
hér 7 kinges.

Né mužen hí werien heom wið chele. wið
þurste ne wið hunger.

ne wið ulde. ne wið deaðe. þe uldre ne ðe
zeonger.

Ac ðer nis hunger ne ðurst. ne dieð. ne unhelðe
ne elde.

of þisse riche wé ðencheð ófte. 7 of þere to
selde.

325 Wé scolden ealle us biðenche ófte. 7 wél
ilome.

hwét wé beoð to whán wé scule. 7 óf hwán
wé come.

Hú litle hwíle wé beoþ hér. hú lange elle`s´
hwáre.

hwét wé muže hebben hér. 7 hwét finde þere.

3ief wé were wise men. ðis wé scolde ðenche.

330 bute wé wurðe us íwer. ðeos woruld
wule us fordrenche.

Mest ealle men he 3íueð drinche. óf ane deofles
scenche.

hé sceal him cunne sculde wél. 3íf hé híne
nele screnche.

Mid ealmihtiges godes luue. ute wé us bi
werien.

wið ðises wrecches woreldes luue. þ-hé maze
us derien.

335 Mid festen ælmes 7 ibede. werie wé us wið
sunne.

Mið ða wepne ðe god haueð. bi 3íten man
cunne.

Léte wé þe brade strét. 7 ðene wei bene.

þe let þ-nizeðe dél to helle of manne. 7 ma
ich wéne.

Gá wé ðene nærewne wei. 7 ðene wei grene.

340 ðer forð fareð litel folc. ac hit is feir 7
scéne.

Þé brade strét is ure íwill. ðe ís us lað to
forláete.

Swunke [we] for godes luue half þat we doð for
eihte.

Nare we naht swo ofte bicherd ne swo euele
bikeiht

3ief we serueden god half þat we doð for
ermínges

We mihten hebben more an heuene þa[n]
zierles 7 kinges

325 Ne muže we werien naðer ne wið þurst ne
wið hunger

Ne wid elde ne wið deað þe elder ne þe zeunger

Ac þar nis hunger ne þurst. deað ne unhalðe ne
elde.

Of þesse riche we þencheð to ofte of þare alto
selde.

We solden biþenchen us wel ofte 7 ilome

330 Hwat we beð to hwan we sullen 7 of hwan
we come.

Hwu litle hwile we bieð her hwu longe elles
þware

Hwat we mužen hebben her 7 hwat we findeð
þare. |

3ief [we] waren wise men þus we solden
þenchen

Bute we wurðen us iwar þis wereld us wile
drenchen

335 Mast alle men hit 3ieueð drinken of on
euele senche

He sal him cunnen silde wel 3ief hit him nele
screnche.

Mid almihtin godes luue úte we us biwerien
[W]ið þesses wrecches woreldes luue þat hit ne
muže us derien.

Mid almesse. mid fasten 7 mid ibeden werie we
us wid senne.

340 Mid þo wapne þe god haued 3ieue alle
mankenne.

[L]ate we þe brode strate 7 þane weiþ bene

[Þ]e lat þe nieðe dal to helle of manne me mai
wene.

Go we þane narewe pað 7 þene wei grene

[Þ]ar forð fareð wel litel folc 7 eche is fair 7
isene

345 [Þ]e brode strate is ure wil. þe is loð te
læte.

[Þ]o þe folzeð here iwil hie fareð bi þare strate.

þa ðe eal folþeð hís íwill. fareð bi ðusse
 stréte.
 Hí mužen lihtliche gán mid ðere underhulde.
 ðurh ane godlíese wude `into´ ane bare felde.
 345 [P]e nærewei ís godes hése. ðer forðfareð
 wél fiewe.
 þ-beoð ða ðe heom sculdeð zeorne wið áche
 unðeawe.
 [P]as gað uníeðe zeanes ðe clíue. azean þe
 heaze hulle.
 ðas leteð eal heore azen wíll. for godes hése
 to fulle.
 [G]a wé alle þene wei. for he us wule bringe.
 350 mid te feawe feire men. beforen heuen
 kinge.
 Þer is ealre murhðe mest. mid englene sange.
 ðe ís a þusend wintre ðer. ne ðincð him naht
 to lange.
 Þe ðe lest haueð. hafð swa michel þ-hé ne bit
 namare.
 þe ða blisse for ðas forlét hít him mei reowe
 sare.
 355 [N]e mei nan uuel ne na wane beon inne
 godes riche.
 ðeh þer beoð wununges fele. æch oðer
 uniliche.
 Sume ðer habbeð lesse murhðe. 7 sume habbeð
 mare.
 æfter ðan þe dude her. efter ðan þ-he swanc
 sare.
 [N]e sceal ðer beon ne bried ne wín. ne oðer
 cunnes éste.
 360 god ane sceal beo eche líf. 7 blisse. 7
 éche reste.
 [N]é sceal ðer beo fah ne græi. ne kuning ne `er
 ´míne.
 ne aquierne. ne martres cheole. ne beuer né
 sabelíne.
 [N]e sceal ðer beo sciet ne scrud. ne woruld
 wele nane.
 eal þe murhðe þe me us bi hat. al hít sceal
 beo god ane.
 365 [N]e mei na murhðe. beo swa muchel. se is
 godes sihte.
 [H]e ís soð sunne 7 briht. 7 dei ábuten nihte.
 [H]e is ælches godes ful. nis him na wiðuten.
 na god nis him wane þe wunieð him abuten.

[H]ie mužen lihtliche cumen mid þare niðer
 helde
 [P]urh one godelease wude to one bare felde
 [P]a nærewei pað is godes has · þar forð fareð
 wel feawe
 350 [P]at beð þo þe hem sildeð zierne wið
 achen unðeawe.
 [P]os goð uneaðe azien þe cliue 7 azien þe heie
 hulle
 [P]os leten al here iwil for godes luue to fulle.
 [G]o we alle þane wei for he us wile bringe
 Mid þo feawe faire men bi fore þe heuen kinge
 355 [P]ar is alre blisse mast mid angles songe.
 [P]e is a þusend wintre þar ne þuncheð hit him
 naht longe. |
 Þe last haueð blisse he haueð sswo muchel þat
 he ne bit no more
 Þe þat blisse forgoð hit sal him rewen sore.
 Ne mai non euel ne non wane ben in godes
 riche
 360 Þeih þar ben wuniinges fele elch oðer
 uniliche
 Sume þar habbeð lasse blisse 7 sume þar
 habbeð more
 Elch after þat he dude her after þane þe swanc
 sore
 Ne sal þar ben bread ne win ne oðer kennes
 este
 God one sal ben ache lif 7 blisse 7 ache reste.
 365 Ne sal þar ben foh ne grai ne cunin ne
 ermine
 Ne aquerne ne metheschele ne beuer ne
 sabeline.
 Ne sal þar ben naðer scat ne srud ne wereldes
 wele none.
 Al þe blisse þe me us bi hat al hit sal ben god
 one
 Ne mai no blisse ben alse muchel se is godes
 sihte.
 370 He is soð sunne 7 briht 7 dai abute nihte.
 He is aches godes ful nis him no wiht uten.

Ɔer is wéle ábute gane. 7 reste abuten swinche.
370 þe mei 7 nele ðider cume. sare hit him
seal óf ðinche.

(EGERTON MS., FIRST COPY.)

Ɔer is blisse abuten treze. 7 lif abuten deaþe
þe eure scullen wunien þer. bliþe muwen ben
eþe
Ɔer is zeoþeðe bute ulde. 7 hele abuten vnhelðe
nis þer so`re`we ne sor. ne neure nan vn
sealþe
375 Ɔer me scal drihte sulf iseon. swa he is mid
iwise
he one mai 7 scal al beo. engle 7 manne
blisse
And ðeh ne beod heore eze naht. alle iliche
brihte
ði nabbed hi nouht iliche. alle of godes lihte
On þisse `liue` hi neren nout. alle of one mihte
380 ne þer ne scullen hi habben god. alle bi
one zihte
Ɔo scullen more of him seon. þe luuede him her
more
7 more icnawen 7 iwiten. his mihte 7 his ore
On him hi scullen finden alþat man mai to
lesten
hali boc hi sculle iseon. al þat hi her nusten
385 Crist scal one beon inou. alle his durlinges
he one is muchele mare 7 betere. þanne alle
oþere þinges
Inoh he haueð þe hine haueð. þe alle þing
wealdded
of him to sene nis no sed. wel hem is þe hine
bihealdeð
God is so mere 7 swa muchel. in his
godcunnesse
390 þal þ-is. 7 al þat wes is wurse. þenne he
7 lesse
Ne mai it neure no man oþer segge mid iwise
hu muchele murhðe habbet þo. þe beod inne
godes blisse
To þere blisse us bringe god. þe rixlet abuten
ende

Nones godes hem nis wane þe wunieð him
abuten.
Ɔar is wele abuten wane 7 reste abuten
swunche.
Ɔe muzen 7 nelleð þider cume hit hem mai of
þunche.

375 Ɔar is blisse abuten treize 7 lif abuten
deaðe
Ɔo þe afre sulle wunie þar bliðe hie muze ben
eaðe.
Ɔar is zieuð abuten elde 7 hale abuten unhalðe
Nis þar sareze ne sor non ne nafre unisalðe.
Ɔar me drihte self isien swo se is mid iwise
380 He one mai 7 sal al ben angles 7 manne
blisse. |
7 þeih ne bed here eien naht alle iliche brihte
Hi nabbeð naht iliche muchel alle of godes
lihte
On þesse liue he naren naht alle of ore mihte
Ne þar ne sullen habben god. alle bi one wihte.
385 Ɔo sullen more of him isien þe luueden
hine more
7 more icnowen 7 ec witen his mihte 7 his ore
On him hie sulle finden al þat man mai to
hleste
On him he sullen ec isien al þat hie ar nesten.
[C]rist sal one bien inoþh alle his derlinges.
390 [þ]e one is muche more 7 betere þan alle
oðer þinges.
[I]noh he haueð þe hine haueð þe alle þing
wealdeð
[O]f him to isiene nis non sæd swo fair he is to
bihelden
[G]od is swo mere 7 swo muchel in his
godcunnesse
[þ]at al þat elles was 7 is is fele werse 7 lasse.
395 [Ne] mai hit nafre noman oðer seggen mid
iwise
[H]wu muchele murihðe habbeð þo þe beð in
godes blisse
[T]o þare blisse us bringe god þe rixleð a buten
ende.

þenne he vre soule vnbint. of licames bende
395 Crist 3yue us leden her swilc lif. 7 habben
her swilc ende
þat we moten þuder come. wanne we henne
wende. AmeN.

[Þ]ane he ure sowle unbint of lichamliche
bende
[C]rist 3ieue us laden her swilch lif 7 habben
her swilch ende ;
400 [Þ]at we moten þider cumen þane we
henne wende.

A M E N.

IX. ANCRENE WISSE

(CORPUS MS.)

“i. Corpus Christi College, Cambridge, 402 (A); on vellum, 215 × 150 mm.... There are glosses in red pencil and words underlined in red.

“The MS. belongs to the second quarter of the thirteenth century. It cannot be earlier than 1225 A.D., for it mentions the Dominicans and Franciscans, and it is probably later than 1230. It is the most correct, but it has additions to the original, such as 62/46–64/62, 64/73–78.

“ii. Caius College, Cambridge, 234 (B); on vellum, 124 × 93 mm.; 368 pages; late thirteenth century. Pages 1-185 consist of extracts from the AR, but not in the order of the other manuscripts (ES iii. 536).

“iii. Cotton Nero A 14, British Museum (N); on vellum, 146 × 114 mm.; written in the second quarter of the thirteenth century. Its contents are ff. 1-120r, the Ancren Riwe; 120v-123v, [The Orison](#).

“iv. Cotton Titus D 18, British Museum (T); on vellum, 158 × 120 mm.; 148 folios in double columns, written from f. 14, where AR begins, to the end, about 1220 A.D.”

A. THE SEVEN DEADLY SINS

A (Caius MS.)

B (Corpus MS.)

B (Cotton MSS.)

A (Parallel Texts)

B (Parallel Texts)

Þvs mine leoue sustren iþe wildernessse þer 3e gað ; in · wið godes
folc toward ierusalemes lond · þ-is þe riche of heouene ; beoð þulliche
beastes · þulliche wurmes. ne nat ich na sunne þ-ne mei beon ilead
oðer to an of ham seouene ; oðer to hare streones. vnsteaðeluest
bileaue a3ein godes lare · nis hit te spece 5 of prude inobedience?
Herto falleð sygaldren · false teolunges · lefunge o swefne · o nore · 7
on alle wicchecreftes. Neomunge of husel in eani heaued sunne · oðer
ei oþer sacrament nis hit te spece of prude þ-ich cleopede *presumptio* ·

3ef me wat hwuch sunne hit · is · [f. 56 v] 3ef me hit nat nawt · þenne
 is hit 3emeles under 10 accidie · þ-ich slawðe cleopede. þe ne warned
 oðer of his uuel oðer of his bi3ete · nis hit slaw 3emeles oðer attri
 onde? teoheði mis · edhalden cwide · fundles oðer lane · oðer þerwið
 misfearen · nis hit spece of 3isceunge ; 7 aneS cunnes þeofðe?
 Edhalden oðres hure ouer his rihte terme nis hit strong reaflac hwase
 3elden hit mei þe is 15 under 3isceunge? 3ef me 3emeð wurse ei þing
 ileanet · oðer bitaht to witene · þen he wene þe ah hit · nis hit oðer
 triccherie · oðer 3emeles of slawðe? alswa is dusi heast oðer folliche
 ipliht trowðe · longe beon unbischpet · falsliche gan to schrift · oðer to
 longe abiden · ne teache pater noster godchild ne Credo · þeos 7 alle
 þulliche beoð ilead to 20 slawðe · þ-is þe feorðe moder of þe seoue
 sunnen. Þe dronc drunch oðer ei þing dude · hwer þurh na child ne
 schulde beon on hire istreonet · oðer þ-istreonede schulde forwurðen ·
 nis þis strong monslaht of galnesse awakenet? Alle sunnen sunderliche
 bi hare nomeliche nomen ne mahte namon rikenin · ah i þeo þe ich
 habbe 25 iseid ; alle oþre beoð bilokene. Ant nis ich wene namon þe ne
 mei understonden him of his sunne nomeliche under sum of þe ilke
 imeane þe beoð her iwritene. Of þeose seoue beastes 7 of hare streones
 i wilderness of anlich lif · is iseid herto · þe alle þe forfearinde fondið
 to fordonne. Þe liun of prude sleað alle þe prude · 30 alle þe beoð hehe
 7 ouerhohe iheortet. Þe attri neddre · þe ontfulle 7 te luðere iþonket.
 Wreaðfule ; þe vnicorne. Alswa of þe oþre o rawe. to godd ha beoð
 isleine · ah [f. 57 r] ha libbeð to þe feond · 7 beoð alle in his hond. 7
 seruið him in his curt euch of þe meoster þe him to falleð. 35

Þe prude beoð his bemeres · draheð wind inward wið worltlich
 hereword · 7 eft wið idel 3elp puffed hit ut ward as þe bemeres doð
 · makieð noise 7 lud dream to schawin hare orhel · ah 3ef ha wel
 þohten of godes bemeres of þe englene bemen þe schulen o fowr half
 þe world biuore þe grurefule dom grisliche blawen · Ariseð 40 deade
 ariseð cumeð to drihtines dom forte beon idemet · þear na prud
 bemere, ne schal beon iborhen · 3ef ha þohten þis wel ; ha walden
 inohreaðe i þe deofles seruise dimlukeR bemin. Of þeose bemeres seið

Jeremie · *Onager solitarius in desiderio anime sue*
attraxit uentum amoris sui · Of þe wind drahinde in for luue
45 of hereword seið as ich seide.

Summe iuglurs beoð þe ne cunnen seru in of nan oþer gleo bute
makien cheres · wrenche þe muð mis · schulen wið ehnen. Of þis
meoster seruið þe unseli ontful e i þe deofles curt · to bringen o lahtre
hare ondfule lauerd · 3ef ei seið wel oðer deð wel ; ne mahen 50 ha
nanes weis lokin þider wið riht ehe of god heorte · ah winkið o þ-half 7
bihaldeð oluft 3ef þer is eawt to edwiten · oðer ladliche þiderward
schuleð mið eiðer. Hwen ha ihereð þ-god ; skleatteð þe earen adun · ah
þe lust a3ein þ-uuel ; is eauer wid open · þenne he wrencheð þe muð ;
hwen he turneð god to uuel · 7 3ef hit is sumdel 55 uuel · þurh mare
lastunge wrencheð hit to wurse · þeos beoð forecwidderes hare ahne
prophetes · þeos bodieð · biuoren hu þe eateliche deoflen schulen 3et
ageasten ham wið hare grennunge · 7 [f. 57 v] hu ha schulen ham seolf
grennin 7 niuelin 7 makien sur semblant for þe muchele angoise i þe
pine of helle. Ah forþi ha 60 beoð þe leasse to meanen þ-ha biuoren
hond leornið hare meoster to makien grim chere.

Þe wreaðule biuore þe feond skirmeð mid cniues · 7 is his cnif
warpere · 7 pleieð mid sweordes · bereð ham bi þe scharp ord up
on his tunge. Sweord 7 cnif eiðer beoð scharpe 7 keoruinde word 65 þ-
he warpeð from him 7 skirmeð toward oþre · 7 he bodeð hu þe deoflen
schulen pleien wið him mid hare scharpe eawles · skirmi wið him
abuten 7 dusten ase pilche clut euch toward oðer · ant wið helle
sweordes asneasen him þurh ut · þ-beoð kene ant eateliche ant
keoruinde pineN. 70

Þe slawe lið 7 slepeð o þe deofles bearm as his deore deorling · 7 te
deouel leið his tutel dun to his eare · 7 tuteleð him al þ-he wule. for
swa hit is sikerliche to hwam se is idel of god ; meaðeleð þe feond
3eorne · 7 te idele underueð luueliche his lare. Jdel 7 3emeles is þes
deofleS bearnes slep · ah he schal o domesdei grimliche abreiden 75
wið þe dredfule dream of þe englene bemen · 7 in helle wontreaðe

echeliche wakieN. Surgite aiunt mortui surgite 7 uenite
ad iudicium saluatoriS.

Þe ȝiscere is his eskibah · feareð abuten esken · 7 bisiliche stureð
him to rukelin to gederes muchele 7 monie ruken · blaweð þrin 80 7
blent him seolf · peaðereð 7 makeð þrin figures of augrim · as þes
rikeneres doð þe habbeð muche to rikenin. Þis is al þe canges blisse 7
te feond bihalt tis gomen 7 laheð þ-he bersteð. Wel un [f. 58 r] derstont
euch wis mon þ-gold ba 7 seoluer · 7 euch eorðlich ahte · nis bute
eorðe 7 ahte esken þe ablendeð euch moN þe ham in blaweð · þ-85 is
þe bolheð him þurh ham in heorte prude. Ant al þ-he rukeleð 7 gedereð
togederes · 7 ethalt of ei þing þ-nis bute esken mare þen hit neodeð ;
schal in helle wurðen him tadden 7 neddren · 7 ba as ysaie seið ·
schulen beon of wurmes ; his cuuertur 7 his hwitel · þe nalde þerwið
neodfule feden ne schruden. *Subter te sternetur* 90 *tinea* 7
operimentum tuum uermiS.

Þe ȝiuere glutun is þe feondes manciple · ah he stikeð eauer iceler
oðer icuchene · his heorte is i þe disscheS · his þoht al i þe neppes ·
his lif i þe tunne · his sawle i þe crohhe · Kimeð biuoren his lauerd
bismuddet 7 bismulret · a disch in his an hond · a scale in his 95 oðer.
Meaðeleð mis wordes · wigleð as fordrunke mon þe haueð imunt to
fallen · bihalt his greate wombe · 7 te deouel lahheð. Þeose þreatið þus
godd þurh ysaie · *Serui mei comedent 7 uos esurietis 7*
c' · Mine men schulen eoten 7 ow schal eauer hungrin · 7 ȝe schule
beon feorle world buten ende. *Quantum glorificauit se 7 in*
deliciis 100 *fuit ; tantum date illi tormentum 7*
luctum · In *apocalipsi* · *Contra unum poculum*
quod miscuit miscete ei duo · ȝef þe kealchecuppe wallinde
bres to drinken · ȝeot in his wide þrote þ-he swelte inwið. aȝein an ȝef
him twa. þullich is godes dom aȝein ȝiuere 7 druncwile iþe apocalipse.

ANCREN RIWLE

(CAIUS MS.)

A. THE SEVEN DEADLY SINS

A (Corpus MS.) (above)

B (Corpus MS.)

B (Cotton MSS.)

A (Parallel Texts)

B (Parallel Texts)

[p. 127] **[p]**us mine leoue frend iþe wildernesse þat ge
gat in wid godes folc toward
ierusalemes londe þat is þe riche of heouene ;
beod þulliche bestes þulliche wurmes · Ne nat
ich nan sunne þat ne mai beon ilad · oþer to an of
ham seoluen oþer to hare streones · vnstapelfast
bileaue · agein hali lare · nis hit of 5 *prude* inobedience? Herto falled
sigaldren · false teolunges · Lefunge o nore. o swefne 7 alle
wicchecraftes. Neominge of husel in ei heaued sunne · oþer ai oþer
sacrement · nis hit spece of *prude* ; þat ich cleopede *presumpciun* · gif
me wat hwat sunne hit is. Gif me hit nat naut ; þenne is hit gemeles
vnder accidie · þat ich slouþe cleopede. 10 þe þat ne warned oþer of his
uuel · oþer of his bigete · nis hit slaþ gemeles oþer attri onde? To
thehewen mis · et halden cwude · fundes oþer lane · nis þis giscunge ;
þeofþe. athalden oþeres hure ouer his richte terme · nis hit strong
reflac. þat is under gissunge ; gif me gemed wurse ai þing [p. 128]
ilened · oþer bitahed te witene þen 15 he wene þat hit ah · nis oþer
tricherie · oþer gemeles of slaue. Alswa is dusi hest · oþer folliche
iplicht trouþe Longe beon unbischbed · falsliche gan to schrifte · oþer
to longe abiden · Ne teachen godchild *pater noster* · Ne Credo · þeos 7
alle þulliche · beod ilad to slaue · þat is þe feorþe moder of þe seoue
sunnan · þeo dronc druch 20 oþer ai þing dude hwer þurh na child ne

3. *sulliche* MS.
11. *bigete*] *b* corr. out
of *l*.
16. *tricherie*] over *c*,
contraction mark for
er.

shulde beon on hire istreoned · oþer þat istreoned shulde forwurpen ;
 Nis þis strong monslaht of galnasse awakened ; Alle sunnen
 sunderliche bi hare nomeliche nome ne mahte namon rikenen. Ah iþeo
 þat ich habbe iseid ; alle oþere beod bilokene. An nis ich wene namon
 þat ne mai 25 understonden him of his sunnen nomeliche wnder summe
 of þe ilke þat imene ; þe beod þer i writene.

[O]f þeos sewe bestes 7 of hare strenes iwildernesse of anlich lif
 is iseid hiderto [p. 129] þe alle þe forfarinde fondet te fordonne. þe
 Leon of prude slead alle þe prude. Alle þat beod 30 hehe 7 for hehe
 iheorted. þe aetri neddre ; þe ondfule. 7 þe lufere iþonked. wredfule
 þe unicorne. Al swa of þen oþer areawe. to god ha beod isleine · Ah ha
 libbed to þe feond 7 beod alle in is hird · 7 serued him in his curt ·
 Euch of þe mester þet him to falleð.

[þ]e prude beod his bemeres · Drahed wind
 in ward · of worldlich 35 hereword · 7 eft wid idel
 ige`l`p puffed hit utward · as þe bemeres dod.

43. *seid*] *d* above a
 blotted letter.

Makied noise 7 lud drem to shawen hare prude. Ah gif ha uel þohtten ·
 of godes bemeres of þe englene bemen · þat shulen afour half þe word
 · bi fore þe grurefule dom grisliche blawen · Arised deade arised ·
 Cumed to drichtines domes forto beon idemed · þer na prud 40 bemere
 ne shal beon iboregen · Gif ha þohtten wel þis · ha walden inoh raþe
 iþe deoueles seruise dimluker bemen. Of þeose bemeres sei`d` [p. 130]
 Jeremie · Onager solitarius in desiderio suo attraxit
 uentum amoris sui · Of þe wind drahinde in for lue of
 hereword ; seid as ich seide. 45

[S]umme iugelurs beod þe ne cunen seruin of
 nan oþer gleo buten maken cheres · wrenchen þe
 mud mis shuli wid þe ehnen. of þis mester seruid
 þe unseli eon`d`fule iþe deoueles curt · to
 bringen a lahtre hare on`d`fule leouerð. gef ei
 ded wel oþer seid wel ; ne mahen ha nanes weis

48, 49. *eondfule*,
ondfule] *d* above in
 darker ink.
 51. *out*] *ont* MS.
 53. *eawid* MS.
 55. On lower margin in
 a later hand: *Prude and*
nid · and lecherie ·
Grede and idelhed ·

liki þiderwarð wid richt ehe of god heorte · Ah 50
winked oþet half 7 bihalded aluft gif þer is out

*couetise and glotunie
beod seouen ded
Sundes.*

to etwite oþer ; ladliche þiderward shuled mid
eiþer. hwen ha ihered þat god skletteð þe earen adun · Ah þe lust agein
þet uuel is ea wid opene. þenne wrenched þe mud mis ; hwen he
turned þet god to uuel · 7 gef hit is [p. 131] sumdel uuel ; þurh more
lastunge wrenched hit to 55 wurse. þeos beod forquiddares hare ahne
prophetes. þeos bodied biuoren hu þe ateliche deouelen shulen get
agastan ham wid hare grennunge · 7 hu ha shulen ham seolf grennen 7
niwelen · 7 makien sur semblant · for þe muchele angoise iþe pine of
helle. Ah forþi ha beod þe lesse te meanen · þat ha bi foren hont
leorned ha meoster te 60 makien grim chere.

[þ] E wreadfule biuoren þe feond skirmed
mid kniwes · is his knif warpare · 7 pleied mid

67. apilche MS.

sweordes · bered ham bi þe sharpe ord open his tunge. swerd 7 knif
eiþer beoð sherpe 7 keorwinde : word þat he warped from him 7
skirmed toward oþere. And he boded hu 65 þe deouelen shulen pleien
wid him · mid hare sharpe eawles · Skirmin wid him abuten · 7 dusten
as a pilche [p. 132] clut · Euch toward oþere · 7 wid helle sweordes
asnesen þurh ut þat beod kene 7 eateliche keorwinde pinen.

[þ] E slauwe lid 7 sleped oþe deoules barm as his deore deorling · 7
70 þe deouel leid his tutel dun to his earen · 7 tutelid him al þat he
eawer uule. for swa hit is sikerliche to hwam se is idel of god ·
Meapeled þe feond georne. 7 þe idele underweng luueliche his lare ·
Idel 7 gemeles is þes deoueles bernas slep · Ah he shal a domes dai
grimliche abreiden · wid þe dredfule drem of þe englene bemen · 7 in
75 helle wondrede etheliche wakien · Surgite mortui qui
jacetis in sepulcris · surgite 7 venite ad Iudicium
saluatoris.

[þ] E gissere is his eskebah · fared abuten
esken · 7 bisiliche stured him te rukelen te
gederes · muchele 7 monie ruken · blawed þer
[p. 133] in · 7 blend him seolf · paþered 7 maked þerin figures of 80

*81. rich`k`eneneres
MS.*

augrim · As þeos rich`k´eneres dod þat habbed muche te rikenen. þis is
þes kanges blisse · 7 þe feond bihald þis gomen · 7 lahed þat he
bersteð. wel understonde þis euch mon · þat gold ba 7 seoluer · 7 euch
worldlich ahte · nis buten eorðe 7 esken þat ablent euchmon þat in ham
blaweð · þat is þat þat bolehed ham þurh ham in heorte 85 prude. And
al þat he rukeled 7 gedered togedere · 7 ethalt of ani þing þat nis buten
esken mare þen hit neodeð ; shal in helle wurden him tadden 7
neddren · 7 ba as ysaie seið shulen beon of wurmes his cuuertur 7 his
`þ´witel þat neolden warwið neodfule feden 7 shruden. *Subter te
sternetur tinea 7 operimentum tuum* 90 uermis.

[þ]e giuere glutun is þes deoules manciple · Ah he stiked eauer
feeler oþer icuche [p. 134] ne · his heorte is iþe dishes · his þoht al iþe
nappes · his lif iþe tunne · his saule iþe crohhe · kimed bi woren his
lauert bismudded 7 bismured · A dich in his an hond · A scale in 95 his
oþer · Meadeled mis wordes wigeled as for drunken · mon þat haued
mint to fallen · bihalt his greate wombe. 7 þe deouel lahheð. þeos
þreated þus god þurh ysaie · *Serui mei comedent 7 uos
esurietis 7 c´*. Mine men shulen eoten · 7 ow shal eawer hungren ·
7 ge shulen beon feondes fode world buten ende. *Quantum
gl[ori]ficauit* 100 *se 7 in deliciis fuit ; tantum
date illi tormentum 7 luctum · Apocalipsis ·
Contra unum quod miscuit date illi duo* · gef þen
kelchecuppe wallinde bras te drinken · geot in his wide þrote · þat he
swelte in wið. agein gef him twa. þullich is godes dom agein giwere 7
druncwile iþe apocalipse. 105

IX. ANCRENE WISSE (CORPUS MS.)

B. THE OUTER RULE

A (Corpus MS.)

A (Caius MS.)

B (Cotton MSS.)

[f. 112 v] 3e mine leoue sustren bute 3ef neod ow driue 7 ower meistre hit reade · ne schulen habbe na beast bute cat ane. Ancre þe haueð ahte · þuncheð bet husewif ase Marthe wes · ne lihtliche ne mei ha nawt beo Marie marthe suster wið griðfullnesse [f. 113 r] of heorte. for þenne mot ha þenchen of þe kues foddre · of heorde 5 monne hure · Olhnin þe heiward · wearien hwen he punt hire · 7 3elden þah þe hearmes. ladlich þing is hit wat crist hwen me makeð i tune man of ancre ahte. Nu þenne 3ef eani mot nedlunge habben hit · loki þ hit namon ne eili ne ne hearmi · ne þ hire þoht ne beo nawiht þron ifestnet. ancre ne ah to habben na þing þ outward drahe hire 10 heorte. Na chaffere ne driue 3e · ancre þ is chepilt · þ is · buð forte sullen efter bizete · ha chepeð hire sawle þe chapmon of helle. þing þah þ ha wurched ha mei þurh hire meistres read ; for hire neode sullen · hali men sumhwile liueden bi hare honden.

Nawt deore dehtren ne wite 3e in ower hus of oðer monne 15 þinges · ne ahte ne claðes · ne boistes · ne chartres · Scoren ne cyrograffes · ne þe chirch uestemenz · ne þe calices · bute neode oðer strengðe hit makie ; oðer muchel eie. Of swuch witunge is muchel vuel ilumpen ofte siðen. IN wið ower wanes ne leote 3e namon slepeN · 3ef muchel neod mid alle makeð breoken ower hus · hwil hit eauer is 20 ibroken · habbeð þrinne wið ow a wummon of cleane lif deies ant nihteS. FOR þi þ wepmen ne seoð ow ne 3e ham · wel mei don of ower clað beo hit hwit beo hit blac bute hit beo unorne · warm 7 wel iwraht · felles wel itawet · 7 habbeð ase monie as ow to neodeð to bedde 7 to rugge. 25

Nest flesch ne schal nan werien linnene clað bute hit beo of hearde 7 of greate heorden. Stamin habbe hwase wule · hwase wule beo buten. 3e schulen in an hetter ant igurd liggen · swa leoðeliche þah þ 3e mahen honden put [f. 113 v] ten þerunder. Nest lich nan ne gurde hire wið na cunne gurdles : bute þurh schriftes leaue. Ne 30 beore nan irn ne here · ne ilespiles felles · ne ne beate hire þerwið ; ne wið scurge i

leadet · wið holin ne wið breres · ne biblodgi hire seolf ; wiðute
schriftes leaue · nohwer ne binetli hire · ne ne beate biuoren · ne na
keoruunge ne keorue · ne ne neome ed eanes to luðere disceplines ·
temptaciuns forte acwenchen · ne for na bote 35 azein cundeliche
secnesses · nan uncundelich lechecreft ne leue 3e ne ne fondin · wið
uten ower meistres read ; leste ow stonde wurse. **O**wer schon i winter
beon meoke · greate 7 warme. I sumer 3e habbeð leaue bearuot gan 7
sitten 7 lihte scheos werieN · **H**osen wið ute vampeþ ; ligge in hwase
likeð · **I**scheoed ne slepe 3e nawt · ne 40 noh wer bute i bedde. Sum
wummon inohreaðe wereð þe brech of here ful wel icnottet · þe
streapeles dun to þe vet ilacet ful feaste · ah eauer is best þe swete 7 te
swote heorte. Me is leouere þ 3e þolien wel an heard word ; þen an
heard here. 3ef 3e muhen beo wimpelles 7 3e wel wullen ; beoð bi
warme cappen · 7 þeruppon hwite oðer blake veiles. 45 **A**ncren summe
sungið in hare wimplunge ; na leasse þen leafdis. Ah þah seið sum þ
hit limpeð to euch wummon cundeliche forte werien wimpel · Nai ·
wimpel ne heaued clað nowðer ne nempneð hali writ ; ah wriheles ane
· **A**d corinthios · **M**ulier uelet caput suum · Wummon seið þe
apostle schal wreon hire heaued. wrihen he seið 50 nawt wimpliN.
wrihen ha schal hire scheome · as eue sunfule dohteR · i mungunge of
þe sunne þ-schende us on earst alle · ant nawt drahe þe wriheles to
tiffunge 7 to prude · Eft wule [f. 114 r] þe apostle þ-wummon wreo i
chirche hire neb 3etten · leste uuel þoht arise þurh hire onsihðe · **E**t
h o c e s t p r o p t e r a n g e l o s . hwi þenne 55 þu chirc ancre
iwimplet openest þi neb to wepmonnes ehe ; tozeines þe sist men ;
spekeð þe apostle · 3ef þu þe ne hudest. ah 3ef þ-ei þing wriheð þi neb
from monnes ehe · beo hit wah beo hit clað · i wel i rund windowe ·
wel mei duhen ancre of oðer wimplunge. Tozeines þe þe þus ne dest ;
spekeð þe apostle nawt tozeines oþre · þ-60 hare ahne wah wriheð wið
euchmonnes sihðe. þer awakenið ofte wake þohtes of · 7 werkes
oðerhwileS. Hwase wule beon isehen ; þah ha atiffi hire nis nawt

muche wunder ; ah to godes ehnen ha is lufsumre ; þe is for þe luue of
 him ; untiffet wiðuteN. **R**ing ne broche ne habbe 3e · ne gurdel
 imembret · ne glouen ne nan swuch ⁶⁵ þing þow ne deh to habben. A
 meoke surpliz 3e mahen in hat sumer werien. **E**auer me is leouere se 3e
 doð greattre werkes. **N**e makie 3e nane purses forte freondin ow wið ·
 bute to þeo þower meistre 3eueð ow his leaue · ne huue ne blodbinde
 of seolc · ne laz buten leaue · Ah schapieð 7 seowið 7 mendið chirche
 claðes · 7 poure monne hettren. ⁷⁰ na swuch þing ne schule 3e 3eouen
 wiðuteN schriftes leaue · namare þen neomen · þ 3e ne seggen him
 fore ; as of oðre þinges · kun oðer cuððe · hu ofte 3e under uengen ·
 hulonge 3e edheolden. tendre of cunne limpeð nawt ancre beonne. A
 mon wes of religiun · 7 com to him efter help his fleschliche broðer · 7
 he tahte him to his þridde ⁷⁵ breðer · þe wes dead biburiet. Þe
 ondswerede wundrinde · Nai quooð he nis he
 dead? ant ich quooð þe hali mon [f. 114 v] am
 dead gasteliche. Na fleschlich freond ne easki me
 fleschlich froure. Amices 7 parures · worldliche
 leafdis mahen inoh wurchen · ant 3ef 3e ham
 makieð ; ne makie 3e þrof na mustreisun · veine
 gloire attreð alle ⁸⁰ gode þeawes · 7 alle gode werkes. Criblin ne schal
 nan of ow for luue ne for hure. Taueles ne forbeode ich nawt. 3ef sum
 riueð surpliz oðeR measse kemese ; opre riuunges ne riue ha nawt
 nomeliche oueregedede · bute for muche neode. **H**elpeð ow wið ower
 ahne swinc se forð se 3e eauer mahen to schriden ow seoluen 7 feden
 3ef ⁸⁵ neod is · 7 þeo þe ow seruið. **A**s sein Jerome leareð · ne beo 3e
 neauer longe ne lihtliche of sumþing allunges idel · for anan rihtes þe
 feond beot hire his werc þe i godes werc ne swinkeð · 7 tuteleð anan
 toward hire. foR hwil he sið hire bisi ; he þencheð þus · for nawt ich
 schulde nu cume neh hire ; ne mei ha nawt izemen to lustni ⁹⁰ mi lare.
 Of idelnesse awakeneð muchel flesches fondunge. Iniquitas
 Sodome ; saturitas panis 7 ocium · þis · SodomeS

75. to his] is on
erasure.

76. breðer] er on
erasure.

77. Before nis, d
erased.

cwedschipe com of idelnesse 7 of ful wombe. In þ-lið stille gedereð
sone rust · weater þe ne stureð nawt ; readliche stinkeð.

Ancre ne schal nawt forwurðe scolmeistre · ne turnen ancre husto 95
childrene scole · hire meiden mei learen sum oðer meiden · þ-were
pliht of to leornin amonge wepmen · oðer bimong gromes. ah ancre ne
ah to 3emen bute godd ane · þah bi hire meistres read ha mei sum
rihten 7 helpen to learen. 3e ne schulen senden leattres · ne underuon
leattres · ne writen bute leaue. 3e schulen beon i doddet · 100 oðer 3ef
3e wulleð ischauen fowr siðen i þe 3er · to lihtin ower heaued · beo bi
þe her ieueset ; [f. 115 r] hwase swa is leouere · ant as ofte ileten blod
7 3ef neod is ; oftre · þe mei beo þer buten ; ich hit mei wel þolien.

Hwen 3e beoð ilete blod ; 3e ne schule don na
þing þe þreo dahes þ-ow greueð · ah talkið to
ower 105 meidnes · 7 wið þeawfule talen schurteð

104. After *beoð*, *al*
greiðe struck out.
120. *towundre* MS.

ow togederes. 3e maheN swa don ofte hwen ow þuncheð heuie ; oðer
beoð for sum worltlich þing sare oðer seke · þah euch worltlich froure
is unwurðe to ancre. Swa wisliche witeð ow in ower blodletunge ; 7
haldeð ow i swuch reste ; þ-3e longe þrefter mahen i godes seruise þe
monluker swinken · 110 ant alswa hwen 3e feleð eani secnesse. Muchel
sotschipe hit is leosen for an dei ; tene oðer tweolue. Vesscheð ow
hwerse neod is as ofte as 3e wulleð · 7 ower oþre þinges. Nes neuer
fulðe godd leof · þah pouerte 7 unorneschipe beon him licwurðe.
VNderstondeð eauer of alle þeose þinges · þ-nan nis heast ne forbod þ-
115 beoð of þe uttre riwle · þet is lute strengðe of. for hwon þ-te inre
beo wel iwist as ich seide i þe frumðe · þeos mei beon ichanget hwerse
eani neod oðer eani skile hit easkeð · efter þ-ha best mei þe leafdi riwle
seruin as hire eadmode þuften · ah sikerliche wiðuten hire þe leafdi
feareð to wundre.

Ancre þe naueð nawt neh 120 honde hire fode ; beoð bisie twa
wummen. An eauer þe leaue ed hame ; an oþer þe wende ut · hwenne
driueð neod · 7 þeo beo ful unorne wiðuten euch tiffunge · oðer a lutel

þuftene ; oðer of feier ealde. Bi þe wei as ha geað ; ga singinde hire
 beoden · ne ne halde na tale wið mon ne wið wummon · ne sitte ne ne
 stonde · bute þ¹²⁵ leaste þet ha eauer mei ear þen ha ham cume.
 Nohwider elles ne ga [f. 115 v] heo bute þider as me send hire · wiðute
 leaue · ne ne eote ha ne ne drinke ute · þe oþer beo eauer inne · ne wið
 ute þe 3eten : ne ga wiðute leaue. Ba beon obedient to hare dame in
 alle þing · bute i sunne ane · na þing nabben þet heo hit nute · ne
 underuo na ¹³⁰ þing · ne ne 3eoue nowðer ; wiðuten hire leaue. Na
 mon ne leote 3e in · ne þe 3ungre ne speoke wið namon bute leaue · ne
 ga ha nawt ut of tune : wiðuten siker fere · 3ef hit swa mei beon ; ne
 ne ligge ute. 3ef heo ne con oboke ; segge bi pater nostres · ant bi auez
 hire ures · 7 wurchen þe me hat hire wið ute gruchunge. hadde eauer hire
¹³⁵ earen opene toward hire dame. Nowðer of þe wummen ne beore
 from hare dame · ne ne bringe to hire nane idele talen ; ne neowe
 tidinges · ne bitweonen ham seolf ; ne singen ne ne spoken na ne
 worldliche spechen · ne lahhen swa ne pleien ; þet ei mon þe hit sehe ;
 mahte hit to uuel turnen. Ouer alle þinges leasunges 7 luðere wordes
¹⁴⁰ heatien. hare her beo icoruen · hare heaued clað sitte lahe · eiðer
 ligge ane. Hare cop beo hehe isticchet · 7 bute
 broche. namon ne seo ham unleppet ne open
 heaued. lah locunge habben. Heo ne schulen
 cussen namon · ne cuðmon ne cunnes mon · ne for na cuððe cluppen ·
 ne weschen hare heaued · ne lokin feaste o na mon ; ne toggin ¹⁴⁵ wið
 ne pleien. Hare weden beon of swuch schape · 7 al hare aturn swuch ;
 þet hit beo edscene hwerto ha beoð iturnde. Hare lates lokin warliche ·
 þe nan ne mahe edwiten ham ; in hus ne ut of hus. On alle wise
 forbeoren to wreaðen hare dame · 7 as ofte as heo hit doð ; ear ha
 drinken oþer eoten ; makien [f. 116 r] hare venie · o cneon ¹⁵⁰ dun
 biuoren hire 7 seggen · mea culpa · 7 underuon þe penitence þe ha leið
 upon hire lutinde hire lahe. þe ancre þrefter neauer mare þe ilke gult ne
 upbreide for na wreaððe · bute 3ef ha eft sone falle i þe ilke · ah do hit

141. *lahhe* MS.
 161. *hond* MS.

allunge ut of hire heorte. 3ef ei strif ariseð bitweone þe wummen ; þe
 ancre makie eiðer to makien oþer venie o cneon to þer 155 eorðe · 7
 eiðer rihte up oþer ; 7 cussen on ende · ant te ancre legge on eiðer ;
 sum penitence · mare up o þe ilke þe greatluker gulte. Dis is a þing
 witen ha wel þ-is gode leouest ; Sahtnesse 7 some · 7 te feond laðest ·
 forþi he is eauer umben to arearen sum leaððe. Nu sið þe sweoke wel ·
 þ-hwen fur is wel o brune ; 7 me wule þ-hit aga ; 160 me sundreð þe
 brondes · 7 he deð nond þ-ilke. luue is ihesu cristes fur · þ-he wule þ-
 bleasie aa i þin heorte · ant te deouel blaweð forte puffen hit ut. Hwen
 his blawunge ne geineð nawt · he bringeð up sum uuel word · oðer
 sum oþer nohtunge · hwer þurh ha to hurten eiðer frommard oþer · 7 te
 hali gastes fuR cwencheð hwen þe 165 brondes þurh wreaððe beoð
 isundret. forþi halden ham i luue feaste to gederes · Ant ne beo ham
 nawt of hwen þe feond blawe · nomeliche 3ef monie beon
 iueietsomet ; 7 wel wið luue ontende. Ðah þe ancre on hire meidnes for
 openliche gultes legge penitence ; to þe preost noðeleater schriuen
 ham hwen neod is · ah eauer þah wið leaue. 3ef ha 170 ne cunnen nawt
 þe mete *graceS* · seggen in hare stude ; *pater noster* biuoren ; 7 aue
 Maria · 7 efter mete alswa · ant a Credo mare · 7 segge þus on ende ·
 feader · Sune · hali gast al mihti godd · 3eoue ure dame his *grace* ·
 [f. 116 v] se lengre se mare · 7 leue hire 7 us ba neomen god ende · for
 3elde alle þe us god doð · 7 milci hare sawle þe us god 175 idon habbeð
 · hare sawle 7 alle cristene sawleS.

Bitweone mel ne gruchesi 3e nawt · nowðer frut
 ne oðerhwet ; ne drinken bute leaue · 7 te leaue
 beo liht in al þ-nis sunne. Ed te mete na word ·

177. *gruchesi*] *ch* on an
 erasure.

oðer lut ; 7 teo stille. Alswa efter þe ancre complie · aþet *prime* · ne
 don na þing ne seggen ; hweRþurh hire silence mahe 180 beon isturbet.
 Nan ancre seruant ne ahte bi rihte to easkin iset hure · bute mete 7 hure
 þ-ha mei flutte bi ; ant godes milce. Ne misleue nan godd ; hwetse tide
 of þe ancre · þ-he hire trukie. þe meidnes wiðuten 3ef ha seruið þe

ancre alswa as ha ahen · hare hure schal beon þe hehe blisse of
heouene. Hwase haueð ehe of hope toward 185 se heh bure ; gleadliche
wule ha seruui 7 lihtliche alle wa · 7 alle teone þolien. wið eise 7 wið
este ne buð me nawt bliSSe.

3e ancres ahen þis leaste stucche reden to ower
wummen euche wike eanes · aþet ha hit
cunnen. Ant mucche neod is þ-3e neomen to ham
mucche 3eme · for 3e mahen muchel beon þurh ham i godet · 7 190
iwurset. On oðer half 3ef þet ha sungið þurh ower 3emeles ; 3e schule
beo bicleopet þrof biuore þe hehe deme · 7 forþi as ow is mucche neod
· 7 ham 3et mare ; 3eornliche leareð ham to halden hare riwle · ba for
ow 7 for ham seolf ; liðeliche 7 luueliche · for swuch ah wummone
lare to beonne · luuelich 7 liðe · 7 selthwenne sturne. Ba is riht þ-ha 195
ow dreden 7 luuien · ant þah þ-ter beo eauer mare of luue ; þen of
drede · þenne schal hit wel fearen · Me schal healden eoli 7 win ba i
wunden efter godes lare · ah mare of softe eoli ; þen of [f. 117 r]
bitinde win . þ-is Mare of liðe wordes ; þen of suhinde · for þer of
kimeð þinge best ; þ-is luue eie. lihtliche 7 sweteliche foR3eoued 200
ham hare gultes · hwen ha ham icnaweð 7 bihateð bote. Ase forð as 3e
mahen of mete 7 of claðes · 7 of oþre þinges þet neode of flesch
easkeð ; beoð large toward ham ; þah 3e nearowe beon 7 hearde to ow
seoluen. Swa deð þe wel blaweð ; went te nearewe of þe horn to his
ahne muð ; ant utward þ-wide. Ant 3e don alswa as 3e wulleð þ-205
ower beoden bemin wel 7 dremen ; i drihtines earen · nawt ane to
ower ahnes ; ah to alle folkes heale · as ure lauerd leue þurh þe grace
of him seolf þ-hit swa mote ameN. Hwen ower sustres meidnes cumeð
to ow to froure ; cumeð to ham to þe þurl ; earunder 7 ouerunder ·
eanes oðer twien · 7 gað a3ein sone ; to ower note gastelich · 210 ne
biuore Complie ne sitte 3e nawt for ham ouer riht time · swa þ-hare

191. 3ef above þurh
deleted.

cume beo na lure of ower religiun ; ah gastelich biȝete. ȝef þer is eani
word iseid þ-mahte hurten heorte ; ne beo hit nawt iboren ut ; ne ibroht
to oþer ancre ; þ-is eð hurte. To him hit schal beon iseid ; þe lokeð ham
alle. Twa niht is inoh þ-ei beo edhalden · ant þ-beo 215 ful seldene · ne
for heom ne breoke silence ed te mete ; ne for blodletunge · bute ȝef
sum mucche god oðer neod hit makie. Þe ancre ne hire meiden ne
plohen `nane´ worldliche gomenes ed te þurle · ne ne ticki togederes ·
foR ase seið seint Beornard. vñwurðe þing is to euch gastelich mon · 7
nomeliche to ancre ; euch swuch fleschlich 220 froure · 7 hit binimeð
gastelich þ-is wiðute met utnume murhðe · 7 þ-is uuel change as is
iseid þruppe.

Of þis boc redeð hwen ȝe beoð eise euche
dei ; leasse oðer mare. Jch hopie þ-hit

225. *godes*] *d* corr. out
of *g* MS.

[f. 117 v] schal beon ow ȝef ȝe hit redeð ofte ;

swiðe biheue ; þurh godes mucchele grace · elles ich hefde uuele bitohe
225 mi mucchele hwile. Me were leouere godd hit wite do me toward
rome ; þen forte biginnen hit eft forte donne. Ȝef ȝe findeð þ-ȝe doð
alswa as ȝe redeð ; þonckið godd ȝeorne · ȝef ȝe ne doð nawt ; biddeð
godes are · 7 beoð umben þeronuuen þ-ȝe hit bet halden efter ower
mihte. 230

Feader · Sune · hali gast · an almihti godd wite ow in hiS warde · he
gleadie ow 7 frouri ow mine leoue sustren · ant for al þ-ȝe for him
dreheð 7 dreaieð · ne ȝeoue ow neauer leasse · þen altogedere him
seoluen · Beo he aa iheiet from world into worlde aa on ecnesse ·
AMeN.

Ase ofte aS ȝe habbeð ired eawiht her on ; greteð þe leafdi 235 wið aN
aue ; for him þ-swonc herabuten · Jnoh meaðful ich am þe bidde se

lutel ·  Explicit · Jþenç o þi writere iþine beoden sum chearre ; ne beo hit ne se lutel. Hit turneð þe to gode ; þ-tu bidest for oþre.

ANCREN RIWLE (COTTON MS. NERO)

B. THE OUTER RULE

A (Corpus MS.)

A (Caius MS.)

B (Corpus MS.) (above)

A (Parallel Texts)

B (Parallel Texts)

In this section, N is Nero (the primary MS); C Cleopatra; T Titus. The Notes explain:

Passages in C (mostly interlined or marginal) which are not in N are inserted between asterisks in the text of the latter. The collations ... show the other divergences of C and those of T from N; when not followed by any letter they give the readings of T; those followed by C are the readings of C, while B indicates agreement of T and C as against N.

Spacing of asterisks is as in the original. Longer paragraphs have been broken up for easier cross-reference. In the printed text, each paragraph began with a large drop capital, except the final paragraph beginning “ase ofte ase 3e readeð ...”.

3 e mine leoue sustren *bute 3ef
neod ow driue* ne schulen
habben no best . bute kat one. ancre
þet haueð eihte þuncheð bet husewif
ase marthe was . þen ancre . ne
none weis ne mei heo beon marie .
*marthe suster * mid griðfulnesse
of heorte. Vor þeonne mot heo
þenchen of þe kues foddre and of 5
heordemonne huire . oluhnen þene
heiward . warien hwon me punt hire

8. *me me* MS.

1. mine ... sustren *om*.
2. schule 3e C || haue || na | nan C || beast B || cat || ane B || þe C
3. haues || ahte | achte C || semes || betere B || as B || wes C || þen ancre *om*. B nanes | for ‘lihtliche oðer’ nanes C
4. weies || mai || ho | ha C || beo || wið B
5. for þenne B || ho | ha C || cuwes C || and *om*. B
6. þe heordes || hure C || Olcne | olchni C || þe B || haiward | haiwart C || hwen he B || pundes
7. 3elde B || þah | þach C || harmes B || ladli

7 3elden þauh ðe hermes. wat crist
 þis is lodlich þing . hwon me
 [f. 116 v] makeð mone in tune of
 ancre eihte. Þauh 3if eni mot nede
 hebben ku : loke ðet heo none
 monne ne eilie : ne ne hermie . ne
 þet hire þouht ne beo nout þeron i
 uestned.
 ancre ne ouh nout 10 to hebben no
 þing þet drawe utward hire heorte.
 none cheffare ne driue 3e. ancre þet
 is cheapild . * þe buð for te sullen
 efter bi3ete * heo cheapeð hire
 soule : þe chepmon of helle. *Þing
 þah þ-ha wurcheð ; ha mei wel þurh
 hire meistres read ; for hire neode
 sullen. þah swa dernliche as ha mei
 for misliche monne wordes.* Ne
 wite 3e 15 nout in oure huse of oðer
 monnes þinges . ne eihte . ne cloðes
 . ne nout ne vnderuo 3e ðe chirche
 uestimenz ne þene caliz bute 3if
 * neod oðer* strençðe hit makie :
 oðer muchel eie. vor of swuche
 witunge is i kumen muchel `vuel`
 oftetiðen. wiðinnen ower woanes :
 ne lete 3e nenne mon slepen. 3if
 muchel neode mid alle makeð
 breken 20 ower hus : þeo hwule ðet
 hit euer is i broken : loke þet 3e
 hebben þerine mid ou one wummon
 of clene liue . deies 7 nihtes.

Uorði þet no mon ne isihð ou .
 ne 3e ne iseoð nenne mon : wel

| ladlich C || þing is wat crist hwen B
 8. mon || makes B || in tune man | itune
 man C || ancres B || ahte | achte C || Nu
 þenne *latter deleted*, þah in margin | Nu
 þach C || 3ef C || ani B
 9. nedinge | nedunge C || haue || ku] hit B ||
 hit na mon B || eile | eili C || harme |
 harmi C

12. 3e over an erasure.

19. vuel on margin.

10. ni || þoht | þocht C || nawt | nawicht C ||
 teron | þron C || ifestnet || Anker || ah |
 ach C || nawt T *om.* C
 11. haue || no þing *om.* T || nan C || utward
 drahe | utwart draze C || Na B || chaffare |
 cheffere C
 12. Anker || chapmon chepilt C
 13. ho | ha C || cheapes | cheapeð C || sawle
 | saule to C || chapmon | chepmon C
 15. Nawt ne | Naut ne C || 3e *om.* C
 16. owre | ouwer C || hus B || of *om.* B ||
 monne C || ahte | achte C || claðes || ne nout
 ... caliz *om.* C, then *interlined* `bute neod
 ... eie' || ne ... 3e *om.*
 17. Nawt te chirche uestemenz ne þe
 chaliz || 3if ... oðer *om.*
 18. strengðe || make || vor *om.* B || swuch |
 swich C || lokinge | witing C
 19. muchel bifallen | muchel uuel
 ilumpen C || vuel *om.* || siðe || Inwið B ||
 owre || wahes | wanes C || lete 3e *bis*
 20. na wepmon | nan mon C || 3ef C ||
 muche B || ned | neod C || wið makes B || to
 breke | breoken C
 21. owre || þe *om.* B || hwil B || ðet *om.* B ||
 eauer B || loke þet 3e *om.* B || haues |
 habbeð C || terinne | þrinne C
 22. wið ow B || a | an C || cleane lif B ||
 daies || nitches C

23, 24. welmeidon MS.

mei don of ower cloðes . beon heo
 hwite : beon heo blake. bute þet heo
 beon unorne 7 warme 7 wel i
 wrouhte. uelles wel i tauwed. 25 7
 habbeð ase monie ase ou to neodeð
 . to bedde and eke to rugge.

Next fleshe ne schal non werien
 no linnene cloð bute 3if hit beo
 of herde and of greate heorden.
 stamin `habbe´ hwose wule. and
 hwose wule mei beon buten. 3e
 schullen liggen in on heater and i
 gurd. ne bere 3e non iren . ne here .
 ne [f. 117 r] irspiles felles. 30 ne ne
 beate`ou´þer mide. ne mid schurge i
 leðered : ne ileaded. ne mid holie .
 ne mid breres . ne ne biblodge hire
 sulf : wiðuten schriftes leaue . ne ne
 nime et enes to ueole disceplines.
 ower schon beon greate and warme.
 Ine sumer 3e habbeð leaue uorto
 gon and sitten baruot. and hosen
 wiðuten uaumpez . and ligge ine
 ham : hwo so likeð. Sum 35 wumon i
 nouhreaðe . wereð þe brech of
 heare fulwel i knotted . and þe
 strapeles adun to hire uet. i laced ful
 ueste.

3if 3e muwen beon wimpel leas : *7
 3e wel wullen* beoð bi warme
 keppen . and þeruppon *oðer hwite
 oðer* blake ueiles. *Ancren summe
 sungið in ha[re] wimlunge na lesse

23. For B || na nan C || seo | sið C || ow B ||
 ne iseoð *om.* B || ham | him C
 24. duhen || owre | ouwer C || clað B || beo
 hit hwit beo hit blac bute hit beo B
 25. 7 *om.* B || warm B || iwraht | iwracht C
 || felles B || iteawet | itauwet C
 26. habbes || as ow B || to nedes || eke
om. B

27. Nest flesch B || nan B || werie || no *om.*
 || nan C || cloð *om.* B || 3if *om.* B
 28. harde B || heordes || were C || hwa B ||
 wile
 29. and *om.* || hwa B || nule ; beo wið uten
 || mei beon *om.* C || schuln in | schulen in C
 || an B || hatter | hetter C
 30. gurd liggen | igurd liggen C || were nan
 irn | beore nan iren C || haire || ylespiles B
 31. hire þerwið B || wið B || i leðered ne
om. B || ileadet B || ne *om.* B
 32. wið holin | wið holine C || wið B || ne
 blodeke | ne bibloðgi C || seluen | seolf C ||
 ute C || schirches
 33. nine *for* ne ne || neome C || ateanes | ed
 eanes C || feole B || disciplines |
 diciplines C || owre || scheon C
 34. I | In C || hauen || barefot to Gan 7
 sitten | barfot gan 7 sitten C
 35. and *om.* B || Hose || uampeþ |
 uampeð C || and *om.* B || ham *om.* B || hwa
 se like | hwase wule C
 36. mon || inohraðe | inochraðe C || weres
 te brec || haire | here C || icnotten |
 icnotted C || and *om.* B
 37. strapples || dun to þe fet B || faste

37. *For* 3if ... bi, T has habbes || 3ef 3e
 mahen (*over muchel del.*) beo wimpelles C
 38. cappes | cappen C || and ... wimlunge in
 l. 52 *om.* || þruppon C
 39. ueilles C

þene lefdi Sum seið þ hit limped . to
 e[i] wummon cundeliche ; 40 forte
 weri[en] wimpel. Nai . Wimpel ne
 hef[ed] nouðer ne nemneð hali
 writ ; ah wriheles of heuet. Ad
 cor[inth.] *Mulier uelet caput*
suum . Wummon seið þe apostel
 schal wrihen hi[re] heauet. wrihen
 he seið naut wimplin. wrihen ha
 schal hire scheome as sunfule eue
 dohte[r ;] i mungunge of þe sunne þ
 sch[en]de us erst alle 7 naut 45
 drah[en] þ wriheles te tiffung 7 te
 pru[e]. Eft wule seinte pael þ
 wumm[on] wreo i chirche hire neb
 zette leste vuel þoht arise þurh
 hir[e] onsihðe 7 *h o c e s t* .
propter ang[e]los .
 Hwi þenne þu chirche ancre al beo
 þu iwimplet ; openest þah þi neb to
 weopmones ehe . Te zeines þe. þe
 isist men spekeð seinte pael. Ah
 3ef ei þing 50 wriheð ; þi neb from
 monnes ehe ; beo hit wah beo hit
 clað i þi parlures þurl ; wel mei
 duhen ancre of oðer wimlunge .
 Hwose wule beon iseien . þauh heo
 atiffe hire ; nis nout muchel
 wunder . auh to godes eien . heo is
 lufsumere þet is uor ðe luue of
 him ; untiffed wiðuten. Ring . ne
 broche nabbe 3e . ne gurdel i

52. *wimlump*e MS.

55. *i menbred* MS.

59. *ha*] & MS.

52. hwa B

53. wile || isehen | isezen C || of alle þ hire
 cumen to *add*. || þah | þach C || ho | ha C ||
 atiffen | atifi C || ham | na | nan C ||
 muche B

54. Ah | ach C || ehne | echnen C || ho |
 ha C || lufsumer || þe is C || for B

55. untiffet B || ni || ni || i membret

56. ni gloues || na | nan C || swich C || ow B
 || deah || i burð C || for *om*. B

membred . 55 ne glouen . ne no
 swuch þing þet ou . ne deih forto
 habben. *vnderstondeð . þof alle
 þeose þinges nis nan hest ne forbot
 for alle ha beoð of þe vttere riwle þ
 is lute strençde of ; for hwon þte
 inre beo wel iwist as ic seide i þe
 frumðe . *ha* mei beon ichanget hwer
 se euer ei neod oder eni skile hit
 askeð . efter þha mei ase 60 þuften .
 best seru in þe leafdi riwle.*

Euer me is leouere . so 3e don
 grette werkes. ne makie none
 purses . uorte ureonden ou mide .
 bute to þeo þower meistre 3eoueð
 ow his leaue* ; ne blodbendes of
 seolke . * ne laz . bute leaue* ; auh
 schepieð and seouweð and amendeð
 chirche cloðes . and poure 65 monne
 cloðes. no þing ne schule 3e 3iuen :
 wiðuten schriftes leaue. helpeð mid
 ower owune swinke so uorð so 3e
 muwen to schruden ou suluen and
 fedes 3ef neod is þeo ðet ou
 serueð . ase seint ierome lereð : ne
 beo 3e neuer idel . uor anonrihtes ðe
 ueond beot hire his werc : þet ine
 godes werke ne wurchað . and he
 tuteleð anonrihtes 70 touward hire.
 uor þeo hwule [f. 117 v] þet he isihð
 hire bisi .

`he´ þencheð þus . vor nout ich
 schulde nu kumen neih hire ; ne

62. Eauer B || leuere | leoure C || se B ||
 grattere | grettere C || Ne ... cloðes in l. 66
om. || make 3e C || nane C
 63. forto freonden ow wið C
 64. blod binden of seolc C
 65. Ach schap`i`eð 7 seoweð 7 mendeð (e
 over a) C || claðes C
 66. menne hettren C || Na | nan || `swuc´ C
 || 3eouen bute 3e hauen chiches leaue ||
 3euen C
 67. Helpes || wið B || owre || ahne | achne C
 || swinc | swinch C || se forð se B || muhen |
 much3en C
 68. ow seluen | ow seoluen C || ta þow
 seruen | ow seruið C || As B || sein
 69. leares | leareð C || neauer B || `allunge´
 idel `7 se forð as 3e mahen´ C || for B ||
 ananrihtes | ananrichtes C || te || feond |
 feont C || bedes.
 70. þe C || i | in C || werc B || swinkes |
 swinkeð C || he *om.* B || tuteles | anan B
 71. toward | towart C || for hwil he B || seos
 | sið C

72. he þe swike þenches tus || for B || noht |
 naut C || ischulde nu cume to hire | cumen
 nu nech hire C || mai

mei heo nout ihwulen uorto her`c
 ´nen mine lore. of idelnesse
 awakeneð muchel flessches
 fondunge . *Iniquitas sode*
. saturitas panis 7 ocium.
 þet is. al sodomes cweadschipe kom
 of idelnesse : 7 of ful 75 wombe.

Iren þet lið stille ; gedereð sone rust
 . and water þet ne stureð nout
 readliche stinkeð. ancre ne schal
 nout forwurðen scolme`i`stre : ne
 turnen hire ancre hus ; to childrene
 scole. hire meiden mei þauh techen
sum lutel meiden. þet were dute of
 forto leornen among gromes . auh
 ancre ne ouh forto 3emen bute god
 one. *þah 80 bi hire meistres read ;
 ha mei *sum* rihten 7 helpe te leren.*

3e ne schulen senden lettres . ne
 underuon lettres . ne writen :
 buten leaue. 3e schulen beon i
 dodded four siðen iðe 3ere : uorto
 lihten ower heaued. *oðer 3ef 3e
 wulled ischauen. hwa se wule
 ieveset. ah ha mot te oftere weschen
 7 kemben hire heauet* ; and ase
 ofte iletan 85 blod . and oftere 3if
 neod is . and hwo so mei beon þer
 wið uten ; ich hit mei wel i þolien.
 hwon 3e beoð iletan blod . 3e ne
 schulen don no þing þeo þreo
 dawes ; þet ou greue . auh talkeð
 mid ower meidenes.

73. ho | ha C || nawt | naut C || 3eme nu |
 izemen C || to B || lustnen mi | lustin min C
 || lare B || wakenen

74. muchele || flesches B || fondinges

75. al *om*. B || sode || cwedschipe C ||
 com B

76. wambe || Irn þ-lis || Gederes || muche C
 || and *om*. B

77. stures || nawt | naut C || raðliche |
 readiliche C || stinkes || 3e ne schule sende
 lettres. | Ne underfo lettres bute leaue C ||
 nawt | naut C || forwurðe B || scolemeister ||
 scol *above erasure* C

78. hire *om*. B || ances || childre`ne`
 schole C || Hire ... leren *in l*. 81 *om*.

79. þauh *om*. C || learen C || lute C || of ;
 to C

80. bimong gremes C || Ach C || nach to
 3eme C || ane C

82. underfon || bute

83. schule C || beo || idoddet C || iþe 3er
 fiftene siðe || 3er C uorto ... heauet *in l*. 85
om. || to lichten ower heauet C

85. 7 fowr siðe iletan 7 as ofte iletan blod
 `7 3ef neod is oftere` C

86. ofte || ned || and ... þolien *om*. C || Hwa
 se mai wel beo wið uten: ich hit mai þolien

87. Hwon ... blod *om*. C || Hwen || arn
 schule C do þreo daies na þing þ-ow
 greues || don `þeo` þreo dages nan þing þ-
 ow greueð C

88. Ah ach C || talkes || to B || owre seruant
 ower meidnes C

and mid þeafule talen : schurteð ou
to gederes. 3e muwen don so ofte :
hwon ou þuncheð heuie . oðer beoð
uor sume worldliche þinge 90 sorie :
oðer seke. So wisliche witeð ou in
our blodletunge : and holdeð ou ine
swuche reste . þet 3e longe þer efter
muwen ine godes seruise þe
monluker swinken . and also hwon
3e iueleð eni secnesse . vor muchel
sotschipe hit is. uorto [f. 118r]
uorleosen uor one deie . tene oðer
tweolue. Wassheð ou hwar se 3e
habbeð neode : ase ofte 95 ase 3e
wulleð.

Ancre þet naueð nout neih honde
hire uode : beoð bisie two
wummen . on ðet bileaue euer
ethom . an oðer þet wende ut hwon
hit is neod . and þeo beo ful unorne
oðer a lute þuhten oðer of feir
elde and biðe weie ase heo geð . go
singinde hire beoden . 100 ne ne
holde heo nout none tale mid mon
ne mid wummon . ne ne sitte ne ne
stonde bute þet leste þet heo mei er
þen heo kume hom. nouhwuder
elles ne go heo ; bute þider ase me
sent hire. wiðute leaue : ne ete heo
ne ne drinke ute. þe oðer beo euer
inne . ne wiðute þe zeate ne go heo
nout wiðute leaue. boðe beon

89. wið B || þeawfule þeufule C || tales:
schurtes ow schurtið C || muhen muze C
|| swa don ofte hwen ow B
90. þunches || heui C || arn || for sum B ||
worldlich C || þing B
91. sari B || Swa B wislich C || wites || Of
ower blodletunge in marg. C || ow B ||
owre ower C || blodletinge
92. haldes haldeð C || ow B || iswuch in
swich C || rest || þrafter þrefter C || muhen
muzen C || ine om. C || igodes
93. þe om. C || wurchen C || alswa also C
|| hwen B || felen feleð C || ani B
94. vor om. B || muche B || sotschipe C ||
uorto om. C || to lose leosen C || for an B
|| dai dei C
95. twelue tweolue C || Vas del. wasches
in marg. wescheð C || ow B || hwer B || ned
is neod is C || as B
96. as B || wiln wullet C || Ouwer meidnes
riwle in marg. C

102. After *mei* erasure of one letter.

97. Anker || þe C || naues || nawt | naut C ||
neh hond | nech hont C || fode B || beos ||
bisi || twa wimmen B
98. an B || þe C || leaue eauer with erasure
of two letters before || eauer leaue C || at
hame | ed hame C || þe C
99. hwen B || ned driues | neod driueð C ||
tat
100. of om. || feizer C || ealde B || and
om. B || wei || as B || ho Gas | ha geað C ||
Ga B || seiende | segginde C || beodes
101. Ni ne || halde B || heo nout om. B || na
| nan C || wið B || wið B || ni sitte ne stonde
| Ne sitten ne stonden C
102. þe B || leaste || ho | ha C || ear B ||
þenne C || ho | ha C || ham cume B
103. Nohwider | Nochwder C || ga B || heo
om. || ha C || as B || mon sendes
104. eote C || ho | ha C || eauer B
105. zate | zete C || ga B || heo om. | ha C ||
nout om. B || Baðe | ba C || hare C
106. þing B || in B || ane B

obedient to hore 105 dame in alle
 binges ; bute ine sūne one.
 ho þing nabben heo ; þet hore dame
 hit nute . ne ne underuon no þing .
 ne ne 3iuen wiðuten hire leaue.
 Nenne mon ne leten heo in . ne ðe
 3ungre ne speke mid none monne :
 bute leaue . ne ne go nout ut of tune
 . wiðuten siker uere . ne ne ligge
 ute. 3if heo ne con o boke : sigge bi
 pater nostres 110 and bi auez hire
 vres . and wurchen þet me hat hire
 wiðuten gruc|chunge. hadde euer
 hire earen opene touward hire
 dame. nouðer of ðe wummen ne
 beren urom hore dame . ne ne
 bringen to hire . none idele talen :
 ne neowe tīpinges . ne bitweonen
 ham sulf ne singen . ne ne speken
 none worldliche spechen . ne
 lauhwen ne ne pleien so ðet 115 ei
 mon þet hit iseie . muhte [f. 118 v]
 hit to v`u`el turnen. ouer alle þing
 leasunge and luðere wordes . hatien.
 Hore her beo i koruen .

hore heuedcloð sitte lowe. eiðer
 ligge one. Hore hesmel beo heie
 istihd ; al wiðute broche. no mon ne
 i seo ham unweawed . ne open
 heaued. *Inwið þe wanes ha muhe
 werie scapeloris hwen mantel 120
 ham heuegeð . ute ; gan i mantlet þe
 heauet i hudeket.* louh lokunge
 habben. heo ne schulen cussen

106. Na | Nan C || heo *om.*
 107. ho | heo C *for* hore dame || ni vnderfo
 | Ne underuo C || na | nan C || 3iue |
 3eouen C || *add* nowðer | nouðer C
 108. leue || Na | Nan C || heo *om.* B || ni ||
 ðe 3ungre *om.* C || spoken C || mid none
 monne *om.* C || wið na wepmon
 109. wið ute B || leue || Ne ga B || noht |
 naut C
 110. fere B || 3ef C || ho | ha C || on C ||
 segge B
 111. auees C || wurchen 7 do hwat C || mon
 bides || wiðute || grucchinge B
 112. eauer B || eares || toward | towart C ||
 lafdi || Nowðer
 113. of þe wummen *om.* C || of þe
 familiers ne beo fram hire lafdi ni ni bringe
 nowðer || ne beore ne ne bringe to heore
 dame C || none *om.* B
 114. tales || newe || tidinges C || bitwenen B
 || self | seolf C || ne ne singen C || ni ne
 speken | ne ne spoken ham seolf C
 115. none *om.* C || nane speches || lahhen
 swa ne pleien þ-| lach3en swa ne pleizen
 þ-C
 116. ani || sehe | sech3e C || mihte |
 machte C || hit *om.* C || turnen hit
 117. þinge || leasiges | leasing C || uuele C
 || hare C || beon C || icoruen B

122. *cuð* corr. out of *enð*.

118. hore ... i hudeket *om.* || hare C ||
 clað C || lach3e C || ane C || hare cop beo
 hech3e isticched C
 119. al *om.* C || na C || seo C || unlepped C
 121. Lah lokinge | Lach locunge C
 122. Eiðer ligge ane *add.* || ho | ha C ||
 schulen *om.* C || schule || cusse B || na |
 nan C || cunnes
 123. ni || na || ne uor ... unkuð *om.* B
 124. ne ... heaued *om.* | nene weschen
 hare C || Ni || loke B || faste || o na | on an C

nenne mon . * ne cuðmon ne cunes
 mon . ne for nan cuððe cluppen* ne
 uor luue cluppen . ne kuð ne unkuð
 . ne wasshen hore heaued . ne loken
 ueste o none monne . ne toggen mid
 him ; ne pleien. hore weaden beon
 of swuche scheape 125 7 alle hore
 aturn swuch ; þet hit beo eðcene
 hwarto heo beoð i turnde. hore lates
 loken warliche . þet non ne edwite
 ham ne ine huse ne ut of huse.
 on alle wise uorberen to wreððen
 hore dame . and ase ofte ase heo hit
 doð er heo drinken oðer eten .
 makien hore uenie akneon adun to
 þer eorðe biuoren hire : 7 sigge
 mea culpa . and underuon 130 ðe
 penitence : ðet heo leið upon hire
 lutende hire louwe. þe ancre neuer
 more þer efter þene ilke gult ne
 upb[r]eide hire : uor none wreððe .
 bute 3if heo eft sone ualle iðet ilke .
 auh do hit allunge ut of hire heorte.
 and 3if eni strif ariseð bitweonen ðe
 wummen ; ðe ancre makie eiðer of
 ham to makien oðer venie akneon to
 ðer eorðe . and 135 eiðer rihte up
 oðer : 7 kussen ham on ende . and
 þe ancre legge on eiðer sum
 penitence. More upon þeo ilke : ðet
 gretluker haueð agult.

þis is o þing wute `3e´ [f. 119 r] wel
 to soðe ðet is gode leouest ;

|| mon B

125. toggle | toggi C || wið B || him *om.* B ||
 pleizen C || Hare B || wede | weden C || beo
 || swuch | swich C || schape B

126. al || 7 of swic aturn þ`hit´ C || eðscene
 | edsene C || hwerto B || ho | ha C || beon B

127. Hare B || werliche C || nan B || etwite
 over wite *del.* C || ne *om.* B || in hus B

128. hus

128. forbeoren B || wradðen | wraððen C ||
 hare C || as B

129. as B || ho | ha C || don || ear || ho | ha C
 || eoten C || Maken C || hire B || o cneos |
 acneon C

130. dun || to þer eorðe *om.* B || bifore |
 biforen C || seggen B || vnder fo

131. penitance C || ho | ha C || leis || ham B
 || lutinde C || lahe | lach3e C || anker

132. þilke gult neauer mare þr after | þer
 efter neauer mare þilke gult C || hire *om.* B
 || for B || na | nan C

133. wraððe B || 3ef C || ho | ha C || sonas
 falle B || i þat ilke | i þilke C || Ah | Ach C

134. and *om.* B || 3ef C || ani B || rises ||

bitwenen ham utewið ; | bitwene þe
 wimmen C || þe anker

135. make B || of ham *om.* B || make B || þe
 oðer C || o cneos | o cneon C || dun to þe |
 to þe C

136. richte C || cussen on B || te anker leie

137. penitance C || Mare B || up o þilke |
 up on þilke C || þe C || greatluker || gulte B

138. 3e added in margin.

138. is *om.* C || a | an C || witen B || ho |
 ha C || to soðe *om.* B || godd | god C ||

seih[t]nesse 7 some. 7 þe ueonde
 loðest. and forþi he is euer umbe to
 arearen sume wreððe. nu isihð ðe
 deouel wel ðet hwon þet fur 140 is
 wel o brune . 7 me wule ðet hit go
 ut : me sundreð ðe brondes . and he
 deð `also´ onond þet ilke. luue is
 ihesu cristes fur þet he wule ðet
 blasie in vre heorte . and þe deouel
 bloweð forto puffen hit ut . and
 hwon his blowinge ne geineð nout :
 þeonne bringeð he up sum luðer
 word . oðer sum oþer nouhtunge :
 hwar þuruh heo to hurteð eiðer 145
 urommard oðer ; and þe holi gostes
 fur ; acwencheð hwon ðe brondes
 þuruh wreððe ; beoð isundred. and
 forþi holden ham ine luue ueste to
 gederes .
 and ne beo ham nout of ; hwon ðe
 ueond blowe . and nomeliche 3if
 monie beoð i ueied somed ; and wel
 mid luue ontende. þauh ðe ancre on
 hire meidenes uor openliche gultes .
 legge penitence 150 neuer ðe later to
 ðe preoste schriuen ham ofte . auh
 euer þauh mid leaue. and 3if heo ne
 kunnen nout ðe mete graces : siggen
 in hore stude ; pater . noster . 7 aue
 maria biuoren mete . and efter mete
 also . 7 credo moare . and siggen
 þus on ende . veder 7 sune 7 holi
 gost . 7 on almihti god ; he 3iue ure

leuest

139. sahtnesse | sachtnesse C || somentale ||
 te feond | þe feont C || laðest B || and *om.* B
 || eauer umben B

140. reare | arere C || sum laððe B || seos |
 sið C || te swike | þe sweoke C || hwen
 fur B

141. onbrune C || mon wile || Ga B || mon
 sundres te || brendes C

142. dos hond to þ-ilke | deð þ-ilke C || fuir
 || wile

143. owre || te || blowes | bloweð C

144. and *om.* B || hwen B || blast |
 blawunge C || Geines || nawt | naut C ||
 þeonne *om.* B || he bringes | he bringeð C

145. luðer *om.* || hwat | nochtunge C ||
 hwer B || þurh | þurch C || ho | ha C ||
 hurren B

146. framward | frommart C || te || hali
 gastes B || cwenches | cwencheð C || hwen

147. þurh | þurch C || wraððe B || beon
 isundret || and *om.* B || halde | halden C ||
 iluue | inluue C || faste | feste C

148. nawt | naut C || hwen B || feond |
 feont C || blawe B || and *om.* B

149. nomeli || 3ef C || beon B || ifest to
 Gedere || iueizet somet C || wel *om.* ||
 wið B || ontendet

150. þah | þach C || þe *om.* || anker ||
 seruanz || for B || Giltas || leie || penitance C

151. to preost no ðe latere | to þe preost no
 ðe latere C || Ah | Ach C || eauer B || þah |
 þach C || wið B

152. and *om.* B || 3ef C || ho | ha C || cunen
 noht | cunne naut C || te || seggen B ||
 hare C

153. studen C || Pater noster biforen | pater
 noster biuoren C || maria. After mete alswa
 | marie. efter mete alse C

154. a crede C || mare B || seggen | segge C
 || fader sune B || 7 *om.* || hali gast B

155. 7 *om.* B || an B || almichtin C || godd ||
 he *om.* B || 3eoue C || lauedi || se B || se

dame his grace ; so lengre so more .
 155 7 leue hire 7 us boðe nimen god
 endinge . 7 forzelde alle ðet us god
 doð . 7 milce hore soulen : þet us
 god i don habbeð . hore soulen 7
 alle cristene soulen. *amen*.

Bitweonen mele ne gruselie 3e nout
 . nouðer frut ; `ne´ oðerhwat . ne
 `ne´ drinken wiðuten leaue .
 [f. 119 v] auh þe leaue beo liht in
 alle þeo þinges ; þer nis sunne. Ette
 mete 160 no word . oðer lut . 7 þeo
 beon stille. also efter ðe ancre
 cumplie uort midmorwen . ne don
 no þing . ne ne siggen . hwar þuruh
 hire silence muwe beon isturbed.
 non ancre seruant ne ouhte mid
 rihte uorto asken isette huire ; bute
 mete 7 cloð : þet heo mei vlutten bi
 . 7 godes milce. ne misleue non
 god ; hwat so bitide of ðe ancre : 165
 þet he hire trukie. Þe meidenes wið
 uten 3if heo serueð ðe ancre also ase
 heo owen ; hore hure schal beon ðe
 eche blisse of heouene. hwo so
 haueð eie hope touward so heie
 hure : gledliche wule heo seruen 7
 lihtliche alle wo and alle teone
 þolien. Mid eise ne mid este ; ne
 kumeð me nout toþer heouene. 170

3e ancren owen þis lutle laste
 stucchen reden to our wummen

mare B

156. baðe | ba C || nime | neome C ||
 ende B || 7 *om.* B || þe C

157. don || heore C || sawle | saule C || 7 þ
 us | þe us C || hauen || hore soulen *om.* C ||
 sawle

158. sawle | saule C || *amen om.* B

158. Bitwene B || meal | mel C || gruse |
 gruuesi C || 3e *om.* C || nawt | naut C

159. nowðer | nouðer C || fruit || oðer
 hwet C || ni | ne C || drinke || bute B

160. 7 te | 7 þe C || licht C || al þ-nis B || At
 te | ed þe C || na | nan C

161. 7 ta stille | 7 þeo stille C || Alswa B ||
 after ancre B || aðet prime | oðet prime C

162. ni do þing ne segge | ne don nan þing
 ne seggen C || hwer þurh | hwar þurch C

163. muhe | mu3e C || beo desturbet | beon
 to sturbed C || Nan B || ancre seruante || ah
 | achte C || bi B

164. richte C || to B || iset hure B || ant C ||
 clað B || ho | ha C || mai || flutte B

165. nan B || godd || hwet C || se tide B ||
 anker

166. *over* trukie faile C || þeo þarn wið
 uten || meidnes C || 3ef C || ho | ha C ||
 seruen | seruið C || anker

167. alswa as B || hom ahen | ha ach3en C ||
 hare C || beo

168. Hwa se B || haues || ehe of | e3e of C ||
 toward | towart C || se B || heh | hech C ||
 gladli wile || ho | ha C || seruin C

169. lichtliche C || wa B || tene || wið B ||
 este ne C || wið B || eise C

170. bueð mon nawt blisse | buð me naut
 blisse C

173. After *gode ȝe* MS.

eueriche wike enes uort ðet heo hit
 kunnen. and muche neod is ou
 beoðe : ðet 3e nimen to ham gode
 zeme . vor 3e muwen muchel þuruh
 ham beon igoded. and iwursed on
 oðer halue. 3if heo sunegeð þuruh
 ower zemeleaste ; 3e schulen beon
 bicleoped þerof biuoren þe 175 heie
 demare . and forþi ase ou is muche
 neod . 7 ham is 3ete more ;
 3eorneliche techeð ham to holden
 hore riulen .

boðe uor ou : 7 for ham suluen .
 liðeliche þauh 7 luueliche ; uor
 swuch ouh wummone lore to beon .
 luuelich and liðe and seldwhonne
 sturne. Boðe hit is riht þet heo ou
 [f. 120 r] dreden 7 luuien . auh þet
 ðer beo . more euer 180 of luue : þen
 of drede. þeonne schal hit wel
 uaren. Me schal helden eoli and win
 beoðe ine wunden, efter godere lore
 . auh more of þe softe eolie ; þen of
 þe bitinde wine . þet is . more of
 liðe wordes : þen of suwinde . vor
 þerof kumeð þinge best ; þet is luue
 eie. lihtliche 7 sweteliche uor3iueð
 ham hore gultes : hwon heo ham
 iknoweð and 185 bihoteð bote.

171. ancres B || ahen | ach3e C || laste
 lutle B || stucche | stuche C || rede || owre |
 ower C || seruanz
 172. euche | uche C || eanes B || til þ-ho |
 oðet `til´ ha C || cunnen B || ned || is þ-3e B
 173. neomen C || to ham nimen || god ||
 muche C || for B || muhen | mughe C ||
 muchel *om.* C || muche || þurh B
 174. hom beo || igodet B || wursnet. |
 iwurset. C || On B || half B || 3ef C || ho |
 ha C || suneheþ | sungeð C
 175. þurh | þurch C || owre || zemeles |
 zemeles`chipe´ C || schule beo bicleopet ||
 þrof | þref C || bifore | biforen C
 176. hehe | hech3e C || deme | dom C || and
om. B || as B || ow B || ned || hom | heom C
 || is *om.* B || 3ette | 3et C || mare B
 177. 3eornliche || leares | leareð C || halden
 hare B || riwle | riuwlen C

177. baðe | ba`þe´ C || for ow B
 178. seolf B || þauh *om.* B || luuelice C ||
 for B || swich C || ah | ach C || wummones
 lare B || of religiun *add.*
 179. *second* and *om.* C || seldscene |
 selthwenne C || Baðe | ba`þe´ C || hit *om.* B
 || richt C
 180. ho | he *corr. out of* ha C || ow B || ah |
 ach C || ter || eauer mare | mare eauer C
 181. of þe || þenne B || faren B || Mon ||
 heolde
 182. baðe | ba C || in B || wundes | wundes
erasure of two letters C || after || godes
 lare B || Ah | Ach C || mare B || þe *om.* B
 183. eoli B || þenne C || þe *om.* B || bitende
 || win B || ma | ma`re´ C || þenne C
 184. suhiende | sturne C || for B || cumes |
 kimeð C || Lichtliche C
 185. swetelich || for 3iues | for3eoueð C ||
 hare C || hwen B || ho | ha C || arn cnawe |
 icnaweð C
 186. bihaten | bihateð

Se uorð ase 3e muwen of drunch
 and of mete and of cloð and of
 oðer þinges þet neode of fleshe
 askeð : beoð large touward ham :
 þauh 3e ðe neruwure beon and te
 herdure to ou suluen . vor so deð þe
 wel bloweð . went þene neruwure
 ende of þe horne to his owune 190
 muðe . 7 utward þene wide. and 3e
 don also . ase 3e wulleð þet ower
 beoden bemen 7 dreamen wel : ine
 drihtenes earen . and nout one to
 ower ones ; auh to alle uolkes heale
 . ase ure louerd leue þuruh ðe grace
 of himsulf . þet hit so mote beon.
 amen.

Opisse boc redeð eueriche deie :
 hwon 3e beoð eise . eueriche
 deie 195 lesse oðer more. uor ich
 hopie þet hit schal beon ou 3if 3e hit
 redeð ofte : swuðe biheue þuruh
 godes grace . and elles ich heuede
 vuele bitowen muchel of mine
 hwule. God hit wot me were leouere
 uorto don me touward rome ; þen
 uorto biginnen hit eft forto donne.
 and 3if 3e iuindeð þet 3e doð also
 ase 3e redeð ; þonkeð god 3eorne .
 200 and 3if 3e ne doð nout ; biddeð
 godes ore . [f. 120 v] and beoð
 umbe þer abuten : þet 3e hit bet hol
 holden : efter ower mihte. Veder
 and sune and holi gost . and on

187. Ase | Alse C || forð as B || muhen |
 muzen C || baðe *add.* || drinch || of drunch
 and *om.* C || and *after* mete *om.* || claðes B
 188. oðre C || þing || ned || flesch | fles C ||
 askes || beos || toward B
 189. þah | þach C || ðe *om.* B || narewe
 beon 7 harde to ow seoluen B || vor *om.* ||
 `for´ C || Swa | swa C || dos
 190. þ-|| blowes | bloweð C || wendes || te |
 þe C || narewe || ende *om.* || `ende´ C ||
 horn B || toward || ahne | achne C
 191. muð B || te | þe C || do alsua as B ||
 wiln | wullet C || owre beodes
 192. bemen wel 7 B || i drihtines | in
 drichtines C || eare || and *om.* B || Nawt |
 naut C || ane B
 193. owre || anres | a`u´nes C || Ah | ach C ||
 folkes B || as B || lauerd B || þurh | þurch C
 194. himself | him seolf C || swa mote B ||
 beon. amen *om.* B

195. Of C || þis B || redes || eueriche deie
om. B || hwen B || arn || aise C || euche dai |
 uchedei C
 196. mare B || uor *om.* B || þet *om.* || ow B
 || 3ef C
 197. hit *add.* B || reden || swiðe B || biheoue
 || þurh B || `godes´ C || and *om.* B || hafde |
 hefde C
 198. bitohen | bitoch3en uuele C || multe
 hwile B || God ... wot *om.* B || leuere |
 leoure C || deu le set *add.* B
 199. to do B || toward | towart C || for to |
 for te C
 200. and *om.* B || 3ef C || finden | findeð C
 || don alsua as B || reden. þonkes godd
 201. and *om.* B || 3ef C || don || nawt |
 naut C || biddes godd || are B || beos ||
 umben B
 202. þer onnuen | þer an ouen C || hit
 bettere halden | hit halden C || after owre
 mihte | efter ower michte C || Fader sune.
 haligast an B
 203. almichti C || godd || he *om.* B || ow B
 204. gladie || ow B || frouri C || ow B || leue

almihti god : he wite ou in his
 warde. he gledie ou and froure ou ;
 mine leoue sustren. and for al þet 3e
 uor him drieð and suffreð . he ne
 3iue ou neuer lesse huire þen 205
 alto gedere him suluen. he beo euer
 iheid from worlde to worlde . euer
 on ecchenesse. amen.

ase ofte ase 3e readeð out o þisse
 boc ; greteð þe lefdi mid one aue
 marie uor him ðet makeð þeos
 riwle . and for him þet hire wrot and
 swonc her abuten. Inouh meðful ich
 am ; þet bidde so lutel. 210

sustre
 205. for B || drehen oðer drehden | dre3eð 7
 dreizēð C || he *om.* B || ni 3iue | Ne 3eoue C
 || ow B || neauer B || lasse || hure C
 206. seluen | seoluen C || Beo he B || ai
 ihehet | eauer ihech3et C || fram || into B
 207. a on ecnesse | `a on echnesse´ C

208. As C | as B || hauen red | habbeð
 ired C || oht o þis boc | eawet þron C ||
 Gretes ure || lauedi | lafdi C || wið an B
 209. marie *om.* B || for B || þ swanc her
 abuten. | þe swong her abuten. C
 210. Inouh ... lutel *om.* || `Jnoh meðful ic
 am þe bidde se lutel´ C

IX. ANCRENE WISSE (PARALLEL TEXTS)

A. THE SEVEN DEADLY SINS

A (Corpus MS.)
 A (Caius MS.)
 B (Corpus MS.)
 B (Cotton MSS.)
 B (Parallel Texts)

(CORPUS MS.)

Þ vs mine leoue sustren iþe wildernesse þer 3e
 gað ; in · wið godes folc toward
 ierusalemes lond · þ is þe riche of heouene ;
 beoð þulliche bestes · þulliche wurmes. ne nat
 ich na sunne þ ne mei beon ilead oðer to an of
 ham seouene ; oðer to hare streones.
 vnsteaðeluest bileaue a3ein godes lare · nis hit
 te spece 5 of prude inobedience? Herto falleð
 sygaldren · false teolunges · lefunge o swefne ·

(CAIUS MS.)

[Þ] us mine leoue frend iþe wildernesse
 þat ge gat in wid godes folc toward
 ierusalemes londe þat is þe riche of heouene ;
 beod þulliche bestes þulliche wurmes · Ne nat
 ich nan sunne þat ne mai beon ilad · oþer to an
 of ham seoluen oþer to hare streones ·
 vnstapelfast bileaue · agein hali lare · nis hit of
 5 *prude* inobedience? Herto falled sigaldren ·
 false teolunges · Lefunge o nore. o swefne 7
 alle wicchecraftes. Neominge of husel in ei

o nore · 7 on alle wicchecreftes. Neomunge of husel in eani heaued sunne · oðer ei oþer sacrement nis hit te spece of prude þ-ich cleopede *presumptio* · 3ef me wat hwuch sunne hit · is · 3ef me hit nat nawt · þenne is hit zemeles under 10 accidie · þ-ich slawðe cleopede. þe ne warneð oðer of his uuel oðer of his bizete · nis hit slaw zemeles oðer attri onde? teoheði mis · edhalden cwide · fundles oðer lane · oðer þerwið misfearen · nis hit spece of zisceunge ; 7 aneS cunnes þeofðe? Edhalden oðres hure ouer his rihte *terme* nis hit strong reaflac hwase zelden hit mei þe is 15 under zisceunge? 3ef me zemeð wurse ei þing ileanet · oðer bitaht to witene · þen he wene þe ah hit · nis hit oðer triccherie · oðer zemeles of slawðe? alswa is dusi heast oðer folliche ipliht trowðe · longe beon unbischpet · falsliche gan to schrift · oðer to longe abiden · ne teache *pater noster* godchild ne Credo · þeos 7 alle þulliche beoð ilead to 20 slawðe · þ-is þe feorðe moder of þe seoue sunnen. Þe dronc drunch oðer ei þing dude · hwer þurh na child ne schulde beon on hire istreonet · oðer þ-istreonedede schulde forwurðen · nis þis strong monslaht of galnesse awakenet? Alle sunnen sunderliche bi hare nomeliche nomen ne mahte namon rikenin · ah i þeo þe ich habbe 25 iseid ; alle oþre beoð bilokene. Ant nis ich wene namon þe ne mei understonden him of his sunne nomeliche under sum of þe ilke imeane þe beoð her i writene.

Of þeose seoue beastes 7 of hare streones i wilderness of anlich lif · is iseid herto · þe alle þe forfearinde fondið to fordonne. Þe liun of prude sleað alle þe prude · 30 alle þe beoð hehe 7 ouerhohe iheortet. Þe attri neddre · þe ontfulde 7 te luðere iþonket. Wreaðfule ; þe vnicorne. Alsua of þe oþre o rawe. to godd ha beoð isleine · ah ha libbeð to þe feond · 7 beoð alle in his hond. 7 seruð him in his curt euch of þe meoster þe him to falleð. 35

Þe prude beoð his bemeres · draheð wind inward wið worltlich hereword · 7 eft wið idel zelp puffed hit ut ward as þe bemeres doð · makieð noise 7 lud dream to schawin hare

heaued sunne · oþer ai oþer sacrement · nis hit spece of *prude* ; þat ich cleopede *presumpciun* · gif me wat hwat sunne hit is. Gif me hit nat naut ; þenne is hit gemeles vnder accidie · þat ich slouþe cleopede. 10 þe þat ne warned oþer of his uuel · oþer of his bigete · nis hit slaþ gemeles oþer attri onde? To thehewen mis · et halden cwude · fundes oþer lane · nis þis giscunge ; þeofþe. athalden oþeres hure ouer his richte terme · nis hit strong reflac. þat is under gissunge ; gif me gemed wurse ai þing ilened · oþer bitahted te witene þen 15 he wene þat hit ah · nis oþer tricherie · oþer gemeles of slauþe. Alsua is dusi hest · oþer folliche iplicht trouþe Longe beon unbischbed · falsliche gan to schrifte · oþer to longe abiden · Ne teachen godchild *pater noster* · Ne Credo · þeos 7 alle þulliche · beod ilad to slauþe · þat is þe feorþe moder of þe seoue sunnen · þeo dronc druch 20 oþer ai þing dude hwer þurh na child ne schulde beon on hire istreoned · oþer þat istreonedede schulde forwurþen ; Nis þis strong monslaht of galnasse awakened ; Alle sunnen sunderliche bi hare nomeliche nome ne mahte namon rikenen. Ah iþeo þat ich habbe iseid ; alle oþere beod bilokene. An nis ich wene namon þat ne mai 25 understonden him of his sunnen nomeliche wnder summe of þe ilke þat imene ; þe beod þer i writene.

[O]f þeos sewe beastes 7 of hare strenes i wilderness of anlich lif is iseid hiderto þe alle þe forfarinde fondet te fordonne. þe Leon of *prude* slead alle þe *prude*. Alle þat beod 30 hehe 7 for hehe iheortet. þe aetri

neddre ; þe ond fule. 7 þe luþere iþonked. wredfule þe unicorne. Al swa of þen oþer areawe. to god ha beod isleine · Ah ha libbed to þe feond 7 beod alle in is hird · 7 serued him in his curt · Euch of þe mester þet him to falleð.

[Þ]E *prude* beod his bemeres · Drahed wind inward · of worldlich 35 hereword · 7 eft wid idel ige'l'p puffed hit utward · as þe bemeres dod. Makied noise 7

orhel · ah 3ef ha wel þohten of godes bemeres of þe englene bemen þe schulen o fowr half þe world biuore þe grurefule dom grisliche blawen · Ariseð 40 deade ariseð cumeð to drihtines dom forte beon idemet · þear na prud bemere, ne schal beon iborhen · 3ef ha þohten þis wel ; ha walden inohreaðe i þe deofles seruise dimlukeR bemin. Of þeose bemeres seið Jeremie · Onager solitarius in desiderio anime sue attraxit uentum amoris sui · Of þe wind drahinde in for luue 45 of hereword seið as ich seide.

Summe iuglurs beoð þe ne cunnen seruin of nan oþer gleo bute makien cheres · wrenche þe muð mis · schulen wið ehnen. Of þis meoster seruið þe unseli ontful e i þe deofles curt · to bringen o lahtre hare ondfule lauerd · 3ef ei seið wel oðer deð wel ; ne mahen 50 ha nanes weis lokin þider wið riht ehe of god heorte · ah winkið o þ-half 7 bihaldeð oluft 3ef þer is eawt to edwiten · oðer ladliche þiderward schuleð mið eiðer. Hwen ha ihereð þ-god ; skleatteð þe earen adun · ah þe lust a3ein þ-uuel ; is eauer wid open · þenne he wrencheð þe muð ; hwen he turneð god to uuel · 7 3ef hit is sumdel 55 uuel · þurh mare lastunge wrencheð hit to wurse · þeos beoð forecwidderes hare ahne prophetes · þeos bodieð · biuoren hu þe eateliche deoflen schulen 3et ageasten ham wið hare grennunge · 7 hu ha schulen ham seolf grennin 7 niuelin 7 makien sur semblant for þe muchele angoise i þe pine of helle. Ah forþi ha 60 beoð þe leasse to meanen þ-ha biuoren hond leornið hare meoster to makien grim chere.

Pe wreaðule biuore þe feond skirmeð mid cniues · 7 is his cnif warpere · 7 pleieð mid sweordes · bereð ham bi þe scharp ord up on his tunge. Sweord 7 cnif eiðer beoð scharpe 7 keoruinde word 65 þ-he warpeð from him 7 skirmeð toward oþre · 7 he bodeð hu þe deoflen schulen pleien wið him mid hare scharpe eawles · skirmi wið him abuten 7 dusten ase pilche clut euch toward oðer · ant

lud drem to shawen hare *prude*. Ah gif ha uel þohtten · of godes bemeres of þe englene bemen · þat shulen afour half þe word · bi fore þe grurefule dom *grisliche* blawen · Arised deade arised · Cumed to drichtines domes forto beon idemed · þer na prud 40 bemere ne shal beon iboregen · Gif ha þohten wel þis · ha walden inoh raþe iþe deoueles seruise dimluker bemen. Of þeose bemeres seið Jeremie · Onager solitarius in desiderio suo attraxit uentum amoris sui · Of þe wind drahinde in for luue of hereword ; seid as ich seide. 45

[S]umme iugelurs beoð þe ne cunen seruin of nan oþer gleo buten maken cheres · wrenchen þe mud mis shuli wid þe ehnen. of þis mester seruid þe unseli eon`d`fule iþe deoueles curt · to bringen a lahtre hare on`d`fule leouerð. gef ei ded wel oþer seid wel ; ne mahen ha nanes weis liki þiderward wid richt ehe of god heorte · Ah 50 winked oþet half 7 bi halded aluft gif þer is out to etwite oþer ; ladliche þiderward shuled mid eiþer. hwen ha ihered þat god skletteð þe earen adun · Ah þe lust agein þet uuel is ea wid opene. þenne wrenched þe mud mis ; hwen he turned þet god to uuel · 7 gef hit is sumdel uuel ; þurh more lastunge wrenched hit to 55 wurse. þeos beoð forquiddares hare ahne prophetes. þeos bodied biuoren hu þe ateliche deouelen shulen get agastan ham wid hare grennunge · 7 hu ha shulen ham seolf grennen 7 niwelen · 7 makien sur semblant · for þe muchele angoise iþe pine of helle. Ah forþi ha beoð þe lesse te meanen · þat ha bi foren hont leorned ha meoster te 60 makien grim chere.

[P]E wreadfule biuoren þe feond skirmed mid kniues · is his knif warpare · 7 pleied mid sweordes · bered ham bi þe sharpe ord open his tunge. swerd 7 knif eiþer beoð sherpe 7 keorwinde : word þat he warped from him 7 skirmed toward oþere. And he boded hu 65 þe deouelen shulen pleien wid him · mid hare sharpe eawles · Skirmin wid him abuten · 7 dusten as a pilche clut · Euch toward oþere ·

wið helle sweordes asneasen him þurh ut · þ
beoð kene ant eateliche ant keoruinde pineN.
70

Þe slawe lið 7 slepeð o þe deofles bearm as
his deore deorling · 7 te deouel leið his tutel
dun to his eare · 7 tuteleð him al þ he wule. for
swa hit is sikerliche to hwam se is idel of god ;
meaðeleð þe feond 3eorne · 7 te idele underueð
luueliche his lare. Idel 7 zemeles is þes deofleS
bearnes slep · ah he schal o domesdei grimliche
abreiden 75 wið þe dredfule dream of þe
englene bemen · 7 in helle wontreaðe echeliche
wakieN. Surgite aiunt mortui
surgite 7 uenite ad iudicium
saluatoris.

Þe ziscere is his eskibah · feareð abuten
esken · 7 bisiliche stureð him to rukelin to
gederes muchele 7 monie ruken · blaweð þrin
80 7 blent him seolf · peaðereð 7 makeð þrin
figures of augrim · as þes rikeneres doð þe
habbeð muche to rikenin. Þis is al þe canges
blisse 7 te feond bihalt tis gomen 7 laheð þ he
bersteð. Wel un derstont euch wis mon þ gold
ba 7 seoluer · 7 euch eorðlich ahte · nis bute
eorðe 7 ahte esken þe ablendeð euch moN þe
ham in blaweð · þ 85 is þe bolheð him þurh
ham in heorte prude. Ant al þ he rukeleð 7
gedereð to gederes · 7 ethalt of ei þing þ nis
bute esken mare þen hit neodeð ; schal in helle
wurðen him tadden 7 neddren · 7 ba as ysaie
seið · schulen beon of wurmes ; his cuuertur 7
his hwitel · þe nalde þerwið neodfule feden ne
schruden. Subter te sternetur 90
tinea 7 operimentum tuum
uermis.

Þe ziuere glutun is þe feondes manciple · ah
he stikeð eauer iceler oðer icuchene · his
heorte is i þe disscheS · his þoht al i þe neppes
· his lif i þe tunne · his sawle i þe crohhe ·
Kimeð biuoren his lauere bismuddet 7
bismulret · a disch in his an hond · a scale in
his 95 oðer. Meaðeleð mis wordes · wigleð as
fordrunke mon þe haueð imunt to fallen · bihalt
his greate wombe · 7 te deouel lahheð. Þeose
þreatið þus godd þurh ysaie · Serui mei
comedent 7 uos esurietis 7 c'.

7 wid helle sweordes asnesen þurh ut þat beod
kene 7 eateliche keorwinde pinen.

[Þ] E slauwe lid 7 sleped oþe deoules
barm as his deore deorling · 7 70 þe
deouel leid his tutel dun to his earen · 7 tutelid
him al þat he eawer uule. for swa hit is
sikerliche to hwam se is idel of god · Meaþeled
þe feond georne. 7 þe idele underweng
luueliche his lare · Idel 7 gemeles is þes
deoueles bernes slep · Ah he shal a domes dai
grimliche abreiden · wid þe dredfule drem of
þe englene bemen · 7 in 75 helle wondrede
etheliche wakien · Surgite mortui qui
jacetis in sepulcris · surgite 7
venite ad Iudicium saluatoris.

[Þ] E gissere is his eskebah · fared abuten
esken · 7 bisiliche stured him te
rukelen tegederes · muchele 7 monie ruken ·
blawed þer in · 7 blend him seolf · þapered 7
maked þerin figures of 80 augrim · As þeos
rich`k`eneres dod þat habbed muche te rikenen.
þis is þes kanges blisse · 7 þe feond bihald þis
gomen · 7 lahed þat he bersteð. wel under
stonde þis euch mon · þat gold ba 7 seoluer · 7
euch worldlich ahte · nis buten eorðe 7 esken
þat ablent euchmon þat in ham blaweð · þat is
þat þat bolehed ham þurh ham in heorte 85
prude. And al þat he rukeled 7 gedered to
gedere · 7 ethalt of ani þing þat nis buten esken
mare þen hit neodeð ; shal in helle wurden him
tadden 7 neddren · 7 ba as ysaie seið shulen
beon of wurmes his cuuertur 7 his `þ`witel þat
neolden warwið neodfule feden 7 shruden.
Subter te sternetur tinea 7
operimentum tuum 90 uermis.

[Þ] e giuere glutun is þes deoules
manciple · Ah he stiked eauer iceler
oþer icuche ne · his heorte is iþe dishes · his
þoht al iþe nappes · his lif iþe tunne · his saule
iþe crohhe · kimed bi worn his lauere bi
smudded 7 bismured · A dich in his an hond ·
A scale in 95 his oþer · Meadeled mis wordes
wigeled as for drunken · mon þat haueð mint to
fallen · bihalt his greate wombe. 7 þe deouel
lahheð. þeos þreated þus god þurh ysaie ·
Serui mei comedent 7 uos

Mine men schulen eoten 7 ow schal eauer
 hungrin · 7 3e schule beon feorle world buten
 ende. *Quantum* glorificauit se 7 in
 deliciis 100 fuit; tantum date illi
 tormentum 7 luctum · In
apocalipsi · *Contra unum*
poculum quod miscuit miscete ei
duo · 3ef þe kealcocuppe wallinde bres to
 drinken · 3eot in his wide þrote þ-he swelte
 inwið. agein an 3ef him twa. þullich is godes
 dom agein 3iuere 7 druncwile iþe apocalipse.
 105

esuriētis 7 c'. Mine men shulen eoten · 7
 ow shal eawer hungren · 7 ge shulen beon
 feondes fode world buten ende. *Quantum*
 gl[ori]ficauit 100 se 7 in deliciis
 fuit; tantum date illi tormentum
 7 luctum · *Apocalipsis* · *Contra*
unum quod miscuit date illi duo ·
 gef þen kelchecuppe wallinde bras te drinken ·
 geot in his wide þrote · þat he swelte in wið.
 agein gef him twa. þullich is godes dom agein
 giwere 7 druncwile iþe apocalipse. 105

ANCRENE WISSE (PARALLEL TEXTS)

B. THE OUTER RULE

A (Corpus MS.)

A (Caius MS.)

B (Corpus MS.)

B (Cotton MSS.)

A (Parallel Texts)

(CORPUS MS.)

3e mine leoue sustren bute 3ef neod ow driue 7
 ower meistre hit reade · ne schulen habbe na
 beast bute cat ane. Ancre þe haueð ahte ·
 þuncheð bet husewif ase Marthe wes · ne
 lihtliche ne mei ha nawt beo Marie marthe
 suster wið griðfullnesse of heorte. for þenne
 mot ha þenchen of þe kues foddre · of heorde 5
 monne hure · Olhnin þe heiward · wearien
 hwen he punt hire · 7 zelden þah þe hearmes.
 ladlich þing is hit wat crist hwen me makeð i
 tune man of ancre ahte. Nu þenne 3ef eani mot
 nedlunges habben hit · loki þ-hit namon ne eili
 ne ne hearmi · ne þ-hire þoht ne beo nawiht
 þron ifestnet. ancre ne ah to habben na þing þ-
 utward drahe hire 10 heorte. Na chaffere ne
 driue 3e · ancre þ-is chepilt · þ-is · buð forte
 sullen efter bi3ete · ha chepeð hire sawle þe
 chapmon of helle. þing þah þ-ha wurchað ha

(COTTON MS. NERO)

3e mine leoue sustren *bute 3ef neod ow
 driue* ne schulen habben no best . bute kat
 one. ancre þet haueð eihte þuncheð bet husewif
 ase marthe was . þen ancre . ne none weis ne
 mei heo beon marie . *marthe suster * mid
 griðfulnesse of heorte. Vor þeonne mot heo
 þenchen of þe kues foddre and of 5
 heordemonne huire . oluhnen þene heiward .
 warien hwon me punt hire 7 zelden þauh ðe
 hermes. wat crist þis is lodlich þing . hwon me
 makeð mone in tune of ancre eihte. Þauh 3if eni
 mot nede habben ku : loke ðet heo none monne
 ne eilie : ne ne hermie . ne þet hire þouht ne
 beo nout þeron iuestned. ancre ne ouh nout 10
 to habben no þing þet drawe utward hire
 heorte. none cheffare ne driue 3e. ancre þet is
 cheapild . * þe buð for te sullen efter bi3ete *
 heo cheapeð hire soule : þe chapmon of helle.

mei þurh hire meistres read ; for hire neode sullen · hali men sumhwile liueden bi hare honden.

Nawt deore dehtren ne wite 3e in ower hus of oðer monne 15 þinges · ne ahte ne claðes · ne boistes · ne chartres · Scoren ne cyrograffes · ne þe chirc uestemenz · ne þe calices · bute neode oðer strengðe hit makie ; oðer muchel eie. Of swuch witunge is muchel vuel ilumpen ofte siðen. **IN** wið ower wanes ne leote 3e namon slepeN · 3ef muchel neod mid alle makeð breoken ower hus · hwil hit eauer is 20 ibroken · habbeð þrinne wið ow a wummon of cleane lif deies ant nihteS.

FOR þi þ-wepmen ne seoð ow ne 3e ham · wel mei don of ower clað beo hit hwit beo hit blac bute hit beo unorne · warm 7 wel iwraht · felles wel itawet · 7 habbeð ase monie as ow to neodeð to bedde 7 to rugge. 25

Nest flesch ne schal nan werien linnene clað bute hit beo of hearde 7 of greate heorden. Stamin habbe hwase wule · hwase wule beo buten. 3e schulen in an hetter ant igurd liggen · swa leoðeliche þah þ-3e mahen honden put ten þerunder. Nest lich nan ne gurde hire wið na cunne gurdles : bute þurh schriftes leaue. Ne 30 beore nan irn ne here · ne ilespiles felles · ne ne beate hire þerwið ; ne wið scurge ileadet · wið holin ne wið breres · ne biblodgi hire seolf ; wiðute schriftes leaue · nohwer ne binetli hire · ne ne beate biuoren · ne na keoruunge ne keorue · ne ne neome ed eanes to luðere disceplines · temptaciuns forte acwenchen · ne for na bote 35 a3ein cundeliche secnesses · nan uncundelich lechecreft ne leue 3e ne ne fondin · wiðuten ower meistres read ; leste ow stonde wurse.

Ower schon i winter beon meoke · greate 7 warme. I sumer 3e habbeð leaue bearuot gan 7 sitten 7 lihte scheos werieN · **H**osen wið ute

Þing þah þ-ha wurdeð ; ha mei wel þurh hire meistres read ; for hire neode sullen. þah swa dernliche as ha mei for misliche monne wordes.

Ne wite 3e 15 nout in oure huse of oðer monnes þinges · ne eihte · ne cloðes · ne nout ne vnderuo 3e ðe chirche uestimenz ne þene caliz bute 3if * neod oðer* strencoðe hit makie : oðer muchel eie. vor of swuche witunge is ikumen muchel `vuel´ oftesiðen. wiðinnen ower woanes : ne lete 3e nenne mon slepen. 3if muchel neode mid alle makeð breken 20 ower hus : þeo hwule ðet hit euer is i broken : loke þet 3e habben þerine mid ou one wummon of clene liue · deies 7 nihtes.

Uorði þet no mon ne isihð ou · ne 3e ne i seoð nenne mon : wel mei don of ower cloðes · beon heo hwite : beon heo blake. bute þet heo beon unorne 7 warme 7 wel i wrouhte. uelles wel i tauwed. 25 7 habbeð ase monie ase ou to neodeð · to bedde and eke to rugge.

Next fleshe ne schal non werien no linnene cloð bute 3if hit beo of herde and of greate heorden. stamin `habbe´ hwose wule. and hwo se wule mei beon buten. 3e schullen liggen in on heater and i gurd. ne bere 3e non iren · ne here · ne irspiles felles. 30 ne ne beate `ou` þer mide. ne mid schurge ileðered : ne ileaded. ne mid holie · ne mid breres · ne ne biblodge hire sulf : wiðuten schriftes leaue · ne ne nime et enes to ueole disceplines.

ower schon beon greate and warme. Ine sumer 3e habbeð leaue uorto gon and sitten baruot. and hosen wiðuten uaumpez · and ligge ine

vampeþ ; ligge in hwase likeð · Ischeoed ne slepe 3e nawt · ne 40 noh wer bute i bedde. Sum wummon inohreaðe wereð þe brech of here ful wel icnottet · þe streapeles dun to þe vet ilacet ful feaste · ah eauer is best þe swete 7 te swote heorte. Me is leouere þ 3e þolien wel an heard word ; þen an heard here. 3ef 3e

muhen beo wimpelles 7 3e wel wullen ; beoð bi warme cappen · 7 þeruppon hwite oðer blake veiles. 45 Ancren summe sungið in hare

wimplunge ; na leasse þen leafdis. Ah þah seið sum þ-hit limpeð to euch wummon cundeliche forte werien wimpel · Nai · wimpel ne heaued clað nowðer ne nempneð hali writ ; ah wriheles ane ·

Ad corinthios · Mulier uelet caput suum · Wummon seið þe apostle schal wreon hire heaued. wrihen he seið 50 nawt wimpliN. wrihen ha schal hire scheome · as eue sunfule dohteR · i mungunge of þe sunne þ-schende us on earst alle · ant nawt drahe þe wriheles to tiffunge 7 to prude ·

Eft wule þe apostle þ-wummon wreo i chirche hire neb 3etten · leste uuel þoht arise þurh hire onsihðe · Et hoc est propter angelos. hwi þenne 55 þu chorch ancre

iwimplet openest þi neb to wepmonnes ehe ; to3eines þe sist men ; spekeð þe apostle · 3ef þu þe ne hudest. ah 3ef þ-ei þing wriheð þi neb from monnes ehe · beo hit wah beo hit clað · i wel i rund windowe · wel mei duhen ancre of oðer wimplunge. To3eines þe þe þus ne dest ; spekeð þe apostle nawt to3eines oþre · þ-60 hare ahne wah wriheð wið euchmonnes sihðe. þer awakenið ofte wake þohtes of · 7 werkes oðerhwileS. Hwase wule beon isehen ; þah ha atiffi hire nis nawt muche wunder ; ah to godes ehnen ha is lufsumre ; þe is for þe luue of him ; untiffet wiðuteN.

Ring ne broche ne habbe 3e · ne gurdel imembret · ne glouen ne nan swuch 65 þing þ-

ham : hwo so likeð. Sum 35 wummon inouhreaðe · wereð þe brech of heare fulwel iknotted · and þe strapeles adun to hire uet. i laced ful ueste. 3if 3e muwen beon wimpel leas : *7 3e wel wullen* beoð bi warme keppen · and þeruppon *oðer hwite oðer* blake ueiles. *Ancren summe sungið in ha[re] wimplunge na lesse þene lefdi Sum seið þ-hit limped · to e[i]

wummon cundeliche ; 40 forte weri[en] wimpel. Nai · Wimpel ne hef[ed] nouðer ne nemneð hali writ ; ah wriheles of heuet.

Ad cor[inth.] Mulier uelet caput suum · Wummon seið þe apostel schal wrihen hi[re] heauet. wrihen he seið naut wimplin. wrihen ha schal hire scheome as sunfule eue dohte[r ;] i mungunge of þe sunne þ-sch[en]de us erst alle 7 naut 45 drah[en] þ-wriheles te tiffung 7 te pru[e].

Eft wule seinte pael þ-wumm[on] wreo i chirche hire neb 3ette leste uel þoht arise þurh hir[e] onsihðe 7 hoc est · propter ang[e]los. Hwi þenne þu chirche ancre al beo þu iwimplet ; openest þah þi neb to weopmones ehe · Te 3eines þe. þe isist men spekeð seinte pael. Ah 3ef ei þing 50 wriheð ; þi neb from monnes ehe ; beo hit wah beo hit clað iþi parlures þurl ; wel mei duhen ancre of oðer wimplunge.* Hwose wule beon iseien · þauh heo atiffe hire ; nis nout muchel wunder · auh to godes eien · heo is lufsumere þet is uor ðe luue of him ; untiffed wiðuten.

Ring · ne broche nabbe 3e · ne gurdel i membred · 55 ne glouen · ne no swuch þing þet

ow ne deh to habben. A meoke surpliz 3e mahen in hat sumer werien.

Eauer me is leouere se 3e doð greattre werkes. Ne makie 3e nane purses forte freondin ow wið · bute to þeo þ-ower meistre 3eueð ow his leaue · ne huue ne blodbinde of seolc · ne laz buten leaue · Ah schapieð 7 seowið 7 mendið chirche claðes · 7 poure monne hettren. 70 na swuch þing ne schule 3e 3eouen wiðuteN schriftes leaue · namare þen neomen ·

þ-3e ne seggen him fore ; as of oðre þinges · kun oðer cuððe · hu ofte 3e under uengen · hulonge 3e edheolden. tendre of cunne limpeð nawt ancre beonne. A mon wes of religiun · 7 com to him efter help his fleschliche broðer · 7 he tahte him to his þridde 75 breðer · þe wes dead biburiet. Þe ondswerede wundrinde · Nai quod he nis he dead? ant ich quod þe hali mon am dead gasteliche. Na fleschlich freond ne easki me fleschlich froure. Amices 7 parures · worldliche leafdis mahen inoh wurchen · ant

3ef 3e ham makieð ; ne makie 3e þrof na mustreisun · veine gloire attreð alle 80 gode þeawes · 7 alle gode werkes. Criblin ne schal nan of ow for luue ne for hure. Talueles ne forbeode ich nawt. 3ef sum riueð surpliz oðeR measse kemese ; oþre riuunges ne riue ha nawt nomeliche oueregede · bute for muche neode.

Helpeð ow wið ower ahne swinc se forð se 3e eauer mahen to schriden ow seoluen 7 feden 3ef 85 neod is · 7 þeo þe ow seruið.

As sein Jerome leareð · ne beo 3e neauer longe ne lihtliche of sumþing allunges idel · for anan rihtes þe feond beot hire his werc þe i godes werc ne swinkeð · 7 tuteleð anan toward hire. foR hwil he sið hire bisi ; he þencheð þus · for nawt ich schulde nu cume neh hire ; ne mei ha

ou · ne deih forto habben. *vnderstondeð . þ-of alle þeose þinges nis nan hest ne forbot for alle ha beoð of þe vttere riwle þ-is lute strençðe of ; for hwon þ-te inre beo wel iwist as ic seide i þe frumðe . ha mei beon ichanget hwerse euer ei neod oder eni skile hit askeð . efter þ-ha mei ase 60 þuften . best seruin þe leafdi riwle.*

E uer me is leouere . so 3e don gretture werkes. ne makie none purses . uorte ureonden ou mide . * bute to þeo þ-ower meistre 3eoueð ow his leaue* ; ne blodbendes of seolke . * ne laz . bute leaue* ; auh schepieð and seuoweð and amendeð chirche cloðes . and poure 65 monne cloðes. no þing ne schule 3e 3iuen : wiðuten schriftes leaue.

helpeð mid ower owune swinke so uorð so 3e muwen to schruden ou suluen and *feden 3ef neod is* þeo ðet ou serueð .

ase seint ierome lereð : ne beo 3e neuer idel . uor anonrihtes ðe ueond beot hire his werc : þet ine godes werke ne wurcheð . and he tuteleð anonrihtes 70 touward hire. uor þeo hwule þet he isihð hire bisi . `he´ þencheð þus . vor nout ich schulde nu kumen neih hire ; ne mei heo nout ihwulen uorto her`c`nen mine lore. of

nawt izemen to lustni 90 mi lare. Of idelnesse
awakeneð muchel flesches fondunge.

Iniquitas Sodome ; saturitas
panis 7 ocium . þis · SodomeS
cwedschipe com of idelnesse 7 of ful wombe.
Irn þ-lið stille gedereð sone rust · weater þe ne
stureð nawt ; readliche stinkeð.

Ancre ne schal nawt forwurðe scolmeistre · ne
turnen ancre husto 95 childrene scole · hire
meiden mei learen sum oðer meiden · þ-were
pliht of to leornin amonge wepmen · oðer
bimong gromes. ah ancre ne ah to 3emen bute
godd ane · þah bi hire meistres read ha mei
sum rihten 7 helpen to learen.

3e ne schulen senden leattres · ne underuon
leattres · ne writen bute leaue. 3e schulen beon
i doddet · 100 oðer 3ef 3e wulleð ischauen fowr
siðen i þe 3er · to lihtin ower heaued · beo bi þe
her ieuerset ; hwase swa is leouere · ant as ofte
ileten blod 7 3ef neod is ; oftre · þe mei beo
þer buten ; ich hit mei wel þolien. Hwen 3e
beoð ilete blod ; 3e ne schule don na þing þe
þreo dahes þ-ow greueð · ah talkið to ower 105
meidnes · 7 wið þeawfule talen schurteð ow to
gederes. 3e maheN swa don ofte hwen ow
þuncheð heuie ; oðer beoð for sum wortlich
þing sare oðer seke · þah euch wortlich froure
is unwurðe to ancre.

Swa wisliche witeð ow in ower blodletunge ; 7
haldeð ow i swuch reste ; þ-3e longe þrefter
mahen i godes seruise þe monluker swinken ·
110 ant alswa hwen 3e feleð eani secnesse.

Muchel sotschipe hit is leosen for an dei ; tene
oðer tweolue. Vesscheð ow hwerse neod is as
ofte as 3e wulleð ·

7 ower opre þinges. Nes neauer fulðe godd leof
· þah pouerte 7 unorneschipe beon him
licwurðe. VNderstondeð eauer of alle þeose
þinges · þ-nan nis heast ne forbod þ-115 beoð
of þe uttre riwle · þet is lute strengðe of. for

idelnesse awakeneð muchel flessches fondunge .

Iniquitas sodome . saturitas
panis 7 ocium . þet is. al sodomes
cweadschipe kom of idelnesse : 7 of ful 75

wombe. Iren þet lið stille ; gedereð sone rust .
and water þet ne stureð nout readliche stinkeð.

ancre ne schal nout forwurðen scolme`i`stre :

ne turnen hire ancre hus ; to childrene scole.
hire meiden mei þauh techen sum lutel meiden.
þet were dute of forto leornen among gromes .
auh ancre ne ouh forto 3emen bute god one.

*þah 80 bi hire meistres read ; ha mei sum
rihten 7 helpe te leren.*

3e ne schulen senden lettres . ne underuon
lettres . ne writen : buten leaue. 3e schulen
beon idodded four siðen iðe 3ere : uorto lihten
ower heaued. *oðer 3ef 3e wulled ischauen.
hwa se wule ieveset. ah ha mot te oftere

weschen 7 kemben hire heauet* ; and ase ofte
ileten 85 blod . and oftere 3if neod is . and hwo
so mei beon þer wið uten ; ich hit mei wel i
þolien. hwon 3e beoð ileten blod . 3e ne
schulen don no þing þeo þreo dawes ; þet ou
greue . auh talkeð mid ower meidenes. and mid
þeawfule talen : schurteð ou to gederes. 3e
muwen don so ofte : hwon ou þuncheð heuie .
oðer beoð uor sume worldliche þinge 90 sorie :
oðer seke.

So wisliche witeð ou in our blodletunge : and
holdeð ou ine swuche reste . þet 3e longe þer
efter muwen ine godes seruise þe monluker
swinken . and also hwon 3e iueleð eni secnesse.
vor muchel sotschipe hit is. uorto uorleosen uor
one deie. tene oðer tweolue. Wassheð ou hwar
se 3e habbeð neode : ase ofte 95 ase 3e wulleð.

hwon þ-te inre beo wel iwist as ich seide i þe frumðe · þeos mei beon ichanget hwerse eani neod oðer eani skile hit easkeð · efter þ-ha best mei þe leafdi riwle seruin as hire eadmode þuften · ah sikerliche wiðuten hire þe leafdi feareð to wundre.

Ancre þe naueð nawt neh 120 honde hire fode ; beoð bisie twa wummen. An eauer þe leaue ed hame ; an oþer þe wende ut · hwenne driueð neod · 7 þeo beo ful unorne wiðuten euch tiffunge · oðer a lutel þuftene ; oðer of feier ealde. Bi þe wei as ha geað ; ga singinde hire beoden · ne ne halde na tale wið mon ne wið wummon · ne sitte ne ne stonde · bute þ-125 leaste þet ha eauer mei ear þen ha ham cume. Nohwider elles ne ga heo bute þider as me send hire · wiðute leaue · ne ne eote ha ne ne drinke ute · Ðe oþer beo eauer inne · ne wiðute þe 3eten : ne ga wiðute leaue.

Ba beon obedient to hare dame in alle þing · bute i sunne ane · na þing nabben þet heo hit nute · ne underuo na 130 þing · ne ne 3eoue nowðer ; wiðuten hire leaue. Na mon ne leote 3e in · ne þe 3ungre ne speoke wið namon bute leaue · ne ga ha nawt ut of tune : wiðuten siker fere · 3ef hit swa mei beon ; ne ne ligge ute. 3ef heo ne con oboke ; segge bi pater nostres · ant bi auez hire ures · 7 wurche þ-me hat hire wið ute gruchunge. habbe eauer hire 135 earen opene toward hire dame. Nowðer of þe wummen ne beore from hare dame · ne ne bringe to hire nane idele talen ; ne neowe tidinges · ne bitweonen ham seolf ; ne singen ne ne spoken na ne worldliche spechen · ne lahhen swa ne pleien ; þet ei mon þ-hit sehe ; mahte hit to uuel turnen.

Ouer alle þinges leasunges 7 luðere wordes 140 heatien. hare her beo icoruen · hare heaued clað sitte lahe · eiðer ligge ane. Hare cop beo hehe isticchet · 7 bute broche. namon ne seo ham unleppet ne open heaued. lah locunge habben.

Ancre þet naueð nout neih honde hire uode : beoð bisie two wummen . on ðet bileaue euer ethom . an oðer þet wende ut hwon hit is neod . and þeo beo ful unorne *oðer a lute þuhten* oðer of feir elde and biðe weie ase heo geð . go singinde hire beoden . 100 ne ne holde heo nout none tale mid mon ne mid wummon . ne ne sitte ne ne stonde bute þet leste þet heo mei er þen heo kume hom. nouhwuder elles ne go heo ; bute þider ase me sent hire. wiðute leaue : ne ete heo ne ne drinke ute. þe oðer beo euer inne . ne wiðute þe 3eate ne go heo nout wiðute leaue.

boðe beon obedient to hore 105 dame in alle þinges ; bute ine sūnne one. no þing nabben heo ; þet hore dame hit nute . ne ne underuon no þing . ne ne 3iuen wiðuten hire leaue. Nenne mon ne leten heo in . ne ðe 3ungre ne speke mid none monne : bute leaue . ne ne go nout ut of tune . wiðuten siker uere . ne ne ligge ute. 3if heo ne con o boke : sigge bi pater nostres 110 and bi auez hire vres . and wurche þet me hat hire wiðuten grucchunge. habbe euer hire earen opene toward hire dame. nouðer of ðe wummen ne beren urom hore dame . ne ne bringen to hire . none idele talen : ne neowe tīþinges . ne bitweonen ham sulf ne singen . ne ne speken none worldliche spechen . ne lauhwen ne ne pleien so ðet 115 ei mon þet hit iseie . muhte hit to v`u`el turnen.

ouer alle þing leasunge and luðere wordes . hatien. Hore her beo i koruen . hore heuedcloð sitte lowe. eiðer ligge one. Hore hesmel beo heie istihd ; al wiðute broche. no mon ne iseo ham unweawed . ne open heaued. *Inwið þe wanes ha muhe werie scapeloris hwen mantel

Heo ne schulen cussen namon · ne cuðmon ne
 cunnes mon · ne for na cuððe cluppen · ne
 weschen hare heaued · ne lokin feaste o na
 mon ; ne toggin 145 wið ne pleien. Hare weden
 beon of swuch schape · 7 al hare aturn swuch ;
 þet hit beo edscene hwerto ha beoð iturnde.
 Hare lates lokin warliche · þ-nan ne mahe
 edwiten ham ; in hus ne ut of hus.

On alle wise forbeoren to wreaðen hare dame ·
 7 as ofte as heo hit doð ; ear ha drinken oþer
 eoten ; makien hare venie · o cneon 150 dun
 biuoren hire 7 seggen · mea culpa · 7 underuon
 þe penitence þ-ha leið upon hire lutinde hire
 lahe. Þe ancre þrefter neauer mare þ-ilke gult ne
 upbreide for na wreaððe · bute 3ef ha eft sone
 falle i þ-ilke · ah do hit allunge ut of hire
 heorte. 3ef ei strif ariseð bitweone þe
 wummen ; þe ancre makie eiðer to makien
 oþer venie o cneon to þer 155 eorðe · 7 eiðer
 rihte up oþer ; 7 cussen on ende · ant te ancre
 legge on eiðer ; sum penitence ·
 mare up o þe ilke þe greatluker gulte. Þis is a
 þing witen ha wel þ-is gode leouest ; Sahtnesse
 7 some · 7 te feond laðest · forþi he is eauer
 umben to arearen sum leaððe. Nu sið þe
 sweoke wel · þ-hwen fur is wel o brune ; 7 me
 wule þ-hit aga ; 160 me sundreð þe brondes · 7
 he deð nond þ-ilke. luue is ihesu cristes fur · þ-
 he wule þ-bleasie aa i þin heorte · ant te deouel
 blaweð forte puffen hit ut. Hwen his blawunge
 ne geineð nawt · he bringeð up sum uuel word
 · oðer sum oþer nohtunge · hwer þurh ha to
 hurten eiðer frommard oþer · 7 te hali gastes
 fuR cwencheð hwen þe 165 brondes þurh
 wreaððe beoð isundret. forþi halden ham i luue
 feaste to gederes ·

120 ham heuegeð . ute ; gan i mantlet þe heauet
 ihudeket.* louh lokunge habben.

heo ne schulen cussen nenne mon . * ne cuð
 mon ne cunes mon . ne for nan cuððe cluppen*
 ne uor luue cluppen . ne kuð ne unkuð . ne
 wasshen hore heaued . ne loken ueste o none
 monne . ne toggen mid him ; ne pleien. hore
 weaden beon of swuche scheape 125 7 alle
 hore aturn swuch ; þet hit beo eðcene hwarto
 heo beoð iturnde. hore lates loken warliche .
 þet non ne edwite ham ne ine huse ne ut of
 huse.

on alle wise uorberen to wreððen hore dame .
 and ase ofte ase heo hit doð er heo drinken oðer
 eten . makien hore uenie akneon adun to þer
 eorðe biuoren hire : 7 sigge mea culpa .
 and underuon 130 ðe penitence : ðet heo leið
 upon hire lutende hire louwe. þe ancre neuer
 more þer efter þene ilke gult ne upb[r]eide
 hire : uor none wreððe . bute 3if heo eft sone
 ualle iðet ilke . auh do hit allunge ut of hire
 heorte. and 3if eni strif ariseð bitweonen ðe
 wummen ; ðe ancre makie eiðer of ham to
 makien oðer venie akneon to ðer eorðe . and
 135 eiðer rihte up oðer : 7 kussen ham on ende
 . and þe ancre legge on eiðer sum penitence.

More upon þeo ilke : ðet gretluker haueð agult.
 þis is o þing wute `3e´ wel to soðe ðet is gode
 leouest ; seih[t]nesse 7 some. 7 þe ueonde
 loðest. and forþi he is euer umbe to arearen
 sume wreððe. nu isihð ðe deouel wel ðet hwon
 þet fur 140 is wel o brune . 7 me wule ðet hit
 go ut : me sundreð ðe brondes . and he deð
 `also´ onond þet ilke. luue is ihesu cristes fur
 þet he wule ðet blasie in vre heorte . and þe
 deouel bloweð forto puffen hit ut . and hwon
 his blowinge ne geineð nout : þeonne bringeð
 he up sum luðer word . oðer sum oþer
 nouhtunge : hwar þuruh heo to hurteð eiðer 145
 uommard oðer ; and þe holi gostes fur ;
 acwencheð hwon ðe brondes þuruh wreððe ;
 beoð isundred. and forþi holden ham ine luue
 ueste togederes .

Ant ne beo *ham* nawt of hwen þe feond blawe ·
 nomeliche 3ef monie beon iueietsomet ; 7 wel
 wið luue ontende. Ðah þe ancre on hire meidnes
 for openliche gultes legge penitence ; to þe
 preost noðeleater schriuē ham hwen neod is ·
 ah eaue þah wið leaue. 3ef ha 170 ne cunnen
 nawt þe mete *graceS* · seggen in hare stude ;
pater noster biuoren ; 7 aue Maria · 7 efter
 mete alswa · ant a Credo mare · 7 segge þus on
 ende · feader · Sune · hali gast al mihti godd ·
 3eoue ure dame his *grace* · se lengre se mare ·
 7 leue hire 7 us ba neomen god ende · for3elde
 alle þe us god doð · 7 milci hare sawle þe us
 god 175 idon habbeð · hare sawle 7 alle
 cristene sawleS.

Bitweone mel ne gruchesi 3e nawt · nowðer
 frut ne oðerhwet ; ne drinken bute leaue . 7 te
 leaue beo liht in al þ-nis sunne. Ed te mete na
 word · oðer lut ; 7 teo stille. Alswa efter þe
 ancre complie · aþet prime · ne don na þing ne
 seggen ; hweRþurh hire silence mahe 180 beon
 isturbet. Nan ancre seruānt ne ahte bi rihte to
 easkin iset hure · bute mete 7 hure þ-ha mei
 flutte bi ; ant godes milce. Ne misleue nan
 godd ; hwetse tide of þe ancre · þ-he hire
 trukie. þe meidnes wiðuten 3ef ha seruið þe
 ancre alswa as ha ahen · hare hure schal beon
 þe hehe blisse of heouene. Hwase haueð ehe of
 hope toward 185 se heh bure ; gleadliche wule
 ha seruui 7 lihtliche alle wa · 7 alle teone
 þolien. wið eise 7 wið este ne buð me nawt
 bliSSe.

3e ances ahen þis leaste stucche reden to
 3ower wummen euche wike eanes · aþet ha
 hit cunnen. Ant muche neod is þ-3e neomen to
 ham muche 3eme · for 3e mahen muchel beon
 þurh ham i godet · 7 190 iwurset. On oðer half
 3ef þet ha sungið þurh ower 3emeles ; 3e schule

and ne beo *ham* nout of ; hwon ðe ueond blowe
 . and nomeliche 3if monie beoð i ueied somed ;
 and wel mid luue ontende. Ðauh ðe ancre on
 hire meidenes uor openliche gultes . legge
 penitence 150 neuer ðe later to ðe preoste
 schriuē ham ofte . auh euer þauh mid leaue.
 and 3if heo ne kunnen nout ðe mete *graces* :
 siggen in hore stude ; *pater . noster .* 7 aue
 maria biuoren mete . and efter mete also . 7
 credo moare . and siggen þus on ende . veder 7
 sune 7 holi gost . 7 on almihti god ; he 3iue ure
 dame his *grace* ; so lengre so more . 155 7 leue
 hire 7 us boðe nimen god endinge . 7 for3elde
 alle ðet us god doð . 7 milce hore soulē : þet
 us god i don habbeð . hore soulē 7 alle
 cristene soulē. amen.

Bitweonen mele ne gruselie 3e nout . nouðer
 frut ; `ne´ oðerhwat . ne `ne´ drinken wiðuten
 leaue . auh þe leaue beo liht in alle þeo þinges ;
 þer nis sunne. Ette mete 160 no word . oðer lut
 . 7 þeo beon stille. also efter ðe ancre *cumple*
 uort midmorwen . ne don no þing . ne ne
 siggen . hwar þuruh hire silence muwe beon i
 sturbed. non ancre seruānt ne ouhte mid rihte
 uorto asken i sette huire ; bute mete 7 cloð : þet
 heo mei vlutten bi . 7 godes milce. ne misleue
 non god ; hwat so bitide of ðe ancre : 165 þet
 he hire trukie. þe meidenes wiðuten 3if heo
 serueð ðe ancre also ase heo owen ; hore hure
 schal beon ðe eche blisse of heouene. hwo so
 haueð eie hope touward so heie hure : gleadliche
 wule heo seruen 7 lihtliche alle wo and alle
 teone þolien. Mid eise ne mid este ; ne kumeð
 me nout toþer heouene. 170

3e ancren owen þis lutle laste stucchen reden
 to our wummen eueriche wike enes uort ðet
 heo hit kunnen. and muche neod is ou beoðe :
 ðet 3e nimen to *ham* gode 3eme . vor 3e muwen
 muchel þuruh *ham* beon i goded. and i wursed
 on oðer halue. 3if heo sunegeð þuruh ower

beo bicleopet þrof biuore þe hehe deme · 7 for
þi as ow is muche neod · 7 ham 3et mare ;
3eornliche leareð ham to halden hare riwle · ba
for ow 7 for ham seolf ; liðeliche 7 luueliche ·
for swuch ah wummone lare to beonne ·
luuelich 7 liðe · 7 selthwenne sturne.

Ba is riht þ-ha 195 ow dreden 7 luuien · ant þah
þ-ter beo eauer mare of luue ; þen of drede ·
þenne schal hit wel fearen · Me schal healden
eoli 7 win ba i wunden efter godes lare · ah
mare of softe eoli ; þen of bitinde win . þ-is
Mare of liðe wordes ; þen of suhinde · for þer
of kimeð þinge best ; þ-is luue eie. lihtliche 7
sweteliche for3eoued 200 ham hare gultes ·
hwen ha ham icnaweð 7 bihateð bote.
Ase forð as 3e mahen of mete 7 of claðes · 7 of
opre þinges þet neode of flesch easkeð ; beoð
large toward ham ; þah 3e nearowe beon 7
hearde to ow seoluen. Swa deð þe wel blaweð ;
went te nearewe of þe horn to his ahne muð ;
ant utward þ-wide. Ant 3e don alswa as 3e
wulleð þ-205 ower beoden bemin wel 7
dremen ; i drihtines earen · nawt ane to ower
ahnes ; ah to alle folkes heale · as ure lauerd
leue þurh þe grace of him seolf þ-hit swa mote
ameN.

Hwen ower sustres meidnes cumeð to ow to
froure ; cumeð to ham to þe þurl ; earunder 7
ouerunder · eanes oðer twien · 7 gað a3ein
sone ; to ower note gastelich · 210 ne biuore
Complie ne sitte 3e nawt for ham ouer riht time
· swa þ-hare cume beo na lure of ower
religiun ; ah gastelich bizete. 3ef þer is eani
word iseid þ-mahte hurten heorte ; ne beo hit
nawt iboren ut ; ne ibroht to oþer ancre ; þ-is
eð hurte. To him hit schal beon iseid ; þe lokeð
ham alle. Twa niht is inoh þ-ei beo edhalden ·

3emeleaste ; 3e schulen beon bicleoped þerof
biuoren þe 175 heie demare . and forþi ase ou
is muche neod . 7 ham is 3ete more ;
3eorneliche techeð ham to holden hore riulen .
boðe uor ou : 7 for ham suluen . liðeliche þauh
7 luueliche ; uor swuch ouh wummone lore to
beon . luuelich and liðe and seldwhonne sturne.
Boðe hit is riht þet heo ou dreden 7 luuien . auh
þet ðer beo . more euer 180 of luue : þen of
drede. þeonne schal hit wel uaren. Me schal
helden eoli and win beoðe ine wunden, efter
godere lore . auh more of þe softe eolie ; þen of
þe bitinde wine . þet is . more of liðe wordes :
þen of suwinde . vor þerof kumeð þinge best ;
þet is luueeie. lihtliche 7 sweteliche uor3iueð
ham hore gultes : hwon heo ham iknoweð and
185 bihoteð bote.

Se uorð ase 3e muwen of drunch and of mete
and of cloð and of oðer þinges þet neode of
fleshe askeð : beoð large touward ham : þauh 3e
ðe neruwure beon and te herdure to ou suluen .
vor so deð þe wel bloweð . went þene neruwure
ende of þe horne to his owune 190 muðe . 7
utward þene wide. and 3e don also . ase 3e
wulleð þet ower beoden bemen 7 dreamen wel :
ine drihtenes earen . and nout one to ower
ones ; auh to alle uolkes heale . ase ure louerd
leue þuruh ðe grace of himself . þet hit so mote
beon. amen.

ant þ-beo 215 ful seldene · ne for heom ne
 breoke silence ed te mete ; ne for blodletunge ·
 bute 3ef sum mucche god oðer neod hit makie.
 Ðe ancre ne hire meiden ne plohiē `nane´
 worldliche gomenes ed te þurle · ne ne ticki to
 gederes · foR ase seið seint Beornard. vñwurðe
 þing is to euch gastelich mon · 7 nomeliche to
 ancre ; euch swuch fleschlich 220 froure · 7 hit
 binimeð gastelich þ-is wið ute met utnume
 murðe · 7 þ-is uuel change as is iseid þruppe.

Of þis boc redeð hwen 3e beoð eise euche
 dei ; leasse oðer mare. Jch hopie þ-hit
 schal beon ow 3ef 3e hit redeð ofte ; swiðe
 biheue ; þurh godes mucchele grace · elles ich
 hefde uuele bitohe 225 mi mucchele hwile. Me
 were leouere godd hit wite do me toward
 rome ; þen forte biginnen hit eft forte donne.
 3ef 3e findeð þ-3e doð als wa as 3e redeð ;
 þonckið godd 3eorne · 3ef 3e ne doð nawt ;
 biddeð godes are · 7 beoð umben þeronuuen þ-
 3e hit bet halden efter ower mihte. 230

Feader · Sune · hali gast · an almihti godd
 wite ow in hiS warde · he gleadie ow 7
 frouri ow mine leoue sustren · ant for al þ-3e
 for him dreheð 7 draieð · ne 3eoue ow neauer
 leasse · þen altogedere him seoluen · Beo he aa
 iheiet from world into worlde aa on ecnesse ·
 AMeN.

Ase ofte aS 3e habbeð ired eawiht her on ;
 greteð þe leafdi 235 wið aN aue ; for him þ-
 swonc her abuten · Jnoh meaðful ich am þe
 bidde se lutel ·  Explicit · Jþench o þi writere
 iþine beoden sum chearre ; ne beo hit ne se
 lutel. Hit turneð þe to gode ; þ-tu bidest for
 oþre.

Oþisse boc redeð eueriche deie : hwon 3e
 beoð eise · eueriche deie 195 lesse oðer
 more. uor ich hopie þet hit schal beon ou 3if 3e
 hit redeð ofte : swuðe biheue þuruh godes
 grace · and elles ich heuede vuele bitowen
 muchel of mine hwule. God hit wot me were
 leouere uorto don me touward rome ; þen uorto
 biginnen hit eft forto donne. and 3if 3e iuindeð
 þet 3e doð also ase 3e redeð ; þonkeð god
 3eorne · 200 and 3if 3e ne doð nout ; biddeð
 godes ore · and beoð umbe þer abuten : þet 3e
 hit bet hol holden : efter ower mihte.

Veder and sune and holi gost · and on almihti
 god : he wite ou in his warde. he gledie ou and
 froure ou ; mine leoue sustren. and for al þet 3e
 uor him drieð and suffreð · he ne 3iue ou neuer
 lesse huire þen 205 alto gedere him suluen. he
 beo euer iheid from worlde to worlde · euer on
 ecchenesse. amen.

ase ofte ase 3e readeð out o þisse boc ; greteð
 þe lefdi mid one aue marie uor him ðet madeð
 þeos riwle · and for him þet hire wrot and
 swonc her abuten. Inouh meðful ich am ; þet
 bidde so lutel. 210

X. IN DIEBUS DOMINICIS

“Lambeth 487: see [\[VIII, Poema Morale\]](#).”

: PRIVILEGES OF SUNDAY

[L] EOFEMEN 3ef 3e lusten wuleð. 7 3e
 willenche hit understonden we eow wulleð
 [f. 16 r] suteliche seggen of þa fredome þe
 limpeð to þan deie þe is iclepeð sunedei. Sunedei
 is ihaten þes lauerdes dei 7 ec þe dei of blisse 7
 of lisse 7 of alle irest. On þon deie þa engles of
 heofene ham iblissieð. 5 forði þe þa erming saulen habbeð rest of heore
 pine. Gif hwa wule witen hwa erest bi won reste þam wrecche saule to
 soþe ic eow segge. þet wes *sancte* paul þe apostel and mihhal þe
 archangel heo tweien eoden et sume time into helle alswa heom
 drihten het for to lokien hu hit þer ferde. Mihhal eode bi foren 7 paul
 com efter 7 þa 10 scawede mihhal to *sancte* paul þa wrecche sunfulle
 þe þer were wuniende [.] þerefter he him sceawede heze treon eisliche
 beorninde et foren helle 3ete. and uppon þan treon he him sceawede þe
 wrecche saulen ahonge. Summe bi þa fet. summe bi þa honden. summe
 bi þe tunge. summe bi þe e3en. summe bi þe hefede. summe bi þer 15
 heorte. Seodðan he him sceauðe an ouen on berninde fure he warp ut
 of him seofe leies uwil[c]an of seolcuðre heowe þe alle weren
 eateliche to bihaldene 7 muchele strengre þen eani þing to þolien. 7
 þer wiðinnen weren swiðe feole saule ahonge. 3ette he him sceawede
 ane welle of fure 7 alle hire stremes urnen fur berninde. 7 þa 20 welle
 bi wisten .xii. meister [f. 16 v] deoflen swilc ha weren kinges to pinen
 þer wiðinnen þa earming saulen þe forgult weren; 7 heore a3ene pine
 neure nere þe lesse þah heo meistres weren. Efter þon he him
 sceawede þe sea of helle 7 innan þan sea weren .vii. bittere uþe. þe
 forme wes snau . þat oðer is. þet þridde fur. þet feorðe blod. þe 25 fifte
 neddren. þe siste smorðer. þe seofeþe ful stunch. heo wes wurse to
 þolien þenne efreni of alle þa oðre pine. Innan þan ilke sea weren un
 aneomned deor summe feðer fotetd. Summe al bute fet . 7 heore e3en
 weren al swilc swa fur. 7 heore epem scean swa deð þe leit amonge
 þunre. þas ilke nefre ne swiken ne dei ne niht to 30 brekene þa erming
 licome of þa ilca men þe on þisse liue her hare *scrift* enden nalden.

4. In MS. *su sunedei*.
 11. *sunfulle wrecche*
 with marks of
 transposition in MS.
 18. *þing*] *þurg* MS.
 25. *snau*] *swnau* MS.

Summe of þan monne sare wepeð. Summe swa deor lude remeð.
 summe þer graninde sikeð. summe þer reowliche gnezeð his azene
 tunge. Summe þer wepeð. 7 alle heore teres beoð berninde gleden
 glidende ouer heore azene nebbe. 7 swiðe reowliche 35 ilome 3eizeð 7
 3eorne bisecheð þat me ham ibure3e from þam uuele pinan [.] of þas
 pinan speked .*dauid*. þe halie wite3e. 7 þus seið. **Misere`re` nostri
 domine quia penas inferni sustinere non possumus.** Lauerd haue
 merci of us forðon þa pinen of helle we ham ne mazen iðolien. [f. 17 r]

Seoðþan he him sceawede ane stude 40 inne
 midde warðe helle. 7 bi foren þam ilke stude
 weren seofen clusterlokan þar neh ne mihte nan
 liuiende mon gan for þan ufele breðe 7 þer wið
 inna he him sceawede gan `on´ ald mon þ.iiii.

40. *ane*] and MS.
 46. *wualde* MS.
 53. *wereðful* MS.
 56. *þunres*] *wunres*
 MS.

deoflen ledden abuten. þa escade paul to mihhal hwet þe alde mon
 were. þa cweð mihhal heh engel he wes an biscop on eoðre liue þe
 nefre 45 nalde *cristes* la3en lokien ne halden. ofter he walde anuppon
 his underlinges mid wohe motien 7 longe dringan þenne he walde
 salmes singen oðer eani oðer god don. Herefter iseh paul hwer .iii.

deoflen ledden an meiden swiðe unbisor3eliche ; `7´ 3eorne escade to
 mihhal hwi me heo swa ledde. þa cweð mihhal. heo wes an meiden on
 oðer liue 50 þwel wiste hire licome in alle clenesse. Ah heo nalde nefre
 nan oðer god don. Elmes3eorn nes heo nefre. ah prud heo wes swiðe 7
 modi. 7 li3ere 7 swikel. 7 wreðful 7 ontful. 7 forði heo bið wuniende
 inne þisse pine. Nu bigon paul to wepen wunderliche. 7 mihhal heh
 engel þer weop forð mid him. þa com ure drihten of heueneriche to 55
 heom on þunres liche 7 þus cweð. A hwi wepest þu paul. paul him
 onswerde. Lauerð ic biwepe þas monifolde pine þe ic her in helle iseo.
 þa cweð ure lauerd. A hwi nalden heo witen mine [f. 17 v] la3e þe
 hwile heo weren en eorðe? þa seide paul him mildeliche to3eines.
 Louerd nu ic bidde þe 3ef þin wille is þ-þu heom 3efe 60 reste la hwure
 þen sunne dei a þet cume domesdei. þa cweð drihten to him. paul wel
 ic wat hwer ic sceal milcien. Ic heom wullemilcien þe weren efterward
 mine milce þa hwile heo on liue weren. þa wes *sancte* paul swiðe wa.
 7 abeh him redliche to his lauerdes fet 7 on halsien hine gon mid þas
 ilke weord þe 3e mazen iheren. Lauerd 65 he cweð þa. Nu ic þe bidde

for þine kinedome 7 for þine engles. 7 for þine muchele milce. 7 for alle þine weorkes. 7 for alle þine haleȝen. 7 ec þine icorene. þat þu heom milcie þes þe redþer þ-ic to heom com 7 reste ȝefe þen sunnedei a þ-cume þin heh domes dei. þa onswerede him drihten mildere steuene. Aris nu paul aris. Ic ham 70 ȝeue reste al swa þu ibeden hauest from non on saterdei a þa cume monedeis lihting. þ-efre forð to domes dei. Nu leofe breðre ȝe habbeð iherð hwa erest bi won reste þam forgulte saule. Nu bicum`e`ð hit þefore to uwilche cristene monne mucheles þe mare to halizen 7 to wurðien þenne dei þe is icleped sunnedei. for of þam deie ure 75 lauerd seolf seið. **Dies dominicus est dies leticie 7 requiei.** [f. 18 r] Sunnedei is dei of blisse 7 of alle ireste. **Non facietur in ea aliquid nisi deum orare manducare 7 bibere cum pace et leticia.** Ne beo in hire naþing iwrat bute chirche bisocnie 7 beode to criste 7 eoten 7 drinken mid griðe 7 mid 80 gledscape. **Sicut dicitur. pax in terra. pax in celo. pax inter homines.** for swa is iset. grið on eorðe. 7 grið on hefene. 7 grið bitwenen uwilc cristene monne. eft ure lauerd seolf seit. **Maledictus homo qui non custodit sabatum.** Amansed beo þe mon þe sunnedei nulle iloken. And forþi leofemen uw`i`lc 85 sunne dei is to locan al swa ester dei for heo is muneȝing of his halie ariste from deðe to liue. 7 muneȝeing of þam halie gast þe he sende in his apostles on þon dei þe is icleped witsunnedei. ec we understondeð þ-on sunnedei drihten cumeð to demene al moncun; we aȝen þene sunnedei swiþeliche wel to wurþien. 90 7 on alle clenesse to locan. for heo hafð mid hire þreo wurdliche mihte þe ȝe iheren mazen. ðet forme mihte is þ-heo on eorðe `ȝeueð reste to alle eorðe` þrelles wepmen 7 wifmen of heore þrelweorkes. þet oðer mihte is on heouene. for þi þa engles heom rested mare þenn on sum oðer dei. þ-þridde mihte is þ-þa 95 erming saule habbeð ireste inne helle [f. 18 v] of heore muchele pine. Hwa efre þenne ilokie wel þene sunnedei. oðer þa oðer halie dazes þe mon beot in chirche to lokien swa þe sunnedei. beo heo dalneominde of heofene riches blisse ; mid þan fedre. 7 mid þan sunne. 7 mid þan halie gast abuten ende. ameN. 100 Quod ipse prestare dignetur qui

93. ȝeueð ... eorðe
added on margin.

94-5. *hem heō rested*
MS. | *þa* | *þa* MS.

99. *ferde* MS.

uiuít 7 regnat deus. *per omnia secula seculorum*.
AmeN.

XI. HIC DICENDUM EST DE PROPHETA

“As for piece x.” Described under [VIII, Poema Morale](#).

[M]issus est ieremias in puteum 7 stetit ibi
usque ad os. Qui cum aliquamdiu ibi stetisset ;
debilitatum est corpus eius. 7 tandem dimissis
funibus subtractus est. Et cum eorum duriciam. quia debilis erat
sustinere non posset. allati sunt panni de domo regia 7
circumpositi sunt funibus ne [e]lorum duricia lederetur. Leofemen
we uindeð in halie boc. þ. ieremie þe prophete stod in ane putte. 7 þ-in
þe uenne up to his muðe 7 þa he hefedede þer ane hwile istonde. þa bi
com his licome swiðe feble. 7 me nom rapes 7 caste in to him for to
drazen hine ut of þisse putte. 10 Ah his licome wes se swiðe feble ; þ-he
ne mihte noht iþolie þe herdnesse of þe rapes. þa sende me claðes ut of
þes kinges huse for to biwinden þe rapes. þ-his licome þe feble wes ne
sc`e`olde noht wursien. Leofemen þeos ilke weord þe ic habbe her iseit
habbeð muchele bi tacnunge [f. 19 r] 7 god ha beoð to heren and
mucheles 15 betere to et halden. Is hit god for to hiheren godes weordes
and heom athalden? 3e fuliwis. for ure lauerd godalmihtin seið in þan
halie god spelle. **Beati qui audiunt uerbum dei 7 custodiunt illud.**
Ædie 7 blessedde beon alle þeo þe ihereð godes weordes 7 heom
athaldeð. Nu 3e habbeð iherd wulc hit is for to iheren godes 20 weordes
7 heom ethalden. Nu we sculen heow sceawen hwilc hit is heom for to
heren 7 nawiht for to ethalden. for seint gregori seið. **Melius est uiam
ueritatis non agnoscere ; quam post agnitam retroire.** Betre hit is þ-
mon ne iknawe noht þe wei to godalmihtin þe he hine icnawe 7 seodðe
hine forhozie ; and on oðer 25 stude he seið. **Qui obturat aures suas**

4. After *erat* ş MS.
10. *for*] *fro* MS.

ne audiat legem dei ; oracio eius erit execrabilis. þe mon þe tuneð his eren in halie chirche to 3eines godes laze and nule noht iheren þe weordes þe of him beoð. his beoden beoð aweriede 7 unwurðe gode. **Puteus est peccati**

28. *gol*des MS.
34. *liggeð*] i above *e* MS.

profunditas. quia quam diu stas in luto ; tam

diu ³⁰ **iacas in mortali peccato.** Þes put bitacneð deopnesse of sunne.

for also longe also we liggeð in heueð sunnen ; al þa hwile we sto[n]deð in þe putte. 7 þ-in þe uenne up to þe muðe also þeos men doð þe liggeð inne eubruche 7 ine glutenerie 7 ine manaðas. 7 ineprude. 7 ine oðre fule sunnen. 7 þ-beoð riche men [f. 19 v] alremest ³⁵ þe habbeð þas muchele prude in þis world. þe habbeð fe`i`re huses. 7 feire hames. 7 feire wifes. 7 feire children. feire hors 7 feire clapes. heauekes 7 hundes. castles 7 tunes. heruppon heo þench`e`ð muchele mare þen uppon godalmihtin þe al þis heom haueð isend þa þe liggeð inne swilc sunne. 7 ne þencheð noht for to arisen ; heo delueð ⁴⁰ deihwamliche heore put deoppre 7 deoppre. **vnde propheta. Non claudit super te puteus os suum nisi cluseris os tuum.** þe prophete seið. þ-þe put ne tuneð noht lihtliche his muð ouer us bute we tunen

ure muð. ah 3if we tuneð ure muð ; þenne do we also þe mon þe delueð ene put feower daze`s` oðer fiue 7 þenne ⁴⁵ he haueð hine alra lengest

44. *we*] *þe* MS.
46. After *haueð*, *al* MS.
49. Before *grace*, *luy*e MS.

idoluen ; þenne ualleð he þerinne. þ. him brekeð

þe sweore. þ. is þ-he ualleð in to helle pine þer neuer eft ne cumeð of bote. Ah leofemen godalmihtin haueð isceaweð us wel muchele *grace*. þenne he haueð geuen us to beon mud freo. þ. we mazen mid ure muðe bringen us ut of þisse putte ; þe ⁵⁰ bitacneð þeo deopnesse of sunne. 7 þ-þurh þreo herde weies þe þus beoð ihaten. **Cordis contricione. Oris confessione. Operis satisfactione.** þurð heorte bireusunke . þurh muðes openunge. þurh dede wel endinge. **Cordis contritione moritur peccatum.** [f. 20 r] **oris confessione defertur ad tumulum. operis satisfactione** ⁵⁵ **tumulatur in perpetuum.** þe[nne] we beoð sari in ure heorte þ-we isuneged habbeð þenne slage we ure sunne; þene we to sunbote cumeð. þenne do we bi ure sunne al swa me deað bi þe deade.

for efterþan þ-þe mon bið dead me leið þene licome in þere þruh. Al swa þu leist þine sunne in þare þruh ; hwenne þu 60 scrift underuongest of þe sunnen þe þu idon hauest to 3eines godes wille. þenne þu hauest þine sunnen ibet ; efter þines scriftes wissunge. þenne buriest þu þine sunnen and bringest heom ut of þine on walde. **Per ieremiam notatur quilibet peccator qui in suo peccato moram facit.** Bi ieremie þe prophete we a3en to understonden 65 ulcne mon sunfulle. þ. lið in heuie sunne 7 þurh soðe scrift his sunbendes nule slakien. **funiculi amaritudines penitencie significant.** Þe rapes þe weren icast to him ; bitacneð þe herdnesse of scrifte. for nis nan of us se strong þe hefde idon þre hef[ed] sunnen þ-his licome nere swiðe feble er he hefde idrezen þet 70 scrift þe þer to bilimpeð. **panni circumpositi funibus ; ecclesie sacramenta significant. quibus penitencie duricia mitigatur.** þas kinges hus bitacneð hali chirc[h]e. þa] claðes þ-weren isende ut of þ[es kinges huse] for to binden þe rapes [f. 20 v] mid ; bitacnet þe halie ureisuns þe me singeð in halie ch`i`rche. 7 þe halie sacramens 75 þe me sacreð in alesnesse of alla sunfulle. Leofemen nu 3e habbeð iherð of þis putte þe bitacninge þe ic habbe embe ispeken. 7 þe bitacninge of þe prophete. 7 þ. þe rapes bitacneð. 7 hwat þa claðes bi tacneð þe þe rapes weren mide biwunden. Thereð nuðe whulche þinges wunieð in þisse putte. þer wunieð fower cunnes 80 wurmes inne. þ- fordoð nuðe al þeos midelerd. þer wunieð inne faze neddren. 7 beoreð atter under heore tunge. Blake tadden 7 habbeð atter uppon `heore` heorte. 3eluwe froggen. 7 crabben. Crabbe is an manere of fissce in þere sea. þis fis is of swulc cunde. þ. euer se he mare strengðeð him to 85 sw[i]mminde mid þe watere ; se he mare swimmeð abac. 7 þe alde crabbe seide to þe 3unge. hwi ne swimmeð þu forð warð in þere sea also oðer fissces doð `7` heo seide. leofe moder swim þu foren me 7 tech me hu ic scal swimmen forðward 7 [heo] bi gon to swimmen forðward mid þe streme. 7 swam hire þer a3en. þas 90 faze neddre bitacneð þis faze folc þe wuneð in þisse weor`l`de. þe speket also feire bi foren heore euencristen`e` [f. 21 r] also heo heom walde in to heore

73, 74. MS. defective.
75. Before *halie ureisuns*, *a*.

bosme puten. 7 swa sone se hi beoð iturnd away from heom ; heom to twiccheð 7 to drazeð mid ufele weordes. **Hii eciam sunt doctores 7 falsi xpistiani.** Þos men þe þus 95 to drazeð heore euencristene bi hinden heo habbeð þe nome of cristene ah þah heo beoð cristes unwines 7 beoð monslazen for heo slazeð heore azene saule. 7 bringeð heon in to þare eche pine of helle. þos blaca tadden þ-habbeð þ-atter uppon heore heorte. bitacneð þes riche men þe habbeð þes mucheles weorldes ehte 7 na 100 mazen noht itimien þarof to eten ne to drinken ne na god don þerof for þe luue of godalmihtin þe haueð hit heom al geuen. ah liggeð þeruppon alse þe tadde deð in þere eorðe þ-neure ne mei itimien to eten hire fulle ; swa heo is afered leste þeo eorðe hire trukie. þeos ilke ehte þe þeos þus ouerliggeð heom turneð to swart 105 atter for heo falleð þer þurh in to þer stronge pine þet na mon ne mei tellen. Þeos zeol`e`we [froggen bitacneð þeos wimmen þe claþeð heom mid zeoluwe] claþe. for þe zeolewe clað is þes deofles helfter. þeos wimmen þe þus lumeð beoð þes deofles musestoch iclepede. for þenne þe mon wule tilden his musestoch he bindeð 110 uppon þa swike chese 7 bret hine for þon þ-he scolde swote smelle. and þurh þe [f. 21 v] sweote smel of þe chese ; he bicherreð monie mus to þe stoke. Alswa doð monie of þas wimmen heo smurieð heom mid blanchet þ-is þes deofles sape 7 claþeð heom mid zeoluwe claþe þ-is þes deofles helfter. 7 seodðan heo lokieð 115 in þe scawere. þ-is þes deofles hindene. Þus heo doð for to feiren heom seoluen. 7 to drazen lechurs to ham. ah heo fuleð heom soluen þermide. Nu leofemen for godes lufe witeð how wið þes deofles musestoch 7 witeð eow þet 3e ne beo noht þe foaze neddre. ne þe blake tadde. ne þe 3olewe frogge. þe feder. 7 þe sune. 7 þe 120 halie gast. iscild us þerwið. 7 wið alle sunnen a buten ende. *per omnia secula seculorum.* AmeN.

103. *þeorðe* MS.
 107. *þeos zeolowe*
claþes MS.
 108. *iþ is* MS.
 109. *lumeð*] *luuieð* MS.
 111. *sclode* MS.

XII. SERMONS FOR PALM SUNDAY AND EASTER DAY

A MITIS SUM ET HUMILIS CORDE

A. DOMINICA PALMARUM

Turbe que *precedebant dominum*. 7 que
sequebantur clamabant dicentes. osanna filio
dauid; benedictus qui uenit in nomine domini. It is
custume þech chirschocne goð þis dai aproce`ssi`on. 7 þis wune haueð
þe biginnigge of þe holie procession. þe ure [f. 43 r] helende makede 5
toward te stede þer he wolde deð þolen. *Et cum uenisset*
bethfage ad montem oliuarum. Mittens [duos] de
discipulis iussit adduci asinam 7 sedit super eam.
Þo þe com to bethfage Swo hatte þe þrop þe preste one wunien. bi
sides ierusalem on þe fot of þe dune þe men clepen munt oliuete. þo
sende tweien of hise diciples 10 into þe bureh of ierusalem. 7 bed hem
bringen á wig one te riden. noðer stede. ne palefrei. ne fair mule. ac
þeh he [were] alre louerdess louerd. 7 alre kingene ki[n]g. napeles he
sende after þe alre unwurpste wig one to riden. 7 þis asse. 7 gaf us
forbisne of admodnesse on his dede. alse he doð on oðre stede on his
speche þus 15 queðinde. *Discite a me; quia mitis sum 7*
humilis corde. lerneð of me for þich am milde 7 admod on herte.
7 þo tweien sander bodes ferdn 7 cudden in þe bureh. þ þe helende
was þider ward. 7 funden an asse mid fole. 7 ledden hit togenes him. 7
þe holie apostles leiden he`re` cloþes þeruppe 7 ure helende rod þer
one; 20 into þe holie burh. 7 þ-burh`folc` hihten
þe hege strete 7 bihengen it mid palmes. 7 mid
oðre riche wedes. þer he wolde þurhfaren to þe
holi temple. 7 wenden ut togenes him. 7 beren on here honde blostme
sum palm twig. 7 sum boh of oliue alse þe holie boc seið.
Occurrunt turbe cum floribus 7 palmis redemptori
o[b]uiam. 25 7c'. Ðet [f. 43 v] folc com togenes him. mid

21. *folc* added in
margin in different ink.

blostmen. 7 midpalmes. 7 understoden him mid procession. swo me
 ki[n]g shal. 7 þo þe ferden biforen him. 7 ðo þe after him comen.
 remden lude stefne þus queðinde. [O] *sanna filio dauid*
benedictus qui uenit in nomine domini. Silof dauīðes
 bern blesced bie he þe cumeð a godes name. 30 7 þo children þe weren
 biforen diden alse þe godspel seið. *Pueri hebreorum*
vestimenta prosternebant 7c' Þe children briggeden þe wei
 biforen ure drihten. sume mid here cloðes. 7 sume mid boges þe hie
 breken of þe trewes 7 swo him brohten into þe holie temple. alse in his
 heorðliche heg settle. Þus makede ure helende his holie procession. 35
 fro betfage to ierusalem. 7 elhc cristene man makeð þis dai procession
 fro chirche to chirche. 7 eft agen. 7 bitocneð þe holie procession þe he
 makede þis dai. 7 þ-mai ech man understonden. þe wot wat bitocneð
 þese tweie names. betfage. 7 ierusalem. *Betfage interpretatur*
domus bucce. uel buccarum siue maxillarum. 7
significat 40 *ecclesiam in qua bucce funguntur*
officio suo peccata confitendo ueniam postulando.
deum laudando. Carnem xpisti manducando. 7
sanguinem eius bibendo. gratias agendo. Betfage is
 cleped on englisse muðene hus. 7 bitocneð holie chirche. þ-men noten
 inne here muðes wike. þanne hie seien 45 here sinnes. 7 forgiuenesse
 bidden. 7 ure louerd ihesu xrist herien. 7 bruken his fles 7 his blod. þ-
 his þe holi husel. 7 him [f. 44 r] þanken. *Ierusalem*
interpretatur uisio pacis 7 item significat
ecclesiam. in qua pax uera uidetur. dum passio
xristi recolitur. et pacis osculum datur. Ierusalem is
 cleped soð of sahtnesse. 50 7 bitocneð holie chirche þer bileffulle men
 inne beð sehte. þenne prest cristes þroweinge minegeð. 7 of þe calice
 understondeð tocne of sehtnesse. þ-is messe cos. 7 þe folc sent. 7 þer
 mide bitocneð þ-ure drihten is þureh þe holie loc wið bileffulle men
 maked sehte. 7 þerfore chirche haueð þe tocninge of bethphage þenne
 55 þe proession ut goð of ierusalem. 7 eft þenne itin cumeð. Nime we
 þenne geme gif ure procession bi maked after ure helendes procession.
 On his procession ferde sume biforen him 7 makede his weie toward
 ierusalem. 7 sume briggeden þe asse mid here cloðes. 7 sume mid
 boges þe hie breken of þe trewes. Ðo þe þe weie 60 makeden biforen

him. bien folkes lorþeawes. bisshopes 7 prestēs. þe mid here wise lore rideð. 7 makeð godes weie in to mannes heorte.

Ðo þe briggeden þe asse mid here cloðes. ben þo þe wisseð þe folc mid faire forbisne of here

62. *made* MS.

64. *hereweldede* MS.

weldede. Ðo þe briggeden þe asse mid þe brokene boges. ben þo þe leren þe folc to understonden god noht mid 65 wel dede. ac mid wise speche. þo þe after him comen ben þo þe here lif [leden] alse here lorðeawes hem lereð. þo þe bisides weren on his riht half. ben þo þe clene lif leden to quemende gode ; noht for hereworde. þo þe on his lift hond comen ben þo þe clenliche liuen [f. 44 v] noht forto

quemende gode ; ac for hereword to hauen. Ðe 70 asse þe ure helende uppe set. ben þo forsinegede þe hauen al here þonc uppen eorðliche richeise. 7 sinne hem is loð to leten. 7 unwill[i]che to bete. for hem þincheð þ-godes hese heuieliche semeð. 7 naðeles gif hie ful don hie shulen on heuene endelese mede fon. Ure louerd ihesu xrist þe makede into ierusalem þis dai his holie procession. þe ech chirche todai minegeð. wisse 7 fulste us swo to folgen his holi eorliche procession þ-we mo ben on þe holie procession þe he wile maken adomes dai mid hise chosene ; fro þe dome in to heuene. *Quod nobis prestat qui secla per omnia regnat.* 80

B. IN DIE PASCHE

IIS ANGELICUS FIT PANIS HOMINUM

H_{EC} est dies *quam fecit dominus*
exultemus 7 letemur in ea. Þis

86. *bided* MS.

dai haueð ure drihten maked to gladien. 7 to blissen us þonked wurðe him. 7 giarked þ-holie gestninge. þe he offe spe`c`ð þus queðinde.

Ecce prandium meum paratum. Mi bord 85 is maked. 7 us biddeð alle þerto þus seggende. *Venite prandium*. Cumeð to borde 7 understondeð bred. ac er þenne þe holie bord bugen. 7 þ-bred understonde do we alse þe apostel bad. seiende þus. *Probet autem se ipsum homo. 7 sic de pane illo edat 7 de calice bibat*. Proue ech man him seluen. 7 gif he feleð 90 þ-he is wurðe þer

to ; þenne understonde he þ husel. 7 drinke of þe calice. þe man hit
 understondeð wurðliche þe cumeð þerto on bicumeliche wise. 7 mid
 bicumeliche wede. 7 on bicumeliche time. On bicumeliche wise
 [f. 45 r] cumeð þe man þe Erest sheweð preste his sinnes 7 forleteð 7
 bimurneð 7 nimeð þerof god wissinge. 7 oðer 95 siðe þe holie acxen
 uppen his heued. 7 þe six pinen þe þerto bilien. *scilicet*
vigilias. labores. saccum. inedia. sitim. þis wecche 7
 swinch. harde cloðes. smerte dintes. selde eten 7 lesse drinken. Þridde
 siðe palm sunedeies *procession.* feorðe siðes shereðuresdaies
absolucio[n] þe liðe þe sinne bendes. þe fifte siðe crepe to cruche on
 100 lange fridai[.] sixte siðe on ester euen gon abuten þe fantston. þe
 bitocneð þe holie sepulcre. 7 þe seueðe siðe þ holie bord bugen 7 þ
 bred bruken. bicumeliche wede ben tweire kinne. lichamliche 7
 gostliche. þe lichamliche wedes ben manie kinnes. ac of hem ne speke
 ich noht ac do of þe gostliche. þe ben ec fele kinnes. 7 alle hie bien 105
 faire him þe þe husel underfoð. ac two þeroffe ben swiche þ no man ne
 mai underfo. him seluen to hele bute he haue here oðer on him. þe ben
 þus clepede. *Vestis innocencie. Vestis misericordie.*
 an is loðlesnesse oðe`r` sinbote. *Vestis innocencie*
restituatur in baptismo dicente sacerdote.
 [A]ccipe uestem candidam 7 110 *immaculatam.*
 loðlesnesse understondeð þe man at his folcninge. 7 þ bitocneð þe
 crisme cloð. þe þe prest biwindeð þ child mide. 7 þus seið. Underfo
 shrud wit 7 clene. þis shrud haueð ech man on him after his fulcninge.
 alle þe wile þe he him beregeð þ he ne do ne ne *queðe.* ne ne ðenche
 no þing for þat he bie unwurðere gode ; 115 [f. 45 v] ne loðere men ; þe
 iuele is soule. Þis wede is wel bicumeliche 7 biheue ech man to hauen
 þenne he husel underfoð. Ðet oðer gostliche shrud ich embe spece ; is
 mildhertnesse. þe is nemed ec ; armhertnesse armheorted is þe man. þe
 swiðere reoweð his sinne. 7 he hem forlet 7 bet. 7 milce bit. also ure
 drihten bad seien þus. 120 *Miserere anime tue placens*
deo. haue reoðe of þin ogen sofle. þenne likeste gode. Mildheorted
 beð þe man þe reouð his nehgebures unselðe. 7 likeð here alre selðe 7
 ofþinð sore wrecche mannes wanrede. 7 freureð hem mid his wel dede.

No man þe sineged haueð ne mai wiðuten þise
wedes holi husel underfon ; bute to eche harme

125. þise] þis MS.

125 his soule 7 lichame 7 ech man þe hit underfoð wiðuten eiðer þese
wedes shal ben shameliche driuen ut of þis holi gestninge. 7 bunden
togedere his honden. 7 his fet. 7 worpen in to þe ateliche pit of helle bi
ure drihtenes word þe seið to swiche men. *A mice quomodo huc*
intrasti non habens uestem nupcialem. 7c hwu come þu
ider 130 in mid unbicumliche weden. þis dai is bicumelich time husel to
underfon. *Quia hec dies quam fecit dominus. non*
quod magis hanc quam alias. sed quia maiora
quam in aliis á morte resurgendo. 7 nos á morte
resuscitando. for þ-þis made ure drihten þe made alle oðre.
ac he kidde oðerluker his mihte. 135 7 mankin more milce dide on þis
dai ; þanne on ani oðre. Ðo he aros of deaðe [7] rerde us mid him.

Vnde exultemus 7 letemur in ea. he us fette ut of helle
wowe. 7 þermide us gledede. 7 gif we him folgieð he gifð us heuene
wele 7 þermide. us blisseð to dai þonked. wurðe him. forþi þis dai is
cleped estrene dai. þ-is aristes dai. for 140 þ-þe he þis dai aros of deaðe.
7 we alle don ; [f. 46 r] þanne we holi husel unde`r`nimen. gif we ben
þe[r] togenes on clene liflode. 7 on rihte leue. 7 wið alle men sehte.
Ure louerd þe us bit to þis gestninge. 7 bringe us to `his´ holi fleis 7 to
his holi blod 7 leue us hem to bruken. 7 þus quedinde. *Accipite 7*
comedite ex hoc omnes 145 *hic est enim calix*
sanguinis mei novi. 7c Understondeð þis 7 brukeð it alle. for
it is mi lichame þe giu shal alle lesen. he bet us ec his holi blod þe shal
ben shad giu to lesende 7 seið þ-þese two þing bien ure bileue. *Caro*
mea uere est cibus 7 sanguis meus uere est potus.
Mi fleis is wis mete. 7 mi blod iwis drinke 7 after þ-150 he seið. *Nisi*
manducaueritis carnem filii hominis 7 biberitis
eius sanguinem non habebitis uitam in uobis. Ne
muge hauen no lif on giu bute ge liuen bi mi fleis 7 bi mi blod. þ-husel
þe ge understonden ; is his holi fleis 7 his blod. Erest it beð ouelete 7
win. 7 þureh þe holi word þe ure helende him self seide mid his holi

155 muð ; 7 efter him prest hem seið atte swimesse turneð þe bred to fleis 7 þe win to blod. Set in carne remanet forma color 7 sapor. ac on þe holi fleis bileueð þe shap 7 hiu. 7 smul of ouelete. 7 on þe holi blod héw 7 smul of win. More mihte doð ure helende þenne þe holi word þe he þurh his muð spec. þanne he giueð mannes cuinde. 160 [his fleis 7 his blod.] 7 Napeles þanne man eteð 7 drinkeð þureh þe lichames cunde þ-bred wurð to fleis. 7 þe drinke to blod. for þi mai godes word turnen þe ouelete to fleis. 7 þ-win to blod. 7 swo doð. 7 þ-is þe felefolde heste. þe is alre hestene heste þ-alle cristene men agen to dai to noten. for þ-þis dai is cleped estre dai 165 þ-is estene da[i]. 7 te este is husel. 7 no man ne mai seien husel ; wu god it is.

Quia est precium mundi. for it is wurð al þe wereld. 7 betere þene [f. 46 v] al þe wereld. þis is þe holi manne þe ure drihten sende alse snow sleðrende alse þe prophete seið. *Pluit illis manna ad manducandum 7 panem celi dedit eis.* 170 [P]anem angelorum manducauit homo. he let hem reine manne to bi liue. 7 gef hem bred of heuene. 7 men eten englene [bred]. *Manna interpretatur. quid est hoc?* Manne bitocneð wat is tis ; 7 þo ure drihten sende þis mete fro heuene þe israelisse folke ; it warð on eches muð wat mete se he mest luuede. 7 bitocneð holi 175 husel ; þe ech cristeman understont nuðe. þe is þe manne hegeste sweteste este þe is of sinne clensed. oðer bigunne to clensende. 7 alre bitere biterest eches mannes soule þe ne haueð alle michele sinnes forleten. 7 bet. oðer bigunnen alse þe apostel seið. *Qui manducat corpus domini 7 bibit* 7 c. Ech þe understandeð þ-holi husel 180 unwurðliche he understant him seluen eche pine.

179. þe] þa MS.
189. driste] d corr. out of e.

7 endelese wowe. Nime we nu geme ure ech agen him seluen. gif we bien cumen on bicumeliche wise. þ-is to soð shrifte. to hol[i] axen a palm sunedai ; to procession. a shereðursdai to absoluciu. a langefridai to holi cruche. an ester euen to procession. 7 gif we ben cumene mid 185 bicumeliche wede. of lodlesnesse þ-is clensinge. swo þ-we hauen ure sinnes forleten. 7 bi shriftes wissenge bet. oðer bigunnen

to beten. 7 milce bidden. þanne muge we bicumeliche to godes bord ;
bugen. 7 his bode wurðliche bruken. 7 þureh þe holi este cumen to
driste. Quod nobis prestat qui hodie surrexit 7 uiuit
cum deo patre 190 in unitate *spiritus sancti*.

XIII. VICES AND VIRTUES

“Stowe 34, British Museum: of the early part of the thirteenth century; written on vellum, 223 × 160 mm., by three scribes, with numerous corrections by at least three other hands.”

A. THE ARK OF HOLY CHURCH

Ð e gastliche hierdes ðe sculen boðe lokin 7 stieren. ðo ðe bieð in
ðare worlð ; 7 ec `ðo´ ðe bieð ute. hie folzið noe ðane gode
stieresmann ðe gode was swiðe lief. 7 3ecweme. For ðare muchele
hersumnesse ðe he manize wintre swanc. ær he `ða´ arche mihte
habben 3emaked. 7 seððen hie swa stierde on ðe muchele 5 wilde
flode. ðe ouerziede all middeneard. mang stronge windes 7 stormes ðat
he ðarof ne forleas naþing. ðe godd him hadde betaht to liue 7 to londe
to bringen. Swa scule ða gastlich`e´ stieresmenn.
`steren´ ða arche of ðe hali cherche ðat hie ðarof
ne forliesen ne lichame ne saule. For none winde
of mannliche fandinge. [f. 15 r] 10 Ne for none
storme of dieuliche fandinge. 7 eft on faire
wedere ne bien hie naht to sikere. forðan swo
manize litle dropes of manizes kennes
3emeleastes mihten cumen in to ðe saule bote ðat
hie mihten sinken. mid alle hire bi3eates. Ac lokien hie alle ðe wið
innen scipes borde wunizeð. þ-hie bien hersum. 7 leðbeize here stieres
manne. 15 swa swa hie willeð cumen to ðe liuiende lande mid saule 7
mid lichame. And hlesteð hwat ðe hlauerd seið. ðe ðat scip auh to ðe

8. *gastliche*] e above
erasure.
14. *lokied* MS.
19. *gewer*] w above *u*.
Body text has
gewer.
rad] d above erasure.
21. *seid* MS.

stieresmannen 7 to alle ðe ðar inne wunizeð. *Qui uos audit me audit.* Se ðe *Ʒe`w`er ra`d`* hlest he seið. he hlest me seluen. 7 se ðe Ʒew forsakþ 7 Ʒewere lare he forsakþ fullƷewiss me seluen. Þis he 20 seið to ða stieresmannen. On michele hahte we fareð alle ðe fareð in *hoc mare magnum*. on ðessere michele sea of ðare bitere woreld. Of ure stieresman is Ʒewriten *Ascendunt usque ad celos. 7 descendunt usque ad abissos*. Hie stieð up to heuene mid here gastliche þohtes for to sceawin ðe michele merhðe of heuene riche. 25 for to sceawin ðe windes 7 ðe euele stormes. ðe cumeð of deules blastes 7 for us te warnin þu ure ropes ne to breken. ðe bieð i broiden mid þrie strænges. Of rihte ileaue. 7 of faste hope te gode. And of ðare soðe luue ðe is ihoten carite ðe Crist mæst luueð. Eft hit seið ðat hie stikð niðer in to niellesse mid here ðohtes. for us eft to 30 warnin wið ðo stanroches of ðe harde herte ðe næure ne wile nexin. for none watere of wisdomes. Ac Ʒif ðar cumþ scip to hit to brekð. Alswo doð ðat unwise mann ðe cumþ to ðan unbiliefde manne ðe ne wile ne ne mai godes lare understanden for his herte hardnesse[.] he to brekð Ʒif he ani god wille hafð. forðan he hert his gode wille 35 7 hie to brecþ.

30. *niellesse*] on margin *abissos*.
 35. *tobrekð* MS.: in lower margin, qui cum in forma dei e` s`set non rapinam arbitratus est semet.
 42. *Ʒif*] 3 corr. out of G.
 44. *bowes*] w corr. out of u.

[f. 15 v] mid þelliche wordes. Hwat dest þu ; he seið ðu dalst al ðat tu hafst. Wile ðu hlesten. spelleres. 7 pr`i`estes. 7 muneke. 7 þese hadede mannen. Ne scalt ðu næure habben god ; Hie wolden for`i`swelzen all ðe woreld Ʒif hie mihten. be trewe mann 7 halt tin god. þu finst feawe ðe wile Ʒiuen ðe ani þing. bute 40 hie witen hwarfore. Ðe unware mann ðe ðis Ʒeherð. ðingþ ðat he seið him god rad. Ʒif he arrer dede litel te gode. ðar after he doð michel`e`lasse. 7 swo he forfarð. for ðan ðe he his priestes lare ne his ræd lesten ne folzin ne wile Carite sprat his bowes on bræde 7 on lengðe swiðe ferr. Hie me haueð idon speken. forðer ðane ic 45 hadde Ʒepouht. Ac nu ic wile wænden to ðe hali mihtes alswo ich ær hadde izunnen be godes fultume. Ac me þincþ ðat tu lokest aweiward 7 heuiliche latst. And hit is me to muchel iswinch ðar embe to þennken oðer to speken, bute Ʒif ðu woldest mid god wille ðarto lhesten. 7 hes understanden. 50

Hu andswereð ðe saule 7 seið :

Ich ðe bidde for ðan ilche hlauerd ðe ðe iscop
me to helpe. ðat alswo ðu hauest zegunnen 7
ðane grundwall ileid. Of ðese hali mihtes ðat tu
hes forðbringe 7 me hes tæche. forðan hie bieð me swiðe unbecnawe
for ðe manize unðeawes ðe ic mid me to longe 55 habbe ihafd. Ac nu ic
hes wile leten. 7 mid godes fultume of hem zeswiken. And min 3eþanc
to ðine lore healden. For ðare hali mihte ðe cariteð is icleped ic ðe
beseche 7 bidde ðat tu ðese halwende lore on write sette. for ðan ic am
michel þenchine ðar hwile ðe ic on ðese wrecche lichame am
wuniende. 7 ofte forzete ðat me god ; wære 60 te healden. and ec sum
oðer saule hit wile helpen.

54. *tæche*] c corr. out
of s.

Hu andswereð scadwisnesse. 7 þus seið.

Ðas þe me þincþ þu wilt godes lore bliðeliche
understonden. 7 liernin. 7 ðat me likeð
swiðe wel. forði ðat hit seið on ðe hali godspelle.
Qui est ex deo uerba dei audit. Se ðe is of gode he 65
harkeð bleðeliche godes wordes. Nu me cump on iþanke an forbisne.
þe *sanctus Gregorius* us seið: *Qui uirtutes sine*
humilitate congregat quasi in uento puluerem
portat. Se ðe gadereð mihtes wiðuten eadmodnesse he seið. he is
ilich ðo manne ðe berð dust amidewarde ðe winde. For ði me þingþ þ
is wisdom ðat we 70 alre ðinge arst speken of ðessere hali mihte wið
uten hwam non ne mai bien wiðhealden te none freme ne te none
gode.

67. *seid* MS.
71. *wid* MS.

B.

Of teares.

Wite ðu to soðe ðat þese teares ðe we embe
spekeð hie bieð iwis godes 3iue. 7 swiðe
niedfulle to ðan inede þat iherd sculen [bien] of

73. *speked* MS.
74. *inede*] n corr. out of

gode. Of hem sade ðe prophete : *Fuerunt mihi* 75 *lacrimae meae* *panes die ac nocte*. Mine teares he sade me waren bred daiȝ 7 niht swa gode hie þouhten. Of opres kennes teares he sade : *Lacrimis meis stratum meum rigabo* : Ich scal watrien min bedd mid mine teares. Ðies bedd tacneð þe *consciencia*. þat is þat inȝied wiðinnen. Þar ðe gode sawle 80 haueð hire reste ; þar haueð se eule sawle hire pine. For þi he sade þat he wolde mid teares wascen þat inȝied þar of ðe his herte him wreizede. Ne finde we nawher þat godd wernde ani þing ðe ani mann mid teares him besouhte. Godd sante to Ezechie þe kinge be his prophete. 7 sade : *Dispone domui tuae quia morieris* 7 tu 85 7 *non uiues*. Becweð þine [f. 47 v] cwide he sade. for ðan þu scalt bien dead. 7 naht ne scalt tu libben. Ðe king warð sari. alswa richeise is lað to laten 7 swiðe lef to libben. He wante þo to ðe wauȝe 7 dede þat betste. `a´ hlauerd godd sade he þench nu ðat ich ðe habbe ȝe luued. 7 for þine luue bliðeliche idon. 7 ȝif me ȝiet 90 a litel ferst for þine godnesse. Ðies was god inȝied. þ̅he mihte his gode dade forðsceawin þa þe he niede hadde. For þi him ȝeherde godd 7 sade to is *prophete* ðe was ham ward. Wand aȝean cwað he 7 sai to þe kinge. *Vidi lacrimam tuam*. Ich iseih cwað he þine tear. 7 ich iherde þine bene. þu scalt ȝiet libben fiftene ȝear. 95 Swa michel ich habbe ieiht þi lif. Ðanne ðu on michele niede gode wilt beseken þanne is ðe wel god þ̅þu muȝe forðdraȝen sume gode dade. þin hierte bieð ðe gladdere. 7 ðe sikerliker ðu miht bidden. Segge we nu forð mid þe prophete *Ciba nos pane lacrimarum*. Hlauerd fed us mid ðo breade of swete teares. 7 *potum da nobis* 100 *in lacrimis in mensura*. 7 ȝif us drinken of oðreskennes teares 7 ðat mid imete. Ðat ich wile þat ðu wel be iwarned. ȝif godd ðe ȝifð þese swete teares þat non win in ðare world nis swa swete. 7 alswa alswa man to michel mai drinken of ðare wine alswa mai ðe mann to michel wepen. þeih hie swete bien. 7 for ði þe is god 105 þ̅þu beseke at gode one mihte. ðe hatte *discrecio*. þat is [f. 48 r] scelewisnesse.

h.
 80. is corr. out of þ.

88. *lað*] ð corr. out of *d*.
 89. *þat* on an erasure.
 97. *god*] MS. *gode*, with *e* partly erased.
 102. *ȝif*] *Gif* MS.

Hie is swiðe beheue mang alle ðe oðre mihtes. Dis ðe hali faderes seggeð Hie is moder of alle ðe oðre mihtes. ðar ðe he rixið ne mai naure man forfaren. þe hire wile rixin 7 folzin. Hit 110 seið in uitas patrum. ðat at sume sal waren ðe hali faderes togedere igadered. 7 waren spekinde betwen hem on `h `williche wise me mihte rihtist 7 sikerest to gode cumen. Sum sade þurh fasten. sum þurh wacchen. sum ðurh bede. sum sade þurh hersumnesse. sum sade ðurh annesse. sum sade ðurh herborzin 115 wrecche menn. 7 feden 7 screden. Sum sade ðurh seke menn to lokin. 7 on manieskennes wisen hie namden after ðan þe þat hali goddspell seið. Ða sade on of ða eldes[t] 7 on of ða wisest. Ðurh alle ðesen we haddeð isezen 7 iherd swiðe maniþe zeborzen. 7 manie of alle ðesen inamde mihten forfaren for þi ðat hem trukede 120 discrecio. þat is scadwisnesse and skele. For ði sume deden michel mare þan hie mihtin wel andin Sume deden to litel. Sume deden euele. 7 wenden wel don. Sume wel agunnen 7 euele andeden. Ac naure ne zeseiþe we manne þat hadde þese hali mihte mid him þat he aure misferde[.] bezete se ðe muge. 125

115. herborzin] 3 on erasure.

118. eldest] hole in MS.

121. ði on erasure.

Perseuerancia hatte an hali mihte. Hie nis naht [f. 48 v] to laten for ðan hie makeð ðanne man ðe godd `h`is. to sant þe þurwuneð on his godnesse. On ðare ealde laze hit was i[h]oten þe alle dier. ðe me gode scolde offrín þat hie lokeden wel ðat ðe tail ware on auriche netene. Þat tocneð ðat ilke mann ðe gode ani seruise 130 offreð. þat he þar on þurzwunie[.] on ðessere newe laze sade crist. *Qvi perseuerauerit usque in finem hic saluus erit.* Se ðurzwuneð on his godnesse ðe he hafð agunnen he worð iborzen 7 naht elles for none gode þe he don hafð. hwat `hwat` it is.

128. ihoten] io corr. by erasure.

129. Before ðe, ðe erased. The word ðe occurs twice in line 129.

132. On margin Ewangelista in red.

133. ður3] dur3 MS.

134. `hwat` on erasure.

Ratio dicit anime :

L ieue `saule', ðis little writt ic `habbe' sare
 beswonken he it wat þ̅wot alle þ̅ing for ðe to
 wissin. for ðe to warnin. 7 for ðe to helpen 7 for
 ðe to berȝin. ȝif ðu wilt wel hit understonden 7
 liernin 7 folȝin 7 [h]ealden wiðuten alche twene
 þu miht mid godes felste ðe berȝen 7 heuneriches
 merchþe mid þese halie mihtes sike`r`liche 140 iwinnen.

136. *habbe* above *write*
 deleted.

137. *þ̅*] *þ̅a* MS.

138. *ȝif*] *Gif* MS.

139. *alche*] *c* corr. out
 of *l*.

Nunc autor loquitur finaliter.

Hvte we nu þ̅a`nkin 7 herien ure hlauerde
 almihtin gode of ðese witte and of ðese
 wisdom. ðe we hier habbeð igadered of `h
 `ishorde. 7 of manizes [f. 49 r] halizes mannes
 ȝeswinkes þe michel 145 sw`u`nken for ðe luue of
 gode. 7 for us to wissin. Hit is riht ðat we herizen 7 þ̅ankin 7 bledscin
 fader 7 sune 7 hali gast on ða hali þ̅rinnesse. se ðe is on soð godd in
 onnesse. se ðe l`i`ueð 7 rixeð aure ma a worlde. amen. Ðat ne forȝeit
 ðu naure. þat ðu godd ne herize. 7 þ̅anke of alle gode. Alswa swa we
 habbeð niede him to bidden be 150 daiȝ 7 be nihte. 7 ofte 7 ȝelome
 alswa hit is niede ; him to herizen. Amen.

142. *þ̅ankin*] *a* over *e*.

146. *swunken*] *u* over *i*.

148. *liueð*] *i* over *e*.

149. *forȝeit*] *i* over
 erasure.

Veni creator *spiritus* mentes tuorum uisita implet
superna gracia que tu creasti p`e`ctora.

XIV. LAȜAMON

THE BRUT (MS. CALIGULA)

i. Cotton Caligula A 9, British Museum (C); on vellum, 216 × 153 mm.; 192
 folios in double columns of 32 to 34 lines, written by two scribes in the first
 quarter of the thirteenth century. It is bound up with another manuscript
 containing the [Owl and the Nightingale](#) and other pieces.

ii. Cotton Otho C 13, British Museum (O); injured in the fire of 1731; on vellum; 145 folios in double columns of 38 lines; written in one hand, of the third quarter of the thirteenth century.

.... Mistakes common to both versions have been derived from an intermediate manuscript X.

MS. Otho
Parallel Texts

Vnder þan comen tiðende ; to vortiger þan kinge.
þouer sæ weoren icumen ; swiðe selcuðe gumen.
Jnne þere Temese ; to londe heo weoren icummen.
þreo scipen gode ; comen mid þan flode.
5 þreo hundred cnihten ; Alse hit weoren kinges.
wiðuten þan scipen monnen ; þe weoren þer wiðinnen.
þis weoren þa færeste men ; þat auere her comen.
Ah heo weore hæðene ; þwes hærm þa mare.
Uortiger heom sende to ; And axede hu heo weoren idon.
10 3if heo grið sohten ; 7 of his freondscipe rohten.
heo wisliche andswerden ; Swa heo wel cuðen.
7 seiden þheo walden ; speken wið þan kinge.
7 Leofliche him heren ; 7 hælden hine for hærre.
And swa heo gunnen wenden ; fforð to þan kinge.
15 Þa wes Uortigerne þa king ; In Cantuarieburi.
þer he mid his hirede ; Hæhliche spilede.
þer þas cnihtes comen ; Bi foren þan folckinge.
Sone swa heo | hine imetten ; fæire heo hine igrættan.
7 seiden þat heo him wolden ; hæren ipisse londe.

20 3if he heom wolde ; mid rihten athalden.
 Ða andswerede vortiger ; of elchen vuele he wes war.
 An alle mine iliue ; þe ich iluued habbe.
 bi dæie no bi nihtes ; ne sæh ich nauere ær swulche cnihtes.
 for eouwer cumen ich æm bliðe ; 7 mid me 3e scullen bilæfuen.
 25 7 eouwer wille ich wulle dri3en ; bi mine quicke 25. *bimi ne* MS.
 liuen.
 Ah of eou ich wulle iwiten ; þurh soðen eouwer wurðscipen.
 whæt cnihten 3e seon ; 7 whænnenen 3e icumen beon.
 7 whar 3e wullen beon treowe ; alde 7 æc neowe. 27. *whæt*] *whahæt*
 MS.
 þa answerede þe oðer ; þat wes þe aldeste broðer.
 30 lust me nu lauerd king ; 7 ich þe wullen cuðen.
 what cnihtes we beoð ; 7 whanene we icumen seoð.
I ch hatte henges ; hors is mi broðer.
 we beoð of alemainne ; aðelest alre londe.
 of þat ilken ænde ; þe angles is ihaten.
 35 Beoð in ure londe ; selcuðe tiðende.
 vmbe fiftene 3er ; þat folc hi[s] isomned. 36. *his*] *hī* MS.
 Al ure iledene folc ; 7 heore loten werpeð.
 vppen þan þe hit fal[l]ed ; he scal uaren of londe. 38. *falled*] *faled*
 MS.
 Bilæuen scul | len þa fiue ; þa sexte scal forð liðe.
 40 ut of þan leode ; to u[n]cuðe londe.
 Ne beo he na swa leof mon ; uorð he scal liðen.
 For þer is folc swiðe muchel ; mære þene heo walden.
 þa wif færeð mid childe ; swa þe deor wilde.

Æueralche 3ere ; heo bereð child þere ;
 45 þ-beoð an us feole ; þat we færen scolden.
 Ne mihte we bilæue ; for liue ne for dæðe.
 Ne for nauer nane þinge ; for þan folckinge.
 þus we uerden þere ; 7 forþi beoð nu here.
 to sechen vnder lufte ; lond 7 godne lauerd. 49. *luste* MS.
 50 Nu þu hæfuest iherd lauerd ki[n]g ; Soð of us þurh alle þi[n]g.
 Ða answarede vortiger ; of alc an vfele he wes war.
 Ich ileue þe cniht ; þ-þu me sugge soðriht.
 7 wulche beoð æoure ileuen ; þ-3e on ileueð.
 7 eoure leofue godd ; þe 3e to luted.
 55 þa andswarede Hænges ; cnihtene alre fæirest.
 Nis in al þis kinelond ; cniht swa muchel ne swa 56. *muchel* over
erasure.
 strong.
 We habbeð gode`s gode ; þe we luuieð an ure mode.
 þa we habbeð hope to ; 7 heoreð heom mid mihte. 58. *mid mid* MS.
 Ðe an hæhte phebus ; þe oðer *Saturnus*.
 60 þe þridde hæhte woden ; þ-is an weoli godd.
 þe feorðe hæh | [te] *Jupiter* ; of alle þinge he is whar.
 þe fifte hæhte *Mercurius* ; þat is þe hæhste ouer us.
 þæ sæxte hæhte appollin ; þ-is a godd wel idon. 62. *is]* *us* MS.
 þe seoueðe hatte teruagant ; an hæh godd in ure lon.
 65 3et we habbeð anne læuedi ; þe hæh is 7 mæhti.
 heh heo is 7 hali ; hiredmen heo luuieð forþi. 64. *seoðueðe* MS.
 heo js ihate Frææ ; wel heo heom dihteð.

Ah for alle ure goden deore ; þa we scullen hæren. 67. *dihteð*] ð corr.
out of s.

Woden hehde þa hæhste laze ; an ure ælderne
dæzen.

70 he heom wes leof ; æfne al swa heore lif.

he wes heore walden ; And heom wurðscipe duden.

þene feorðe dæi iþere wike ; heo 3ifuen him to wurðscipe.

þa þunre heo 3iuen þunres dæi ; forþi þat heo heom helpen mæi.

Freon heore læfdi ; heo 3iuen hire fridæi.

75 Saturnus heo 3iuen sætteredæi ; þene sunne heo 3iuen sonedæi.

Monen heo 3ifuen mone dæi ; Tidea heo 3euen tis 76. *Monenen heo*
3ifuenen MS.
dæi.

þus seide hæ[n]gest ; cnihten alre hendest.

þa answerede vortiger ; of ælchen vfel he wæs wær.

Cnihtes 3e beoð me leofue ; ah þas tiðende me beoð laðe.

80 eouwer ileuen beoð vnwraste ; 3e ne ileoueð noht an criste. |

Ah 3e ileoueð a þene wurse ; þe godd seolf awariede.

eoure godes ne beoð nohtes ; In helle heo niðer 80. *ileuen* written
over *ilauerd*
deleted. *cristre*
MS.
liggeð.

Ah neoðeles ich wulle eou athælde ; An mine
anwalde.

for norð Beoð þa Peohtes ; swiðe ohte cnihtes.

85 þe ofte ledeð in mine londe ; ferde swiðe stronge.

7 ofte dod me muchele scome ; 7 þerfore ich habbe grome.

7 3if 3e me wulleð wræken ; 7 heore hæfden me bi3eten.

Ich eou wullen 3euen lond ; muchel seolueR 7 gold.

þa andswerede hængest ; cnihtene alre feirest.

90 3if hit wulle saturnus ; al hit scal iwurðe þus.

7 Woden ure lauerd ; þe we on biliueð.

86. *me]* *e* corr. out
of *u*.

Hengest nom læue ; 7 to scipen gon liðe.

þer wes moni cniht strong ; heo drozen heore scipen uppe þe lond.

forð wenden dringches ; to vortigerne þan kenge.

95 Biuoren wende hengest ; 7 hors him alre hændest.

Seoððen þa alemainisce men ; þa aðele weoren an
deden.

93. *uppe* on an
erasure.

7 seoððen heo senden him to ; heore sæxisce cnihtes wel idon.

hengestes cunnesmen ; of his aldene cudðe.

heo comen in to halle ; hændeliche alle.

100 Bett weoren iscrudde ; 7 bed weoren iuædde.

hængest | swaine ; þene vortigernes. þeines.

þa wes vortigernes hired ; for hehne ihalden.

100. *Bett* corr. out
of *Bette*.

Bruttes weoren særi ; for swulchere isihðe.

102. *ihaldendę* MS.

Nes hit nawiht longe ; þat ne comen to þan kinge.

105 Cnihtes sunen uiue ; þa i faren hafden biliue.

heo sæiden to þan kinge ; neowe tiðenden.

nu forðrihtes ; Icumen beoð þa peohtes.

þurh þi lond heo ærneð ; 7 hær3ieð 7 berneð.

7 al þene norð ænde ; iuald to þan grunde.

110 herof þu most ræden ; oðer all we beoð dæden.

þe king hine biþohte ; whæt he don mihte.

he sende to þan innen ; after al his monnen.

þer com hengest þer com hors ; þer com mani mon ful oht.

þer comen þa saxisce men ; hengestes cunnes men.
 115 7 þa Alemainisce cnihtes ; þe beoð gode to fihte.
 þis isæh þe king vortiger ; bliðe wes he þa þer.
 Ða peohtes duden heore iwune ; a þas hælf þere humbre. heo weoren
 icume.
 7 þe king VortigeR ; of heore cume wes ful war.
 Togadere heo comen ; 7 feole þer ofslozen.
 120 þer wes feht swide strong ; Comp swiðe sturne.
 Ðe Peohtes weoren ofte iwuned ; Vortige[r]ne to ouer | cumen.
 7 þa heo þohten a[l]swa ; Ah hit ilomp an oðer þa.
 for hit wes heom al hele ; þat hængest wes þere.
 7 þa cnihtes stronge ; þe comen of saxelonde.
 125 7 þa ohte alemanisce ; þe þider comen mid horse.
 Swiðe monie peohtes ; heo slozen iþan fehte.
 feondliche heo fuhten ; feollen þa fæie. 113. *muni* MS.
 Ða þe non wes icumen ; þa weoren Peohtes ouer 116. *þa þa* MS.
 cumen.
 7 swuðe heo awæi flozen ; an ælche helue heo forð fluzen.
 130 7 alle dai heo fluzen ; monie 7 vnnifoze.
 Ðe king vortigerne ; wende to herberwe.
 7 æuere him weoren onuast ; Hors 7 hængest.
 Hængest wes þan kinge leof ; 7 him lindesaʒe ʒef.
 and he ʒæf horse ; madmes inoʒe.
 135 7 alle heore cnihtes ; he swiðe wel dihte.
 7 hit gode stunde ; stod a þan ilke. 133. *leof* ; 7 *him*
 Ne durste nauere peohtes ; cumen i þan londes. *linde* over an

no ræueres no utlazen ; þ-heo neoren sone ofslæzen. ^{erasure.}
 7 hængest swiðe fæire ; herede þane king.
 140 Ða ilomp hit in ane time ; þ-þe king wes swiðe bliðe.
 An ane hæze dæie ; imong his duzeðe monnen. ^{137. *peohtestes* MS.}
 Hengest hine biþohte ; what he don mihte.
 for he wolde wið þan kinge ; holden | runinge.
 þan kinge he eode to ; foren ; 7 fæire hine gon greten.
 145 Ðe king sone up stod ; 7 sætte hine bi him seoluen.
 heo drunken heo dremden ; blisse wes among heom. ^{144. *gonðe* MS.}
 Ða queð hengest to þan kinge ; lauerd hærcne ^{146. *heon dremden*}
 tiðende. ^{MS.}
 7 ich þe wulle ræcchen ; deorne runen.
 3if þu mine lare ; wel wult lusten.
 150 7 noht halden to wraððe ; þat ich wel leare.
 þe king answarede ; swa henges hit wolde.
 Ða sæide hængest ; cnihten alre fæirest.
 lauerd ich habbe moni a dæi ; þine monscipe ihæzed.
 7 þin holde mon ibeon ; i richen þine hirede.
 155 7 in ælche fæhte ; hæhst of þine cnihten.
 7 ich habbe ofte ihærd ; hohfulle ronon.
 Imong þine hiredmonnen ; heo hatieð þe swiðe.
 In to þan bare dæðe ; 3if heo hit dursten cuðe. ^{156. *ronenen* MS.}
 Ofte heo stilleliche spækeð ; 7 spilieð mid runen.
 160 of twam 3unge monnen ; þat feor wunieð hennen.
 þe an hæhte VtheR ; þe oðer ambrosie. ^{159. *stilledliche*}
 MS.

þe þridde hæhte Co[n]stance ; þes wes king i þisse `lond´.

7 he her wes ofslazen ; þurh swicfulle lazen.

Nu wulleð cume þa oðere ; 7 wræken heore broðer.

Al forbær | nen þi lond ; 7 slæn þine leoden.

166 þe seoluen 7 þine duzeðen; driuen ut of londe.

7 þus suggeð þine men ; þer heo somned sitteð.

for þa twene broðere ; beoð `beyne´ kineborne.

Of androeinnes kunne ; þas aðele bruttes.

170 7 þus þine duzeðe ; stille þe fordemed.

Ah ich þe wulle ræde ; Of muchele þire neode.

þþu bi 3ite *cnihtes* ; þa gode beoð to fihte.

168. *beyne* added in
margin, *beoren*
deleted.

7 bitache me ænne castel ; Oðer ane kineliche burh.

þat ich mai inne ligge ; þa while þa ich libbe.

172. *cnihtes*]
mihtest MS.

175 Ic am uor þe iuaid ; þærfore ic wene beon dæd.

fare þer ic auer fare ; næm ich næuere bute care.

Buten ich ligge faste ; biclused inne castle.

3if þu þis me wult don ; Ich hit wulle mid luue afon.

7 ich wulle biliue ; senden after mine wiue.

180 þat is a sexisc wimmon ; of wisdomes wel idon.

7 after rouwenne ; mire dohter; þe me is swiðe deore.

þenne ich habbe mi wif ; 7 mine winemaies.

7 ich beo i þine londe ; fulliche atstonde.

þa bet ich wullen hiren þe ; 3if þu þis 3etest me.

þa answerede vortiger ; Of ælchen vuele he wes | war.

186 Nim *cnihtes* biliue ; 7 send æfter þine wiue.

7 æfter þine children ; þan zungen 7 þan olden.
7 æfter þine cunnen ; 7 afeoh heom mid wunne.
þenne heo to þe cumeð ; þu scat habben gærsume.
190 hæhliche heom to ueden ; 7 wurðliche scruden.
Ah nulle ich castel na burh ; nane þe bitechen.
for men me wolden scenden ; I mine kinelond.
for ze haldeð þa hæðene laze ; þat stod on eoure ælderen dæze.
7 we haldeð cristes laze ; 7 wulleð auere an ure
 dæze. 192. *kine kine lond*
MS.
195 Þa zet spæc hængest ; cnihten alre hendest.
lauerd ich wulle þin iwil ; driȝen her 7 oueral.
7 don al mine dæde ; æfter þine ræde. 197. *don ðon MS.*
Nu ic wulle biliue ; sende after mine wiue.
7 æfter mire dohter ; þe me is swa deore.
200 7 æfter ohte monnen ; þa bezste of mine cunne.
And þu ȝif me swa muchel lond ; to stonden a mire azere hond.
Swa wule anes bule hude ; Ælches weies ouerspræden.
feor from ælche castle ; amidden ane ualde.
þenne ne mai þe atwite ; þe hæne ne þe riche.
þ-þu æi hæhne | burhze ; hæðene monne habbe bi tæht.
206 Þe king him izette ; swa hengest ȝirnde.
Hengest nom læue ; 7 forð he gon liðe.
7 æfter his wiue sende sonde ; to his azene londe.
7 he seolf wende ȝeond þis lond ; to sechen ænne bræ[d]ne fæld.
210 þer he mihte wel spræde ; On his feire hude.

He com æn enne ende ; In enne fæire uelde.
 he hafde ane hude ; biȝite to his neode.
 o ane wilde bule ; þe wes wunder ane strong. 207. *nom* corr. out
 of *mom*.
 He hæfden ænne wisne mon ; þe wel cuðe a craften.
 215 þe nom þas hude ; 7 a bord leide.
 and whætte his særes ; also he schæren wolde.
 Of þere hude he kærfe enne þwong ; swiðe *smal* 7 swiðe long.
 Nes þe þwong noht swiðe bræd ; buten swulc a twines þræd.
 þa al islit wes þe þong ; He wes wunder ane long. 217. *swal* MS.
 220 abuten he bilæde ; mucche del of londe.
 He bigon to deluen ; dic swiðe mucchele.
 þeruppe stenene wal ; þe wes strong oueral.
 ane burh he arerde ; mucchele 7 mare.
 Ða þe burh wes al ȝare ; þa scop he hire nome.
 225 he hæhte heo ful iwis ; KaeRCarrai an Bruttisc.
 7 ænglis | ce cnihtes ; heo Cleopeden þwong Chastre.
 Nu and auere mare ; þe nome sto[n]deð þere.
 7 for nan odere gome ; næueden þæ burh þene 224. *wes*] *wel* MS.
 nome.
 a þet come densce men ; and driuen ut þa bruttes.
 230 þene þridde nome heo þer sætte ; 7 lanecastel hine hæhten.
 7 for swulche gomen ; þæ tun hafde þas þreo nomen.
 Vnder þan com liðen hider ; hengestes wif mid hire scipen.
 heo hæfde to iueren ; fiftene hundred ridern.
 mid hire comen to iwiten ; mucchele æhtene scipen.

235 þer comen inne ; muchel of hengestes cunne.
 7 Rouwen his dohter ; þe him we` s´ swide deore. 233. *hūd'ed* MS.
 Hit wes umbewhile ; þ-com þe ilke time.
 þ-izarked wes þa burh ; mid þan alre bezste.
 Hengest com to þan kinge ; 7 bad him gistninge.
 240 7 seide þ-he hafde an in ; I3arked to 3eines him.
 7 bad þat he come þerto ; 7 he scolde beon fæire under fon.
 7 þe king him 3ette ; swa hengest hit wolde.
 Hit com to þan time ; þ-þe king gon forð liðe.
 Mið þan deoreste monnen ; of alle his du3eðe.
 forð he gon bu3en ; | þ-he to burh com.
 246 he biheold þene wal ; up and dun oueral.
 al him wel likede ; þ-he on lokede.
 He wende in to halle ; 7 his heleðes mid him alle.
 Bemen heo bleowen ; gomen men gunnen cleopien.
 250 Bord heo hetten bređen ; cnihtes setten þer to.
 heo æten heo drunken ; dræm wes iburh3en.
 þa þe du3eðe hafde i3eten ; þa wes heom þa bet iloten.
 Hængest eode in to þan inne ; þer wunede Rouwenne.
 he heo lette scruden ; mid vnime`te´ prude.
 255 al þ-scrud þe heo hafde on ; heo weoren swiðe wel ibon.
 heo weoren mid þan bezste ; ibrusted mid golde. 255. *swiðe*] *iwiðe* MS.
 heo bar an hire honde ; Ane guldene bolle.
 Iuulled mid wine ; þe wes wunder ane god.
 hæ3e iborene men ; heo lædden to hallen.

260 biuoren þan kinge ; fæirest alre þinge.
 Reowen sæt acneowe ; 7 Cleopede to þan kinge.
 7 þus ærest sæide ; In ænglene londe.
 lauerd king wæs hæil ; for þine kime ich æm uæin.
 Þe king þis ihærde ; 7 nuste what heo seide. 260. *farrest MS.*
 265 þe king vortigerne ; fræinede his cnihtes sone.
 what weoren þat speche ; þe þ-maide spiledede.
 Ða andswere | de Keredic ; a cniht swiðe sellic.
 he wes þe bezste latimer ; þat ær com her.
 lust me nu lauerd king ; 7 ich þe wulle cuðen.
 270 whæt seið Rouwenne ; fæirest wimmonnen.
 Hit beoð tiðende ; Inne sæxelonde.
 whær swa æi duzeðe ; gladieð of drenche ; 272. *gladēieð MS.*
 þat freond sæiðe to freonde ; Mid fæire loten hende.
 leofue freond wæs hail ; þe oðer sæið drinc hail.
 275 þe ilke þat halt þene nap ; he hine drinkeð up.
 oder uul me þideR fareð ; 7 bitecheð his iueren.
 þenne þat uul beoð icumen ; þenne cusseoð heo 273. *sæiðe] ð corr.*
 þreoien. *out of d.*
 þis beoð sele lazen ; Inne saxelonde. 276. *bithecheð MS.*
 7 Inne alemaine ; heo beoð ihalden aðele.
 280 Þis iherde uortiger ; of alchen uuele he wes war.
 7 seide hit an bruttisc ; ne cuðe he nan ænglisc.
 maiden Rouwenne ; drinc bluðeliche þenne.
 Ðat maide dronc up þat win ; 7 lette don oðer þerin.

280. *alchel* MS.

THE BRUT (MS. OTHO)

Line numbers are taken from the longer Caligula text. In the original, they were printed in the gutter, between the two versions.

vnder þan com tydinge : to vortiger þan kinge.
þat ouer séé weren icome ; swiþe selliche gomes.
þreo sipes gode ; i come were mid þan flode
5 þaron þreo hundred cnihtes ; also hit were kempes.
þes weren þe faireste men þat euere come here.
ac hii weren heþene þat was har[m] þe more.
þeos comen to þan kinge and faire hine grette.
and seide þat hii wolde ; him sarui in his londe
20 3if vs þou wolle ; mid rihte atholde.
þo answerede vortiger ; þat of eche vuele he was war.
In al mine lifue ; þat ich ileued habbe ;
Bi dai no bi nihte ; Ne seh ich soche cnihtes.
for 3ou ich ham bliþe ; and mid me 3e solle bilefue.
Ac forst ich wolle wite ; for 3oure mochele worsipe.
wat cnihtes | beo 3eo ; and wanene 3eo icomen beo.
þo answerede þe oþer ; þat was þe elder broþer.
Ich hatte Hengest ; Hors hatte min broþer.
we beoþ of Alemaine ; of one riche londe.
of þan ilke hende þat Ænglis his ihote.
35 Beoþ in vre londe wonder þenges gonde.
bi eche fiftene 3er. þat folk his isomned.
And werpeþ þare hire lotes ; fo[r] to londes seche.
vp wan þat lot falleþ ; he mot neod wende.
Ne beo he noht so riche ; he mot lond seche.
Forþe wifues goþ þare mid childe ; also þe deor wilde.
bi euereche 3ere ; hii goþ mid childe þere.
45 Þat lot on vs ful ; þat we faren solde.

38. vp] vt MS.

Ne moste we bilefue ; for life ne for deape.
 þus hit fareþ þere ; þarfore we beoþ nou here.
 50 Nou þou hauest ihord louerd king ; soþ of vs and no lesing.
 þo saide vortiger þat was wis and swiþe war.
 And woche beoþ 3oure biléue ; þat 3eo an biléfep.
 We habbeþ godes gode ; þe we louieð in mode.
 þe on hatte phebus ; þe oþer Saturnus
 60 þe þri[d]de hatte Woden ; þat was a mihti þing.
 þe feorþe hatte Jubiter of alle þinges He his war. |
 þe fifþe hatte Merchurius ; þat his þe hehest ouer vs.
 þe sixte hatte appolin ; þat his a god of gret win. 63. *þe* e partly
 destroyed.
 þe soueþe hatte Teruagant ; an heh god in vre lond.
 65 3et we habbeþ an leafdi ; þat heh his and mihti.
 3eo his ihote frea. heredmen hire louieþ.
 To alle þeos godes we worsipe wercheþ.
 And for hire loue ; þeos dazes we heom 3efue.
 Mone we 3efue moneday. Týdea we 3efue tisdei.
 Woden we 3efue wendesdei. Þane þonre we 3efue þorisdei.
 Frea þane friday. Saturnus þane sateresdei.
 þus saide Hengest ; cniht alre hendest.
 þo answerede vortiger ; of alle harme he was war.
 Cnihtes 3eo beoþ me leofue ; ac 3oure bilefues me beoþ loþe.
 Ac ich wolle ou atholde ; in min anwolde.
 For norþ beoþ þe peutes ; swiþe ohte cnihtes.
 þat ofte doþ me same ; and þarvore ich habbe grame.
 And 3ef 3e wolleþ me wreke ; of [hire] wiþere dedes ;
 Ich 3ou wolle 3eue ; 3eftes swiþe deore.

þo saide Hengest ; al hit sal iworþe þus.
 Hengest nam lefue ; and to sipe gan wende.
 And al hire | godes ; hii beore to londe.
 Forþ hii wende alle ; to vortiger his halle.
 100 Bed weren iscrud ; and bet weren ived.
 Hengestes sweines ; þane vortiger his cnihtes. 101. *swenise MS.*
 Bruttes weren sori ; for þan ilke sihte.
 Nas noht longe ; þat ne come tyðinge.
 þat þo forþrihtes icomen were þe peutes.
 Oueral þin lond hii erneþ ; and sleaþ þin folk and bearneþ.
 and alle þane norþ ende ; hii falleþ to þan grunde.
 110 herof þou most reade ; oþer alle we beoþ deade.
 þe king sende his sonde ; to þeos cnihtes hinne.
 þat hii swiþe sone to him seolue come.
 þar com Hengest and his broþer ; and manian oþer.
 þat þe king vortiger ; bliþe was þo þer.
 þe Peutes dude hire wone ; a þis half vmbre hii were icome.
 And þe king vortiger ; of hire come was war.
 Togadere hii comen ; and manie þar ofslozen.
 þe peutes weren ofte iwoned ; vortiger to ouercome.
 And þo ipohten al so ; ac hit bi ful oþerweies þo.
 for hii hadde mochel care ; for Hengest was þare.
 for swiþe manie peutes ; hii slozen in þan fihte.
 þo þat non was icome ; þo were Peutes ouercome.
 And swiþe hii away | floze. on euereche side.
 and vortiger þe king ; wende azen to his hin.

and to hengest an his cnihtes he 3ef riche 3eftes.
Ne dorste neuere peutes ; come in þisse londe.
þat hii nere sone of slaze ; and idon of lifdaze.
and Hengest swiþe hendeliche ; cwemde þan kinge.

140 Ðo hit bi ful in on time ; þat þe king was swiþe 140. After *þe*, *ren*
 bliþe. MS.

Hengest wolde wiþ þan kinge ; holde rouning.
þane kinge he come bi vore and faire hine grette.
Ðo saide hengest to þan kinge ; louerd hercne týdinge.

And ich þe wolle telle ; of deorne rouninges.
3ef þou mine lore wel wolt ihure.

150 And noht holde to wrappe ; 3ef ich þe wel leore.

And þe king answerede ; alse Hengest hit wolde.

louerd ofte ich habbe ihord ; among þine cnihtes.

þat hii þe hatieþ swiþe ; into þare bare deathe.

Ofte hii stille spekeþ. of two 3onge cheldren.

þe on hatte vther ; þe oþer Aurelie.

þe þridde hehte Constance ; þat þou dedest to deaþe.

Nou wolleþ come þe oþer ; and wreken hire broþer.

Al forbearne þi lond ; and sleaþ þine leo | de.

167 And þus seggeþ þine men ; stille bi twine heom.

Ac ich þe wolle reade ; of mochele þine neode.

þat þou bi 3ete cnihtes ; þat gode beon to fihte.

And bitak me one castel ; þat ich mai on wonie.

175 For ich ham for þe iveiþed ; þat ich wene beo dead.

þare ware ich euere vare ; nam ich neuere bout care.

Bote ihc ligge faste ; bi clused in on castle.
 3ef þou þis woldes don ; Mi wif solde come sone.
 and mi dohter Rowenne ; and moche of mine cunne.
 Wan we þos beoþ in londe ; folliche at stonde.
 þe bet we wollep cweme þe ; 3ef þou þis wolt granti me.
 185 þo answerede vortiger ; þat of ech vuele was war.
 Nim cnihtes swiþe ; and send after þine wifue.
 And after þine children ; þe 3ong and þe heoldre
 And after þine cunne ; and onderfang heom mid winne.
 wane hii to þe comeþ ; þou salt habbe garisome.
 190 hehliche heom to fede ; and worþliche to scrude.
 Ac nelle ich Castel ne Borh ; nanne þe bitake.
 For men me wolde sende ; in mine kinelonde.
 3ef | ich heþene men ; londes bitoke.
 195 þe 3et spac hengest ; cniht alre hendest.
 louerd nou ich wolle ; don al þine wille.
 Nou ich wolle bliue ; sende after mine wifue.
 And þou 3ef me so mochel lond ; to stonde on min owe hond.
 Ase wole a Bole hude ; in grene ouersprede.
 For fram eche Castle ; amidde one felde.
 þanne ne mai þe atwite ; þe pore no þe riche.
 205 þat þou eni heh Borh ; heþene Man bitakest.
 And þe king him 3af ; þat lutel þat he 3ornde.
 Hengest nam lefue ; and forþ he gan wende.
 And after his wifue he sende sonde ; to his owene londe.

And him seolf wende ; oueral to biholde.
 210 ware he mihte wel sprede ; his Bole hude.
 Hengest hadde one wisneman ; þat wel coupe of crafte.
 215 He nam þeos bole hude ; and a borde laide.
 þar of he makede ane þwang ; swiþe smal and swiþe lang.
 Nas þe þwang noht brod bote ase hit were a twined 218. *atwined* MS.
 þred.
 220 Aboute þarmid he leide ; moche deal of londe.
 He lette þo delue ; on euerech halue.
 þar vppe stonene wal ; swiþe | strong oueral.
 ane castel he arerde ; fair to biholde.
 þo þe Borh was al 3arue ; þo sette he hire name.
 225 he hehte hire foliwis ; CaýrKarri in Bruttesse.
 and Englisse cnihtes ; Þwangchestre.
 Nou and euere more ; þe name stondeþ þ[are].
 forte þat Dence men driuen vt þe cnihtes.
 230 þane þridde name þar sette ; and leane Castel hine cleopede.
 vnder þan com liþe hider ; Hengestes wif mid hire sipes.
 3eo hadde to iveres ; fiftene hundred Rideres.
 And Rowen his dohter ; þat was him swiþe deore.
 Hit was bi on wile ; þat com þe ilke time.
 þat `i`zarked was þe borh ; mid þan alre beste.
 And Hengest wende to þan kinge ; and bad hine to gýstninge.
 240 And seide þat he hadde on In ; himakede to 3enes him.
 And þe king him grantede ; also Hengest wolde.
 245 Forþ hii gonne wende ; þat hii come to þan ende.

þe king biheold þane wal ; vp and dun oueral.
 Al him wel likede ; þat he on lokede.
 He wende in to halle ; and his cnihtes mid him alle.
 250 Bordes hii lette sprede ; cnihtes þar to sete.
 hii eoten | hii drongken ; blisse was amang heom.
 Hengest wende to þe inne ; þar Rowenne was hinne.
 he hire lette scrude ; mid onimete prude.
 3eo bar in hire hond ; ane goldene bolle.
 Hi fulled mid w[i]ne ; ne mihte non be rich[ere].
 Heh3e ibore men ; hire ladde in to halle.
 260 bi vore þan kinge ; fairest alle þing.
 Rowenne sat a cnouwe ; and seide to þan kinge.
 þus erest 3eo spac ; in Englene lond.
 Louerd king wassayl ; for * þine comes me beoþ hail.
 Þe king hit ihorde ; and nuste wat 3eo saide.
 265 þe king vortigerne ; haxede his cnihte`s´.
 wat were þe speche ; þat þe maide speke.
 Ðo answerede ; Keþereh ; cniht mid þe wisest.
 he was þe beste latimer ; þat euere wone[de] her. 268. *wone* MS.
 Lust nou mi louerd king ; and ich þe wolle cuðen.
 270 wat seiþ Rowenne ; fairest of al wommanne.
 Hit his þe wone ; Ine saxlonde.
 þat freond saiþ to his freond ; wane he sal [dri]nge. 273. *dringe* MS.
 leofue freond wassail ; þe oþer saiþ dringhail. defective here.
 275 þe ilke þat halt þane nap ; þane dringe dringþ vp.

And a3[ein]es me hine fulþ ; and takeþ his iverē. 276. *a3eines*] MS.
 defective here.
 Þis beoþ þe | lawes ; ine saxlonde.
 280 þis ihorde vortiger ; of eche vuele he was war.
 And saide hit on Bruttesse ; ne coupe he noht on CEnglisse.
 Mayde Rowenne ; dring blopeliche þanne.
 Þat maide drong vt þat win ; and lette don oþer þarin.
 And bitahte þan kinge ; and he hit vp swipte.
 285 And þorh þisne ilke game ; þe lawe come to londe.
 wassayl and dringhayl ; þat mani men lofuieþ.
 Þe faire Rowenne ; sat bi þan kinge.
 þe king hire 3eorne biheold ; 3eo was him leof on heorte.
 Ofte he hire custe ; and ofte he hire clupte.
 Þe worse was þare wel neh ; þat to soche game his wel sleh.
 þe worse þat neuere ne doþ god ; he meýnde þare þes kinges mod
 þe king mornede swiþe ; for habbe hire to wifue.
 þat was swiþe loplich þing ; þat þe cristene king.
 295 louede þat Maide heapene ; folk to harme.
 To Hengest bad þe king ; þat he þat maide 3efue him.
 Hengest funde on his Reade ; don þat þe king him beade.
 He 3ef him Rowenne ; womman swiþe hende.

LA3AMON

THE BRUT: PARALLEL VERSIONS

MS. Caligula
MS. Otho

Each line of verse has been split at the caesura.

MS. CALIGULA

Vnder þan comen tiðende ;
to vortiger þan kinge.
þouer sæ weoren icumen ;
swiðe selcuðe gumen.
Jnne þere Temese ;
to londe heo weoren icummen.
þreo scipen gode ;
comen mid þan flode.
5 þreo hundred cnihten ;
Else hit weoren kinges.
wiðuten þan scipen monnen ;
þe weoren þer wiðinnen.
þis weoren þa færeste men ;
þat auere her comen.
Ah heo weore hæðene ;
þ-wes hærm þa mare.
Uortiger heom sende to ;
And axede hu heo weoren idon.
10 3if heo grið sohten ;
7 of his freondscipe rohten.
heo wisliche andswerden ;
Swa heo wel cuðen.
7 seiden þ-heo walden ;
speken wið þan kinge.
7 Leofliche him heren ;
7 hælden hine for hærre.
And swa heo gunnen wenden ;
fforð to þan kinge.
15 Þa wes Uortigerne þa king ;
In Cantuarieburi.

MS. OTHO

vnder þan com tyðinge :
to vortiger þan kinge.
þat ouer séé weren icode ;
swiþe selliche gomes.

þreo sipes gode ;
i come were mid þan flode
þaron þreo hundred cnihtes ;
alse hit were kempes.

þes weren þe faireste men þat euere come here.
ac hii weren heþene þat was har[m] þe more.

þer he mid his hirede ;
 Hæhliche spiledede.
 þer þas cnihtes comen ;
 Bi foren þan folckinge.
 Sone swa heo hine imetten ;
 fæire heo hine igrætten.
 7 seiden þat heo him wolden ;
 hæren iþisse londe.
 20 3if he heom wolde ;
 mid rihten athalden.
 Ða andswerede vortiger ;
 of elchen vuele he wes war.
 An alle mine iliue ;
 þe ich iluued hadde.
 bi dæie no bi nihtes ;
 ne sæh ich nauere ær swulche cnihtes.
 for eouwer cumen ich æm bliðe ;
 7 mid me 3e scullen bilæfuen.
 25 7 eouwer wille ich wulle dri3en ;
 bi mine quicke liuen.
 Ah of eou ich wulle iwiten ;
 þurh soðen eouwer wurðscipen.
 whæt cnihten 3e seon ;
 7 whænnenen 3e icumen beon.
 7 whar 3e wullen beon treowe ;
 alde 7 æc neowe.
 þa answerede þe oðer ;
 þat wes þe aldeste broðer.
 30 lust me nu lauerd king ;
 7 ich þe wullen cuðen.
 what cnihtes we beoð ;
 7 whanene we icumen seoð.
Ich hatte henges ;
 hors is mi broðer.
 we beoð of alemainne ;
 aðelest alre londe.

þeos comen to þan kinge and faire hine grette.
 and seide þat hii wolde ;
 him sarui in his londe
 3if vs þou wolle ;
 mid rihte atholde.
 þo answerede vortiger ;
 þat of eche vuele he was war.
 In al mine lifue ;
 þat ich ileued hadde ;
 Bi dai no bi nihte ;
 Ne seh ich soche cnihtes.
 for 3ou ich ham bliþe ;
 and mid me 3e solle bilefue.

 Ac forst ich wolle wite ;
 for 3oure mochele worsipe.
 wat cnihtes beo 3eo ;
 and wanene 3eo icomen beo.

 þo answerede þe oþer ;
 þat was þe elder broþer.

 Ich hatte Hengest ;
 Hors hatte min broþer.
 we beoþ of Alemaine ;
 of one riche londe.
 of þan ilke hende
 þat Ænglis his ihote.

of þat ilken ænde ;
 þe angles is ihaten.
35 Beoð in ure londe ;
 selcuðe tiðende.
vmbe fiftene 3er ;
 þat folc hi[s] isomned.
Al ure iledene folc ;
 7 heore loten werpeð.
vppen þan þe hit fal[l]ed ;
 he scal uaren of londe.
Bilæuen scul len þa fiue ;
 þa sexte scal forð liðe.
40 ut of þan leode ;
 to u[n]cuðe londe.
Ne beo he na swa leof mon ;
 uorð he scal liðen.
For þer is folc swiðe muchel ;
 mære þene heo walden.
þa wif færeð mid childe ;
 swa þe deor wilde.
Æueralche 3ere ;
 heo bereð child þere ;
45 þ-beoð an us feole ;
 þat we færen scolden.
Ne mihte we bilæue ;
 for liue ne for dæðe.
Ne for nauer nane þinge ;
 for þan folckinge.
þus we uerden þere ;
 7 forþi beoð nu here.
to sechen vnder lufte ;
 lond 7 godne lauerd.
50 Nu þu hæfuest iherd lauerd ki[n]g ;
 Soð of us þurh alle þi[n]g.
þa answarede vortiger ;
 of alc an vfele he wes war.

Beoþ in vre londe
 wonder þenges gonde.
bi eche fiftene 3er.
 þat folk his isomned.
And werpeþ þare hire lotes ;
 fo[r] to londes seche.
vp wan þat lot falleþ ;
 he mot neod wende.

Ne beo he noht so riche ;
 he mot lond seche.

Forþe wifues goþ þare mid childe ;
 alse þe deor wilde.
bi euereche 3ere ;
 hii goþ mid childe þere.
þat lot on vs ful ;
 þat we faren solde.
Ne moste we bilefue ;
 for life ne for deaþe.

þus hit fareþ þere ;
 þarfore we beoþ nou here.

Nou þou hauest ihord louerd king ;
 soþ of vs and no lesing.
þo saide vortiger
 þat was wis and swiþe war.

Ich ileue þe cniht ;
 þ-þu me sugge soðriht.
7 wulche beoð æoure ileuen ;
 þ-3e on ileueð.
7 eoure leofue godd ;
 þe 3e to luted.
55 þa andswarede Hænges ;
 cnihtene alre fæirest.
Nis in al þis kinelond ;
 cniht swa muchel ne swa strong.
We habbeð gode`s gode ;
 þe we luuieð an ure mode.
þa we habbeð hope to ;
 7 heoreð heom mid mihte.
Ðe an hæhte phebus ;
 þe oðer Saturnus.
60 þe þridde hæhte woden ;
 þ-is an weoli godd.
þe feorðe hæh [te] Jupiter ;
 of alle þinges he is whar.
þe fifte hæhte Mercurius ;
 þat is þe hæhste ouer us.
þæ sæxte hæhte appollin ;
 þ-is a godd wel idon.
þe seoueðe hatte teruagant ;
 an hæh godd in ure lon.
65 3et we habbeð anne læuedi ;
 þe hæh is 7 mæhti.
heh heo is 7 hali ;
 hiredmen heo luuieð forþi.
heo js ihate Fræa ;
 wel heo heom dihteð.
Ah for alle ure goden deore ;
 þa we scullen hæren.

And woche beoþ 3oure biléue ;
 þat 3eo an biléfep.
We habbeþ godes gode ;
 þe we louieð in mode.
þe on hatte phebus ;
 þe oþer Saturnus
þe þri[d]de hatte Woden ;
 þat was a mihti þing.
þe feorþe hatte Jubiter
 of alle þinges He his war.
þe fifþe hatte Merchurius ;
 þat his þe hehest ouer vs.
þe sixte hatte appolin ;
 þat his a god of gret win.
þe soueþe hatte Teruagant ;
 an heh god in vre lond.
3et we habbeþ an leafdi ;
 þat heh his and mihti.
3eo his ihote frea.
 heredmen hire louieþ.
To alle þeos godes
 we worsipe wercheþ.
And for hire loue ;
 þeos dazes we heom 3efue.
Mone we 3efue monedaȝ.
 Týdea we 3efue tisdei.

Woden hehde þa hæhste laze ;
an ure ælderne dægen.
70 he heom wes leof ;
æfne al swa heore lif.
he wes heore walden ;
And heom wurðscipe duden.
þene feorðe dæi iþere wike ;
heo 3ifuen him to wurðscipe.
þa þunre heo 3iuen þunres dæi ;
forþi þat heo heom helpen mæi.
Freon heore læfdi ;
heo 3iuen hire fridæi.
75 Saturnus heo 3iuen sætteredæi ;
þene sunne heo 3iuen sonedæi.
Monen heo 3ifuen monedæi ;
Tidea heo 3euen tisdæi.
þus seide hæ[n]gest ;
cnihten alre hendest.
þa answerede vortiger ;
of ælchen vfel he wæs wær.
Cnihtes 3e beoð me leofue ;
ah þas tiðende me beoð laðe.
80 eouwer ileuen beoð vnwraste ;
3e ne ileoueð noht an criste.
Ah 3e ileoueð a þene wurse ;
þe godd seolf awariede.
eoure godes ne beoð nohtes ;
In helle heo niðer liggeð.
Ah neoðeles ich wulle eou athælde ;
An mine anwalde.
for norð Beoð þa Peohtes ;
swiðe ohte cnihtes.
85 þe ofte ledeð in mine londe ;
ferde swiðe stronge.
7 ofte dod me muchele scome ;
7 þerfore ich habbe grome.
7 3if 3e me wulleð wræken ;
7 heore hæfden me bizeten.

Woden we 3efue wendesdei.
þane þonre we 3efue þorisdai.

Frea þane fridaȝ.
Saturnus þane sateresdai.

þus saide Hengest ;
cniht alre hendest.
þo answerede vortiger ;
of alle harme he was war.
Cnihtes 3eo beoþ me leofue ;
ac 3oure bilefues me beoþ loþe.

Ac ich wolle ou atholde ;
in min anwolde.
For norþ beoþ þe peutes ;
swiþe ohte cnihtes.

þat ofte doþ me same ;
and þarvore ich habbe grame.

Ich eou wullen 3euen lond ;
muchel seolueR 7 gold.
þa andswerede hængest ;
cnihtene alre feirest.
90 3if hit wulle saturnus ;
al hit scal iwurðe þus.
7 Woden ure lauerd ;
þe we on biliueð.
Hengest nom læue ;
7 to scipen gon liðe.
þer wes moni cniht strong ;
heo dro3en heore scipen uppe þe lond.
forð wenden dringches ;
to vortigerne þan kenge.
95 Biuoren wende hengest ;
7 hors him alre hændest.
Seoððen þa alemainisce men ;
þa aðele weoren an deden.
7 seoððen heo senden him to ;
heore sæxisce cnihtes wel idon.
hengestes cunnesmen ;
of his aldene cuddæ.
heo comen in to halle ;
hændeliche alle.
100 Bett weoren iscrudde ;
7 bed weoren iuædde.
hængest swaine ;
þene vortigernes. þeines.
þa wes vortigernes hired ;
for hehne ihalden.
Bruttes weoren særi ;
for swulchere isihðe.
Nes hit nawiht longe ;
þat ne comen to þan kinge.
105 Cnihtes sunen uiue ;
þa i faren hafden biliue.
heo sæiden to þan kinge ;
neowe tiðenden.

And 3ef 3e wollep me wreke ;
of [hire] wiþere dedes ;
Ich 3ou wolle 3eue ;
3eftes swiþe deore.
þo saide Hengest ;
al hit sal iworþe þus.
Hengest nam lefue ;
and to sipe gan wende.
And al hire godes ;
hii beore to londe.
Forþ hii wende alle ;
to vortiger his halle.
Bed weren iscrud ;
and bet weren ived.
Hengestes sweines ;
þane vortiger his cnihtes.
Bruttes weren sori ;
for þan ilke sihte.
Nas noht longe ;
þat ne come týdinge.

nu forðrihtes ;
Icumen beoð þa peohtes.
þurh þi lond heo ærneð ;
7 hærðieð 7 berneð.
7 al þene norð ænde ;
iuald to þan grunde.
110 herof þu most ræden ;
oðer all we beoð dæden.
Ðe king hine biþohte ;
whæt he don mihte.
he sende to þan innen ;
after al his monnen.
þer com hengest þer com hors ;
þer com mani mon ful oht.
þer comen þa saxisce men ;
hengestes cunnesmen.
115 7 þa Alemainisce cnihtes ;
þe beoð gode to fihte.
þis isæh þe king vortiger ;
bliðe wes he þa þer.
Ða peohtes duden heore iwune ;
a þas hælf þere humbre. heo weoren
icume.
7 þe king VortigeR ;
of heore cume wes ful war.
Togadere heo comen ;
7 feole þer of slozen.
120 þer wes feht swide strong ;
Comp swiðe sturne.
Ðe Peohtes weoren ofteiwuned ;
Vortige[r]ne to ouer cumen.
7 þa heo þohten a[l]swa ;
Ah hit ilomp an oðer þa.
for hit wes heom al hele ;
þat hængest wes þere.
7 þa cnihtes stronge ;
þe comen of saxelonde.

þat þo forþrihtes
icomen were þe peutes.
Oueral þin lond hii erneþ ;
and sleaþ þin folk and bearneþ.
and alle þane norþ ende ;
hii falleþ to þan grunde.
herof þou most reade ;
oþer alle we beoþ deade.
Ðe king sende his sonde ;
to þeos cnihtes hinne.
þat hii swiþe sone
to him seolue come.
þar com Hengest and his broþer ;
and manian oþer.
þat þe king vortiger ;
bliþe was þo þer.
Ðe Peutes dude hire wone ;
a þis half vmbre hii were icome.
And þe king vortiger ;
of hire come was war.
Togadere hii comen ;
and manie þar of slozen.
þe peutes weren ofte iwoned ;
vortiger to ouercome.
And þo iþohten al so ;
ac hit bi ful oþerweies þo.
for hii hadde mochel care ;
for Hengest was þare.

125 7 þa ohte alemanisce ;
þe þider comen mid horse.

Swiðe monie peohtes ;
heo sloʒen iþan fehte.

feondliche heo fuhten ;
feollen þa fæie.

Þa þe non wes icumen ;
þa weoren Peohtes ouercumen.

7 swuðe heo awæi floʒen ;
an ælche helue heo forð fluʒen.

130 7 alle dai heo fluʒen ;
monie 7 vnnifoʒe.

Þe king vortigerne ;
wende to herberwe.

7 æuere him weoren onuast ;
Hors 7 hængest.

Hængest wes þan kinge leof ;
7 him lindesaʒe ʒef.

and he ʒæf horse ;
madmes inoʒe.

135 7 alle heore cnihtes ;
he swiðe wel dihte.

7 hit gode stunde ;
stod a þan ilke.

Ne durste nauere peohtes ;
cumen i þan londes.

no ræueres no utlaʒen ;
þ-heo neoren sone ofslæʒen.

7 hængest swiðe fæire ;
herede þane king.

140 Þa ilomp hit in ane time ;
þ-þe king wes swiðe bliðe.

An ane hæʒe dæie ;
imong his duʒeðe monnen.

Hengest hine biþohte ;
what he don mihte.

for swiþe manie peutes ;
hii sloʒen in þan fihte.

þo þat non was icode ;
þo were Peutes ouercome.
And swiþe hii away floʒe.
on euereche side.

and vortiger þe king ;
wende aʒen to his hin.

and to hengest an his cnihtes
he ʒef riche ʒeftes.

Ne dorste neuere peutes ;
come in þisse londe.

þat hii nere sone ofslaʒe ;
and idon of lifdaʒe.

and Hengest swiþe hendeliche ;
cwemde þan kinge.

Þo hit biʒul in on time ;
þat þe king was swiþe bliþe.

Hengest wolde wiþ þan kinge ;
holde rouning.
þane kinge he come biʒore
and faire hine grette.

for he wolde wið þan kinge ;
holden runinge.
þan kinge he eode to ; foren ;
7 fæire hine gon greten.
145 Þe king sone up stod ;
7 sætte hine bi him seoluen.
heo drunken heo dremden ;
blisse wes among heom.
Ða queð hengest to þan kinge ;
lauerd hærcne tiðende.
7 ich þe wulle ræcchen ;
deorne runen.
zif þu mine lare ;
wel wult lusten.
150 7 noht halden to wraððe ;
þat ich wel leare.
þe king answarede ;
swa henges hit wolde.
Ða sæide hængest ;
cnihten alre fæirest.
lauerd ich habbe moni a dæi ;
þine monscipe ihæzed.
7 þin holde mon ibeon ;
i richen þine hirede.
155 7 in ælche fæhte ;
hæhst of þine cnihten.
7 ich habbe ofte ihærd ;
hohfulle ronon.
Imong þine hiredmonnen ;
heo hatieð þe swiðe.
In to þan bare dæðe ;
zif heo hit dursten cuðe.
Ofte heo stilleliche spækeð ;
7 spilieð mid runen.
160 of twam zunge monnen ;
þat feor wunieð hennen.
þe an hæhte VtheR ;
þe oðer ambrosie.

þo saide hengest to þan kinge ;
louerd hercne tȳdinge.
And ich þe wolle telle ;
of deorne rouninges.
ʒef þou mine lore
wel wolt ihure.
And noht holde to wrappe ;
ʒef ich þe wel leore.
And þe king answerede ;
alse Hengest hit wolde.

louerd ofte ich habbe ihord ;
among þine cnihtes.
þat hii þe hatieþ swiþe ;
into þare bare deathe.

Ofte hii stille spekeþ.
of two 3onge cheldren.

þe on hatte vther ;
þe ober Aurelie.

þe þridde hæhte Co[n]stance ;
þes wes king i þisse `lond´.

7 he her wes ofslažen ;
þurh swicfulle lažen.

Nu wulleð cume þa oðere ;
7 wræken heore broðer.

165 Al forbær nen þi lond ;
7 slæn þine leoden.

þe seoluen 7 þine duȝeðen;
driuen ut of londe.

7 þus suggeð þine men ;
þer heo somned sitteð.

for þa twene broðere ;
beoð `beyne´ kineborne.

Of androeinnes kunne ;
þas aðele bruttes.

170 7 þus þine duȝeðe ;
stille þe fordemed.

Ah ich þe wulle ræde ;
Of muchele þire neode.

þ-þu biȝite cnihtes ;
þa gode beoð to fihte.

7 bitache me ænne castel ;
Oðer ane kineliche burh.

þat ich mai inne ligge ;
þa while þa ich libbe.

175 Ic am uor þe iuaid ;
þærfore ic wene beon dæd.

fare þer ic auer fare ;
næm ich næuere bute care.

Buten ich ligge faste ;
bicluded inne castle.

ȝif þu þis me wult don ;
Ich hit wulle mid luue afon.

7 ich wulle biliue ;
senden after mine wiue.

180 þat is a sexisc wimmon ;
of wisdomes wel idon.

þe þridde hehte Constance ;
þat þou dedest to deaþe.

Nou wolleþ come þe oþer ;
and wreken hire broþer.

Al forbearne þi lond ;
and slean þine leo de.

And þus seggeþ þine men ;
stille bitwine heom.

Ac ich þe wolle reade ;
of mochele þine neode.

þat þou biȝete cnihtes ;
þat gode beon to fihte.

And bitak me one castel ;
þat ich mai on wonie.

For ich ham for þe iverped ;
þat ich wene beo dead.

þare ware ich euere vare ;
nam ich neuere bout care.

Bote ihc ligge faste ;
bicluded in on castle.

Ȝef þou þis woldes don ;
Mi wif solde come sone.

7 after rouwenne ; mire dohter;
þe me is swiðe deore.
Þenne ich habbe mi wif ;
7 mine winemaies.
7 ich beo i þine londe ;
fulliche atstonde.
þa bet ich wullen hiren þe ;
3if þu þis 3ettest me.
185 Þa answerede vortiger ;
Of ælchen vuele he wes war.
Nim cnihtes biliue ;
7 send æfter þine wiue.
7 æfter þine children ;
þan 3ungen 7 þan olden.
7 æfter þine cunnen ;
7 afeoh heom mid wunne.
þenne heo to þe cumeð ;
þu scat habben gærsume.
190 hæhliche heom to ueden ;
7 wurðliche scruden.
Ah nulle ich castel na burh ;
nane þe bitechen.
for men me wolden scenden ;
I mine kinelond.
for 3e haldeð þa hæðene la3e ;
þat stod on eoure ælderen dæ3e.
7 we haldeð cristes la3e ;
7 wulleð auere an ure dæ3e.
195 Þa 3et spæc hængest ;
cnihten alre hendest.
lauerd ich wulle þin iwil ;
drizen her 7 oueral.
7 don al mine dæde ;
æfter þine ræde.
Nu ic wulle biliue ;
sende afteR mine wiue.
7 æfter mire dohter ;
þe me is swa deore.

and mi dohter Rowenne ;
and moche of mine cunne.

Wan we þos beoþ in londe ;
folliche atstonde.
þe bet we wolleþ cweme þe ;
3ef þou þis wolt granti me.
þo answerede vortiger ;
þat of ech vuele was war.
Nim cnihtes swiþe ;
and send after þine wifue.
And after þine children ;
þe 3ong and þe heoldre
And after þine cunne ;
and onderfang heom mid winne.
wane hii to þe comeþ ;
þou salt habbe garisome.
hehliche heom to fede ;
and worpliche to scrude.
Ac nelle ich Castel ne Borh ;
nanne þe bitake.
For men me wolde sende ;
in mine kinelonde.
3ef ich heþene men ;
londes bitoke.

þe 3et spac hengest ;
cniht alre hendest.
louerd nou ich wolle ;
don al þine wille.

Nou ich wolle bliue ;
sende after mine wifue.

200 7 æfter ohte monnen ;
þa bezste of mine cunne.
And þu 3if me swa muchel lond ;
to stonden a mire a3ere hond.
Swa wule anes bule hude ;
Ælches weies ouerspræden.
feor from ælche castle ;
amidden ane ualde.
þenne ne mai þe atwite ;
þe hæne ne þe riche.
205 þ þu æi hæhne burh3e ;
hæðene monne habbe bi tæht.
þe king him izette ;
swa hengest 3irnde.
Hengest nom læue ;
7 forð he gon liðe.
7 æfter his wiue sende sonde ;
to his a3ene londe.
7 he seolf wende 3eond þis lond ;
to sechen ænne bræ[d]ne fæld.
210 þer he mihte wel spræde ;
On his feire hude.
He com æn enne ende ;
In enne fæire uelde.
he hafde ane hude ;
bi 3ite to his neode.
o ane wilde bule ;
þe wes wunder ane strong.
He hæfden ænne wisne mon ;
þe wel cuðe a craften.
215 þe nom þas hude ;
7 a bord leide.
and whætte his særes ;
alse he schæren wolde.
Of þere hude he kærfe enne þwong ;
swiðe smal 7 swiðe long.
Nes þe þwong noht swiðe bræd ;
buten swulc a twines præd.

And þou 3ef me so mochel lond ;
to stonde on min owe hond.
Ase wole a Bole hude ;
in grene ouersprede.
For fram eche Castle ;
amidde one felde.
þanne ne mai þe atwite ;
þe pore no þe riche.
þat þou eni heh Borh ;
heþene Man bitakest.
And þe king him 3af ;
þat lutel þat he 3ornde.
Hengest nam lefue ;
and forþ he gan wende.
And after his wifue he sende sonde ;
to his owene londe.
And him seolf wende ;
oueral to biholde.
ware he mihte wel sprede ;
his Bole hude.

Hengest hadde one wisneman ;
þat wel coupe of crafte.
He nam þeos bole hude ;
and a borde laide.

þar of he makede ane þwang ;
swiþe smal and swiþe lang.
Nas þe þwang noht brod
bote ase hit were a twined præd.

þa al islit wes þe þong ;
 He wes wunder ane long.
 220 abuten he bilæde ;
 muche del of londe.
 He bigon to deluen ;
 dic swiðe muchele.
 þeruppe stenene wal ;
 þe wes strong oueral.
 ane burh he arerde ;
 muchele 7 mare.
 Ða þe burh wes al 3are ;
 þa scop he hire nome.
 225 he hæhte heo ful iwis ;
 KaeRCarrai an Bruttisc.
 7 ænglis ce cnihtes ;
 heo Cleopeden þwongChastre.
 Nu and auere mare ;
 þe nome sto[n]deð þere.
 7 for nan odere gome ;
 næueden þæ burh þene nome.
 a þet come densce men ;
 and driuen ut þa bruttes.
 230 þene þridde nome heo þer sætte ;
 7 lane castel hine hæhten.
 7 for swulche gomen ;
 þæ tun hafde þas þreo nomen.
 Vnder þan com liðen hider ;
 hengestes wif mid hire scipen.
 heo hæfde to iueren ;
 fiftene hundred ridern.
 mid hire comen to iwiten ;
 muchele æhtene scipen.
 235 þer comen inne ;
 muchel of hengestes cunne.
 7 Rouwen his dohter ;
 þe him we`s´ swide deore.

Aboute þarmid he leide ;
 moche deal of londe.
 He lette þo delue ;
 on euerech halue.
 þar vppe stonene wal ;
 swiþe strong oueral.
 ane castel he arerde ;
 fair to biholde.
 þo þe Borh was al 3arue ;
 þo sette he hire name.
 he hehte hire foliwis ;
 CayrKarri in Bruttisse.
 and Englisce cnihtes ;
 þwangchestre.
 Nou and euere more ;
 þe name stondeþ þ[are].

 forte þat Dence men
 driuen vt þe cnihtes.
 þane þridde name þar sette ;
 and leane Castel hine cleopede.

 vnder þan com liþe hider ;
 Hengestes wif mid hire sipes.
 3eo hadde to iveren ;
 fiftene hundred Rideres.

 And Rowen his dohter ;
 þat was him swiþe deore.

Hit wes umbewhile ;
þ-com þe ilke time.
þ-iʒarked wes þa burh ;
mid þan alre bezste.
Hengest com to þan kinge ;
7 bad him gistninge.
240 7 seide þ he hafde an in ;
Iʒarked to ʒeines him.
7 bad þat he come þerto ;
7 he scolde beon fæire under fon.
7 þe king him ʒette ;
swa hengest hit wolde.
Hit com to þan time ;
þ-þe king gon forð liðe.
Mið þan deoreste monnen ;
of alle his duʒeðe.
245 forð he gon buʒen ;
þ-he to burh com.
he bi heold þene wal ;
up and dun oueral.
al him wel likede ;
þ-he on lokede.
He wende in to halle ;
7 his heleðes mid him alle.
Bemen heo bleowen ;
gomen men gunnen cleopien.
250 Bord heo hetten bređen ;
cnihtes setten þer to.
heo æten heo drunken ;
dræm wes iburhʒen.
þa þe duʒeðe hafde iʒeten ;
þa wes heom þa bet iloten.
Hængest eode in to þan inne ;
þer wunede Rouwenne.
he heo lette scruden ;
mid vnime`te´ prude.
255 al þ-scrud þe heo hafde on ;
heo weoren swiðe wel ibon.

Hit was bi on wile ;
þat com þe ilke time.
þat `iʒarked was þe borh ;
mid þan alre beste.
And Hengest wende to þan kinge ;
and bad hine to gýstninge.
And seide þat he hadde on In ;
himakede to ʒenes him.
And þe king him grantede ;
alse Hengest wolde.
Forþ hii gonne wende ;
þat hii come to þan ende.
þe king bi heold þane wal ;
vp and dun oueral.
Al him wel likede ;
þat he on lokede.
He wende in to halle ;
and his cnihtes mid him alle.
Bordes hii lette sprede ;
cnihtes þar to sete.
hii eoten hii drongken ;
blisse was amang heom.
Hengest wende to þe inne ;
þar Rowenne was hinne.
he hire lette scrude ;
mid onimete prude.

heo weoren mid þan bezste ;
 ibrusted mid golde.
 heo bar an hire honde ;
 Ane guldene bolle.
 Iuulled mid wine ;
 þe wes wunder ane god.
 hæƷe iborene men ;
 heo lædden to hallen.
 260 biuoren þan kinge ;
 fæirest alre þinge.
 Reowen sæt acneowe ;
 7 Cleopede to þan kinge.
 7 þus ærest sæide ;
 In ænglene londe.
 lauerd king wæs hæil ;
 for þine kime ich æm uæin.
 Þe king þis ihærde ;
 7 nuste what heo seide.
 265 þe king vortigerne ;
 fræinede his cnihtes sone.
 what weoren þat speche ;
 þe þ-maide spilede.
 Ða andswere de Keredic ;
 a cniht swiðe sellic.
 he wes þe bezste latimer ;
 þat ær com her.
 lust me nu lauerd king ;
 7 ich þe wulle cuðen.
 270 whæt seið Rouwenne ;
 fæirest wimmonnen.
 Hit beoð tiðende ;
 Inne sæxelonge.
 whær swa æi duƷeðe ;
 gladieð of drenche ;
 þat freond sæiðe to freonde ;
 Mid fæire loten hende.

3eo bar in hire hond ;
 ane goldene bolle.
 Hi fulled mid w[i]ne ;
 ne mihte non be rich[ere].
 HehƷe ibore men ;
 hire ladde in to halle.
 bi vore þan kinge ;
 fairest alle þing.
 Rowenne sat a cnouwe ;
 and seide to þan kinge.
 þus erest 3eo spac ;
 in Englene lond.
 Louerd king wassaȳl ;
 for * þine comes me beoþ hail.
 Þe king hit ihorde ;
 and nuste wat 3eo saide.
 þe king vortigerne ;
 haxede his cnihte`s´.
 wat were þe speche ;
 þat þe maide speke.
 Ðo answerede ; Keþereh ;
 cniht mid þe wisest.
 he was þe beste latimer ;
 þat euere wone[de] her.
 Lust nou mi louerd king ;
 and ich þe wolle cuðen.
 wat seiþ Rowenne ;
 fairest of al wommanne.
 Hit his þe wone ;
 Ine saxlonge.
 þat freond saiþ to his freond ;
 wane he sal [dri]nge.

leofue freond wæs hail ;
 þe oðer sæið drinc hail.
275 þe ilke þat halt þene nap ;
 he hine drinkeð up.
oder uul me þideR fareð ;
 7 bitecheð his iueren.
þenne þat uul beoð icumen ;
 þenne cusseoð heo þreoien.
þis beoð sele lazen ;
 Inne saxelonde.
7 Inne alemaine ;
 heo beoð ihalden aðele.
280 Þis iherde uortiger ;
 of alchen uuele he wes war.
7 seide hit an bruttisc ;
 ne cuðe he nan ænglisc.
maiden Rouwenne ;
 drinc bluðeliche þenne.
Ðat maide dronc up þat win ;
 7 lette don oðer þerin.
7 bitæhten þan kinge ;
 7 þrien hine custe.
285 7 þurh þa ilke leoden ;
 þa lazen comen to þissen londe.
wæshail 7 drinchæil.
 moni mon þerof is fain ;
Rouwenne þe hende ;
 sat bi þan kinge.
þe king heo Ʒeorne biheold ;
 heo was him an heorte leof.
ofte he heo custe ;
 ofte he heo clupte.
290 Al his mod 7 his main ;
 halde to þan mæidene.
Ðe wurse wes þer ful neh ;
 þe in ælche gomene iS ful ræh.
þe wurse ne dude næuere god ;
 he mæingde þas kinge`s mod.

leofue freond wassail ;
 þe oþer saiþ dringhail.
þe ilke þat halt þane nap ;
 þane dringe dringþ vp.
And a3[ein]es me hine fulþ ;
 and takeþ his ivere.
Þis beoþ þe lawes ;
 ine saxlonde.
þis ihorde vortiger ;
 of eche vuele he was war.
And saide hit on Bruttesse ;
 ne couþe he noht on CEnglisse.
Mayde Rowenne ;
 dring bloþeliche þanne.
Ðat maide drong vt þat win ;
 and lette don oþer þarin.
And bitahte þan kinge ;
 and he hit vp swipte.
And þorh þisne ilke game ;
 þe lawe come to londe.
wassayl and dringhayl ;
 þat mani men lofuieþ.
Ðe faire Rowenne ;
 sat bi þan kinge.
þe king hire Ʒeorne biheold ;
 Ʒeo was him leof on heorte.
Ofte he hire custe ;
 and ofte he hire clupte.
Ðe worse was þare wel neh ;
 þat to soche game his wel sleh.
þe worse þat neuere ne doþ god ;
 he meýnde þare þes kinges mod

he murnede ful swiðe ;
to habben þat mæiden to wiue.

þat wes swide ladlic þing ;
þat þe cristine king.

295 luuede þat haðene maide ;
leoden to hærne.

þ-maiden wes þan kinge leof ;
æfne also his aʒene lif.

he bad hengest his dring ;
ʒiuen him þat maide child.

Hengest funde an his ræd ;
to don þ-þe king him bed.

he ʒef him Rouwenne ;
wimmon swiðe hende.

þe king mornede swiþe ;
for habbe hire to wifue.

þat was swiþe loþlich þing ;
þat þe cristene king.

louede þat Maide heaþene ;
folk to harme.

To Hengest bad þe king ;
þat he þat maide ʒefue him.

Hengest funde on his Reade ;
don þat þe king him beade.

He ʒef him Rowenne ;
womman swiþe hende.

XV. ORM

THE ORMULUM

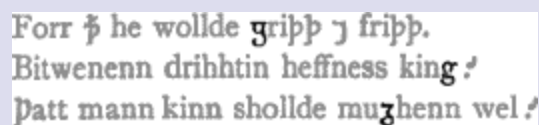
“Junius 1, Bodleian Library, Oxford: an oblong folio, written in double columns on 118 leaves of parchment varying considerably in size, the largest being 508 × 200 mm.; about 1210 A.D., and an autograph, but corrected by a second and third hand.”

Further detail from Notes volume:

“Orm supplemented the current graphic methods by devices of his own. Thus he systematically doubled a consonant after a short vowel in a closed syllable, so *tunnderrstanndenn* 109. Whether he meant thereby to indicate shortness of the vowel or length of the consonant is disputed.... Where the consonant after an open syllable is in fact short, Orm often places a breve over the preceding short vowel.... Likewise he uses very seldom an almost horizontal accent to indicate vowel length, as *á* 174, but more frequently, as if to emphasize his warning against possible error, doubles it ... even for greater insistence trebles it ... mostly before final *t*.

“Furthermore, Orm invented a special symbol {g} with a flat top projecting on both sides for the guttural stop *g*, reserving the continental *g* for the *dz*h sound in such words as *egge* (edge), *leggen*, *seggen*: the latter occurs in this extract only in *gluternesse* 167, and that by mistake.”

This page image shows all three “*g*” forms, with Orm’s unique {*g*} in the first line, and insular “*g*” in the third. Note that the ordinary (“continental”) “*g*” form is regularly used in “*ng*”.



Forr þ he wolde griþþ 7 friþþ.
Bitwenenn drihhtin heffness king.
Þatt mann kinn sholde mug'henn wel.

In this e-text, ordinary capital *G* was used for capital insular *g* (ȝ), because font support for the correct form □ (hex A77D) is extremely limited. The printed linenotes almost always use yogh (ȝ) for insular *g* (ȝ), plain *g* for Orm’s unique {*g*}. Lines have been split at the caesura for cleaner display.

F orrþrihht anan se iesu crist.

Wass borenn off hiss moderr ;

ȝho wand himm sone iwinndeclút.

7 leȝȝde himm inn a`n´ cribbe.

Acc uss birrþ wĭtenn þ-he warrþ.
All wiþþ hiss aȝhenn wille.

Vnnorne. 7 wrecche 7 usell child ;
Inn ure mennisscnesse :

5 Forr þ-he wollde inn heffness ærd ;
Vss alle makenn riche.

¶ 7 he þ-all þiss middellærd.

Onn alle wise shrideþþ ;
He wollde wundenn | ben forr uss.
I wrecche winnde clutess.

Forr þ-he wollde shridenn uss ;
Wiþþ hefennlike wæde·

¶ 7 he þ-all þiss werelld shop·

7 alle shaffte stereþþ ;
10 He lēt himm baþe bindenn her.

Wiþþ bandess fēt 7 hande ;
Forr þ-he wollde unnbindenn uss.
Off hellepiness bandess.

¶ 7 heffne. 7 lifft. 7 land. 7 sæ.

Wiþþ {g}oddcunndnesse filleþþ ;
Þatt illke child. tatt tær wass leȝȝd.

Inn an full naru cribbe ;
Forr þ-he wollde ȝifenn uss.
All heffness rume riche.

15 ¶ 7 he þ-fedeþþ enn{g}le þed.

7 alle cwike shaffte ;
He laȝȝ all alls hiss wille wass.
Biforenn asse i cribbe.

Swa summ he wære ȝifenn himm ;
To wurrþenn himm to fode.

5. *heffness*] erasure
of *o* after *he*; so also
in *hefennlike*, l. 8;
werelld, l. 9, &c.;
see notes.

13. *full naru* over
an erasure.

Forr þ he wollde brinn{g}enn uss ;
Vpp inntill heffness blisse.
7 gifenn uss himm sellfenn þær ;
Wiþþ enn{g}less eche fode.
20 ¶ Þuss {g}odess sune allmahhtiȝ {g}odd ;
Warrþ wrecche mann onn erþe.
Forr swa to brinngenn mannkinn onn ;
To ȝernenn affterr litell.
Forr þ he lufeþþ alle þa ;
þ hise laȝhess haldenn.
7 lufenn forr þe lufe off himm ;
To libbenn her onn erþe.
Full wrecchelike inn uselldom ;
Off metess. 7 off clapess.
25 ¶ 7 tatt te laferd iesu crist.
Wass leȝȝd inn asse cribbe.
Þatt tacneþþ uss. þ he comm her.
To wurrþenn mann onn erþe.
Wiþþ mannkinn. þ wass stunnt. 7 dill ;
7 skill læs swa summ asse.
¶ 7 asse. þohh itt litell be.
Itt hafeþþ mikell afell.
To berenn upp well mikell sæm ;
Giff mann itt doþ þæronne.
30 7 swa wass neh all follc þ daȝȝ.
Þatt crist comm her to manne.
Neh all itt wass þa strang inoh.
To þewwtenn lape {g}astess.
To berenn upp þ lape sæm ;
To don all þeȝȝre wille.

¶ 7 þurh þ {g}odd wass wurrþenn mann.

Forr ure miccle nede ;

Þurh þ wass he. `þatt witt tu wel.´

All wiþþ hiss lefe wille.

Niþpredd. 7 wannsedd wunnderriḡ.

7 laḡhedd inn himm | sellfenn.

36 Forr o þ hallf þ he wass mann ;

Mann mihhte himm fon. 7 pinenn.

Wiþþ hāt. 7 kald. wiþþ nesshe. 7 harrd·

Wiþþ pine off þrisst. 7 hunngerr.

7 cwellenn himm mann mihhte wel ;

Inn ure mennisscnesse.

7 {g}odd wass wurrþenn swa forr uss ;

Gēt lasse þann an enn{g}ell.

40 Forr mann ne maḡḡ nohht enn{g}ell sen ;

Ne tākenn himm ne bindenn.

Ne pinenn himm. ne cwellenn himm.

Forr he ne deḡeþþ næfre.

Acc drihhtin {g}odd warrþ her forr þe

Gēt lasse þann hiss enn{g}ell.

7 lahḡhre inoh. forr þi þatt he ;

þe wollde ḡifenn bisne.

þatt te birrþ aḡḡ þe sellfenn her ;

Þurh soþ mecnesse laḡhenn.

45 7 lætenn swiþe unorneliḡ ;

7 litell off þe sellfenn.

þ

¶

att hirdess wokenn o þat nahht.

þatt crist wass borenn onne ;

34. *þatt witt tu wel*
substituted at
bottom of column
for *þatt seḡḡ þe*
boc in text.
37. *kald* over an
erasure.

41. *pinenn*] *i* over
an erasure. *næfre]*
r changed into *n* by
erasure.
42. *godd warrþ*
over an erasure.
45. *unorneliḡ* with
erasure over the
first *n*.

Ðatt wass swa *summ* hiss wille wass.
 Forr þ-itt shollde tacnenn.
 Ðatt he forrþi wass wurrþenn mann ;
 Forr þ-he wollde sammnenn.
 An flocc off menn till cristenndom ;
 7 till þe rihhte læfe.
 50 Ðatt sholldenn wurrþenn hise shep ;
 Þurh here unnshapiǵnesse.
 7 sholldenn habbenn oferr *hemm* ;
 Bisscopess. prestess. dæcness
 Forr þ-teǵǵ sholldenn hirdess ben ;
 To ǵemenn *hemm*. 7 {g}ætenn.
 7 ec forr þ-he wollde ben.
 Himm sellf ūt numenn hirde.
 55 Swa þ-he wollde hiss aǵhenn lif ;
 Forr hise shep forrlætenn.
 ¶ Ðatt {g}odess enn{g}ell *comm* o nihht.
 Swa *summ* ðe {g}oddspell kiþeþþ.
 To spekenn wiþþþa wake menn.
 Ðatt wokenn heore faldess ;
 7 tatt he *comm* þ-nihht till *hemm*.
 Wiþþ heoffness lihht. 7 leome.
 7 tatt teǵǵ wærenn forr þ-lihht.
 7 forr ðatt enn{g}less sihhþe.
 Forr dredde swiþe fasste anan.
 Swa *summ* þe {g}oddspell kiþeþþ ;
 60 7 ec þatt {g}odess enn{g}ell toc.
 To frofrenn *hemm* wiþþ worde.
 All þ-wass don | þurh iesu *crist*.
 Forr mikell þin{g} to tacnenn.
 ¶ Itt tacneþþ uss þatt ure {g}odd.
 Well offte senndeþþ enn{g}less.

Inn till þiss middellærd. tatt iss.
 All full off þessterrnesse :
 Þatt iss off all þ-ifell iss ;
 Inn alle kinne sinne ;
 65 Itt tacneþþ þ-he senndeþþ hemm ;
 Inn till þiss þeossterrnesse.
 To frofrenn þa þ-wakenn wel ;
 Onnǵæness laþe {g}astess.
 7 stanndenn inn to shildenn hemm ;
 Fra deofless swikedomess.
 7 all þ-flocc þ-hemm iss sētt ;
 To ǵemenn. 7 to {g}ætenn.
 To frofrenn swillke senndeþþ {g}odd.
 Enn{g}less. 7 hallǵhe sawless.
 70 7 aǵǵ þeǵǵ cumenn dun till þa ;
 Wiþþ heoffness lihht. 7 leome.
 Þatt iss wiþþ witt. 7 {g}od innsihht ;
 Inn alle kinne þin{g}e.
 Forr drihhtin ǵifeþþ her hiss þeww ;
 {g}od witt. 7 mahht. 7 wille.
 To stanndenn ǵæn þe laþe {g}ast.
 7 ǵæn all þ-he læreþþ.
 Acc aǵǵ þeǵǵ sinndenn þohh swa þehh ;
 Well swiþe sare offdredde.
 75 Off domess daǵǵes starrke dom ;
 7 off þe demess irre.
 All all swa summ þa wǣke menn ;
 Well swiþe offdredde wærenn.
 Off heoffness brihhte lihht 7 lem ;
 7 off þ-enn{g}less sihhþe.

Ace hihht. 7 hope o drihhtin {g}odd.
 7 onn hiss mildheorrtnesse ;
 Þatt frofreþþ hemm. 7 beldeþþ *hemm* ;
 To follǵhenn {g}odess lare.
 80 To fandenn ǵiff þeǵǵ muǵhenn swa ;
 ðe demess are winnenn.
 7 tatt wass uss bitacnedd wel ;
 Þurh ðatt tatt {g}odess enn{g}ell.
 Toc sone anan wiþþ milde word ;
 ða wāke menn to frofrenn.
 Forr þ-he wisse wel þ-teǵǵ ;
 Off *himm* forrdredde wærenn.
 Forr {g}odess enn{g}ell frofreþþ mann ;
 Giff þ-he seþ *himm* færedd.
 85 Forr {g}odess enn{g}ell iss full mec ;
 7 soffte. 7 milde. 7 bliþe.
 ¶ 7 defell iss all full off niþ ;
 7 full off {g}rammcunndnesse.
 7 full off hēte towarrd mann ;
 7 full off modiznesse
 7 ǵiff he seþ þe mann forrdredd ;
 He wile *himm* skerrenn mare.
 7 ræfenn *himm* hiss rihhte witt ;
 7 shetenn inn hiss herrte. |
 Acc whas itt iss þ-wæpnedd iss.
 Wiþþ fulle trowwþe o criste ;
 91 Þohh þ-he {g}risliǵ defell seo.
 Niss he rihht nohht forrfæredd.
 ¶ Þatt enn{g}ell seǵǵde ðatt he wass ;
 Þa cumenn forr to kiþenn.

O {g}odess hallfe þær till hemm.
 A`n´ swiþe mikell blisse.
 Þatt shollde ben till all þe follc.
 Þatt seȝȝde he forr þ-tanne ;
 95 Wass cumenn i þiss middellærd.
 Full mikell blisse. 7 sellðe.
 Till alle `þa´ þ-sholldenn wel ;
 O {g}odess sune lefenn.
 O iesu crist. tatt borenn wass.
 þ-illke nahht to manne.
 ¶ He seȝȝde þ-te laferrd crist.
 Wass borenn her to manne.
 Nohht o þe nahht. acc o þe daȝȝ.
 Forr mikell þing to tacnenn.
 100 Forr daȝȝess lihht bitacneþþ uss ;
 All eche lifess blisse
 7 nahht bitacneþþ all þ-wa ;
 Ðiss inn helle pine.
 7 crist wass borenn i þiss lif ;
 To lesenn uss off helle.
 Forr þ-he wollde ȝifenn uss ;
 Wiþþ enn{g}less eche blisse.
 ¶ 7 tatt wass uss bitacnedd ec.
 Ðurh þ-tatt {g}odess enn{g}ell.
 105 Wass awwnedd till ða wāke menn ;
 Wiþþ heffness lihht 7 leme.
 Forr {g}odess sune iesu crist ;
 Wass wurrþenn mann onn erþe.
 To ȝifenn heoffness lihht. 7 lem ;
 Ð-folc. þ-shollde himm follȝhenn.

105. *awwnedd* in
 MS.

¶ Þatt {g}odd allmahhtiȝ wurrþenn wass.
 Gun{g} child *inn* ure kinde.
 7 wrecche child. off wrecche kinn ;
 ðatt doþ uss tunnderrstanndenn.
 110 Þatt uss birrþ mikell lufenn crist.
 7 lofenn *himm* 7 wurrþenn.
 Off þatt he wolde *himm* sellfenn swa ;
 Forr ure lufe laȝhenn.
 7 off þatt he warrþ wrecche mann ;
 Forr uss to makenn riche.
 Wiþþ enn{g}less upp inn heoffness ærd ;
 Wiþþutenn ende i blisse.
 Annd þurh þ-tatt tær awwnedd wass.
 An here off {g}odess enn{g}less.
 115 Þatt time þ-te laferd crist.
 Wass borenn her to manne ;
 Þurh þ-wass uss don þær full wel.
 To sen. 7 tunnderrstanndenn.
 Þatt enn{g}less stanndenn aȝȝ occ aȝȝ.
 To lofenn {g}odd 7 wurrþenn.
 ¶ 7 þurh þ-illke wass uss ec.
 Don full wel tunnderrstanndenn.
 Þatt uss birrþ lofenn drihhtin aȝȝ ;
 Wiþþ innwarrd herrtess tunge.
 120 7 þannkenn *himm* þ-miccle {g}od ;
 Þatt he doþ uss onn erþe.
 ¶ 7 þurh þ-illke wass uss ec.
 Don full wel tunnderrstanndenn.
 Þatt crist all enn{g}le þede kin{g}.
 Wass borenn her to manne.
 Alls iff he ȝæn þe laþe {g}ast.
 Wiþþ hære wollde fihhtenn.

To winnenn adam. 7 hiss kinn ;
 V̇t off þe defless walde.
 125 7 settenn enn{g}less oferr hemm ;
 To ȝemenn hemm 7 {g}ætenn.
 7 forr to shildenn hemm onnȝæn ;
 ðe deofless lape wiless.
 ¶ Annd {g}odess enn{g}less wærenn þa ;
 Well swiþe glade wurrþenn.
 Off ðatt tatt {g}odd wass wurrþenn mann.
 Forr þ-teȝȝ wisstenn alle.
 Þatt teȝȝre {g}en{g}e shollde ben ;
 Wiþþ {g}ode sawless ekedd.
 130 7 wurrþedd ec. 7 all forrþi ;
 Þeȝȝ wærenn swiþe bliþe.
 7 all forr þi þeȝȝ sun{g}enn þa.
 ðiss san{g} wiþþ mikell blisse.
 Si drihhtin upp inn heffness ærd ;
 Wurrþshipe. 7 loff. 7 wullderr.
 7 upponn erþe {g}riþþ. 7 friþþ ;
 Þurh {g}odess mildherrtnesse.
 Till iwhillc mann þ-habbenn shall ;
 {g}od herte 7 `aȝȝ´ {g}od wille.
 135 ¶ Þiss sun{g}enn þeȝȝ. forrþi þ-teȝȝ.
 Full wel þær unnderrstodenn.
 Þatt teȝȝre {g}en{g}e shollde ben ;
 Þurh hallȝhe sawles. ekedd.
 Þurh whatt biforenn drihhtin {g}odd.
 Giff þ-itt waxenn mihhte.
 Wurrþshipe 7 wullderr shollde ben ;
 Swa summ itt waxenn wære.

124. walde] After l,
 l erased.

134. aȝȝ added in
 margin and *god*
 corrected out of
gode, so too in
 ll. 147, 154.

7 ec forr þatt teǵǵ wistenn wel.
 Þatt {g}odd *comm* her to manne.
 140 Forr þ he wollde {g}riþþ 7 friþþ.
 7 soþ sahhtnesse settenn.
 Bitwenenn drihhtin heffness king ;
 7 mannkinn her onn erþe.
 Þatt mann kinn shollde muǵhenn wel ;
 Vpp cumenn *inn* till heffne.
 Þatt heffness here mihhte swa ;
 Þurh hallǵhe sawless waxenn.
 Þurh whatt bi forenn drihhtin {g}odd ;
 Wurrþshipe waxenn shollde.
 145 Giff þ himm mihhte waxenn ohht ;
 7 wurrþenn bettre 7 mare.
 ¶ Þatt {g}riþþ wass sett till alle þa.
 Swa *summ* þe {g}oddspell kipeþþ.
 Þatt sholl | denn wurrþenn {g}odemenn ;
 7 habbenn `aǵǵ´ {g}odwille.
 Till þa þ sholldenn unnderrfon ;
 Wiþþ blisse cristess come.
 7 nohht till þa þ sholldenn *himm* ;
 Forrhoǵhenn 7 forrwerppenn.
 150 Forr niss nohht {g}odess {g}riþþ wiþþ þa ;
 Ðwiþþrenn {g}odd onnǵæness.
 Acc helle wawenn iss till þa ;
 All affterr þeǵǵre wrihhte.
 ¶ 7 her mann unnderrstanndenn maǵǵ ;
 Whillc mann iss drihhtin cweme.
 Þatt illke mann iss drihhtin lef ;
 Ðhafaþþ {g}ode wille.

Forr whase itt iss þatt illke mann
 Þatt hafeþþ `aʒʒ´ {g}od wille
 155 Þatt illke mann ne sinnʒheþþ nohht.
 Ne {g}illteþþ hise þannkess.
 Ne towarrd {g}odd· ne towarrd mann ;
 Giff þ he maʒʒ himm lokenn.
 7 ʒiff þ iss þ he missdop.
 Onn aniʒ kinne wise ;
 Itt reweþþ himm. 7 sone anan ;
 He stannt itt inn to betenn.
 ¶ Þatt {g}odess enn{g}ell comm o nahht.
 Wiþþ heffness lihht onn erþe ;
 160 Þatt tacneþþ þ-tiss middellærd.
 Wass full off þessternesne.
 Þurh illkess kinness hæþenndom.
 Inn iwhillc unnclænnesse ;
 Þatt time þ-te laferd crist.
 Wass borenn her to manne.
 To ʒifenn heffness lihht. 7 lem ;
 Ðfolc þ-sholde himm cwemenn.
 ¶ 7 tatt tatt enn{g}ell nohht ne comm.
 Till kin{g}ess ne till erless.
 165 Ne till þ-laþe riche flocc.
 Þatt follʒheþþ modiʒnesse ;
 Þatt dop uss tunnderrstanndenn wel ;
 Ðdrihhtin {g}odd forrwerrpeþþ.
 All modiʒleʒʒc. 7 {g}reditleʒʒc :
 7 irre. 7 gluternesne.
 7 all þ-follʒheþþ horedom.
 7 swikedom onn erþe.
 Þatt mann maʒʒ findenn allre mast.
 I þa þ-sinndenn riche.

159. *enngell comm*
o nahht over an
 erasure.

170 þatt {g}odess enn{g}ell awwnedd wass.

In aness weress hewe ;

Þatt wass forrþi þ-enn{g}ell maðð.

Wipþ hiss drihhtiness wille.

Himm awwnenn alls he wære a mann.

I manness limess alle.

I bodið. þ-he doþ himm inn ;

Off hefennlike kinde.

¶ 7 {g}odd wipþ enn{g}less gife uss. á.

To brukenn heffness blisse.´

Amæn.

170. *þatt*] between
þ and *a* an erasure.

174. Added
lengthwise on the
margin.

XVI. SAWLES WARDE

“i. Bodleian 34, Oxford (B); on vellum, 165 × 120 mm.; written in one hand throughout about 1210 A.D.... It has lost two leaves after f. 80, which is very faint and defective. Entries in fourteenth-century hands connect it with Ledbury, Godstow, and Magna Coworne (Much Cowarne) in Herefordshire. The text is printed from this manuscript up to its end at 127/4.

“The writing is sometimes difficult to decipher; the letters are often crowded and hesitating, a, e, o are sometimes hard to distinguish. Doubts are permissible in the following cases, hwen *or* hwon 118/24, ihaten *or* ihoten 37, hondon *or* honden 51; in sent 55, the last letter wavers between t and d; in ȝemelese 56, ȝ appears to have been corrected out of g; after mei 60, there is a half-formed c; under the second o of preoouin 72, there is what looks like a casual pen mark, not a dot of erasure; in seoueuald 287, d is corrected out of t, or the reverse.

“ii. Royal 17 A 27, British Museum (R); on vellum, 160 × 117 mm.; early thirteenth century. Has all the pieces in B except Hali Meidenhad, with the addition of an incomplete copy of the Oreisun of Seinte Marie (printed in OEH i., p. 305). This manuscript supplies the end here from 127/4.

“iii. Cotton Titus D 18, British Museum (T). See [IX, [Ancrene Wisse](#)].”

her bigineð ; sawles warde.

Si sciret paterfamilias *qua* hora fur uenturus
esset ; vigilaret utique 7 non sineret perfodi
domum suam. Ure lauereð i þe godspel teacheð us þurh abisne. hu
we ahen wearliche to biwiten us seoluen wið þe unwiht of helle. 7 wið
his wernches. 5 3ef þes lauereð wiste he seið. hwenne 7 hwuch time. þe
þeof walde cume to his hus ; he walde wakien. ne nalde he nawt þolien
þe þeof forte breoken hire. Ðis hus þe ure lauereð spekeð of ; is seolf þe
mon inwið þe monnes wit. I þis hus. is þe huse lauereð. ant te fulitohe
wif ; mei beon wil ihaten. þ-ga þe hus efter hire ; ha diht hit al to
wundre. 10 bute wit ase lauereð chasti hire þe betere. 7 bineome hire
muchel of þ-ha walde. ant tah walde al hire hird folhin hire ouer al ;
gef wit ne forbude ham. for alle hit beoð untohene. 7 rechelese hinen ;
bute 3ef he ham rihte. Ant hwucche beoð þeos hinen ; Summe beoð
wiðvten. 7 summe wið innen. þeo wiðvten beoð. þe monnes fif 15
wittes. Sihðe. 7 herunge. smechnge. 7 smeallunge. 7 euch limes
felunge. þeos beoð hinen vnder wit. as under huse lauereð. 7 hwer se he
is 3emeles ; nis hare nan þe ne feareð ofte
untoheliche. 7 gulteð ilome. oðer ifol semblant ;
oder in vuel dede. In wið beoð his hinen. in se
moni mislich þonc to cwemen wel þe husewif ; a3ein godes 20 wille. 7
swerieð somet reaðliche. þ-efter hire hit schal [f. 72 v] gan. þah we hit
ne here nawt ; we mahen `ipþlen´ hare nurhð. 7 hare untohe bere. a þet
hit cume forð. 7 ba wið eie. 7 wið luue tuhte ham þe betere. Ne bið
neauer his hus for þeos hinen wel iwist. for hwen þ-he slepe. oðer
ohwider from hame. þ-is hwen mon for3et his wit. 25 7 let ham i
wurðen. ah ne bihoueð hit nawt. þ-tis hus beo irobbet. for þer is inne þe
tre[sor] þ-godd 3ef him seolf fore. þ-is monnes sawle. forte breoke þis
hus efter þis tresor. þ-godd bohte mid his deað. 7 lette lif o rode ; is

17. *hwer*] *r* over *ȝ*.
37. After *gastelich*, *e*
erased.

moni þeof abuten ba bi dei 7 bi niht. vnseheliche gasttes wið alle
 unwreaste þeawes. 7 azein euch god þeaw. þe biwiteð 30 iþis hus godes
 deore castel . vnder wittes wissunge þis huse lauerd. is eauer hire
 unþeaw forte sechen in3onge abute þe wahes to amurðrin hire þrinne.
 þheued þrof is þe feont. þe meistreð ham alle azeines him 7 his keis.
 þe husebonde þis wit. warneð his hus þus. vre lauerd haueð ileanett
 him froure of his dehtren. þbeoð to 35 vnderstonden þe fowr heued
 þeawes. þe earste is warschipe icleopet. ant te oþer is ihaten gasteli`c`h
 strengðe. 7 te þridde is meað. rihtwisnesse þe feorðe. **W**it þe husbonde
 godes cunestable cleopeð warschipe [f. 73 r] forð. 7 makid hire
 durewart. þe warliche loki hwam ha leote in 7 ut. 7 of feor bihalde alle
 þe cuminde. hwuch beo wurðe 40 in3onge to habben ; oðer beon
 bisteken þrute. Strengðe stont nest hire. þ3ef ei wule in ; warschipes
 vnþonkes. warni strengðe fore. þis hire suster ; 7 heo hit ut warpe. þe
 þridde suster þis meað. hire he makeð mestre ouer his willesfule hirð
 þwe ear of speken. þha leare ham mete . þme meosure hat. þe middel
 of twa uueles . for 45 þis þeaw in euch stude 7 tuht forte halden. 7
 hateð ham alle þnan of ham azein hire ; nohwer wid vnmeoð ; ne ga
 ouer mete. þe feorðe suster rihtwisnesse. sit on hest as deme . 7 beateð
 þeo þe azulteð. 7 cruneð þeo þe wel doð. 7 demeð euchan his dom
 efter his rihte. for dret of hire nimeð his hirð euch efter þhe is warde
 to witene . þe 50 ehnen hare. þe muð his. þe earen hare. þe hondon
 hare. 7 euch alswa of þe oþre wit þonont him ne schal nan unþeaw
 cumen iN.

As þis is ido þus. 7 is al stille þrinne ;
 warschipe þáá is waker is offearet lest sum for
 truste him. 7 feole oslepe. 7 for3eme his warde. 7
 sent ham. in a sonde. þha wel cnaweð. of feorren icumen. forte 55
 offearen þeo þe beoð [f. 73 v] ouer hardi. 7 þeo þe 3emelese beoð ;
 halden ham wakere. he is underuon in. 7 swiðe bihalden of ham alle.
 for lonc he is. 7 leane. 7 his leor deaðlich. 7 blac 7 elheowet. 7 euch
 her þunc`h`eð þstont in his heued up ; warschipe hat him tellen

58. Before *lean*, *feier*
 erased.
 73. *enbreueðt* MS.

biuoren. hwet he beo 7 hweonene he *comme* 7 hwet he þer seche. Ne
 mei 60 ich he seið. nohwer spoken. bute ich habbe god lust ; lustnið
 me þenne. fearlac ich hatte. ant am deaðes sonde. 7 deaðes
 munegunge. 7 am icumen biuore hire to warnin ow of hire cume.
 warschipe þ-best con bisetten hire wordes. 7 ec hire werkes ; spekeð
 for ham alle. 7 freineð hweonene he cume. 7 hwuch hird ha leade.
 fearlac 65 hire ontswereð. Ich nat nawt þe time ; for ha ne seide hit me
 nawt. ah eauer lokið hwenne. for hire wune is to cumen bi stale
 ferliche 7 unmundlunge hwen me least weneð. of hire hird þ-tu
 easkest. Ich þe ondswerie. ha lihteð hwer se ha eauer kimeð wið a
 þusent deoflen. 7 euch an bereð a gret boc al of sunnen iwriten wið
 swarte smeale 70 leattres. 7 an unrude raketehe gledread of fure. forte
 binden 7 to drahen in to inwarde helle. hwuch se he mei preouin þurh
 his boc þ-is on euch sunne enbre[f. 74 r]uet. þ-he wið wil. oðer wið
 word. oðer wið werc. wrahte in al his lif siðe. bute þ-he haueð i bet
 earþon wið soð schrift. 7 wið deadbote. ant warschipe hire easkeð.
 Hweonene 75 cumest tu fearlac deaðes munegunge. Ich cume he seið
 of helle. Of helle ha seið warschipe. 7 hauest tu isehen helle? 3e seið
 fearlac witerliche. ofte 7 ilome. Nu seið þenne warschipe. forþi trowðe
 treoweliche tele us hwuch is helle. 7 hwet tu hauest isehen þrin. ant ich
 he seið fearlac omi trowðe bluðeliche. nawt tah efter þ-hit is. for þ-ne
 mei na 80 tunge `tellen´. ah efter þ-ich mei 7 con ; þer towart ich chulle
 readien.

Helle is [wid] wiðute met. 7 deop wiðute grunde. ful of brune
 uneuenlich . for ne mei nan eorðlich fur euenin þer towart. ful of
 stench unþolelich. for ne mahte in eorðe na cwic þinge hit þolien. ful
 of sorhe untalelich. for ne mei na muð for wrecchedom 85 ne for wa ;
 rikenin hit ne tellen. Se þicke is þrinne þe þosternesse ; þ-me hire mei
 grapin. for þ-fur. ne 3eueð na liht. ah blent ham þe ehnen. þe þer beoð
 wið a smorðrinde smeke smeche forcuðest. 7 tah iþ-ilke swarte
 þeosternesse swarte þinges ha iseoð as deoflen þ-ham meallið 7 derueð
 áá 7 dreccheð wið alles cunnes pinen. 7 iteilede 90 draken *gri`s´liche*
 ase deoflen þe forswolheð ham ihal. 7 speoweð ham [f. 74 v] eft ut

biuoren 7 bihinden. oðer hwile torendeð ham 7 tocheoweð ham euch greot. ant heo eft iwurðeð hal. to a swuch bale bute bote as ha ear weren. ant ful wel ha iseoð ham to grisle 7 to grure. 7 to echen hare pine. þe laðe helle wurmes. tadden 7 froggen. 95 þe freoteð ham ut te ehnen. 7 te nease gristles. ant snikeð in. 7 ut neddren. 7 eauraskes. nawt ilich þeose her ; ah hundredet siðe *grislu*ker et muð. 7 et earen. ed ehnen. 7 ed neauele. ant ed te breoste holke as meaðen iforrotet flesch eauer³ete þickest. þer is remunge iþe brune. 7 toðes hechelunge iþe snawi weattres. ferliche ha flutteð from þe 100 heate ; into þe chele. Ne neauer nuten ha of þeos twa ; hweðer ham þuncheð wurse. for eiðer is unþolelich. ant iþis ferliche monge þe leatere þurh þe earre derueð þe mare. þ-fur ham forbearneð al to colen calde. þ-pich ham forwalleð aðet ha beon formealte. 7 eft acwikieð anan to drehen al þ-ilke ; ant muchedeale wurse á wiðuten 105 ende. Ant tis ilke unhope is ham meast pine. þ-nan naueð neauer mare hope of nan acouerunge. Ah aren sikere of euch uuel to þurhleasten iwa from world in to worlde áá on echnesse. Euch aþrusmeð oðer. 7 euch is oðres pine. Ant euchan heateð oðer. 7 him seoluen as [f. 75 r] þe blake deouel. 7 eauer se ha i þis world luueden 110 ham mare ; se ha þer heatieð ham swiðere. 7 eiðer curseð oðer. 7 fret of þe oðres earen. 7 te nease alswa. Ich habbe bigunne to tellen of þing þ-ich ne mahte nawt bringe to eni ende. þah ich hefde a þusent tungen of stele 7 talde aðet ha weren alle forwerede. Ah þencheð nu her þurh hwuch þe measte pine beo ; for þe leaste pine is 115 se heard þ-hefde a mon islein ba mi feader. 7 mi moder ant al þe ende of mi cun. 7 ido me seoluen al þe scheome 7 te hearm þ-cwic mon mahte þolien. 7 ich isehe þes mon i þe ilke leaste pine. þ-ich iseh in helle ; Ich walde 3ef hit mahte beon. þolien a þusent deaðes to a rudden him ut þrof. swa is þe sihðe *grislich* 7 reowðful to bihalden. 120 for þah neauer nere nan oðer pine bute to iseon eauer þe unseli gastes. 7 hare *grisliche* schape. biseon on hare *grimfule*. 7 grurefule nebbes. 7 heren hare rarunge. 7 hu ha wið hokeres edwiteð 7 up breideð euchan his sunnen. þis schenðlac 7 te grure of ham were unimete pine ; 7 hure

þolien 7 abeoren hare unirude duntles wið 125 mealles istelet. 7 wið hare eawles gledreade hare dustlunges. as þah hit were a pilche clut euchan towart oðer imisliche pinen. O helle deaðes hus. wununge of wanunge. of grure ant of granunge. heatel [f. 75 v] ham. 7 heard wan. of alle wontreaðes. buri of bale. 7 bold of eauer euch bitternessse . þu laðest lont of alle. þu dorc stude ifullet 130 of alle dreorinesses. Ich cwakie of grisle 7 of grure. 7 euch ban schekeð me. 7 euch her me rueð up of þi munegunge. for nis þer na steuene bituhhe þe forðemde bute wumme. 7 wa is me. 7 wa beo þe. 7 wa beo þe. wa ha 3eieð. 7 wa ha habbeð ne of al þeauer wa is ; ne schal ham neauer wontin. þe swuch wununge of earneð. for ei hwilinde 135 blisse her o þisse worlde ; wel were him 3ef þhe neauer ibore nere. bi þis 3e mahen sumdel witen hwuch is helle. for i wis ich habbe þrin isehen a þusent siðe wurse. 7 from þeonne kimeð deað wið a þusent deoflen hiderwart as ich seide. ant ich com þus quoð fearlac forte warnin ow fore ; 7 tellen ow þeos tidinges. 140

133. *bicuhhe* MS.

Nv lauerd godd quoð warschipe wardi us 7 werie. 7 rihte us 7 reade hwet us beo to donne. ant we beon þe warre 7 wakere to witen us on euch half under godes wengen. 3ef we wel

142. *donne*] the second *n* corr. out of *t*.
145. *of* over *a* MS.

werieð 7 witeð ure hus 7 godes deore tresor þhe haueð bitaht us ; cume deað hwen he wule. Ne þurue we nowðer beon `of`dred for hire. ne 145 for helle. for ure deað bið deore godd 7 in3ong in to heouene. of þeos fikeline world ; ne of hire false blisse : ne neome we neauer 3eme. for al þis on eorðe. nis bute as a schadewe ; for al wurðeð [f. 76 r] to noht bute þe deore tresor godes deorewurðe feh þis us bitaht to witene. Ich habbe þeruore sar care for ich iseo seið warschipe hu þe 150 unwhiht wið his ferd ase liun iburst. 3eað abuten ure hus sechinde 3eornliche hu he hit forswolhe. 7 tis ich mei seið warschipe warnin ow of his lað 7 for his wrenches. ah ich ne mei nawt a3eines his strengðe.

Do nu quoð strengðe. warschipe suster þte limpet to þe 7 warne us of his wiheles. for of

159. *3enis* MS.

al his strengðe ne drede 155 we nawiht. for nis his strengðe noht wurð
 bute hwerse he ifindeð eðeliche. 7 wake unwarnede of treowe bileaue.
 þe apostle seið. Etstont. þen feont. 7 he flið anan riht. schulde we
 þenne fleon him? 3e nis godd ure scheld. 7 alle beoð ure wepnen of his
 deore *grace*. ant godd is on ure half. 7 stont bi us ifehte. 3ef he schute
 160 towart me wið weole 7 wunne of þe world. wið este of flesches
 lustes. of þulliche nesche wepnen ich mahte carien summes weis. ah ne
 mei me na þing heardes offearen. ne nowcin. ne na wone falsi min
 heorte ne wursi mi bileaue towart him þ-3eueð me alle mine strengðen.

For ba me ah. *quoð* meað. ant for heart of
 nowcin. 7 for wone of 165 wunne dreden. 7
 carien. for moni for to muchel heard of wa þ-he
 d`r`eheð. for3et ure lauerd. ant ma þah for nesche ant for flesches
 licunge for [f. 76 v] 3emeð ham ofte. bituhhen heard 7 nesche. bituhhe
 wa of þis world ant to muche wunne. bituhhe muchel 7 lutel is in euch
 worldlich þing þe middel wei 3uldene. 3ef we hire haldeð 170 þenne
 gawe sikerliche ne þerf us nowðer for deað ne for deouel dreden. hwet
 se beo of heardes ne drede ich nawiht nesches for ne mei·na wunne. ne
 na flesches licunge ne licomlich este bringe me ouer þe midel of
 measure. 7 of mete.

166. *carien* MS.
 170. *we]* *we]* MS.

Rihtwissnesse spekeð nu. Mi suster ha seið warschipe þe haueð 175
 wit. 7 schad bituhhe god. 7 uuel. 7 wat hwet is in euch þinge to
 cheosen 7 to schunien ; readeð us 7 leareð forte 3eme lutel alle fallinde
 þing. 7 witen warliche þeo þe schulen á lesten. 7 seið as ha soð seið þ-
 þurh unweotenesse ne mei ha nawt sunegin. 7 tah nis nawt siker of þe
 unwihtes strengde as þeo þe halt hire wac 180 þah ha beo muche wurð.
 7 ure alre ehnen demeð hire unmihti onont hire seoluen to etstonden
 wið his. *turnes* 7 deð ase þe wise. Mi suster strengðe is swiðe bald. 7
 seið þ-nawiht heardes ne mei hire offearen. ah þah ha ne trust nawt on
 hire ahne wepnen ; ah deð o goðes *grace* 7 þ-ich demi riht 7 wisdom to
 donne. Mi 185 þridde suster. meað spekeð of þe middel sti. bituhhe riht
 7 luft þ-lut cunnen halden. [f. 77 r] 7 seið inesche ha is bald. 7 heard
 mei hire offearen. 7 forþi ne 3elpeð ha of na sikernesne ant deð as þe
 wise. Mi meoster is to do riht forte demen ant ich deme me seolf þ-ich

þurh me ne do hit nawt ; for al þ-god is of godd þ-we her 190 habbeð.
 Nu is riht þenne þ-we demen us seolf eauer unmihtie to werien 7 to
 witen us oðer ei god to halden wið ute godes helpe. Ðe rihtwise godd
 wule þ-we demen us seolf eðeliche 7 lahe. Ne beo we neauer
 swucche ; for þenne demeð he us mucche wurð 7 gode ant halt for his
 dehtren. for þah mi forme suster war beo of euch uuel ; 195 ant min
 oðer strong beo to 3eines euch nowcin ; ant mi þridde meaðul in alles
 cunnes estes ; 7 ich do riht 7 deme. bute we wið al þis milde beon 7
 meoke ; 7 halden us wake. godd mei mid rihte fordemen us of al þis
 þurh ure prude. ant forþi is riht dom þet we al ure god þonkin him ane.
Wjit þe husebonde godes cunestable hereð 200 alle hare sahen 7
 þonkeð god 3eorne wið swiðe glead heorte of se riche lane as beoð
 þeos sustren his fowr dehtren þ-he haueð ileanet him on helpe forte
 wite wel 7 werien his castel. 7 godes deorewurðe feh. þ-is biloke
 þrinne.

Ðe willesfule husewif halt hire al stille. ant al þ-hird þ-ha wes 205 i
 wunet to dreaien efter hire ; turneð [f. 77 v] ham treowliliche to wit
 hare lauerd. 7 to þeos fowr sustren. **V**mben ane stunde spekeð eft
 warschipe. 7 seið ich iseo a sonde cumen swide gledd icheret. feier 7
 freolich 7 leofliche aturnet. let him in seið wit 3ef godd wule he
 bringeð us gleade tidinges. ant þ-us were mucche 210 neod. for fearlac
 deaðes sonde haueð wið his ; offearet us swiðe mid alle. warschipe let
 him in. 7 he gret wit þen lauerd. 7 al þ-hird seoðen. wið lahhinde
 chere. ant ha 3eldeð him his gretunge. 7 beoð alle ilihtet 7 igleadet ham
 þuncheð of his onsihðe. for al þ-hus schineð. 7 schimmeð of his leome.
 he easkeð ham 3ef ham biluueð to 215 heren him ane hwile. 3e *quoð* ha
 rihtwisnesse. wel us biluueð hit. 7 wel is riht þ-we þe liðeliche lustnin.

Hercnið nu þenne he seið. 7 3eornliche understondeð. [I]ch am
 murðes sonde. 7 munegunge of eche lif. ant liues luue i haten 7
 cume riht from heouene þ-ich habbe isehen nu ant ofte ear 220 þe blisse
 þ-na monnes tunge ne mei of tellen. þe iblescede godd iseh ow

offruhte. 7 sumdel drupnin of þ fearlac talde of deað. 7 of helle. ant sende me to gleadien ow. nawt forþi þ hit ne beo al soð þ he seide. 7 þ schulen alle uuele fondin. 7 ifinden. Ah 3e wið þe fulst of godd ne þurue na þing dreden for he sit on [f. 78 r] he þ is 225 ow on helpe. 7 is al wealdent þ haueð ow to witene.

A seið warschipe welcume liues luue. ant for þe luue of godd seolf 3ef þu eauer sehe him ; tele us sumhwet of him. 7 of his eche blisse. 3e iseoð *quoð* liues luue ; Murhdes sonde. Ich

229. After *habbe*, *him* ofte deleted MS.
234. *mine* above *meine* MS. |
after *habbe*, *ofsee* deleted MS.

habbe isehen him ofte nawt tah alswa as he is ; for a3ein þe brihtnesse 7 te 230 liht of his leor. þe sunne gleam is dosc 7 þuncheð aschadewe. ant forþi ne mahte ich nawt a3ein þe leome of his wlite lokin ne bihalden ; bute þurh a schene schawere bituhhe me 7 him þ schilde *mine* ehnen. Swa ich *habbe* ofte isehen þe hali þrumnesse. feader 7 sune. 7 hali gast. þreo an untodealet. ah lutle hwile ich mahte þolie 235 þe leome. ah *summes* weis ich mahte bihalden ure lauerd ihesu *crist*. godes sune þ bohte us o rode. Hu he sit blisful on his feader riht half þ is al wealdent rixleð i þ eche lit bute linnunge. se unimete feier ; þ te engles ne beoð neauer ful on him to bihalden. ant 3et ich iseh etscene þe studen of his wunden. 7 hu he schaweð ham his 240 feader to cuðen hu he luuede us 7 hu he wes buhsum to him þe sende him swa to alesen us 7 bisecheð him a for moncunnes heale.

Efter him ich iseh on heh ouer alle heouenliche þe eadi meiden his moder marie i nempnet sitten in [f. 78 v] a trone se swiðe briht wid 3immes i stirret. 7 hire wlite *se* weoleful ; þ euch eorðlich liht ; is 245 þeoster þe[r]o 3eines.

245. After *se*, *wle* deleted.
255. *ha*] *ha ha* MS.
266. *cunfessurs*] *urs* above *oręs* MS.

þear ich iseh as ha bit hire deore wurðe sune se 3eornliche. 7 se inwardliche for þeo þ hire seruið. 7 he hire 3etteð blideliche al þ ha bi secheð. Ðet liht þa ich ne mahte lengre þolien ; Ich biseh to þe engles 7

to þe archangles ant to þe oðre ; þe beoð buuen ham. iblescede gastas
 þe beoð a biuore godd 7 seruið him 250 eauer. 7 singeð a unwergeð.
 Nihe wordes þer beoð. ah hu ha beoð iordret 7 sunderliche isette. þe an
 buue þe oðre. 7 euchanes meoster were long to tellen. Se muche
 murhðe ich hefde on hare on sihðe ; þ-ne mahte `ich´ longe hwile elles
 hwider lokin. *Efter* ham ich iseh towart te *patriarches*. 7 te *prophetes*
 þe makied swuch murhðe þ-ha 255 aren nuðe i þ-ilke lont of blisse þ-ha
 hefden of feor igret ear on eorðe 7 seoð nu al þ-isoðet. þ-ha hefden
 longe ear icwiddet of ure lauerd as he hefde ischawed ham igastelich
 sihðe. Ich iseh þe apostles poure. 7 lah on eorðe. ifullet 7 bigoten al of
 unimete blisse sitten i trones. ant al under hare uet þ-heh is i þe worlde.
 3arowe forte 260 demen i þe dei of dome kinges 7 keiseres. 7 alle
 cunreadnes of alle cunnes ledenes. [f. 79 r] Ich biheolt te *Martyrs*. 7
 hare unimete murhðe þe þoleden her pinen. 7 deað for ure lauerd. 7
 lihtliche talden to alles cunnes neowcins. 7 eorðliche tintreohen
 azeines þe blisse þ-godd in hare heorte schawede ham to cumene. *Efter*
 ham 265 ich biheolt þe *cunfessurs* hird þe liueden igod lif. 7 haliche
 deiden. þe schineð as doð steorren iþe eche blissen. 7 seoð godd in his
 wlite þ-haueð alle teares iwipet of hare ehnen. Ich iseh þ-schene 7 þ-
 brihte fer`r`eden of þe eadi meidnes ilikest towart engles. ant
 feolohlukest wið ham blissin 7 gleadien. þe libbinde iflesche ouergað
 270 flesches lahe ant ouercumeð cunde þe leadeð heouenlich lif in
 eorðe as ha wunieð hare murhðe. 7 hare blisse. þe feierl`e`ac of hare
 wlite. þe swetnesse of hare song ; ne mei na tunge tellen. Alle ha
 singeð þe þer beoð. Ah hare song ne mahe nane buten heo singen. Se
 swote sme`a`l ham folheð hwiderse ha wendeð. þ-me mahte libben 275
 aa bi þe swotnesse. hwam se heo bisecheð fore ; is sikerliche iborhen.
 for azein hare bisocnen ; godd him seolf ariseð þ-alles þe oðre halhen
 sittende ihereð.

S wiðe wel quoð warschipe likeð us þ-tu seist. Ah nu þu hauest se
 wel iseið of euch a setnesse ; of þe seli sunder lepes sumhwet sei
 280 us nu hwuch blisse is to alle iliche meane ; 7 liues luue hire

ondswereð. [f. 79 v] Þe imeane blisse is seouenfald. lengðe of lif. wit.
7 luue. 7 of þe luue a gleadunge. wiðute met murie. loft song. 7
lihtschipe. ant sikernesse. is þe seoueðe. þah ich þis seið warschipe
sumdel understonde ; þu most unwreo þis witerluket 7 openin to þeos
oðre. 285 ant hit schal beon seið liues luue warschipe as þu wilnest.

Ha liuieð á in awlite. þis brihtre seoueuald. 7
schenre þen þe sunne. ant eauer in a
strengðe to don buten euch swinc al þ-ha wulleð.

291. After 7 *godes*, an
erasure MS.

7 eauer mare in a steal in al þ-eauer god is wiðute wonunge. wiðuten
euch þing þ-mahe hearmin oðer eilin. 290 in al þ-eauer is. softe oðer
swote. 7 hare lif is godes sihðe. 7 *godes cnawlechung*e as ure lauereð
seide. þis *quoð* he eche lif to seon 7 cnawen sod godd. 7 him þ-he
sende ihesu *crist* ure lauereð to ure alesnesse 7 beoð for þi ilich him iþe
ilke wlite þ-he is. for ha seoð him as he is. nebbe to nebbe. **Ha** beoð se
wise þ-ha witen 295 alle godes reades. his runes 7 his domes þe derne
beoð. 7 deopre þen eni sea dingle. ha seoð igodd alle þing. 7 witen of
al þ-is 7 wes 7 eauer schal iwerden. hwet hit beo. hwi. 7 hwerto 7
hwerof hit bigunne. **Ha** luuieð god wiðute met. for þ-ha understondeð
hu he haueð bi ham idon þurh his muchele godlec 7 hwet ha ahen his
300 deorewurde milce to 3elden. ant euchan luueð oðer ase muchel as
him seoluen. Se gleade ha beoð of godd ; þ-al is hare blisse. se muchel

[f. 80 r] þ-ne mei hit munne na muð. ne spealie
[na speche] for þi þ-euchan luueð oðer as him
seoluen. Euchan haueð of odres god ase muche
murhðe as of his ahne. bi þis 3e mahen seon 7
witen. 305 þ-euchan haueð sunderlepes ase feole
gleadschipes ; as ha beod monie alle. 7 euch of

303. This leaf of the
MS. defective.
312, 313. MS.
defective here.
320-2. MS. defective
here and at ll. 337-9.

þe ilke gleadschipes is to eauer euchan ase muche gleadunge ; as his
ahne sunderliche. 3et ouer al þis. hwen euchan luueð godd mare þen
him seoluen. 7 þen alle þe odre ; mare he gleadeð of godd wiðuten ei
etlunge þen of his ahne gleadunge. 310 7 of alle þe oðres. Neomeð nu
þenne 3eme 3ef neauer anes heorte ne mei in hire [und]eruon hire ahne
gleadunge sunderliche. [iseide. se unim]ete muchel is þe anlepi blisse.

þ-ha nimeð i[n] hi[re] þus monie. 7 þus muchele. forþi seide ure lauerd
to þeo þe him hefden icwemet. *Intra in gaudium. et c'.* Ga
quoð he into þi 315 lauerdes blisse. þu most al gan þrin. ant al beon
bigotten þrin for in þe ne mei hit nanesweis neomen in. herof ha herieð
godd 7 singeð á unwerget eauer iliche lusti in þis loft songes. as hit
iwriten is. *Beati qui habitant. et c'.* Eadi beoð þeo lauerd.
þe ipin hus wunieð. ha schulen herien þe from [worlde into worlde].
Ha beoð 320 alle ase li[hte 7 ase swifte as þe sunne.] gleam þe sc[heot
from est into west. ase þin ehe[f. 80 v]lid tuneð ant openeð for hwer se
eauer þe gast wule þe bodi is ananriht wiðute lettunge. for ne mei ham
na þing azeines etstonden. for euchan is almihti to don al þ-he wule. 3e
makie to cwakien heouene ba 7 eorðe wið his an finger. 325 **S**ikere ha
beoð of al þis. of þulli lif. of þulli wit. of þulli luue 7 gleadunge þrof. 7
of þulli blisse. þ-hit ne me neauer mare lutlin ne wursin. ne neome nan
ende. þis lutle ich habbe iseid of þ-ich iseh in
heouene ah nower neh ne seh ich al. ne þ-3et þ-
ich [iseh. ne] ne con ich half tellen. **W**iter[liche
quoð] warschipe. wel we understondeð 330 þ-tu
hauest ibeo þear 7 soð hauest iseid trof. efter þi
sihðe. ant wel is him þ-is war. 7 bisið him hu he mahe beast halden his
hus þ-godes tresor is in azeines godes unwine þe weorreð þer towart a
wið unþeawes. for þet. schal bringen him þider as he schal. al þis þ-tu
hauest ispeken of an hundred siðe mare of blisse buten euch bale 335
folhin 7 ifinden. *Quoð* strengðe hwen hit swa is ; hwet mei tweamen
us from godd 7 hald[en us þeonne. ich] am siker ine godd. [þ-ne schal
lif ne deað ; ne wa] ne wunne nowðer [to dealen us ant his luue. ah al
þis] us haueð igarc [f. 10 r] ket. 3ef we as treowe tresures witeð wel his
tresor þ-is bitaht us tohalden. as we schulen ful wel undeR his wengen.
340

329. *seh*] *neh* MS.
339. MS. Bod. ends
with *igarc*; the rest is
from MS. Royal 17 A
27.

Varpeð ut quoð warschipe ; farlac ure fa. nis nawt riht þ-an hus
halde þeos tweien. for þeR as murðes sonde is ; 7 soð luue of eche lif.
farlac is fleme. nu ut quoð strenðe farlac ne schaltu na lengere leuen in
uRe ende. nu quoð `he' ich seide for god al þ-ich seide. 7 þah hit muri

nere nes na lessere mi tale þen wes murhðes 345 sondes ne unbihefre to
ow. þah hit ne beo so licwurðe ne icweme. Eiðer of ow haueð his
stunde to speokene. ne nis inckeR noðres tale to schunien in his time.
þu warnest of wa. he telleð of wunne. muche neod is þ me ow ba
zeornliche hercni. Flute nu faRlac þah. hwil liues luue is heRinne. 7
þole wið efne heorte þe dom of rihtwisnesse. 350 for þu schal[t]. ful
bliðeliche beon underfon in as ofte as liues luue stutteð forto spekene.

Nv is wil þ husewif al stille. þ eR wes so willesful. Alituht efter
wittes wissunge þ is husebonde. 7 Al þ hird halt him stille. þ wes i
wunet to beon fulitohen 7 don efteR wil haRe lefdi. Ant 355 nawt efteR
wit ; lustneð nu his lare. 7 fondeð eueR euchan efteR þ him limpeð to.
þurh þeos twa sonden. þ ha iheRd habbeð. 7 þ fowr sustren larden
þruppe for euch unþeawes in3ong his warde te witene. antte waRden
treowliche. [f. 10 v]

Þvs ah mon te þenchen ofte Ant ilome. Ant wið þulliche þohtes 360
awecchen his heorte. þe islep of 3emeles for3et hire sawle heale.
efter þeos twa sonden. From helle sihðe biseon ; to þe blisse of
heouene. To habben farlac of þ an ; luue toward þ oðeR. ant leaden
him ant hinen. þ beoð his limen alle. nawt efteR wil þe untohe lefdi 7
his lust leareð. ah efteR þ wit wule þ is husebonde. tuhten 7 teachen þ
wit ga 365 eueR biuore ant teache wil efter him. to al þ he dihteð 7
demeð to donne. ant wið þe fowR sustren ; þerfore þe fowr heued
þeawes. WaRschiþe. Strencðe in godd. Ant Með. Ant Rihtwisnesse.
witen godes treosor þ is his ahne sawle. iþe hus of þe bodi ; from þe
þeof of helle. þulli þoht makeð mon te fleon alle unþeawes ant ontent
his 370 heorte toward þe blisse of heouene. þ ure lauerd 3eue us þurh
his hali milce þ wið þe fedeR. ant e sune ant e hali gast rixleð in þreo
had á buten ende. AMEN.

Par seinte charite biddeð a pateR noster for iohan þ þeos boc wrat. 375

Hwa se þis writ haueð ired.
Ant crist him haueð swa isped.
Ich bidde par seinte charite.

Þet 3e bidden ofte for me.

380 **Aa** *pateR nosteR*. ant aue maRie.

Þet ich mote þ-lif heR drehen.

Ant ure lauerd wel icwemen.

I Mi zuheðe 7 in min elde.

Þet ich mote ihesu crist mi sawle 3elden.

AMEN.

XVII. SAINT KATHERINE

“As for [Sawles Warde](#). The text of this extract is from the Royal MS.”

ARA PER PROGENITORES

Constantin. ant Maxence weren on ane time as in keiseres stude
hehest i rome. ah constantin ferde þurh þe burhmenne read into
fronclonde. ant wunede summe hwiles þer for þe burhes neode. ant
Maxence storede þe refschiþe in rome. weox umbewiles wreððe him
bitweonen. ant comen to þe fehte. 5 þes maxence wes ouercumen. ant
fleh into alixaundre. Constantin walde efter. ant warpen him þeonne.
ah so wide him weox weorre on euch halue. ant
nomeliche in an lond ylirie hatte. þ-ter he
etstutte. Ða Maxence iherde þis ; þ-he wes of him
siker. ant of his cume karles. warð king of þat lond þ-lei into rome. as
duden meast 10 alle þe oðere of þe world. bigon anan as wedwulf to
weorrin hali chirche. ant dreien cristene men þe lut þ-ter weren alle to
heðenedom heðene as he wes. Summe þurh muchele zeoue ant
misliche meden. Summe þurh farlac of his fule þreates. Oleast wið
stronge tintreo ant licomliche pinen. Ðe fif 7 þrittuðe 3er of his 15
rixlunge he set okineseotle i þe moderburh [f. 11 v] of alixaundres
riche. he sende heste. 7 bode so wide so þ-lond wes. þ-poure ba 7 riche
comen biuoren him to þe temple iþe tun of his heðene godes. euchan

8. After *an*, *e* erased
yrrie MS.

wið his lac ; forto wurgin ham wið. comen alle to his bode. 7 euchan bi
 `hi's euene biuoren Maxence seolf to wurgen his 20 mawmez. þe riche
 roðeren 7 schep 7 bule hwa so mahte brohte to lake. þe poure cwike
 briddes in þis ilke burh wes wuniende a meiden swiðe zung of 3eres
 twa wone of twenti. feie`r' 7 freolich o wlite 7 o
wastum. ah zet þ-wes mare wurð steðeluest wið
 innen of treowe bileaue. anes kinges cost hehte
 anlepi dohter icuret clergesse. katherine 25
 inempnet. þis meiden wes boðen federles 7 moderles of hire child-
 hade, ah þah ha zung were ; ha heold hire aldrene hird wisliche 7
 warliche iþe eritage. 7 iþe herd þ-com of hire burde. nawt for þi hire
 þuhte god to habben monie under hire 7 beon icleopet lefdi þ-feole
 telleð wel to. ah ba ha wes offearet of scheome 7 of sunne. 30 þ-þeo
 weren todreuet oðer misferden þ-hire forð-federes hefden ifostred. For
 hire seolf ne kepte heo nawt of þe world. þus lo for hare sake ane dale
 [f. 12 r] heo etheold [of hire eldrene god] 7 spende al þ-oðer in neodful
 7 in nakede.

24. *wastun* MS.
 28. *þi* MS.
 33. *of ... god* from C.

Ðeos milde meoke meiden þes lufsum lefdi
 mid lasteles lates ne 35 luuede heo nane lihte
 plohen ne nane luue ronnes. nalde heo nane
 songes. ne nane luuerunes leornin ne lustnin ah eauer ha hefde on hali
 writ ehnen oðer horte. oftest ba to gederes. hire feder hefde iset hire
 earliche to leaf 7 to lare. 7 heo underueng hit þurh þen hali gast so wel
 þ-nan nes hire eueninge. Modie meistres 7 40 feole fondeden hire ofte.
 oswiðe feole halue forto underneomen hire. ah nes þer nan þ-mahte
 neuer enes wrenchen hire mid al his crefti crokes ut of þe weie. ah swa
 sone heo 3eld ham swucche 3ein cleppes. 7 wende hare wiheles uppon
 ham seoluen þ-al ha icneowen ham crauant 7 ouercumen. 7 cweðen
 hire þe meistrie 7 te menske al up. 45

35. After *lates*, *f*
 erased.

Ðus hwil ha wiste hire 7 þohte aa to witen hire
 meiden imeiðhad. as ha set in a bur of hire
 burde boldes heo iherde a swuch murhðe towart
 þe awariede mawmetes temple lowinge of þ-ahte.
 ludinge of þe men. gleowunge [f. 12 v] of each gleo to herien 7

53. After *of hire*, *hā w*
 MS.
 56. *þes þes* MS.

hersumin hare heðene godes. as ha þis iherde 7 nuste 3et hwet hit wes.
 ha sende swiðe for 50 to witen hwet wunder hit were. sone so hire
 sonde com a3ein 7 seide hire þ-soðe ; heo swa itend of wreððe wes þ-
 wod ha wurðen walde. het up of hire hird hwuch as heo walde ant
 wende hire þideward. ifont þer swiðe feole 3einde 7 3urinde. 7
 þeotinde unpuldeliche wið rewfule remes þ-cristene weren. 7 leafful in
 godes laý. ah for dred 55 of deað duden þes deouel[e]s lac as þe heðene
 duden. hwa wes wurse þen hire heorte iwundet inwið for þe wrecches
 þ-heo iseh wraðe werkes wurchen a3eines godes wille. þohte þah as
 heo wes þuldi 7 þolemod so 3ung þing as heo wes. hwet hit mahte
 3einen þah heo hire ane were a3ein so kene keisere 7 his kineriche. 60
 stod stille ane hwile 7 hef hire heorte up to þe hehe healent þe iheret is
 in heouene. bisohte him help. 7 hap. 7 wisdom. as wisliche as al þe
 world is iwald þurh his wissunge. þrefter wepnede hire mid soðe
 bileaue. 7 wrat on hire breoste ant biuoren hire teeð 7 tunge of hire
 muð þe hali [f. 13 r] rode taken. 7 com lepinde 65 forð al itend of lei of
 þen hali gast. as þe keiser stod bimong þe sunful slaht of þ-islein ahte
 deoulen to lake þ-euch wariet weouet of þe mix mawmez ron of þ-
 balefule blod albi blodeget. 7 bigon to 3eien ludere stefne.

Gretinge keiser walde. þe bicumen for þin
 hehnesse 3ef þu þis 70 ilke 3eld þ-tu dest to

71. ille MS.

deouelen þ-fordeð þe baðe ilicom 7 i sawle ; 7 alle þ-hit driueð. 3ef þu
 hit 3ulde 7 3eue to his wurðmunt þe scheop þe ant al þe world. 7 al
 walt þurh his wisdom. 7 al þ-ischapen is. ich walde keiser igreten þe.
 3ef þu understode þ-he him ane is to herien þurh hwam 7 under hwam
 75 alle kinges rixleð. ne ne mei na þing wiðstonden his iwil. þah he
 mucche þolie. þes heouenliche lauerd luueð treowe bileaue. 7 nowðer
 blod ne ban of unforgult ahte. ah þ-me halde 7 heie his halewunde
 heastes. Ne nis na þing hwar þurh monnes mucchele medschipe
 wreððeð him wið mare þen þe schaft of mon ; þ-he scheop. 7 3ef 80
 schad ba of god 7 of uel þurh wit 7 þurh wisdom schal wurðen forð.
 ut of his witte þurh þe awariede gast þ-he 3elt þe wur [f. 13 v] ðmunt to
 unwitlese þing þ-te feont wuneð in. þ-he ahte to godd 7 hereð 7
 hersumeð seheliche schaftes 7 blodles 7 banles. 7 leomen buten liue. as

he schulde his 7 heoren. 7 alre þinge schuppent þis 85 godd
unsehelich.

FRUIT PER SACROS MORES

Þe feont þe fint al uuel bimong alle his crokinde creftes. wið neauer
an ne keccheð he creftluker cang men ne leadeð to unbileau. þen þ
he makeð men. þahten to witen wel. þha beoð biȝetene. i borene 7
broht forð þurh þe heoueneliche feder ; to makien 90 swucche
mawmez of treo. oðer of stan. oðer þurh mare medschipe. of gold oðer
of seoluer ; 7 ȝeouen ham misliche nome. of sunne oðer of mone. of
wind of wude. of wettres. 7 hersumið. 7 wurgið as þah ha godes weren.
ne naueð he þurh oðer þing i þis bileau ibroht ow bute þow þuncheð
þha schulden leaten aa. forþi þȝe ne schulen 95 ham neuer biginnen.
ah þer nis buten an godd þurh hwam witerliche alle weren i wrahte. 7
of nawt i þis woorld iset us forto frouirin. ant to fremien. 7 alswa as
euch þing hefde biginnunge of his godlec ; alswa schulden alle habben
endunge ȝef ha þ[f. 14 r] walden. engles 7 sawlen þurh þha bigunnen
ahten 7 mahten endin þurh cunde. 100 ah he þurh his milce. 7 godlec of
his grace makeð ham þha beoð in eche buten ende. 7 ter uore nis na
þing euening. ne eche wið godd þȝe gremieð. for he is hare alre
schuppent. 7 scheop as in sum time. 7 na time nes neauer þhe ne bigon
te beon in.

XVIII. THE ORISON OF OUR LADY

“Cotton Nero A 14, British Museum. See [IX, [Ancrene Wisse](#)].”

EDICTA TU IN MULIERIBUS

On god ureisun of ure lefdi.

Cristes milde moder seynte marie.
 Mines liues leome mi leoue lefdi.
 to þe ich buwe 7 mine kneon ich beie.
 and al min heorte blod to ðe ich offrie.
 5 þu ert mire soule liht. 7 mine heorte blisse.
 Mi lif 7 mi tohope min heale mid iwisse.
 Jch ouh wurðie ðe mid alle mine mihte
 and singge þe lofsong bi daie 7 bi nihte.
 vor þu me hauest iholpen aueole kunne wise.
 10 and ibrouht of helle into paradise.
 Jch hit þonkie ðe mi leoue lefdi.
 and þonkie wulle þe hwule ðet ich liuie.
 alle cristene men owen don ðe wur` s´chipe.
 and singen ðe lofsong mid swuðe muchele gledschipe.
 15 vor ðu ham hauest alesed of deoflene honde.
 and isend mid blisse to englene londe. |
 wel owe we þe luuien mi swete lefdi.
 wel owen we uor þine luue ure heorte beien.
 þu ert briht 7 blisful ouer alle wummen.
 20 and god ðu ert 7 gode leof ouer alle wepmen.
 alle meidene were wurðeð þe one.
 vor þu ert hore blostme biuoren godes trone.
 nis no wummon iboren þet ðe beo iliche.
 ne non þer nis þin eming wiðinne heoueriche.
 25 heih is þi kinestol onuppe cherubine.
 biuoren ðine leoue sune widinnen seraphine.
 Murie dreameð engles biuoren þin onsene.
 pleieð 7 sw`e´ieð 7 singeð. bitweonen.
 Swuðe wel ham likeð biuoren þe to beonne.
 30 vor heo neuer ne beoð sead þi ueir to iseonne.
 þine blisse ne mei no wiht understonden.
 vor al is godes riche anunder þine honden.
 alle þine ureondes þu makest riche kinges.
 þu ham 3iuest kinescrud beies 7 gold ringes.
 35 þu 3iuest eche reste ful of swete blisse.

16. *isend*] *d* corr.
 out of *t*.

þer ðe neure deað ne com ; ne herm ne sorinesse.
 þer bloweð inne blisse blostmen. hwhite 7 reade.
 þer ham neuer ne mei. snou. ne uorst iureden,
 þer ne mei non ualuwen. uor þer is eche sumer.
 40 ne non liuiinde þing woc þer nis ne zeomer
 þer heo schulen resten þe her ðe doð wurschipe.
 3if heo zemeð hore lif cleane urom alle queadschipe.
 þer ne schulen heo neuer karien ne swi`n`ken.
 ne weopen ne murnen ne helle stenchies stinken.
 45 þer me schal ham steoren mid guldene chelle. |
 and schenchen ham eche lif mid englene wille.
 ne mei non heorte þenchen ne no wiht arechen.
 ne no muð imelen ne no tunge techen
 hu muchel god ðu zeirkest wiðinne paradise.
 50 ham þet swinkeð dei 7 niht iðine seruise
 al þin hird is ischrud mid hwhite ciclatune.
 and alle heo beoð ikruned mid guldene krune.
 heo beoð so read so rose so hwit so þe lilie.
 and euer more heo beoð gled 7 singeð þuruhut murie.
 55 Mid brihte zimstones hore krune is al biset.
 and al heo doð þet ham likeð. so þet no þing ham ne let.
 þi leoue sune is hore king 7 þu ert hore kwene.
 ne beoð heo neuer idreaued mid winde ne mid reine.
 Mid ham is euer more dei wiðute nihte.
 60 Song wiðute seoruwe 7 sib wiðute uihte.
 Mid ham is muruhðe moniuold wiðute teone 7 treie.
 Gleobeames 7 gome inouh liues wil 7 eche pleie.
 þereuore leoue lefdi long hit þuncheð us wrecchen
 vort þu of þisse erme liue to ðe suluen us fecche.
 65 we ne muwen neuer habben fulle gledschipe.
 er we to þe suluen kumen to þine heie wurschipe.
 Swete Godes moder softe meiden 7 wel icoren.
 þin iliche neuer nes ne neuermore ne wurð iboren.
 Moder þu ert 7 meiden cleane of alle laste.
 70 þuruhut hei 7 holi in englene reste.

48. *techen*] *tegen*
 MS.

al englene were 7 alle holie þing
Siggeð 7 singeð þet tu ert liues welsprung
and heo siggeð alle þet ðe ne wonteð neuer ore.
ne no mon, þet ðe wurdeð ne mei neuer beon
uorloren. |

73. *ðene* MS.

þu ert mire soule [leoue] wiðute leasunge.
76 efter þine leoue sune ; leouest alre þinge.
al is þe heouene ful of þine blisse.
and so is al þes middeleard of þine mildheortnesse.
So muchel is þi milce 7 þin eðmodnesse.
80 þet no mon þet ðe 3eorne bit of helpe ne mei
missen.

79. *eomodnesse*
MS.

ilch mon, þet to þe bisihð þu 3iuest milce 7 ore.
þauh he ðe habbe swuðe agult 7 idreaued sore.
þereuore ich ðe bidde holi heouene kwene.
þet tu 3if þi wille is ihere mine bene.

84. *iher* MS.

85 ich ðe bidde lefdi uor þere gretunge.
þet Gabriel ðe brouhte urom ure heouen kinge.
and ek ich ðe biseche uor ihesu cristes blode
þet for ure note was isched oðere rode.
vor ðe muchele seoruwe ðet was oðine mode.
90 þo þu et ðe deaðe him biuore stode
þet tu me makie cleane wiðuten 7 eke wiðinnen.
So þet me ne schende none kunnes sunne.
þene loðe deouel 7 alle kunnes dweoluhðe.
aulem urom me ueor awei mid hore fule fulðe.
95 Mi leoue lif urom þine luue ne schal me no þing todealen
vor oðe is al ilong mi lif 7 eke min heale.
vor þine luue i swinke 7 sike wel ilome
vor þine luue ich ham ibrouht in to þeoudome,
vor þine luue ich uorsoc al þet me leof was.
100 and 3ef ðe al mi suluen. looue lif iþench þu þes.
þet ich ðe wreðede sume siðe hit me reoweð sore.
vor cristes fif wunden ðu 3if me milce 7 ore.
3if þu milce nauest of me þet ich wot wel 3eorne |

þet ine helle pine swelten ich schal 7 beornen.
 105 ful wel þu me iseie þauh þu stille were.
 hwar ich was 7 hwat i dude þauh þu me uorbere.
 3if þu heuedest wreche inumen of mine luðernesse.
 iwis ich heuede al uorloren paradises blisse.
 þu hauest 3et forboren me uor þine godnesse.
 110 and nu ich hopie habben fulle uor3iuenesse.
 ne wene ich neure uallen into helle pine.
 hwon ich am to ðe ikumen 7 am ðin owune hine
 þin ich am 7 wule beon nu 7 euer more.
 vor oðe is al mi lif ilong 7 o godes ore.
 115 Mi leoue swete lefdi to þe me longed swuðe.
 bute ich habbe þine help ne beo ich neuer bliðe.
 ich þe bidde þet tu kume to mine uorðsiðe.
 and nomeliche þeonne þine luue kuðe.
 auouh mine soule hwon ich of þisse liue uare
 120 and ischild me urom seoruwe 7 from eche deaðes kare.
 3if þu wult ðet ich iðeo gode 3eme nim to me.
 vor wel ne wurð me neuer bute hit beo þuruh ðe.
 Mid swuþe luðere lasten mi soule is þuruhbunden.
 ne mei no þing so wel so þu healen mine wunden.
 125 to þe one is al mi trust efter þine leoue sune
 vor is holie nome of mine liue 3if me lune.
 ne þole þu þene unwine þet he me arine
 ne þet he me dra`w`e in to helle pine.
 nim nu 3eme to me so me best a beo ðe beo.
 130 vor þin is þe wurchipe 3if ich wrecche wel iþeo.
 þu ne uorsakest nenne mon uor his luðernesse.
 3if he `is´ to bote 3eruh 7 bit þe uor3iuenesse. |
 þu miht lihtliche 3if þu wult al mi sor aleggen.
 and muchele bet biseon to me þen ich kunne siggen.
 135 þu miht for3elden lihtliche mine gretunge.
 al mi swinc 7 mi sor 7 mine kneouwunge.
 Jne me nis noþing feier on to biseonne.
 Ne no þing þ-beo wurðe biuoren þe to beonne.
 þereuore ich þe bidde þ-þu me wassc`h`e 7 schrude

126. *lune*] *luue* MS.

127. *arine* on an
erasure.

128. *drawe*] w over
i MS.

130. *wreeche* MS.

138. *þingþ*-MS.

140 þuruh þine muchele milce þ̅spert so swuðe wide
 Nis hit ðe no wurðscipe þ̅þe deouel me todrawe.
 3if þu wult hit iðauien iwis he wule ðurchut fawe.
 vor he nolde neuerre þ̅þu hefedest wurðschipe.
 Ne no mon þ̅þe wurðeð þ̅he hedde gledschipe.
 145 þu hit wost ful 3eorne þ̅þe deouel hateð me.
 and nomeliche þereuore þ̅ich wurðie þe.
 þereuore ich þe bidde þ̅þu me wite 7 werie.
 þet þe deouel me ne drecche ne dweolðe me ne derie.
 So þu dest 7 so þu schalt uor ðire mildheortnesse.
 150 þu schalt me aueir dol of heoueriche blisse.
 3if ich habbe muchel ibroken, muchel ich wulle beten.
 and do mine schrifte 7 þe ueire greten.
 þe hwule þ̅ich habbe mi lif 7 mine heale.
 vrom ðire seruise ne schal me no þing deale.
 155 biuoren þine uote ich wulle liggen 7 greden.
 vort ich habbe uor3iuenesse of mine misdeden.
 Mi lif is þin mi luue is þin mine heorte blod is þin.
 and 3if ich der se`g`gen mi leoue leafdi þu ert min.
 alle wurðschipe haue þu on heouene and ec on eorðe.
 160 and alle gledschipe haue þu al so ðu ert wurðe. |
 Nu ich þe biseche ine cristes cherite.
 þet þu þine blescinge 7 þine luue 3iue me.
 3eme mine licame ine clenenesse
 Godalmihti unne me vor his mildheortnesse.
 165 þ̅ich mote þe iseo in ðire heie blisse.
 and alle mine ureondmen þe bet beo nu to dai.
 þ̅ich habbe isungen þe ðesne englissce lai.
 and nu ich þe biseche vor ðire holinesse.
 þet þu bringe þene Munuch to þire glednesse.
 170 þet funde ðesne song bi ðe mi looue leafdi.
 Cristes milde moder seinte marie. amen.

169. *Munuch*] *nu* on
 an erasure MS.
 170. *biðe* MS.

Between ll. 163, 4, a line omitted: it was supplied at the top of the folio, but cut
 away by the binder. Zupitza read the traces of the last two words as *ine*
eadmodnesse.

XIX. SAINT JULIANA

“i. Bodleian 34, Oxford (B). ii. Royal 17 A 27, British Museum (R): for descriptions see [XVI, [Sawles Warde](#)]. ... R is abbreviated ... the joints are often visible.”

Bodleian MS
Parallel Texts

ROYAL MS.

Her cumseð þe uie of seinte iuliane. ant telleð of liflade hire.

In ure lauwerdes luue þe is feader of frumschaft. ant on his deorewurðe sunes nome. ant o þes haligastes. þ glideð of ham baðen. alle lewede men. þ understonden ne mahen latines ledene. 5 liðin. 7 lustnin ane meidenes liflade. þ is of latin iturnd into englisch. þ te lifhali lefdi. in heouene luuie us þe mare. ant of þis lihinde lif : leade us wið hire ern [f. 56 v] dunge. þe is icoren of crist into þe eche of heouene.

Þeos meiden. ant tis martir. wes iuliane inempnet. in nichomedes 10 burh. 7 of heðene cun icumen. ant hire fleschliche feder wes affrican ihaten. of þe heðene mest þeo þ cristene weren ; derfliche droh ham to deaðe. ah heo as þeo þ te heouenlich feder luuede. leafde al hire aldrene lahen. 7 bigon to luuien þene liuiende lauerd þe lufsum godd. þ wisseð ant weldeð al þ is on worlde ; 7 al þ iwraht is. Ða wes 15 biþon time as redegunge telleð. Maximian þe modi keiser ine Rome heinde ant heriende heðene mawmez. wið unmeð muchel hird 7 unduhti duheðe. 7 fordemde alle þeo ; þe on drihtin bilefden. þes Maximian luuede an heh mon of cunne ant eke riche of rente elewsius wes ihaten. ant weren as feolahes þurh muche freontschipe. 20 þis meidenes feder 7 he. weren swiðe wel to gederes. as he sumchere iseh hire utnume feir. ant freoliche. he felde him iwundet. þ wiðuten

lechnunge of hire libben he ne mahte. Affrican wiste wel þ̅ he wes freo boren. 7 þ̅ him walde bicumen a freo boren burde. ant ȝettede *him* his dohter. 7 wes sone [f. 57 r] ihondsald al hire unwilles. ah 25 heo truste on him þ̅at ne trukeneð namon ; þ̅-trusteð treowliche on him. ant each deis dei eode to ch`i`rche to leornen godes lare. ȝeornliche to witen hu ha mahte best witen hire unweommet. . .

ah as ha wende hire summes weis to witene ;
sende him to seggen. þ̅-nalde 30 ha lihten swa
lahe ne nehlechen him for nan liuiende mon. er
þ̅en he were under Maximian hehest in rome þ̅-is hehreue. Sone so he
iherde þ̅is. he biȝet et te keiser þ̅-he ȝettede him reue to beonne as þ̅-he
iȝirnd hefde. ant he as me þ̅a luuede. lette leaden him into cure. 7 te
riche riden in. 7 tuhen him ȝont te tun ; from strete to strete. 35 ant al
þ̅e cur wes bitild. þ̅-he wes in. wið purple wið pal. 7 wið ciclatun. 7
deorewurðe claðes. as þ̅e þ̅-heh þ̅ing hefde to heden. ant þ̅a he hefde
þ̅is idon ; he sende hire to seggen. þ̅-he hefde hire wil iwraht. 7 heo
schulde his wurchen.

34, 36. *ture tur* MS.
37. *ciclatun* MS.

Iuliane þ̅e edie iesu cristes leouemon of his blisfule luue balde 40 hire
seoluen. sende him to onswere [f. 57 v] bi an of hire sonden.
Elewsius wite þ̅u hit wel ireadi. wraðði so þ̅u wraðði. no lengre nulich
hit heolen þ̅e. ȝef þ̅u wult leauen þ̅e lahen þ̅-tu list in. ant leuen in godd
feder. 7 in his deorewurðe sune. 7 iþe hali gast. ichulle wel neomen þ̅e.
ȝef þ̅u nult no ; þ̅u art wundi of me. 7 oðer luue sech þ̅e. 45 Þ̅a þ̅e reue
iherde þ̅is ; he wreððede him swiðe. 7 hire feder cleopede. ant feng on
to tellen him. hu his dohter droh him from deie to deie. ant efter þ̅-he
wende to habben his iwil so ha him þ̅is word sulliche sende. Bi þ̅-ilke
godd *quoð* hire feder þ̅-me is lað to gremien beo hit soð þ̅-tu seist to
wraðer heale seide ha hit. ant nu ichulle o great 50 grome al biteachen
hire þ̅e. to wurchen þ̅i wil. 7 al þ̅-te wel likeð as mit tin ahne. 7 me
cleopede hire forð biuoren hire feder. 7 he feng feire to fondin his
dohter Mi deorewurðe dohter hwerfore uorsakestu þ̅i sȝ. ant ti selhðe.

þe weolen ant te wunnen þ-walden awakenin ant waxen of þi wedlac. þ-
 ich þe to reade. for he is inoh 55 lauerd elewsius ine rome. 7 tu maht
 beon leafdi dohter 3ef þu wel wult. Iuliane þe eadie onswerede him 7
 seide as þeo þat [f. 58 r] ine godd hire hope hefde. 3ef he wule leuen an
 god al mihti. þenne mei he spoken þrof 7 inoh raðe speden. ant 3ef þ-
 he nule nawt. ne schal wiuen on me. wiue þer his wil is. þa hire feder
 iherde þis ; 60 þa feng he to swerien. Bi mi kinewurðe lauerd apollo.
 ant bi mi deore leafdi diane. þ-ich muche luuie. 3ef þu haldest heron.
 ichulle leoten deor toteoren ant toluken þe. 7 3eouen þi flesch ; fuheles
 of þe lufte. Iuliane him onswerede 7 softeliche seide. ne wen þu nawiht
 leoue feder. þ-tu affeare me swa. for iesu crist godes sune 65 þ-ich on
 leue 7 luuie as lauerd lufsumest on liue. þah ich beo forbernd. 7 to
 loken limel. nulich heronont buhen þe nawiht þa feng eft hire [feder]
 on wið olhnunge to fondin 3ef he mahte eisweis wenden hire heorte. 7
 seide hire lufsumliche. þ-ne schulde ha nane wunne lihtliche wilnin ; þ-
 he ne schulde welden. wið þ-ha walde hire þonc wenden 70 Nai quod þ-
 meiden schuldich don me to him þ-is alle deoulen bitaht. 7 to eche deð
 idemet. to furwurðen wið him world abuten ende. for his wedlakes
 weole oðer for eni wunne. for soð ich hit segge unwurð is hit me.
 ichulle þ-he hit wite wel. ant tu [f. 58 v] eke mid him þ-ich am iweddēt
 to an þ-ichulle treowliche to halden ant wiðuten les 75 luuiē. þe is
 unlich him. 7 alle worldlich men. ne nullich him nowðer leauen. ne
 lihen for weole ne for wunne. for wa. ne for wunne þet 3e mahen don
 me. þa feng hire feder te wreððen swiðe ferlich 7 swiðe hokerliche
 freinede. Me hwet is he þes were þ-tu art to iweddēt. þ-tu hauest wið
 uten me þine luue ilene[t] for hwam þu letest
 lutel of 80 þ-tu schuldest luuiē. ne ich neuer þ-
 ich wite nes wið him icnawen. For gode quod þet
 meiden þin harm is þe mare nawt forþi þet tu
 nauest ofte iherd of him 3are. þ-is iesu godes
 sune. þe forto lesen moncun þ-forloren schulden beon ; lette his deo`r
 ´wurðe lif on rode. ne ich ne seh him neuer þ-me sare for þuncheð. ah
 ichim luuie ant 85 leue as on lauerde. ne schal me firsin him from ;

80. *ilenet*] MS.
defective here.

89. *wraðel* MS.

98. *schal*] *salch* MS.

nowðer deouel ne mon. For mi lif quoð hire feder þe schal laðin his
 luue for þu schalt beon ibeaten. mid besmes swa bittre þ-tu wummon
 were. schal to wraðer heale iwurðen. Swa muche quoð ha ich iwurðe
 him þe leouere ; So ich derure þing for his luue drehe. þ-ti wil is ;
 wurch nu. 90 7 he het hatterliche strupen hire steornaket. 7 beten hire
 swa luðere þ-hire leofliche lich ; liðeri al oblode. 7 swa ha duden so
 luðere þ-te blod 3et adun of þe 3erden. 7 heo bigon to 3eien. Beaten so
 3e beaten 3e beliales bu[f. 59 r]deles. ne mahe 3e nowðer mi luue ne
 min bileaue lutlen toward him mi lufsum leof mi leowinde lauerd ne 95
 nullich leauen ower read þ-for readeð ow seoluen. ne ower mix
 mawmex þ-beoð þes feondes fetles heien ne herien. for teone ne for
 tintreow þ-3e mahen timbrin. Na quoð he is hit swa hit schal sutelin
 sone. for ichulle biteachen mislich þi bodi to elewsium þe riche reue
 irome ant he schal forswelten ant forreden þe efter es wille wið 100
 allescunnes pinen. 3e quoð þis meiden þ-me crist welden. for ne mahe
 3e nawt don me bute hwet he wule þeauien ow to muchelin mi mede 7
 te murðe þ-lið to meiðhades menske for euer so 3e mare merrið me
 her ; so mi crune bið brihtre 7 fehere. for ichulle bliðeliche drehen
 euereuch derf for mi deore lauerdes luue. ant softe me 105 bið euch
 derf hwen ich him serui þah þume to elewsium willes biteache ; ne
 3eue ich for inc nowðer. þ-3e me mahen harmen. for so 3e mare me her
 harmeð. so mare [3]e me helpeð seoueuald to heouene. 7 3ef 3e me doð
 to deaðe hit bið me deorewurðe ant ich schal þer þurh bliðe bicumen
 into endelese blissen ant 3e schulen wrecches 110 áwei ower wurðes þ-
 3e iboren weren sinken to wraðer heale ow to þe bale bitter deope into
 helle. **H**ire feder affrican þurh þis bittre teone bitahte hire to elewsium
 þe luðere [f. 59 v] reue. ant he lette bringen hire biuoren him to his heh
 seotel as he set in dome as reue of þe burhe . . . 115

[f. 61 r] þa elewsius iseh þis þ-ha þus feng on to festnen hire seoluen
 þohte þ-he walde anan don hire ut of dahene 7 bed swiðe bringen hire
 brune of wallinde breas ant healden on hire heauet þ-hit urne endelong
 hire leofliche bodi dun to þe helen ant swa me dude sone. ah hire
 hende healent wiste hire unweommet. elewsius 120 warð wod ut of his

witte. ant nuste hwet seggen 7 het swiðe don hire ut of his ehsihðe. 7 dreihen hire into darc hus 7 prisunes pine. ant he duden sone. Heo as ha þrinne wes in þeosternesse hire ane feng te cleopien to crist ant bidden þeos bone.

L auerd godd al mihti. mi murhðe ant mi mede mi sy ant mi 125
selhðe þu isist hu icham bistaðet ant bistonden festne mi bileau
steor me ant streng me. for al mi strençðe is uppon þe. mi fedeR. 7 mi
modeR for ich nulle forsaken þe ; habbeð forsaken me 7 al mi nest
falde cun me heaneð þet schulden mine freond beon ; beoð me mest
feondes ant mine hinen me beoð mest heanen ah habbich þin 130 anes
help icham wil cweme ne leaf þume neuer liuiende lauerd as þu wistest
daniel bimong þe wode leuns ant te þreo chil[f. 61 v]dren ananie
zacharie misael inempnet. bi wistest unweommet from þe ferliche fur
of þe furneise swa þu wite ant witen me to witen me from sunne.
lauerd þurh þis lease lif ; lead me to lestinde to þe hauene 135 of heale
as þu leddest israeles folc þurh þe reade sea buten schip druifot ant
hare fan senchtest þ-ham efter sohten afal þumine famen ant todrif
drihtin þen deouel þ-me derueð. for ne mei na mon wiðuten þi strençðe
stonden him azeines lef me þ-ich mote iseon him 3et schent ; þ-weneð
me to schrenchen ant schunchen of þe 140 weie ; þ-leadeð to eche lif.
wite me from his lað ant wið his crefti crokes. wite me wið mine
unwines þ-tu beo euer iheret ant ihei et in heouene ant in eorðe beo þu
áá iblescet as þu were ant art. ant euer schalt beon in eche blisse. amen.

SAINT JULIANA

BODLEIAN MS.

Royal MS (above)
Parallel Texts

**I þe feaderes 7 i þe sunes 7 i þe hali gastes Name. Her Biginneð þe
liflade. ant te passiun of seinte Juliene.**

In ure lauerdes luue þe feader is of frumscheft.
ant iþe deore wurðmunt of his deorewurðe
sune. 7 iþe heiunge of þe hali gast. þe of ham ba glideð. an godd
unagin euch godes ful. Alle leawede 5 men. þe understonden ne muhen
latines ledene. lideð 7 lusteð þe liflade of a meiden. [f. 37 r] þ-is of
latin iturnd ; to engliche leode. wið þon þat teos hali leafdi. in
heouene luuie us þe mare. 7 þurh þis lihnide lif ; leade us to þ-eche.
þurh hire eadi erndunge. þ-crist is swiðe icweme. 10

5. *baðe* MS.

Þeos meiden 7 teos martyr þ-ich of munne ;
wes Juliene inempnet. i Nichomedese burh. Al of
heaðene cun icumen 7 akennet. 7 hire fleshliche
feader affrican hehte. þe heande 7 heascede mest men þe weren
cristene. 7 droh ham þurh derue pinen to deaðe. Ah heo as þeo þ-te
hehe heouenliche lauerd hefde his luue ilenet. leafde 15 hire ealdrene
lahen 7 bigon to luuien þen áá liuiende goð þe lufsume lauerd. þ-
schupte alle sche`a`ftes 7 wealdeð 7 wisseð efter þet his wil is. al þ-
ischeapen iS.

12. *Al* MS.
15. *ileuet* MS.

Wes iþon time as þe redunge telleð. þe modi
Maximien keiser irome. heriende. 7
heiende heaðene maumez. wið unimeað 20 muchel hird. 7 wið heh
duheðe. 7 fordemde alle þeo þe o drihtin bilefden. Þes mihti maximien
luuede an eleusium biuoren monie of his men. Akennet of heh cun. 7
swiðe riche of rente. 7 zunge mon of zeres. þes zunge mon eleusius. þ-
þus wes wel wið þe kinge. hefde iunne feolahschipe to affrican. 7 wes
iwunet ofte to cumen wið him 25 [f. 37 v] to his in. 7 iseon his dohter.

25. *inune* MS.

As he hefde en chere bihalden swiðe zeorne
hire utnumne feire. 7 freoliche zuheðe ;
felde him iwundet in wið in his heorte wið þe
flan þe of luue fleoð. swa þ-him þuhte þet ne mahte he nanes weis wið

36. After *were*, *al*
erased.

ute þe lechnunge of hire luue libben. Ant efter lutle 30 stounde wið ute longe steuene. wes him seolf sonde to affrican hire feader. 7 bisohte him 3eorne þ he hire 3eue him. 7 he hire walde menskin wið al þ he mahte. As þe þing i þe world þ he meast luuede. Affrican wiste þ he wes swið freo iboren. ant walde wel bicumen him a freo iboren burde. 7 3etede him his bone. Ha wes 35 him sone i hondsald þah hit hire unwil were. AÐ ha truste upon him þ ne truked na mon. ha trewliche him truste on. 7 eode to chirche euche daheðes dei. to leornin godes lare. biddinde 3eorne wið reowfule reames. þ he wissede hire o hwuche wise ha mahte witen hire meiðhað.

· 40 ·

Ah heo forte werien hire wið him summe `h´wile : [f. 38 r] sende him to seggen. þ nalde ha nawt lihten se lahe to luuien. Ne nalde ha neolechin him for na liuiende mon. ear þen he were under Maximien. hehest i Rome. þ is heh reue. He ase timliche as he hefde iherd þis. bizet ed te Keiser þet he 3ette him al þ he walde. 45 7 lette as me luuede þa leaden him i cure up o fowr hweoles. 7 teon him 3eonte tun þron from strete to strete. Al þe cure ouertild þ he wes itohen on ; wið purpres 7 pelles. wið ciclatuns 7 cendals 7 deorewurðe claðes. AS þe þ se heh þing hefde to heden. ant se riche refschipe to rihten 7 to readen. þa he hefde þus idon. sende hire þus 50 to seggen hire wil he hefde iwraht. Nu his ha schulde wurchen. Juliene þe eadie ihesu cristes leofmon of his blisfule luue balde hire seoluen, 7 sende him al openliche bi sonde to seggen. þis word ha send te for nawt þu hauest iswechte. wreaðe se þu wreaðe. Do þ tu do wult nule ich ne ne mei ich lengre heolen hit te 3ef þu wult 55 leauen. þe lahen þet tu liuest in ant leuen i godd feader. 7 in his deorwurðe sune. 7 i þe hali gast folkene froure. an godd [f. 38 v] þ is igret wið euches cunnes gode ; Ich chule wel neome þe. 7 3ef þ tu nult no ; þu art windi of me. 7 oðer luue sech þe. Ða þe hehe reue iherde þis ondsware ; bigon to wreðen swiðe. 7 cleopede hire 60 federforð. 7 feng on to tellen. hwuch word ha sende him. Efter þ he wende forte habben idon al þ he wilnede. Affrican hire

53. al] *to al* MS.
70. *treade* MS.

feader wundrede him swiðe. 7 bigon to swerien. bi þe ilke godes þ̅ me
is lað to gremien. beo hit soð þ̅-tu seiist ; to wraðer heale. ha sehð hit.
ant ich wulle o great grome al biteachen hire þe. 7 tu do hire. al þ̅-tu 65
wult. He þonkede him. 7 heo wes icleopet forð. 7 affrican hire feader
feng on earst feire on ; to lokin 3ef he mahte wið eani luue speden.

Juliene *quoð* he mi deorewurðe dohter. sei me hwi þu forsakest þi sy 7
ti selhðe? þe weolen 7 te wunnen. þe walden awakenen. 7 waxen of þe
wedlac þ̅-ich reade þe to : hit nis nan 70 eðelich þing. þe refschipe of
rome. ant tu maht 3ef þu wult. beon burhene leafdi. 7 of alle þe londes
þe þerto liggeð. Juliene þe eadie ontswerede him 7 seide. 3ef he wule
luuien. 7 leuen g`o`dd. al mihti ; þenne mei he [spoken] þrof. 7

speden inoh reaðe. for 3ef he þ̅-nule no ; ich segge þe þ̅-soð is. ne schal
he wiuen on me. Sei nu 75 hwet ti wil is. affrican wreaðede 7 [f. 39 r]
swor swiðe deopliche. for þe drihtfule godd apollo mi lauerd. 7 mi
deore leafdi þe deorewurðe diane þ̅-ich mucho luuie. 3ef þu haldest her
on ; ich schal leote wilde deor toluken 7 toteore þe 7 3eoue þi flesch
fode to fuheles of þe lufte. Juliene him ondswerede. 7 softeliche seide.
Ne lef þu 80 nawt leoue feader þ̅-tu offeare me swa ; ich swerie a3ein.
þe ihesu crist godes sune. þ̅-ich on leue. 7 luuie as leofluket. 7
lufsumest lauerd. þah ich cwic beo forbearnd baðe lim 7 lið ileitinde
leie. Nulle ich þe her onont þ̅reate se þu þ̅reate buhe ne beien.

[A]ffrican feng eft on. 7 to fondin ongon 3ef he mahte eanis weis
85 wið olhnunge wenden hire heorte. 7 leoftede luueliche. 7 seide hire
sikerliche. Ð̅ne schulde ha lihtliche wilni na wunne ; þ̅-ha ne schulde
wealden. wið þ̅erean þ̅-ha walde hire wil wenden. Nai *quoð* ha þ̅-nis
nawt. schulde ich do me to him. þ̅-alle deoflen is bitaht. 7 to eche deað
fordemet. to forwurðe wið him worlt buten ende iþe putte 90 of helle?
for his wedlackes weole oðer for ei wunne. To soðe ich hit segge þe.

Vnwurð hit is me. Ich chulle þ̅-he wite hit ful wel. 7 tu eke mid al ; i`c
`h am to an iweddēt þ̅-ich chulle treowliche wiðute leas luuien. þ̅-is
unlich him 7 alle wortliche men. ne nulle ich neauer mare him lihen

ne lea[f. 39 v]uen. for weole ne for wunne. for 95 wa ne for wontreaðe
þ 3e me mahen wurchen.

Hire feader feng on to wreaððin swiðe ferliche
7 easkede hire hokerliche. Ant hwet is he
þes were þ-tu art to iweddēt. þ-tu hauest wiðute
me se forð þi luue ilenet. þ-tu letest lutel. of al þ-
tu schuldest luuiē. Ne ich nes neauer þ-ich wite
3et. wið him 100 icnawen. for gode quoð þe
meiden þin hearm is þe mare. Nawt forþi þ-tu
nauest iherd of him 3are. Ðis ihesu godes sune. þ-forfe alesen moncun
þ-schulde beon forloren al ; lette lif o rode. Ich ne seh him neauer 7 þ-
me ofþuncheð. Ah ich him luuie 7 wulle don. 7 leue on as o lauērd. Ne
schal me firsē him from. Nowðer 105 deouel ne mon. for mi lif quoð
hire feader þe schal laðin his luue. for þu schalt habbe þrof hearm 7
scheome baðe 7 nu þu schalt on alre earst. as on ernesse swa beon
ibeaten wið bittere besmen. þ-tu were wummon of wummone bosum to
wraðerheale eauer iboren iþe worlde. Swa mucche quoð þ-meiden ich
beo him þe leouere. se ich 110 derfre þing for his luue drehe. [wurch]
þu þ-ti wil is. 3e quoð he bliðeliche. ant swiðe heatterliche. strupen
hire steort naket. 7 leggeð se luðer[f. 40 r]liche on hire leofliche lich ;
þ-hit liðeri o blode. Me nom hire 7 dude swa þ-hit 3eat adun of þe
3erden. ant heo bigon to 3eien. Beaten se 3e beaten 3e beliales budeles.
ne mahe 3e nowðer 115 mi luue ne mi bileaue lutlin towart te liuiende
godd mi leofsume leofmon. þe luuewurðe lauērd. ne nulle ich leuen
ower read þe forreadeð ow seolf. ne þe mix maumez þe beoð þes
feondes fetles ; heien ne herien. for teone ne for tintreohe þ-3e me
mahe timbrin. Na nult tu quoð affrican. hit schal sone sutelin. for ich
chulle sende 120 þe nu 7 biteache þi bodi to eleusium þe riche þ-reue is
ouer rome. ant he schal þe forreaden. 7 makie to forswelten. as his
ahne wil is þurh al þet eauer sar iS.

99. *ileuet* MS.

111. After *drehe* an
erasure of three letters
MS.

112. *leggeð* corr. out of
leggen MS.

113. *þ*] 7 MS.

3e quoð þis meiden þ-meī godd welden. ne
mahe 3e nawt do me bute þet he wule
þeauien 7 þolien ow to donne to mucli mi mede 125 7 te murhðe þ-lið

125. *mutli* MS.

to meiðhades menske. for eauer se 3e nu her mearreð me mare ; se mi crune schal beon brihttre ba 7 fehere. forþi ich chulle bliðeliche 7 wið bliðe heorte drehen eauer euch derf. for mi leofmones luue þe lufsume lauerd 7 softe me bið euch sar in his seruise. þu wult þu seist a3eoue me to eleusium þe luðere. 130 a3ef [f. 40 v] me for nawiht ne 3eoue ich for inc nowðer. Ðet 3e mahen ane pine me here. Ah hit ne hearmeð me nawt ah helpeð 7 heueð up 7 makeð mine murhðes monifalde in heouene. ant 3ef 3e doð me to deað. hit bið deore to godd. 7 ich schal bliðe bicumen to endelese blissen. ant 3e schulen wrecches wei ower wurðes. 135 þ 3e weren iþe worlt iboren 7 i broht forð se wraðer heale 3e schule sinken adun to sar 7 to eche sorhe. to bitternesse ant to bale deope into helle.

[A] ffrican hire feader bitterliche iteonet bitahtte hire eleusium þe luðere reue of rome 7 lette bringen hire biuoren his 140 ehsihðe. as he set 7 demde. þe hehe burh domes.

[þ] a eleusius seh þ ha þus feng on to festnin hire seoluen isoðe bileaue ; þohte he walde don hire anan ut of dahene : 7 bed biliue bringen forð brune wallinde bres. 7 healden hit se wal [f. 42 r] hat hehe up on hire heaued. þ hit urne 145 enddelong hire leofliche lich adun to hire helen. Me dude al as he het. Ah þe worldes wealdent þ wiste sein iuhan his ewangeliste unhurt iðe ueat of wallinde eoli þer he wes idon in. þ ase hal com up þrof ; as he wes hal meiden. þe ilke liues lauerd. wiste him unwemmet. his brud of þe bres þ wes wallinde. swa þ ne þuhte 150 hit hire buten ase wlech weater al þ ha felde. Eleusius wod þa nuste hwet segen. Ah hehte swiðe don hire ut of his ehsihðe. 7 dreaien into dorc hus to prisunes pine ant swa ha wes idon sone.

143. After *hire*, of MS.
146. *heqlen* MS.

[H] eo as ha þrinne wes i þeosternesse hire ane. feng to 155 cleopien to crist 7 bidde þeos bone. lauerd godd almihti mi murhðe 7 mi mede. mi sý 7 al þe selhðe. þ ich efter seche þu sist al hu ich am bistaðet 7 bistonden. festne mi bileaue. Riht me 7 read me. for al mi trust is on þe. Steor me 7 streng

159. Between *mi* and *trust*, erasure of five letters MS.
163. *heamen* MS.
177. After 7, þuþ MS.

me for al mi strengðe is of þe. Mi feader 7 Mi moder forþi þ-ich nule
 þe 160 forsaken ; habbe forsake me. 7 al mi nestfalde cun. þ-schulde
 beo me best freond ; beoð me meast feondes. 7 mine inhinen ; alre
 meast hea[r]men. herewurðe healent. habbe [f. 42 v] ich þin anes help.
 ich am wilcweme ne forleaf þu me nawt luuiende lauerd. as þu
 biwistest daniel bimong þe wode liuns ilatet se luðere. 7 te þreo 165
 children þe chearre nalden from þe lahen þ-ha schulden luuiien. Ananie
 7 Azarie 7 Misahel inempnet. Al þu al wealdent biwistest ham
 unwemmet. wid þ-ferliche fur i þe furneise. swa þu wunne of þe worlt
 wite me 7 were 7 witere. 7 wisse þurh þi wisdom to wite me wið
 sunne. lauerd liues lattow. lead me þurh þis lease. þis lutle 170 leastinde
 lif ; to þe hauene of heale. As þu lead`d`est israeles leode of egipte
 bute schip dru fot þurh þe reade sea. 7 asenchttest hare uan þe ferden
 ham efter. 7 tu folkes feader. aual mine vamen. 7 tu drihtin todrif þe
 deouel þ-me derueð. for ne mei na monnes st`r`engðe wiðuten þin
 stonden him to 3eines. lef me þ-ich mote 175 mihti meinfule godd iseon
 him ischeomet 3et þe weneð me to schrenchen. 7 schunchen of þe
 nearowe wei þ-leadeð to eche lif. loke me from his lað liuiende lauerð.
 Make me war 7 wite me wið his crefti crokes. þ-ha me ne crechen.
 were me swa wið þen vnwine. helpleses heale. Ðtu beo iheiet 7 iheret
 eaure in eorðe. as in 180 heouene. [f. 43 r] Beo þu aa iblescet lauerd as
 þu were ant art 7 schalt beon in eche.

SAINT JULIANA

PARALLEL TEXTS

Royal MS
 Bodleian MS

ROYAL MS.

BODLEIAN MS.

**Her cumseð þe uie of seinte iuliane. ant
telleð of liflade hire.**

In ure lauerdes luue þe is feader of frumschaft. ant on his deorewurðe sunes nome. ant o þes hali gastes. þ̅ glideð of ham baðen. alle lewede men. þ̅-understonden ne mahen latines ledene. 5 liðin. 7 lustnin ane meidenes liflade. þ̅-is of latin iturnd into englich. þ̅-te lifhali lefdi. in heouene luue us þe mare. ant of þis lihinde lif : leade us wið hire ern dunge. þe is icoren of crist into þe eche of heouene.

Þeos meiden. ant tis martir. wes iuliane inempnet. in nichomedes 10 burh. 7 of heðene cun icumen. ant hire fleschliche feder wes affrican ihaten. of þe heðene mest þeo þ̅-cristene weren ; derfliche droh ham to deaðe. ah heo as þeo þ̅-te heouenlich feder luuede. leafde al hire aldrene lahen. 7 bigon to luuien þene liuiende lauerd þe lufsum godd. þ̅-wisseð ant weldeð al þ̅-is on worlde ; 7 al þ̅-iwraht is.

Þa wes 15 biþon time as redegunge telleð. Maximian þe modi keiser ine Rome heinde ant heriende heðene mawmez. wið unmeð muchel hird 7 unduhti duheðe. 7 fordemde alle þeo ; þe on drihtin bilefden. þes Maximian luuede an heh mon of cunne ant eke riche of rente elewsius wes ihaten. ant weren as feolahes þ̅urh muche freontschipe. 20 þis meidenes feder 7 he. weren swiðe wel to gederes.

as he sumchere iseh hire utnume feir. ant freoliche. he felde him iwundet. þ̅-wiðuten lechnunge of hire libben he ne mahte. Affrican wiste wel þ̅-he wes freo boren. 7 þ̅-him walde bicumen a freo boren burde. ant zettede him his dohter. 7 wes sone ihondsald al hire unwilles. ah 25 heo truste on him þat ne trukeneð namon ; þ̅-trusteð treowliche on him. ant euch

**I þe feaderes 7 i þe sunes 7 i þe hali gastes
Name. Her Biginneð þe liflade. ant te
passiun of seinte Juliene.**

In ure lauerdes luue þe feader is of frumscheft. ant iþe deore wurðmunt of his deorewurðe sune. 7 iþe heiunge of þe hali gast. þe of ham ba glideð. an godd unagin euch godes ful. Alle leawede 5 men. þe understonden ne muhen latines ledene. lideð 7 lusteð þe liflade of a meiden. þ̅-is of latin iturnd ; to engliche leode. wið þon þat teos hali leafdi. in heouene luue us þe mare. 7 þ̅urh þis lihnde lif ; leade us to þ̅-eche. þ̅urh hire eadi erndunge. þ̅-crist is swiðe icweme. 10

Þeos meiden 7 teos martyr þ̅-ich of munne ; wes Juliene inempnet. i Nichomedese burh. Al of heaðene cun icumen 7 akennet. 7 hire fleshliche feader affrican hehte. þe heande 7 heascede mest men þe weren cristene. 7 droh ham þ̅urh derue pinen to deaðe. Ah heo as þeo þ̅-te hehe heouenliche lauerd hefde his luue ilenet. leafde 15 hire ealdrene lahen 7 bigon to luuien þen áá liuiende goð þe lufsume lauerd. þ̅-schupte alle sche`a`ftes 7 wealdeð 7 wisseð efter þet his wil is. al þ̅-ischeapen iS.

Wes iþon time as þe redunge telleð. þe modi Maximien keiser irome. heriende. 7 heiende heaðene maumez. wið unimeað 20 muchel hird. 7 wið heh duheðe. 7 fordemde alle þeo þe o drihtin bilefden. þes mihti maximien luuede an eleusium biuoren monie of his men. Akennet of heh cun. 7 swiðe riche of rente. 7 zunge mon of zeres. þes zunge mon eleusius. þ̅-þus wes wel wið þe kinge. hefde iunne feolahschipe to affrican. 7 wes iwunet ofte to cumen wið him 25to his in. 7 iseon his dohter.

As he hefde en chere bihalden swiðe 3eorne hire utnumne feire. 7 freoliche zuheðe ; felde him iwundet in wið in his heorte wið þe flan þe of luue fleoð. swa þ̅-him þuhte þet ne mahte he nanes weis wiðute þe lechnunge of hire luue libben. Ant efter lutle 30 stounde wið ute longe steuene. wes him seolf sonde to affrican hire feader. 7 bisohte him 3eorne þ̅-he

deis dei eode to ch'irche to leornen godes lare.
zeornliche to witen hu ha mahte best witen hire
unweommet. . .

ah as ha wende hire summes weis to witene ;
sende him to seggen. þ-nalde 30 ha lihten swa
lahe ne nehlechen him for nan liuiende mon. er
þen he were under Maximian hehest in rome þ-
is hehreue. Sone so he iherde þis. he biȝet et te
keiser þ-he ȝettede him reue to beonne as þ-he
iȝirnd hefde. ant he as me þa luuede. lette
leaden him into cure. 7 te riche riden in. 7
tuhen him ȝont te tun ; from strete to strete. 35
ant al þe cur wes bitild. þ-he wes in. wið purpre
wið pal. 7 wið ciclatun. 7 deorewurðe claðes.
as þe þ-heh þing hefde to heden. ant þa he
hefde þis idon ; he sende hire to seggen. þ-he
hefde hire wil iwraht. 7 heo schulde his
wurchen.

Iuliane þe edie iesu cristes leouemon of his
blisfule luue balde 40 hire seoluen. sende
him to onswere bi an of hire sonden. Elewsius
wite þu hit wel ireadi. wraðði so þu wraðði. no
lengre nulich hit heolen þe. ȝef þu wult leauen
þe lahen þ-tu list in. ant leuen in godd feder. 7
in his deorewurðe sune. 7 iþe hali gast. ichulle
wel neomen þe. ȝef þu nult no ; þu art wundi of
me. 7 oðer luue sech þe. 45 Ða þe reue iherde
þis ; he wreððede him swiðe. 7 hire feder
cleopede. ant feng on to tellen him. hu his
dohter droh him from deie to deie. ant efter þ-
he wende to habben his iwil so ha him þis word
sulliche sende. Bi þ-ilke godd *quoð* hire feder þ-
me is lað to gremien beo hit soð þ-tu seist to
wraðer heale seide ha hit. ant nu ichulle o great
50 grome al biteachen hire þe. to wurchen þi

hire ȝeue him. 7 he hire walde menskin wið al þ-
he mahte. As þe þing i þe world þ-he meast
luuede. Affrican wiste þ-he wes swið freo
iboren. ant walde wel bicumen him a freo
iboren burde. 7 ȝetede him his bone. Ha wes 35
him sone i hondsald þah hit hire unwil were. **AH**
ha truste upon him þ-ne truked na mon. ha
trewliche him truste on. 7 eode to chirche
euche daheðes dei. to leornin godes lare.
biddinde ȝeorne wið reowfule reames. þ-he
wissede hire o hwuche wise ha mahte witen
hire meiðhað.

40

Ah heo forte werien hire wið him summe `h
´wile : sende him to seggen. þ-nalde ha nawt
lihten se lahe to luuien. Ne nalde ha neolechin
him for na liuiende mon. ear þen he were under
Maximien. hehest i Rome. þ-is heh reue. He ase
timliche as he hefde iherd þis. biȝet ed te
Keiser þet he ȝette him al þ-he walde. 45 7 lette
as me luuede þa leaden him i cure up o fowr
hweoles. 7 teon him ȝeonte tun þron from strete
to strete. Al þe cure ouertild þ-he wes itohen
on ; wið purpres 7 pelles. wið ciclatuns 7
cendals 7 deorewurðe claðes. **AS** þe þ-se heh
þing hefde to heden. ant se riche refschipe to
rihten 7 to readen. þa he hefde þus idon. sende
hire þus 50 to seggen hire wil he hefde iwraht.
Nu his ha schulde wurchen.

Juliene þe eadie ihesu cristes leofmon of his
blisfule luue balde hire seoluen, 7 sende him al
openliche bi sonde to seggen. þis word ha send
te for nawt þu hauest iswechte. wreaðe se þu
wreaðe. Do þ-tu do wult nule ich ne ne mei ich
lengre heolen hit te ȝef þu wult 55 leauen. þe
lahen þet tu liuest in ant leuen i godd feader. 7
in his deorwurðe sune. 7 i þe hali gast folkene
froure. an godd þ-is igret wið euches cunnes
gode ; Ich chule wel neome þe. 7 ȝef þ-tu nult
no ; þu art windi of me. 7 oðer luue sech þe. Ða
þe hehe reue iherde þis ondsware ; bigon to
wreðen swiðe. 7 cleopede hire 60 federforð. 7
feng on to tellen. hwuch word ha sende him.
Efter þ-he wende forte habben idon al þ-he
wilnede. Affrican hire feader wundrede him

wil. 7 al þ-te wel likeð as mit tin ahne. 7 me cleopede hire forð biuoren hire feder. 7 he feng feire to fondin his dohter Mi deorewurðe dohter hwerfore uorsakestu þi sý. ant ti selhðe. þe weolen ant te wunnen þ-walden awakenin ant waxen of þi wedlac. þ-ich þe to reade. for he is inoh 55 lauerd elewsius ine rome. 7 tu maht beon leafdi dohter 3ef þu wel wult. Iuliane þe eadie onswerede him 7 seide as þeo þat ine godd hire hope hefde. 3ef he wule leuen an god al mihti. þenne mei he spoken þrof 7 inoh raðe speden. ant 3ef þ-he nule nawt. ne schal wiuen on me. wiue þer his wil is. þa hire feder iherde þis ; 60 þa feng he to swerien. Bi mi kinewurðe lauerd apollo. ant bi mi deore leafdi diane. þ-ich mucho luuie. 3ef þu haldest heron. ichulle leoten deor toteoren ant toluken þe. 7 3eouen þi flesch ; fuheles of þe lufte. Iuliane him onswerede 7 softeliche seide. ne wen þu nawiht leoue feder. þ-tu affeare me swa. for iesu crist godes sune 65 þ-ich on leue 7 luuie as lauerd lufsumest on liue. þah ich beo forbernd. 7 to loken limel. nulich heronont buhen þe nawiht

Þa feng eft hire [feder] on wið olhnunge to fondin 3ef he mahte eisweis wenden hire heorte. 7 seide hire lufsumliche. þ-ne schulde ha nane wunne lihtliche wilnin ; þ-he ne schulde welden. wið þ-ha walde hire þonc wenden 70 Nai quod þ-meiden schuldich don me to him þ-is alle deoulen bitaht. 7 to eche deð idemet. to furwurðen wið him world abuten ende. for his wedlakes weole oðer for eni wunne. for soð ich hit segge unwurð is hit me. ichulle þ-he hit wite wel. ant tu eke mid him þ-ich am iweddert to an þ-ichulle treowliche to halden ant wiðuten les 75 luuien. þe is

swiðe. 7 bigon to swerien. bi þe ilke godes þ-me is lað to gremien. beo hit soð þ-tu seiist ; to wraðer heale. ha sehð hit. ant ich wulle o great grome al biteachen hire þe. 7 tu do hire. al þ-tu 65 wult. He þonkede him. 7 heo wes icleopet forð. 7 affrican hire feader feng on earst feire on ; to lokin 3ef he mahte wið eani luue speden. Iuliane quod he mi deorewurðe dohter. sei me hwi þu forsakest þi sy 7 ti selhðe? þe weolen 7 te wunnen. þe walden awakenen. 7 waxen of þe wedlac þ-ich reade þe to : hit nis nan 70 eðelich þing. þe refschiþe of rome. ant tu maht 3ef þu wult. beon burhene leafdi. 7 of alle þe londes þe þerto liggeð. Iuliane þe eadie onswerede him 7 seide. 3ef he wule luuien. 7 leuen g`o`dd. al mihti ; þenne mei he [spoken] þrof. 7 speden inoh reaðe. for 3ef he þ-nule no ; ich segge þe þ-soð is. ne schal he wiuen on me. Sei nu 75 hwet ti wil is. affrican wreaðede 7 swor swiðe deopliche. for þe drihtfule godd apollo mi lauerd. 7 mi deore leafdi þe deorewurðe diane þ-ich mucho luuie. 3ef þu haldest heron ; ich schal leote wilde deor to luken 7 toteore þe 7 3eoue þi flesch fode to fuheles of þe lufte. Iuliane him ondsowerede. 7 softeliche seide. Ne lef þu 80 nawt leoue feader þ-tu offeare me swa ; ich swerie a3ein. þe ihesu crist godes sune. þ-ich on leue. 7 luuie as leoflucet. 7 lufsumest lauerd. þah ich cwic beo forbearnd baðe lim 7 lið ileitinde leie. Nulle ich þe her onont þreate se þu þreate buhe ne beien.

[A] ffrican feng eft on. 7 to fondin ongon 3ef he mahte eanis weis 85 wið olhnunge wenden hire heorte. 7 leoftede luueliche. 7 seide hire sikerliche. Ð-ne schulde ha lihtliche wilni na wunne ; þ-ha ne schulde wealden. wið þerean þ-ha walde hire wil wenden. Nai quod ha þ-nis nawt. schulde ich do me to him. þ-alles deoflen is bitaht. 7 to eche deað fordemet. to forwurðe wið him worlt buten ende iþe putte 90 of helle? for his wedlackes weole oðer for ei wunne. To soðe ich hit segge þe. Vnwurð hit is me. Ich chulle þ-

unlich him. 7 alle worldlich men. ne nullich him nowðer leauen. ne lihen for weole ne for wunne. for wa. ne for wunne þet 3e mahen don me.

þa feng hire feder te wreððen swiðe ferlich 7 swiðe hokerliche freinede. Me hwet is he þes were þ-tu art to iweddēt. þ-tu hauest wiðuten me þine luue ilene[t] for hwam þu letest lutel of 80 þ-tu schuldest luuien. ne ich neuer þ-ich wite nes wið him icnawen. For gode *quoð* þet meiden þin harm is þe mare nawt forþi þet tu nauest ofte iherd of him 3are. þ-is iesu godes sune. þe forto lesen moncun þ-forloren

schulden beon ; lette his deo`r`wurðe lif on rode. ne ich ne seh him neuer þ-me sare for þuncheð. ah ichim luuie ant 85 leue as on lauerde. ne schal me firsin him from ; nowðer deouel ne mon. For mi lif *quoð* hire feder þe schal laðin his luue for þu schalt beon ibeaten. mid besmes swa bittre þ-tu wummon were. schal to wraðer heale iwurðen. Swa muche *quoð* ha ich iwurðe him þe leouere ; So ich

derure þing for his luue drehe. þ-ti wil is ; wurch nu. 90 7 he het hatterliche strupen hire steortnaket. 7 beten hire swa luðere þ-hire

leofliche lich ; liðeri al oblode. 7 swa ha duden so luðere þ-te blod 3et adun of þe 3erden. 7 heo bigon to 3eien. Beaten so 3e beaten 3e beliales bu deles. ne mahe 3e nowðer mi luue ne min bileaue lutlen toward him mi lufsum leof mi leowinde lauerd ne 95 nullich leauen ower read þ-for readeð ow seoluen. ne ower mix mawmex þ-beoð þes feondes fetles heien ne herien. for teone ne for tintreow þ-3e mahen timbrin. Na *quoð* he is hit swa hit schal sutelin sone. for ichulle biteachen mislich þi bodi to elewsium þe riche reue irome ant he schal forswelten ant forreden þe efter es wille wið 100 allescunnes pinen.

he wite hit ful wel. 7 tu eke mid al ; i`c`h am to an iweddēt þ-ich chulle treowliche wiðute leas luuien. þ-is unlich him 7 alle wortliche men. ne nulle ich neauer mare him lihen ne lea uen. for weole ne for wunne. for 95 wa ne for wontreaðe þ-3e me mahen wurchen.

Hire feader feng on to wreaððin swiðe ferliche 7 easkede hire hokerliche. Ant hwet is he þes were þ-tu art to iweddēt. þ-tu hauest wiðute me se forð þi luue ilenet. þ-tu letest lutel. of al þ-tu schuldest luuien. Ne ich nes neauer þ-ich wite 3et. wið him 100 icnawen. for gode *quoð* þe meiden þin hearm is þe mare. Nawt forþi þ-tu nauest iherd of him 3are. Ð-is ihesu godes sune. þ-forfe alesen

moncun þ-schulde beon forloren al ; lette lif o rode. Ich ne seh him neauer 7 þ-me ofþuncheð. Ah ich him luuie 7 wulle don. 7 leue on as o lauerd. Ne schal me firsin him from. Nowðer 105 deouel ne mon. for mi lif *quoð* hire feader þe schal laðin his luue. for þu schalt habbe þrof hearm 7 scheome baðe 7 nu þu schalt on alre earst. as on ernesne swa beon ibeaten wið bittere besmen. þ-tu were wummon of wummone bosum to wraðerheale eauer iboren iþe worlde. Swa muche *quoð* þ-meiden ich beo him þe leouere. se ich 110 derfre þing for his luue drehe. [wurch] þu þ-ti wil is. 3e *quoð* he bliðeliche. ant swiðe heatterliche. strupen hire steort naket. 7 leggeð se luðer liche on hire

leofliche lich ; þ-hit liðeri o blode. Me nom hire 7 dude swa þ-hit 3eat adun of þe 3erden. ant heo bigon to 3eien. Beaten se 3e beaten 3e beliales budeles. ne mahe 3e nowðer 115 mi luue ne mi bileaue lutlin towart te liuiende godd mi leofsume leofmon. þe luuewurðe lauerd. ne nulle ich leuen ower read þe forreadeð ow seolf. ne þe mix maumez þe beoð

þes feondes fetles ; heien ne herien. for teone ne for tintreowe þ-3e me mahe timbrin. Na nult tu *quoð* affrican. hit schal sone sutelin. for ich chulle sende 120 þe nu 7 biteache þi bodi to eleusium þe riche þ-reue is ouer rome. ant he schal þe forreaden. 7 makie to forswelten. as his ahne wil is þurh al þet eauer sar iS.

3e quoð þis meiden þ-mei crist welden. for ne
mahe 3e nawt don me bute hwet he wule
þeauien ow to muchelin mi mede 7 te murðe þ-
lið to meiðhades menske for euer so 3e mare
merrið me her ; so mi crune bið brihtre 7
fehere. for ichulle bliðeliche drehen euer euch
derf for mi deore lauwerdes luue. ant softe me
105 bið euch derf hwen ich him serui þah þume
to elewsium willes biteache ; ne 3eue ich for
inc nowðer. þ-3e me mahen harmen. for so 3e
mare me her harmeð. so mare [3]e me helpeð
seoueuald to heouene. 7 3ef 3e me doð to deaðe
hit bið me deorewurðe ant ich schal þer þurh
bliðe bicumen into endelese blissen ant 3e
schulen wrecches 110 áwei ower wurðes þ-3e
iboren weren sinken to wraðer heale ow to þe
bale bitter deope into helle.

Hire feder affrican þurh þis bittre teone bitahte
hire to elewsium þe luðere reue. ant he lette
bringen hire biuoren him to his heh seotel as he
set in dome as reue of þe burhe . . . 115

þa elewsius iseh þis þ-ha þus feng on to festnen
hire seoluen þohte þ-he walde anan don hire ut
of dahene 7 bed swiðe bringen hire brune of
wallinde breas ant healden on hire heauet þ-hit
urne endelong hire leofliche bodi dun to þe
helen ant swa me dude sone. ah hire hende
healent wiste hire unweommet. elewsius 120
warð wod ut of his witte. ant nuste hwet seggen
7 het swiðe don hire ut of his ehsihðe. 7
drehen hire into darc hus 7 prisunes pine. ant
he duden sone. Heo as ha þrinne wes in
þeosternes hire ane feng te cleopien to crist
ant bidden þeos bone.

Lauerd godd al mihti. mi murhðe ant mi
mede mi sy ant mi 125 selhðe þu isist hu
icham bistaðet ant bistonden festne mi bileaue

3e quoð þis meiden þ-mei godd welden. ne
mahe 3e nawt do me bute þet he wule
þeauien 7 þolien ow to donne to mucli mi mede
125 7 te murhðe þ-lið to meiðhades menske. for
eauer se 3e nu her mearreð me mare ; se mi
crune schal beon brihttre ba 7 fehere. forþi ich
chulle bliðeliche 7 wið bliðe heorte drehen
eauer euch derf. for mi leofmones luue þe
lufsume lauwerd 7 softe me bið euch sar in his
seruise. þu wult þu seist a3eoue me to elewsium
þe luðere. 130 a3ef me for nawiht ne 3eoue ich
for inc nowðer. Þet 3e mahen ane pine me here.
Ah hit ne hearmed me nawt ah helpeð 7 heueð
up 7 makeð mine murhðes monifalde in
heouene. ant 3ef 3e doð me to deað. hit bið
deore to godd. 7 ich schal bliðe bicumen to
endelese blissen. ant 3e schulen wrecches wei
ower wurðes. 135 þ-3e weren iþe worlt iboren 7
ibroht forð se wraðer heale 3e schule sinken
adun to sar 7 to eche sorhe. to bitternesse ant to
bale deope into helle.

[A]ffrican hire feader bitterliche iteonet
bitahte hire elewsium þe luðere reue
of rome 7 lette bringen hire biuoren his 140 eh
sihðe. as he set 7 demde. þe hehe burh domes.

.

[þ]a elewsius seh þ-ha þus feng on to
festnin hire seoluen isoðe bileaue ;
þohte he walde don hire anan ut of dahene : 7
bed biliue bringen forð brune wallinde bres. 7
healden hit se wal hat hehe up on hire heaued.
þ-hit urne 145 enddelong hire leofliche lich
adun to hire helen. Me dude al as he het. Ah þe
worldes wealdent þ-wiste sein iuhan his
ewangeliste unhurt iðe ueat of wallinde eoli þer
he wes idon in. þ-ase hal com up þrof ; as he
wes hal meiden. þe ilke liues lauwerd. wiste him
unwemmet. his brud of þe bres þ-wes wallinde.
swa þ-ne þuhte 150 hit hire buten ase wlech
weater al þ-ha felde. Elewsius wod þa nuste
hwet seggen. Ah hehte swiðe don hire ut of his
ehsihðe. 7 dreaen into dorc hus to prisunes
pine ant swa ha wes idon sone.

[H]eo as ha þrinne wes i þeosternes
hire ane. feng to 155 cleopien to crist
7 bidde þeos bone. lauwerd godd al mihti mi

steor me ant streng me. for al mi strençðe is
 uppon þe. mi fedeR. 7 mi modeR for ich nulle
 forsaken þe ; habbeð forsaken me 7 al mi nest
 falde cun me heaneð þet schulden mine freond
 beon ; beoð me mest feondes ant mine hinen
 me beoð mest heanen ah habbich þin 130 anes
 help icham wil cweme ne leaf þume neuer
 liuiende lauerd as þu wistest daniel bimong þe
 wode leuns ant te þreo children ananie zacharie
 misael inempnet. biwistest unweommet from
 þe ferliche fur of þe furneise swa þu wite ant
 witen me to witen me from sunne. lauerd þurh
 þis lease lif ; lead me to lestinde to þe hauene
 135 of heale as þu leddest israeles folc þurh þe
 reade sea buten schip druifot ant hare fan
 senchtest þ-ham efter sohten afal þumine famen
 ant todrif drihtin þen deouel þ-me derueð. for
 ne mei na mon wiðuten þi strençðe stonden
 him azeines lef me þ-ich mote iseon him 3et
 schent ; þ-weneð me to schrenchen ant
 schunchen of þe 140 weie ; þ-leadeð to eche lif.
 wite me from his lað ant wið his crefti crokes.
 wite me wið mine unwines þ-tu beo euer iheret
 ant iheiet in heouene ant in eorðe beo þu áá
 iblescet as þu were ant art. ant euer schalt beon
 in eche blisse. amen.

murhðe 7 mi mede. mi sý 7 al þe selhðe. þ-ich
 efter seche þu sist al hu ich am bistaðet 7
 bistonden. festne mi bileaue. Riht me 7 read
 me. for al mi trust is on þe. Steor me 7 streng
 me for al mi strengðe is of þe. Mi feader 7 Mi
 moder forþi þ-ich nule þe 160 forsaken ; habbe
 forsake me. 7 al mi nestfalde cun. þ-schulde
 beo me best freond ; beoð me meast feondes. 7
 mine inhinen ; alre meast hea[r]men.
 herewurðe healent. habbe ich þin anes help. ich
 am wilcweme ne forleaf þu me nawt luuiende
 lauerd. as þu biwistest daniel bimong þe wode
 liuns ilatet se luðere. 7 te þreo 165 children þe
 chearre nalden from þe lahen þ-ha schulden
 luuien. Ananie 7 Azarie 7 Misahel inempnet. Al
 þu al wealdent biwistest ham unwemmet. wid þ-
 ferliche fur i þe furneise. swa þu wunne of þe
 worlt wite me 7 were 7 witere. 7 wisse þurh þi
 wisdom to wite me wið sunne. lauerd liues
 lattow. lead me þurh þis lease. þis lutle 170
 leastinde lif ; to þe hauene of heale. As þu
 lead`d`est israeles leode of egipte bute schip
 dru fot þurh þe reade sea. 7 asenchtest hare uan
 þe ferden ham efter. 7 tu folkes feader. aual
 mine vamen. 7 tu drihtin todrif þe deouel þ-me
 derueð. for ne mei na monnes st`r`engðe wið
 uten þin stonden him to 3eines. lef me þ-ich
 mote 175 mihti meinfule godd iseon him
 ischeomet 3et þe weneð me to schrenchen. 7
 schunchen of þe nearowe wei þ-leadeð to eche
 lif. loke me from his lað liuiende lauerð. Make
 me war 7 wite me wið his crefti crokes. þ-ha
 me ne crechen. were me swa wið þen vnwine.
 helpleses heale. Ð-tu beo iheiet 7 iheret eare in
 eorðe. as in 180 heouene. Beo þu aa iblescet
 lauerd as þu were ant art 7 schalt beon in eche.

XX. THE OWL AND THE NIGHTINGALE

“i. Jesus College, Oxford, E 29 (J); see [VI, Alfred]. ii. Cotton Caligula A 9,
 British Museum (C); see XIV, *Lazamon*. They are copies of a common

exemplar X, which was probably taken directly from the poet's original. X was written by two scribes; the work of the first is represented in ll. 1-353 of the present selection; that of the second in ll. 354-437; the former was accustomed to French scribal methods. The writer of C was a mechanical copyist and not at home in English, consequently he reproduces X with tolerable accuracy. The scribe of J was more independent (see [VI, Alfred, second paragraph in the e-text])."

Cotton MS.
Parallel texts

JESUS COLLEGE MS.

Incipit Altercacio inter filomenam 7 Bubonem.

I ch wes in one sumere dale.
In one swiþe dyele hale.
I herde ich holde grete tale.
An vle and one nyhtegale.
5 þat playd wes· stif· 7 starc· 7 strong.
Sum hwile softe· 7 lud among.
And eyþer ayeyn oþer swal.
And let þat vuele mod vt al.
And eyþer seyde of oþres custe.
10 þat alre wrste þat hi ywuste.
7 hure 7 hure of oþres songe.
hi holde playding swiþe stronge.
þe Nihtegale bi gon þo speke.
In one hurne of one beche.
15 7 sat vp one vayre bowe.
þat were abute blostme ynowe.
In ore vaste thikke hegge.
I meynd myd spire. 7 grene segge.
He wes þe gladdre. vor þe ryse.
20 7 song a veole cunne wyse.
Bet þuhte þe drem. þat he were.

6. *among*] o corr.
out of *g*.

of harpe· 7 pipe· þan he nere.
Bet þuhte þat heo were i shote.
of harpe· 7 pipe· þan of þrote.
25 Þo stod on old stok. þar bȳ side.
Þar þe vle song hire tyde.
And wes myd i vi al bi growe.
Hit wes þare vle erdingstowe.
Þe Nihtegale hi iseyh.
30 7 hibiholdeþ. and ouerseyh.
7 þuhte wel ful of þare vle.
For me hi halt. lodlich 7 fule. |
vnwyht heo seide away þu fleo.
Me is þe wurs. þat ich þe iseo.
35 Iwis for þine wle lete.
wel ofte ich my song furlete
Min heorte atflyhþ· 7 falt my tunge.
hwenne þu art to me iþrunge.
Me luste bet speten þane singe.
40 of þine fule howelynge.
Þeos vle abod for hit wes eve.
heo ne myhte no leng bileue.
vor hire heorte wes so gret.
þat wel neyh hire fnast atset.
45 7 warp a word þar after longe.
hw þynk þe nu bi mine songe.
Wenestu þat ich ne kunne singe.
Þe ich ne cunne of wrytelinge.
Ilome þu dest me grome.
50 7 seist me boþe teone 7 schome.
If ich þe heolde on myne vote.
So hit bitide þat ich mote.
7 þu were vt of þine ryse.
þu scholdest singe on oþer wise.
55 Þe Nihtegale 3af onsware.
If ich me loki wiþ þe bare.
7 me schilde wit þe blete.

Ne recche ich nouht of þine þrete.
 If ich me holde *in* myne hegge
 60 Ne recche ich neuer hwat þu segge.
 Ich wot þat þu art vnmilde.
 wiþ heom þat ne muwe from þe schilde.
 And þu tukest wroþe 7 vuele
 Hwar þu myht ouer smale voweþe. |
 vorþi þu art loþ al fowel cunne.
 66 7 alle heo þe dryueþ heonne.
 7 þe biscrycheþ. 7 bi gredeþ
 7 wel narewe þe by ledeþ.
 7 ek forþe þe sulue mose
 70 hire þonkes wolde þe to tose.
 þu art lodlich to biholde.
 And þu art loþ *in* monye volde.
 þi bodi is scort. þi swere is smal.
 Grette is þin heued ne þu al.
 75 þin éyen beoþ colblake 7 brode.
 Ryht so hi weren ipeynt myd wode
 þu starest so þu wille abyten
 Al þat þu myht myd clyure smyten
 þi bile is stif· 7 sarp· 7 hoked.
 80 Riht as on ewel þat is croked.
 þar myd þu clechest euer among.
 And þat is on of þine song.
 Ac þu þretest to myne vleysse.
 Mid þine cleures woldest me meysse.
 85 þe were icundere to one frogge.
 þat sit at Mulne vnder cogge.
 Snayles. Mus. and fule wihte.
 Beoþ þine cunde 7 þine rihte.
 Þu sittest a day and flyhst a niht.
 90 þu cuþest þat þu art on vnwiht.
 þu art lodlich· and unclene.
 Bi þine neste· ich hit mene.
 And ek bi þine fule brode.

75. *en ... brode* on
an erasure.

91. *7 and MS.*

þu vedest on heom a wel ful vode.

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The “e” in “þeos” is subscripted in two different printings. It is not explained in the Notes.

þ_eos word ayaf þe nihtegale.
96 And after þare longe tale.
Heo song so lude. 7 so scharpe.
Ryht so me grulde. schille harpe.
þeos vle luste þiderward.
100 7 heold hire eyen neþerward.
7 sat toswolle 7 to bolewe.
so heo hedde one frogge i` s` wolwe.
For heo wel wiste. 7 was iwar.
þat heo song hire a bysemar.
105 7 napeles heo yaf ondsware.
hwy neltu fleon into bare.
And schewi hweþer vnker beo.
of brihter hewe. of fayrur bleo.
No. þu hauest scharpe clawe.
110 Ne kepe ich noht þat þu me clawe.
þu hauest clyures swiþe stronge.
þu twengest þar mid so doþ a tonge.
þu þoutest so doþ þine ilyche.
Mid fayre worde me biswike.
115 Ich nolde don þat þu me raddest.
Ich wiste wel þat þu me misraddest.
schomye þe vor þine vnrede.
vnwryen is þi swikehede.
schild þi swikedom from þe lyhte.
120 And hud þat wowe among þe ryhte.
hwanne þu wilt þu vnriht spene.
Loke þat hit ne beo isene. |
vor swikedom haueþ schome and het

If hit is ope. and vnder yete.
 125 Ne spedestu nouht mid þin vnwrenche
 For ich am war. and can blenche.
 Ne helpeþ noht· þat þu bo· to þriste.
 Ich wolde vyhte bet myd liste.
 þan þu mid al þine strengþe.
 130 Ich habbe on brede· 7 ek on lengþe.
 Castel god on myne ryse.
 wel fyht þat wel flyhþ. seyþ þe wise.
 Ac lete away þeos cheste.
 For suche wordes beoþ vnwreste.
 135 And fo we on· myd rihte dome.
 Mid fayre worde. 7 myd some.
 þeyh we ne beon at on acorde.
 we mawe bet myd fayre worde.
 wiþvte cheste· and bute vyhte.
 140 Playde mid soþe. 7 mid ryhte.
 7 may vr eyþer hwat he wile.
 Mid rihte segge. 7 myd skile.
Þo qwaþ þe vle. hwo schal vs seme.
 þat cunne 7 wille riht vs deme.
 145 Ich wot wel quaþ þe nyhtegale.
 Ne þarf þer of beo no tale.
 Mayster Nichol· of guldeuorde.
 he is wis· and war· of worde.
 he is of worde swyþe glev.
 150 And him is loþ eurich vnþeu.
 he wot insyht in euche songe.
 hwo singeþ wel. hwo singeþ wronge.
 And he con schede from þe rihte.
 Þat wowe. þat þuster from þe lyhte.
Þ 155 e vle. one hwile hi bihouhte.
 And after þan þis word up brouhte. |
 Ich graunti wel þa`t` he vs deme.
 For þeyh he were hwile breme.
 7 leof him wre Nihtingale.

160 And oþer wyhte gent 7 smale.
 Ich wot. he is nu þe acoled.
 Nis he vor þe nouht afoled.
 þat he vor þine olde luue.
 Me a dun legge 7 þe a buue.
 165 N[e] schaltu. neuer so him queme.
 þat he vor þe fals dom deme.
 he is nv ripe. 7 fast rede.
 Ne luste hym nv to non vnrede.
 Nv him ne lust namore pleye
 170 he wile gon a rihte weye.
Þe nihtegale· wes al ware.
 heo hedde ileorned· wel ihware.
 vle heo seyde seye me soþ.
 hwi dostu þat vnwihtes doþ.
 175 þu singest a nyht 7 nouht aday.
 And al þi song is waylaway.
 þu miht mid þine songe afere.
 Alle þat hereþ þine ibere.
 Þ[u] scrichest 7 yollest to þine fere
 180 þat hit is gryslich to ihere.
 hit þincheþ boþe wise 7 snepe.
 Nouht þat þu singe. at þu wepe.
 þu flyhst a nyht and noht a day.
 þar of ich wundri 7 wel may.
 185 For vych þing þat schonyeþ riht.
 hit luuyeþ þuster 7 hateþ lyht.
 7 euych þing. þat luueþ misdede.
 hi luueþ þuster to his dede.

188. *hi* corr. out of
his MS.

.
Þeos vle luste swiþe longe.
 190 7 wes ofteoned swiþe stronge.
 heo quab. þu hattest Nihtegale.
 þu mihtest bet hote galegale.
 vor þu hauest to monye tale.
 let þine tunge habbe spale.

195 þu wenest þat þes day beo þin owe.

let me nv habbe myne þrowe.

Beo nv stille 7 let me speke.

Ich wile beo of þe a wreke.

7 lust hw ich con me bitelle.

200 Mid rihte soþe wiþvte spelle.

þu seyst þat ich me hude aday

þar to ne segge ich nyk no nay

7 lust ich telle hwervore

Al hwi hit is 7 hwarevore. |

Ich habbe bile stif 7 stronge.

206 7 gode cleures scharp 7 longe.

So hit bycumeþ to hauekes cunne.

hit is myn hyhte· 7 my ynnē.

þat ich me drawe to mine cunde.

210 Ne may me no mon þarfor sende.

on me hit is wel i sene.

For rihte cunde ich am so kene.

vor þi ich am loþ smale vowele.

Þat fleoþ bi grunde 7 bi þuuele.

215 hi me bichirmeþ 7 bigredeþ.

7 heore flockes to me ledeþ.

Me is leof to habbe reste.

And sitte stille in myne neste.

.

wenestu þat hauek beo þe wrse.

220 Þe crowe bigrede him bi þe mersche.

7 goþ to him myd heore chyrme.

Riht so hi wille. wiþ him schirme.

þe hauek foleweþ gode rede.

He flyhþ his wey 7 let hi grede.

Þ 225 et þu me seyst of oþer þinge.

7 tellest þat ich ne can nouht singe.

Ac al my reorde is wonyng.

And to ihere gryslych þing.

þat nis nouht soþ. ich singe efne.

230 Mid fulle dreme· 7 lude stefne.
 þu wenest þat eoch song beo *grislich*.
 þat þine pipinge nis ilich.
 Mi stefne is bold· 7 nouht vnorne.
 heo is ilich one grete horne.
 235 7 þin is iliche one pype.
 of one smale weode vnripe.
 Ich [singe] bet þan þu dest.
 Þu chaterest so doþ on yris prest.
 Ich singe an efne. aryhte time.
 240 7 seþþe hwenne hit is bedtime.
 þe þridde syþe a middelnyhte.
 7 so ich myne songe adihte.
 hwenne ich iseo arise veorre
 oþer dayrewe· oþer daysteorre.
 245 Ic do god myd myne þrote.
 And warny men to heore note.
 Ac þu singest alle longe nyht.
 From eue þat hit is dayliht.
 7 euer lesteþ þin o song,
 250 so longe so þe nyht is long.
 7 euer croweþ þi wrecche crey.
 Ðat he ne swikeþ nyht ne day. |
 Mid þine pipinge þu adunest.
 þas monnes eren. þar þu wunest.
 255 7 makest þi song, so vnwiht.
 þat me ne telleþ. of þe nowiht.
 Eurych mureþe may so longe leste.
 þat heo schal liki wel vnwreste.
 for harpe. 7 pipe. 7 foweles song.
 260 Mislikeþ. if hit is to long.
 Ne beo þe song ne so murie.
 þat he ne sal þinche vnmurie.
 If he ilesteþ ouer vnwille.
 So þu myht þi song aspille.
 265 for hit is soþ Alured hit seyde.

7 me hit. may in boke rede.
Eurich þing may lesen his godhede.
Mid vnmeþe and ouerdede.

· · · · ·
Þe nyhtegale in hire þouhte.
270 Atheold al þis. 7 longe þouhte.

hwat heo þar after myhte segge,
vor heo ne myhte noht alege.
þat þe vle hedde hire i seyd.
vor ho spak boþe riht 7 red.

275 7 hire of þuhte þat heo hadde.
þe speche so feoruorþ iladde.

7 wes aferd þat hire answare
Ne wrþe nouht a riht ivare.

Ac noþeles heo spak boldeliche
280 vor heo is wis þat hardeliche.
wiþ his fo berþ grete ilete.

þat he for arehþe hit ne forlete.
vor suych worþ bold if þu flyhst.

þa t´ wile fleo if þu swykst. |
If he isihþ þat þu nart areh.

286 he wile of bore wurche bareh.
7 for þi· þey `þe´ nyhtegale.

Were aferd· heo spak bolde tale.

Hvle heo seyde· hwi dostu so.
290 þu singest a wynter wolawo.

þu singest so doþ hen asnowe.

Al þat heo singeþ hit is for wowe.

A winter þu singest wroþe 7 yomere.

7 euer þu art. dumb a sumere.

295 hit is for þine fule nyþe

þat þu ne myht. myd vs be bliþe.

vor þu forbernest· neyh for onde.

hwenne vre blisse cumeþ to londe.

þu farest so doþ þe ille.

300 Euerich blisse him is vnwille.

282. *þat]* *hwat* MS.

285. *art* MS.

287. *þe* added in
margin.

289. *Þule*

Grucching· 7· luryng. him beoþ rade.
 If he iseoþ. þat men beoþ glade.
 he wolde þat he iseye.
 Teres *in* eueriche monnes eye.
 305 Ne roughete þe. þeyh flockes were.
 Imeynd bi toppes· 7 bi here.
 Also þu dost on þire syde.
 For hwanne snouh liþ þikke 7 wide.
 7 alle wihtes habbeþ sorewe.
 310 þu singest from eue to amorewe.
 Ac ich mid me alle blisse bringe.
 Ech wiht is glad· for myne þinge.
 7 blesseþ hit· hwenne ich cume.
 7 hihteþ ayeyn myne cume.
 315 þe blostme. gynneþ springe 7 sprede.
 Boþe *in* treo 7 ek *in* mede.
 þe lilie myd hire fayre wlite.
 welcomeþ me þeyh þu hit wite.
 Bid me myd hire fayre bleo. |
 þat ich schulle to hire fleo.
 321 þe rose also myd hire rude.
 þat cumeþ of þe þorne wode.
 Bit me þat ich schulle singe.
 For hire luue one skentyng.

.
 [V]le þu axest me heo seyde.
 326 [I]f ich con eny oþer dede.
 Bute syngen *in* sume tyde.
 7 bringe blisse veor 7 wyde.
 hwy axestu of craftes myne.
 330 Beter is myn on þan alle þine.
 Beter is o song of myne muþe.
 þan al þat þi kun kuþe.
 7 lust. ich telle þe hwarvore.
 wostu to hwan· mon wes ibore.
 335 To þare blisse of heueryche. |

þar euer is song. 7 Murehþe ilyche.
 þider fundeþ euer ich man.
 þat eny þing of gode can.
 for þi me syngþ in holy chireche.
 340 7 clerekes gynneþ songes wrche.
 þat mon yþenche. bi þe songe.
 hwider he shal. 7 þar beon longe.
 þat he þe murehþe ne voryete.
 Ac þar of þenche. 7 bi gete.
 345 7 nyme yeme of chirche stefne.
 hw Murie is þe blisse of heuene.
 Clerekes· Munekes· 7 canúnes.
 þar beoþ þos gode wiketunes.
 Ariseþ vp to middelnyhte.
 350 7 singeþ of þon heuenelyhte.
 7 preostes vpe londe singeþ.
 [Hwenne þe liht of daye springeþ.]
 7 ich heom helpe hwat ic may.

344. *bi gete]* *bi*
gethe MS.

352. Wanting in
MS.

.
Þe Nihtegale myd sweche worde.
 355 for monymon myd speres orde.
 haueþ lute strengþe. 7 mid his schelde.
 Ah napeles in one felde.
 þurh belde worde 7 myd ilete.
 Deþ his iuo· for arehþe swete.
 360 þe wrenne for heo cuþe singe.
 þar com in þare moreweninge.
 To helpe þare nyhtegale.
 vor heo hadde stefne smale.
 heo hadde gode þrote 7 schille.
 365 7 fale monne song a wille.
 þe wrenne· wes wel wis iholde.
 vor þeih heo nere ibred a wolde.
 heo wes itowen. among mankunne
 7 hire wisdom brouhte þenne.
 370 heo myhte speke hwar heo wolde.

To fore þe kinge· þah heo scholde.
 lusteþ· heo queþ· leteþ me speke.
 hwat wille ye. þis pays to breke.
 7 do þan [kinge] such schome.
 375 yet nys heo nouþer ded ne lome.
 hunke schal i tyde harm 7 schonde.
 If we doþ gryþbruche on his londe.
 Leteþ beo and beoþ isome.
 7 fareþ riht to eure dome.
 380 7 leteþ dom þis playd to breke.
 Also hit wes erure bispeke.
 Ich vnne wel queþ þe Nihtegale.
 Ah wrenne· nouht for þine tale.
 Ac do for myre lauhfulnesse.
 385 Ic nolde þat vnrihtfulnesse.
 Me at þen ende· me ouercome.
 Ic nam of dred. of none dome.
 Bihote ic habbe· soþ hit is.
 þat maýster Nichole. þis wis.
 390 Bitwihen eu deme schulle.
 7 yet ic wene þat he wulle. |
 Ah war myhte we hine fynde.
 þe wrenne sat in hore lynde.
 hwat mihte yet quaþ heo his hom.
 395 heo wuneþ at porteshom.
 At one tune in dorsete.
 Bi þare séé in ore vtlete.
 þar he demeþ mony riht dom.
 7 diht 7 wryt mony wisdom.
 400 7 þurh his muþe. 7 þurh his honde.
 hit is þe betere into scotlonde.
 To seche hyne. is lyhtlych þing.
 he naueþ buten o wunyng.
 þis biscoppen muchel schame.
 405 7 alle þan þ of his nome.
 habbeþ iherd. 7 of his dede.

374. *þan kinge]*
þanne MS.

392. *war]* *þar MS.*

394. *lyet MS.*

hwi nulleþ hi nymen heom to rede.
þ he were myd heom ilome.
vor teche heom of his wisdom.
410 7 yeue him rente on vale stude.
þ he myhte ilome heom beo myde.
Certes quap þe vle. þat is soþ.
þeos riche men· Muchele mysdoþ.
þat leteþ þane gode man.
415 þat of so fele þinge can.
7 yeueþ rente wel mislyche.
7 of him leteþ wel lyhtliche.
wiþ heore kunne heo beoþ Mildre.
7 yeueþ rente lute childre.
420 so heore wit hi demep adwole.
þ euer abit Mayster Nichole.
Ah vte we þah· to him fare,
vor þat is vnker dom al yare
Do we þe Nihtegale seyde.
425 Ah hwo schal vnker speche rede.
7 telle tovore vnker dome.
þar of ic schal þe wel iqueme
Queþ þe vle. for al ende of orde. |
Telle ic con. word after worde.
430 7 if þe þinkþ þat ic misrempe.
þu stond ayeyn and do me crempe.
Mid þisse worde forþ hi ferden.
Al bute here and bute verde.
To portes ham. þer hi bcome.
435 Ah hw heo spedde of heore dome.
Ne can ic eu namore telle.
her nys namore of þisse spelle.
Explicit.

435. hw heo sp on
an erasure.

THE OWL AND THE NIGHTINGALE

COTTON MS.

Ich was in one sumere dale.
In one suþe diþele hale.
I herde ich holde grete tale.
An hule and one niztingale.
5 Þat plait was stif 7 starc 7 strong.
Sum wile softe 7 lud among.
An aiþer aþen oþer sval.
7 let þat wole mod ut al.
7 eiþer seide of oþeres custe.
10 þat alre worste þat hi wuste.
7 hure and hure of oþere[s] songe
Hi holde plaiding suþe stronge.
Þe niztingale bigon þe speche.
In one hurne of one breche.
15 7 sat upone vaire boþe.
þar were abute blosme inoþe.
In ore waste þicke hegge.
Imeind mid spire 7 grene segge.
Ho was þe gladur uor þe rise.
20 7 song auele cunne wise.
Bet þuþte þe dreim þat he were.
Of harpe 7 pipe þan he nere.
Bet þuþte þat he were ishote.
Of harpe 7 pipe þan of þrote.
25 [Þ]o stod on old stoc þarbise.
þar þo vle song hire tide.
7 was mid iui albigrowe.
Hit was þare hule eardingstowe.
[Þ]e niztingale hi iseþ.

7. *asþer. oþer* in
margin MS.

10. *alere* MS.

21. *Bet] Het* MS.

23. *is hote* MS.

30 7 hi bihold 7 ouerseȝ.
 7 þuȝte wel wl of þare hule.
 For me hi halt lodlich 7 fule.
 vn wiȝt ho sede awei þu flo.
 Me is þe wrs þat ich þe so. |
 I wis for þine wle lete.
 36 wel oft ich mine song forlete.
 Min horte atfliþ 7 falt mi tonge.
 wonne þu art to me iþrunge.
 Me luste bet speten þane singe.
 40 Of þine fule ȝoȝelinge.
Þ os hule abod fort hit was eve.
 Ho ne miȝte no leng bileue.
 vor hire horte was so gret.
 þat welneȝ hire fnast atschet.
 45 7 warp a word þar after longe.
 Hu þincþe nu bi mine songe.
 we[n]st þu þat ich ne cunne singe.
 þeȝ ich ne cunne of writelinge.
 Ilome þu dest me *g*rame
 50 7 seist me boþe tone 7 schame
 ȝif ich þe holde on mine uote.
 So hit bitide þat ich mote.
 7 þu were vt of þine rise.
 þu sholdest singe an oþer w[i]se.
Þ 55 e niȝtingale ȝaf answare.
 ȝif ich me loki wit þe bare.
 7 me schilde wit þe blete.
 Ne reche ich noȝt of þine þrete.
 ȝif ich me holde in mine hegge.
 60 Ne recche ich neuer what þu segge.
 Ich wot þat þu art unmilde.
 Wiþ hom þat ne muȝe from þe schilde.
 7 þu tukest wroþe 7 vuele.
 Whar þu miȝt over smale fuȝele.
 65 Vorþi þu art loþ al fuelkunne.

62. *þe*] *se* MS.

7 alle ho þe driueþ honne.
 7 þe bischricheþ 7 bigredet.
 7 wel narewe þe biledet. |
 7 ek forþe þe sulue mose.
 70 Hire þonkes wolde þe totose.
 Þu art lodlich to biholde.
 7 þu art loþ in monie volde.
 þi bodi is short þi swore is. smal.
 Gretteþ is þin heued þan þu al.
 75 þin eþene boþ colblake 7 brode.
 Riht swo ho weren ipeint mid wode.
 þu starest so þu wille abiten.
 Al þat þu mist mid cliure smiten.
 þi bile is stif 7 scharp 7 hoked.
 80 Riht so an owel þat is croked.
 þarmid þu clackes oft`e´ 7 longe.
 7 þat is on of þine songe.
 Ac þu pretest to mine fleshe.
 Mid þine cliures woldest me meshe.
 85 þe were icundur to one frogge.
 [Þat sit at mulne under cogge.]
 Snailes, mus 7 fule wihte.
 Boþ þine cunde 7 þine rihte.
 þu sittest adai and fliht[st] aniht.
 90 þu cuþest þat þu art on unwiht.
 þu art lodlich 7 unclene.
 Bi þine neste ich hit mene.
 7 ek bi þine fule brode.
 þu fedest on hom a wel ful fode.

86. Line omitted in MS. but there is a mark on margin.

89. *fliht*] *ih* corr. out of *u*.

.
Þos word a 3af þe nihtingale.
 96 7 after þare longe tale.
 He song so lude 7 so scharpe.
 Riht so me grulde schille harpe.
 þos hule luste þiderward.
 100 7 hold hire eþe noþerwa[r]d.

7 sat to svolle 7 ibolwe.
 also ho hadde one frogge isuol3e.
 for ho wel wiste 7 was i war.
 þat ho song hire a bisemar.
 105 7 nopeles ho 3af andsuare.
 whi neltu flon into þe bare.
 7 sewi þare unker bo.
 Of brizter howe of uairur blo.
 No þu hauest wel scharpe clawe.
 110 Ne kepich no3t þat þu me clawe.
 þu hauest cliuers suþe stronge.
 þu tuengst þarmid so doþ a tonge.
 þu þo3test so doþ þin ilike.
 Mid faire worde me biswike.
 115 Ich nolde don þa`t´ þu me raddest.
 Ich wiste wel þat þu me misraddest.
 Schamie þe for þin unrede.
 vnwro3en is þi svikelhede.
 Schild þine svikeldom vram þe lizte.
 120 7 hud þat wo3e amon3 þe rizte.
 þane þu wilt þin unrizt spene.
 Loke þat hit ne bo isene.
 vor svikedom haued schome 7 hete.
 3if hit is ope 7 under 3ete.
 125 Ne speddestu no3t mid þine unwrenche.
 for icham war 7 can wel blenche.
 Ne helpþ no3t þat þu bo to þriste. |
 Ich wolde vizte bet mid liste.
 þan þu mid all þine strengþe.
 130 Ich abbe on brede 7 eck on lengþe.
 Castel god on mine rise.
 wel fizt þat wel flizt seiþ þe wise.
 ac lete we awei þos cheste.
 vor suiche wordes boþ unwerste.
 135 7 fo we on mid rizte dome.
 Mid faire worde 7 mid wsome.

105. 3as corr. in
 margin to 3af.

115. þat] t added by
 a second hand.

127. þriste] wriste
 MS.

130. eck corr. out of
 ech MS.

þeʒ we ne bo at one acorde.
we muʒe bet mid fawre worde.
witure cheste 7 bute fiʒte.

140 Plaidi mid foʒe 7 mid riʒte.
7 mai hure eiþer wat he wile.
Mid riʒte segge 7 mid sckile.

141. *he]* *hi* MS.

Þo quap þe hule wo schal us seme.
þat kunne 7 wille riʒt us deme.

143. *wo]* *þu* MS.

145 Ich wot wel quap þe niʒtingale.
Ne þaref þar of bo no tale.
Maister nichole of guldeforde.
He is wis an war of worde.
He is of dome suþe gleu.

150 7 him is loþ eurich unþeu.
He wot insiʒt in eche songe.
wo singet wel wo singet wronge.

7 he can schede vrom þe riʒte.
þat woʒe þat þuster from þe liʒte.

Þ 155 o hule one wile hi biþoʒte.
7 after þan þis word up broʒte.

Ich granti wel þat he us deme.
vor þeʒ he were wile breme.
7 lof him were niʒtingale.

160 7 oþer wiʒte gente 7 smale.

Ich wot he is nu suþe acoled. |

Nis he vor þe noʒt afoled.

þat he for þine olde lo`u`ue.

Me adun legge 7 þe buue.

165 Ne schaltu neure so him queme.

þat he forþe fals dom deme.

He is him ripe 7 fastrede.

Ne lust him nu to none unrede.

Nu him ne lust na more pleie.

170 He wile gon a riʒte weie.

e niʒtingale was al ʒare.

Ho hadde ilorned wel aiware.

167. A mark in
margin apparently
calling attention to
him, MS.

Þ Hule ho sede seie me soþ.
 wi dostu þat unwiȝtis doþ.
 175 þu singist aniȝt 7 noȝt adai.
 7 al þi song is wailawai.
 þu miȝt mid þine songe afere.
 alle þat ihereþ þine ibere.
 þu schirchest 7 ȝollest to þine fere.
 180 þat hit is grislich to ihere.
 Hit þinchest boþe wise 7 snepe.
 Noȝt þat þu singe ac þat þu wepe.
 þu fliȝst aniȝt 7 noȝt adai.
 þarof ich wndri 7 wel mai.
 185 vor eurich þing þat schuniet riȝt.
 Hit luueþ þuster 7 hatiet liȝt.
 7 eurich þing þat is lof misdede.
 Hit luueþ þuster to his dede.

.
Þ os hule luste suþe longe.
 190 7 was oftoned suþ`e´ stronge.
 quap Ho þu `h´ attest niȝtingale.
 Þu miȝtest bet hoten galegale.
 Vor þu hauest to monie tale.
 Lat þine tunge habbe spale.
 195 þu wenest þat þes dai bo þinoȝe.
 Lat me nu habbe mine þroȝe.
 Bo nu stille 7 lat me speke.
 Ich wille bon of þe awreke.
 7 lust hu ich con me bitelle.
 200 Mid riȝte soþe witute spelle.
 þu seist þat ich me hude adai.
 þarto ne segge ich nich ne nai.
 7 lust ich telle þe wareuore.
 al wi hit is 7 wareuore.
 205 Ich habbe bile stif 7 stronge.
 7 gode cliuers scharp 7 longe.
 So hit bicumeþ to hauekes cunne.

191. *Ho quap* with
 marks of inversion
 MS.

Hit is min hizte hit is mi wune.
þat ich me draze to mine cunde. |
Ne mai noman þareuore schende.

211 On me hit is wel isene.
vor rizte cunde ich am so kene.
vorþi ich am loþ smale foþle.
þat floþ bi grunde an bi þuuele.
215 Hi me bichermet 7 bigredeþ.
7 hore flockes to `m´e ledeþ.
Me is lof to habbe reste.
7 sitte stille in mine neste.

216. *me]* *ne* with *i*
added above: *me* in
margin.

.
wenestu þat haueck bo þe worse.
220 þoþ crowe bigrede him bi þe mershe.
7 goþ to him mid hore chirme.
Rizt so hi wille wit him schirme.
þe hauec folþeþ gode rede. |
7 fliþt his wei 7 lat hem grede.

223. *f]* *folþeþ* MS.
224. *hem* corr. out
of *hi* MS.

3 225 et þu me seist of oþer þinge.
7 telst þat ich ne can noþt singe
Ac al mi rorde is woning
7 to `i´hire grislich þing
þat nis noþt soþ ich singe efne.
230 Mid fulle dreme 7 lude stefne.
þu wenist þat ech song bo grislich.
þat þine pipinge nis ilich.
Mi stefne is bold 7 noþt unorne.
ho is ilich one grete horne.
235 7 þin is ilich one pipe.
Of one smale w`e´ode unripe.
Ich singe bet þan þu dest.
Þu chaterest so doþ on irish pr`e´ost.
Ich singe an eue arizte time
240 7 soþþe won hit is bedtime.
þe þridde siþe ad middelnizte.
7 so ich mine song adizte.

233. MS. *blod* corr.
in margin to *bold*.

236. *woede e* added
by corrector MS.

wone ich i so arise vorre.
 Oþer dairim oþer daisterre.
 245 Ich do god mid mine þrote.
 7 warni men to hore note.
 Ac þu singest alle longe niȝt.
 From eue fort hit is dailiȝt.
 7 eure seist þin o song.
 250 So longe so þe niȝt is long.
 7 eure croweþ þi wrecche crei.
 þat he ne swikeþ niȝt ne dai.
 Mid þine pipinge þu adunest.
 þas monnes earen þar þu wunest.
 255 7 makest þine song so unwrþ.
 þa`t` me ne telþ of þar noȝt wrþ.
 Eurich murȝþe mai so longe ileste.
 þat ho shal liki wel unwreste.
 vor harpe 7 pipe 7 fuȝeles songe.
 260 Mislikeþ ȝif hit is to long.
 Ne bo þe song neuer so murie.
 þat he ne shal þinche wel unmurie.
 ȝef he ilesteþ ouer unwille.
 So þu miȝt þine song aspile.
 265 vor hit is soþ alured hit seide.
 7 me hit mai ine boke rede.
 Eurich þing mai losen his godhede
 Mid unmeþe 7 mid ouerdede.

247. *allelonge* MS.

265. *seiȝde* MS.

.
Þe niȝtingale in hire þoȝte.
 270 Athold al þis 7 longe þoȝte.
 wat ho þare after miȝte segge.
 vor ho ne miȝte noȝt alegge.
 þat þe hule hadde hire ised.
 vor he spac boþe riȝt an red.
 275 An hire ofþuȝte þat ho hadde.
 þe speche so foruorþ iladde.
 An was oferd þat hire answare.

270. *alþis* MS.

Ne wrþe noȝt ariȝt i fare.
 Ac noþeles he spac boldeliche.
 280 vor he is wis þat hardeliche.
 wiþ is uo berþ grete ilete.
 þat he uor areȝþe hit ne forlete.
 vor suich worþ bold ȝif þu flizste.
 þat wle flo ȝif þu svicst.
 285 Ȝif he isiþ þat þu nart areȝ.
 He wile of bore wrchen bareȝ.
 7 forþi þeȝ þe niȝtingale. |
 were aferd ho spac bolde tale
Hule ho seide wi dostu so.
 290 þu singest awinter wolawo.
 þu singest so doþ hen asnowe.
 Al þat ho singeþ hit is for wowe.
 A wintere þu singest wroþe and ȝomere.
 An`d` eure þu art dumb asumere.
 295 Hit is for þine fule niþe.
 þat þu ne miȝt mid us be bliþe.
 vor þu forbernest welneȝ for onde,
 wane ure blisse cumeþ to londe.
 þu farest so doþ þe ille.
 300 Evrich blisse him is unwille.
 Grucching 7 luring him boþ rade.
 Ȝif he isiþ þat men boþ glade.
 he wolde þat he iseȝe.
 Teres in evrich monnes eȝe.
 305 Ne roȝte he þeȝ flockes were.
 Imeind bi toppes 7 bi here.
 Also þu dost on þire side.
 vor wanne snov liþ þicke 7 wide.
 an`d` alle wiȝtes habbeþ sorȝe.
 310 þu singest from eue fort amorȝe.
 Ac ich alle blisse mid me bringe.
 Ech wiȝt is glad for mine þinge.
 7 blisseþ hit wanne ich cume.

284. *ışvicst* MS.

286. *bareȝ*] *a* corr.
out of *r* MS.

289. *þule* MS.

297. *foronde* MS.

7 hiȝteþ aȝen mine kume.
 315 þe blostme ginneþ springe 7 sprede
 Boþe ine tro 7 ek on mede.
 þe lilie mid hire faire wlite.
 Wolcumeþ me þat þu hit wte.
 Bit me mid hire faire blo.
 320 Þat ich shulle to hire flo.
 þe rose also mid hire rude. |
 þat cumeþ ut of þe þorne wode.
 Bit me þat ich shulle singe
 vor hire luue one skenting.

315. *þe blostme* on
an erasure MS.

319. *Bit]* *t* corr. out
of *d* MS.

324. *one* *one* MS.

.
H 325 ule þu axest me ho seide.
 ȝif ich kon eni oþer dede.
 Bute singen in sume tide.
 an bringe blisse for 7 wide.
 wi axestu of craftes mine.
 330 Betere is min on þan alle þine.
 Betere is o song of mine muþe.
 þan al þat eure þi kun kuþe.
 An lust ich telle þe wareuore. |
 wostu to wan man was ibore.
 335 To þare blisse of houeneriche.
 þar euer is song 7 murȝþe iliche.
 þider fundeþ eurich man.
 þat eniþing of gode kan.
 vor þi me singþ in holi chirche.
 340 an clerkes ginneþ songes wirche.
 þat man iþenche biþe songe.
 wider he shal 7 þar bon longe.
 þat he þe murȝþe ne uorȝete.
 Ac þar of þenche and biȝete.
 345 An nime ȝeme of chirche steuene.
 Hu murie is þe blisse of houene.
 Clerkes munekes 7 kanunes.
 þar boþ þos gode wicke tunes.

325. *Hule]* *Nule*
MS.

Ariseþ up to midelnizte.
350 An singeþ of þe houene lizte.
An prostes upe londe singeþ.
wane þe lizt of daie springeþ.
An ich hom helpe wat i mai.

.
Þe niztegale mid swucche worde.
355 for moniman mid speres orde.
haueþ lutle strence 7 mid his [s]chelde.
Ah neþeles in one felde.
Þurh belde worde an mid ilete.
Deþ his iuo for arehþe swete.
360 þe wranne for heo cuþe singe.
þar com in þare morezen[i]nge.
To helpe þare niztegale.
For þah heo hadde steuene smale.
Heo hadde gode þrote 7 schille.
365 An fale manne song awille.
þe wranne was wel wis iholde.
`Vor þeg heo nere ibred awolde.`
Ho was itozen among menne.
An hire wisdom brohte þenne.
370 Heo mihte speke hwar heo walde.
Touore þe king þah heo scholde.
Lusteþ heo cwaþ lateþ me speke.
Hwat wulle 3e þis pes tobreke.
An do þan [kinge] swuch schame.
375 3e[t] nis he nouþer ded ne lame.
Hunke schal itide harm 7 schonde.
3ef 3e doþ griþbruche on his londe.
Lateþ beo 7 beoþ isome. |
An fareþ riht to ower dome.
380 An lateþ dom þis plaid to breke.
Al swo hit was erur bispeke.
ch an wel cwað þe niztegale.
Ah wranne nawt for þire tale.

361. *more zeunge*
MS.

364. *þorte* MS.

367. This line
comes after l. 378
in MS.

368. *menne]*
mannēne MS.

374. *þan kinge]*
þanne MS.

I Ah do for mire lahfulnesse.
 385 Ich nolde þ-unrihtfulnesse.
 Me at þen ende ouerkome.
 Ich nam of drad of none dome.
 Bihote ich habbe soþ hit is.
 þat maister nichole þ-is wis.
 390 Bituxen vs deme schulde.
 An 3ef ich wene þ-he wule.
 Ah war mihte we hine finde.
 þe wranne sat in ore linde.
 Hwat nu3te 3e cwap heo his hom.
 395 He wunep at porteshom.
 At one tune ine dorsete.
 Bi þare see in ore utlete.
 þar he demep manie ri3te dom.
 An diht 7 writ mani wisdom.
 400 An þurh his muþe 7 þurh his honde.
 Hit is þe betere into scotlonde.
 To seche hine is lihtlich þing.
 He naueþ bute one woning.
 þ-his bischopen muchel schame.
 405 An alle þan þ-of his nome.
 Habbeþ ihert. 7 of his dede.
 Hwi nulleþ hi nimen heom to rede.
 þ-he were mid heom ilome.
 for teche heom of his wisdom.
 410 An 3iue him rente auale stude.
 þ-he mi3te heom ilome be mide.
 Certes cwap þe hule þ-is soð. |
 þeos riche men wel mucche misdoð.
 þ-leteþ þane godemon.
 415 þ-of so feole þinge con.
 An 3iueþ rente wel misliche.
 An of him leteþ wel lihtliche.
 wið heore cunne heo beoþ mildre.
 An 3eueþ rente litle childre.

409. *theche* MS.

413. *misdoð*] ð corr.
 out of some other
 letter.

420 swo heore wit hi demþ adwole.

þ-euer abid maistre nichole.

Ah ute we þah to him fare.

For þar is unker dom al 3are.

Do we þe niztegale seide.

425 ah wa schal unker speche rede.

An telle touore unker deme.

Þarof ich schal þe wel icweme.

Cwaþ þe houle for al ende of orde.

Telle ich con word after worde.

430 An 3ef þe þincþ þ-ich misrempe.

þu stond a3ein 7 do me crempe.

431. *dome* MS.

Mid þisse worde forþ hi ferden.

Al bute here and bute uerde.

To portesham þ-heo bcome.

435 Ah hu heo spedde of heore dome.

Ne can ich eu namore telle.

436. *chan* MS.

Her nis na more of þis spelle.

THE OWL AND THE NIGHTINGALE

PARALLEL TEXTS

Jesus College MS.
Cotton MS.

JESUS COLLEGE MS.

COTTON MS.

Incipit Altercacio inter filomenam 7

Bubonem.

Ich wes in one sumere dale.

In one swiþe dyele hale.

I herde ich holde grete tale.

An vle and one nýhtegale.

5 þat playd wes· stif· 7 starc· 7 strong.

Ich was in one sumere dale.

In one suþe diþele hale.

I herde ich holde grete tale.

An hule and one niztingale.

5 þat plait was stif 7 starc 7 strong.

Sum hwile softe· 7 lud among.
 And eyþer ayeyn oþer swal.
 And let þat vuele mod vt al.
 And eyþer seyde of oþres custe.
 10 þat alre wrste þat hi ywuste.
 7 hure 7 hure of oþres songe.
 hi holde playding swiþe stronge.
 Þe Nihtegale bi gon þo speke.
 In one hurne of one beche.
 15 7 sat vp one vayre bowe.
 þat were abute blostme ynowe.
 In ore vaste thikke hegge.
 I meynd myd spire. 7 grene segge.
 He wes þe gladdre. vor þe ryse.
 20 7 song a veole cunne wyse.
 Bet þuhte þe drem. þat he were.
 of harpe· 7 pipe· þan he nere.
 Bet þuhte þat heo were ishote.
 of harpe· 7 pipe· þan of þrote.
 25 Þo stod on old stok. þar bý side.
 Þar þe vle song hire tyde.
 And wes myd iui al bigrowe.
 Hit wes þare vle erdingstowe.
 Þe Nihtegale hi iseyh.
 30 7 hi biholdeþ. and ouerseyh.
 7 þuhte wel ful of þare vle.
 For me hi halt. lodlich 7 fule. |
 vnwyht heo seide awei þu fleo.
 Me is þe wurs. þat ich þe iseo.
 35 Iwis for þine wle lete.
 wel ofte ich my song furlate
 Min heorte atflyhþ· 7 falt my tunge.
 hwenne þu art to me iþrunge.
 Me luste bet speten þane singe.
 40 of þine fule howelynge.
 Þeos vle abod for hit wes eve.
 heo ne myhte no leng bileue.
 vor hire heorte wes so gret.
 þat wel neyh hire fnast atset.
 45 7 warp a word þar after longe.
 hw þynk þe nu bi mine songe.
 Wenestu þat ich ne kunne singe.
 Þe ich ne cunne of wrytelinge.
 Ilome þu dest me grome.
 50 7 seist me boþe teone 7 schome.
 If ich þe heolde on myne vote.
 So hit bitide þat ich mote.

Sum wile softe 7 lud among.
 An aiþer azen oþer sval.
 7 let þat wole mod ut al.
 7 eiþer seide of oþeres custe.
 10 þat alre worste þat hi wuste.
 7 hure and hure of oþere[s] songe
 Hi holde plaiding suþe stronge.
 Þe niztingale bigon þe speche.
 In one hurne of one breche.
 15 7 sat upone vaire boze.
 þar were abute blosme inoze.
 In ore waste þicke hegge.
 Imeind mid spire 7 grene segge.
 Ho was þe gladur uor þe rise.
 20 7 song auele cunne wise.
 Bet þuzte þe dreim þat he were.
 Of harpe 7 pipe þan he nere.
 Bet þuzte þat he were ishote.
 Of harpe 7 pipe þan of þrote.
 25 [Þ]o stod on old stoc þarbisode.
 þar þo vle song hire tide.
 7 was mid iui albigrowe.
 Hit was þare hule eardingstowe.
 [Þ]e niztingale hi iseþ.
 30 7 hi bihold 7 ouerseþ.
 7 þuzte wel wl of þare hule.
 For me hi halt lodlich 7 fule.
 vn wiþt ho sede awei þu flo.
 Me is þe wrs þat ich þe so. |
 I wis for þine wle lete.
 36 wel oft ich mine song forlete.
 Min horte atfliþ 7 falt mi tonge.
 wonne þu art to me iþrunge.
 Me luste bet speten þane singe.
 40 Of þine fule 3oþelinge.
 Þos hule abod fort hit was eve.
 Ho ne miþte no leng bileue.
 vor hire horte was so gret.
 þat welneþ hire fnast atschet.
 45 7 warp a word þar after longe.
 Hu þincþe nu bi mine songe.
 we[n]st þu þat ich ne cunne singe.
 þeþ ich ne cunne of writelinge.
 Ilome þu dest me grame
 50 7 seist me boþe tone 7 schame
 3if ich þe holde on mine uote.
 So hit bitide þat ich mote.

7 þu were vt of þine ryse.
 þu scholdest singe on oþer wise.
 55 Þe Nihtegale 3af onsware.
 If ich me loki wiþ þe bare.
 7 me schilde wit þe blete.
 Ne recche ich nouht of þine þrete.
 If ich me holde in myne hegge
 60 Ne recche ich neuer hwat þu segge.
 Ich wot þat þu art vn milde.
 wiþ heom þat ne muwe from þe schilde.
 And þu tukest wroþe 7 vuele
 Hwar þu myht ouer smale vowe. |
 vorþi þu art loþ al fowel cunne.
 66 7 alle heo þe dryueþ heonne.
 7 þe biscrycheþ. 7 bigredeþ
 7 wel narewe þe byledeþ.
 7 ek forþe þe sulue mose
 70 hire þonkes wolde þe totose.
 þu art lodlich to biholde.
 And þu art loþ in monye volde.
 þi bodi is scort. þi swere is smal.
 Grette is þin heued ne þu al.
 75 þin éyen beoþ colblake 7 brode.
 Ryht so hi weren ipeynt myd wode
 þu starest so þu wille abyten
 Al þat þu myht myd clyure smyten
 þi bile is stif. 7 sarp. 7 hoked.
 80 Riht as on ewel þat is croked.
 þar myd þu clechest euer among.
 And þat is on of þine song.
 Ac þu þretest to myne vleysse.
 Mid þine cleures woldest me meysse.
 85 þe were icundere to one frogge.
 þat sit at Mulne vnder cogge.
 Snayles. Mus. and fule wihte.
 Beoþ þine cunde 7 þine rihte.
 Þu sittest a day and flyhst a niht.
 90 þu cuþest þat þu art on vnwiht.
 þu art lodlich. and unclene.
 Bi þine neste. ich hit mene.
 And ek bi þine fule brode.
 Þu vedest on heom a wel ful vode.

.
 Þeos word ayaf þe nihtegale.
 96 And after þare longe tale.
 Heo song so lude. 7 so scharpe.
 Ryht so me grulde. schille harpe.

7 þu were vt of þine rise.
 þu sholdest singe an oþer w[i]se.
 Þ 55 e niztingale 3af answare.
 3if ich me loki wit þe bare.
 7 me schilde wit þe blete.
 Ne reche ich nozt of þine þrete.
 3if ich me holde in mine hegge.
 60 Ne recche ich neuer what þu segge.
 Ich wot þat þu art un milde.
 Wiþ hom þat ne muze from þe schilde.
 7 þu tukest wroþe 7 vuele.
 Whar þu mizt over smale fuzele.
 65 Vorþi þu art loþ al fuelkunne.
 7 alle ho þe driueþ honne.
 7 þe bischricheþ 7 bigredet.
 7 wel narewe þe biledet. |
 7 ek forþe þe sulue mose.
 70 Hire þonkes wolde þe totose.
 Þu art lodlich to biholde.
 7 þu art loþ in monie volde.
 þi bodi is short þi swore is. smal.
 Grette is þin heued þan þu al.
 75 þin ezene boþ colblake 7 brode.
 Riht swo ho weren ipeint mid wode.
 þu starest so þu wille abiten.
 Al þat þu mist mid cliure smiten.
 þi bile is stif 7 scharp 7 hoked.
 80 Riht so an owel þat is croked.
 þarmid þu clackes oft `e´ 7 longe.
 7 þat is on of þine songe.
 Ac þu þretest to mine fleshe.
 Mid þine cliures woldest me meshe.
 85 þe were icundur to one frogge.
 [Þat sit at mulne under cogge.]
 Snailles, mus 7 fule wihte.
 Boþ þine cunde 7 þine rihte.
 þu sittest adai and fliz[s]t anizt.
 90 þu cuþest þat þu art on unwizt.
 þu art lodlich 7 unclene.
 Bi þine neste ich hit mene.
 7 ek bi þine fule brode.
 þu fedest on hom a wel ful fode.

.
 Þos word a 3af þe niztingale.
 96 7 after þare longe tale.
 He song so lude 7 so scharpe.
 Riht so me grulde schille harpe.

þeos vle luste þiderward.
 100 7 heold hire eyen neþerward.
 7 sat toswolle 7 to bolewe.
 so heo hedde one frogge i's wolwe.
 For heo wel wiste. 7 was iwar.
 þat heo song hire a bysemar.
 105 7 napeles heo yaf ondsware.
 hwy neltu fleon into bare.
 And schewi hweþer vnker beo.
 of brihter hewe. of fayrur bleo.
 No. þu hauest scharpe clawe.
 110 Ne kepe ich noht þat þu me clawe.
 þu hauest clyures swiþe stronge.
 þu twengest þar mid so doþ a tonge.
 þu þoutest so doþ þine ilyche.
 Mid fayre worde me biswike.
 115 Ich nolde don þat þu me raddest.
 Ich wiste wel þat þu me misraddest.
 schomye þe vor þine vnrede.
 vnwryen is þi swikehede.
 schild þi swikedom from þe lyhte.
 120 And hud þat wowe among þe ryhte.
 hwanne þu wilt þu vnriht spene.
 Loke þat hit ne beo isene. |
 vor swikedom haueþ schome and het
 If hit is ope. and vnder yete.
 125 Ne spedestu nouht mid þin vnwrenche
 For ich am war. and can blenche.
 Ne helpeþ noht. þat þu bo. to þriste.
 Ich wolde vyhte bet myd liste.
 þan þu mid al þine strengþe.
 130 Ich habbe on brede. 7 ek on lengþe.
 Castel god on myne ryse.
 wel fyht þat wel flyhþ. seyþ þe wise.
 Ac lete away þeos cheste.
 For suche wordes beoþ vnwreste.
 135 And fo we on. myd rihte dome.
 Mid fayre worde. 7 myd some.
 þeyh we ne beon at on acorde.
 we mawe bet myd fayre worde.
 wiþvte cheste. and bute vyhte.
 140 Playde mid soþe. 7 mid ryhte.
 7 may vr eyþer hwat he wile.
 Mid rihte segge. 7 myd skile.
 Ð o quap þe vle. hwo schal vs seme.
 þat kunne 7 wille riht vs deme.
 145 Ich wot wel quap þe nyhtegale.

þos hule luste þiderward.
 100 7 hold hire ege noþerwa[r]d.
 7 sat to svolle 7 ibolwe.
 also ho hadde one frogge isuolþe.
 for ho wel wiste 7 was iwar.
 þat ho song hire a bisemar.
 105 7 nopeles ho 3af andsuare.
 whi neltu flon into þe bare.
 7 sewi þare unker bo.
 Of brizter howe of uairur blo.
 No þu hauest wel scharpe clawe.
 110 Ne kepich nozt þat þu me clawe.
 þu hauest cliuers suþe stronge.
 þu tuengst þar mid so doþ a tonge.
 þu þoztest so doþ þin ilike.
 Mid faire worde me biswike.
 115 Ich nolde don þa`t' þu me raddest.
 Ich wiste wel þat þu me misraddest.
 Schamie þe for þin unrede.
 vnwrozen is þi svikelhede.
 Schild þine svikeldom vram þe lizte.
 120 7 hud þat woze amon3 þe rizte.
 þane þu wilt þin unrizt spene.
 Loke þat hit ne bo isene.
 vor svikedom haued schome 7 hete.
 3if hit is ope 7 under 3ete.
 125 Ne speddestu nozt mid þine unwrenche.
 for icham war 7 can wel blenche.
 Ne helpþ nozt þat þu bo to þriste. |
 Ich wolde vizte bet mid liste.
 þan þu mid all þine strengþe.
 130 Ich abbe on brede 7 eck on lengþe.
 Castel god on mine rise.
 wel fizt þat wel flizt seiþ þe wise.
 ac lete we awei þos cheste.
 vor suiche wordes boþ unwerste.
 135 7 fo we on mid rizte dome.
 Mid faire worde 7 mid wsome.
 þe3 we ne bo at one acorde.
 we muze bet mid fawre worde.
 witute cheste 7 bute fizte.
 140 Plaidi mid foze 7 mid rizte.
 7 mai hure eiþer wat he wile.
 Mid rizte segge 7 mid skile.
 Ð o quap þe hule wo schal us seme.
 þat kunne 7 wille rizt us deme.
 145 Ich wot wel quap þe niztingale.

Ne þarf þer of beo no tale.
 Mayster Nichol· of guldeuorde.
 he is wis· and war· of worde.
 he is of worde swyþe glev.
 150 And him is loþ eurich vnþeu.
 he wot insyht in euche songe.
 hwo singeþ wel. hwo singeþ wronge.
 And he con schede from þe rihte.
 Ðat wowe. þat þuster from þe lyhte.
 Ð 155 e vle. one hwile hi bihouhte.
 And after þan þis word up brouhte. |
 Ich graunti wel þa`t he vs deme.
 For þeyh he were hwile breme.
 7 leof him wre Nihtingale.
 160 And oþer wyhte gent 7 smale.
 Ich wot. he is nu þe acoled.
 Nis he vor þe nouht afoled.
 þat he vor þine olde luue.
 Me a dun legge 7 þe a buue.
 165 N[e] schaltu. neuer so him queme.
 þat he vor þe fals dom deme.
 he is nv ripe. 7 fast rede.
 Ne luste hym nv to non vnrede.
 Nv him ne lust namore pleye
 170 he wile gon a rihte weye.
 Ð e nihtegale· wes al ware.
 heo hedde ileorned· wel ihware.
 vle heo seyde seye me soþ.
 hwi dostu þat vnwihtes doþ.
 175 þu singest a nyht 7 nouht aday.
 And al þi song is waylaway.
 þu miht mid þine songe afere.
 Alle þat hereþ þine ibere.
 Ð[u] srichest 7 yollest to þine fere
 180 þat hit is gryslich to ihere.
 hit þincheþ boþe wise 7 snepe.
 Nouht þat þu singe. at þu wepe.
 þu flyhst a nyht and noht a day.
 þar of ich wundri 7 wel may.
 185 For vych þing þat schonyeþ riht.
 hit luuyeþ þuster 7 hateþ lyht.
 7 euych þing. þat luueþ misdede.
 hi luueþ þuster to his dede.

.
 Ð eos vle luste swiþe longe.
 190 7 wes ofteoned swiþe stronge.
 heo quap. þu hattest Nihtegale.

Ne þaref þar of bo no tale.
 Maister nichole of guldeforde.
 He is wis an war of worde.
 He is of dome suþe gleu.
 150 7 him is loþ eurich unþeu.
 He wot insiȝt in eche songe.
 wo singet wel wo singet wronge.
 7 he can schede vrom þe riȝte.
 þat woȝe þat þuster from þe liȝte.
 Ð 155 o hule one wile hi biþoȝte.
 7 after þan þis word up broȝte.
 Ich granti wel þat he us deme.
 vor þeȝ he were wile breme.
 7 lof him were niȝtingale.
 160 7 oþer wiȝte gente 7 smale.
 Ich wot he is nu suþe acoled. |
 Nis he vor þe noȝt afoled.
 þat he for þine olde lo`u`ue.
 Me adun legge 7 þe buue.
 165 Ne schaltu neure so him queme.
 þat he forþe fals dom deme.
 He is him ripe 7 fastrede.
 Ne lust him nu to none unrede.
 Nu him ne lust na more pleie.
 170 He wile gon a riȝte weie.
 Ð e niȝtingale was al ȝare.
 Ho hadde ilorned wel aiware.
 Hule ho sede seie me soþ.
 wi dostu þat unwiȝtis doþ.
 175 þu singist aniȝt 7 noȝt adai.
 7 al þi song is wailawai.
 þu miȝt mid þine songe afere.
 alle þat ihereþ þine ibere.
 þu schirchest 7 ȝollest to þine fere.
 180 þat hit is grislich to ihere.
 Hit þinchest boþe wise 7 snepe.
 Noȝt þat þu singe ac þat þu wepe.
 þu fliȝst aniȝt 7 noȝt adai.
 þarof ich wndri 7 wel mai.
 185 vor eurich þing þat schuniet riȝt.
 Hit luueþ þuster 7 hatiet liȝt.
 7 eurich þing þat is lof misdede.
 Hit luueþ þuster to his dede.

.
 Ð os hule luste suþe longe.
 190 7 was oftoned suþ`e` stronge.
 quap Ho þu `h`attest niȝtingale.

þu mihtest bet hote galegale.
 vor þu hauest to monye tale.
 let þine tunge habbe spale.
 195 þu wenest þat þes day beo þin owe.
 let me nv habbe myne þrowe.
 Beo nv stille 7 let me speke.
 Ich wile beo of þe a wreke.
 7 lust hw ich con me bitelle.
 200 Mid rihte soþe wiþvte spelle.
 þu seyst þat ich me hude aday
 þar to ne segge ich nyk no nay
 7 lust ich telle hwervore
 Al hwi hit is 7 hwarevore. |
 Ich habbe bile stif 7 stronge.
 206 7 gode cleures scharp 7 longe.
 So hit bycumeþ to hauekes cunne.
 hit is myn hyhte· 7 my ynne.
 þat ich me drawe to mine cunde.
 210 Ne may me no mon þarfor sende.
 on me hit is wel i sene.
 For rihte cunde ich am so kene.
 vor þi ich am loþ smale voweale.
 Þat fleoþ bi grunde 7 bi þuueale.
 215 hi me bichirmeþ 7 bigredeþ.
 7 heore flockes to me ledeþ.
 Me is leof to habbe reste.
 And sitte stille in myne neste.

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 wenestu þat hauek beo þe wrse.
 220 Þe crowe bigrede him bi þe mersche.
 7 goþ to him myd heore chyrme.
 Riht so hi wille. wiþ him schirme.
 þe hauek foleweþ gode rede.
 He flyhþ his wey 7 let hi grede.

Þ 225 et þu me seyst of oþer þinge.
 7 tellest þat ich ne can nouht singe.
 Ac al my reorde is wonyng.
 And to ihere gryslych þing.
 þat nis nouht soþ. ich singe efne.
 230 Mid fulle dreme· 7 lude stefne.
 þu wenest þat eoch song beo grislich.
 þat þine pipinge nis ilich.
 Mi stefne is bold· 7 nouht vnorne.
 heo is ilich one grete horne.
 235 7 þin is iliche one pype.
 of one smale weode vnripe.
 Ich [singe] bet þan þu dest.

Ðu miȝtest bet hoten galegale.
 Vor þu hauest to monie tale.
 Lat þine tunge habbe spale.
 195 þu wenest þat þes dai bo þinoȝe.
 Lat me nu habbe mine þroȝe.
 Bo nu stille 7 lat me speke.
 Ich wille bon of þe awreke.
 7 lust hu ich con me bitelle.
 200 Mid riȝte soþe witute spelle.
 þu seist þat ich me hude adai.
 þarto ne segge ich nich ne nai.
 7 lust ich telle þe wareuore.
 al wi hit is 7 wareuore.
 205 Ich habbe bile stif 7 stronge.
 7 gode cliuers scharp 7 longe.
 So hit bicumeþ to hauekes cunne.
 Hit is min hiȝte hit is mi wune.
 þat ich me draȝe to mine cunde. |
 Ne mai noman þareuore schende.
 211 On me hit is wel isene.
 vor riȝte cunde ich am so kene.
 vorþi ich am loþ smale foȝle.
 þat floþ bi grunde an bi þuueale.
 215 Hi me bichermet 7 bigredeþ.
 7 hore flockes to `m'e ledeþ.
 Me is lof to habbe reste.
 7 sitte stille in mine neste.

.
 wenestu þat haueck bo þe worse.
 220 þoȝ crowe bigrede him bi þe mershe.
 7 goþ to him mid hore chirme.
 Riȝt so hi wille wit him schirme.
 þe hauec folȝeþ gode rede. |
 7 flizt his wei 7 lat hem grede.

3 225 et þu me seist of oþer þinge.
 7 telst þat ich ne can noȝt singe
 Ac al mi rorde is woning
 7 to `i'hire grislich þing
 þat nis noȝt soþ ich singe efne.
 230 Mid fulle dreme 7 lude stefne.
 þu wenist þat ech song bo grislich.
 þat þine pipinge nis ilich.
 Mi stefne is bold 7 noȝt unorne.
 ho is ilich one grete horne.
 235 7 þin is ilich one pipe.
 Of one smale w'e'ode unripe.
 Ich singe bet þan þu dest.

Du chaterest so doþ on yris prest.
 Ich singe an efne. aryhte time.
 240 7 seþþe hwenne hit is bedtime.
 þe þridde syþe a middelnyhte.
 7 so ich myne songe adihte.
 hwenne ich iseo arise veorre
 oþer dayrewe· oþer daysteorre.
 245 Ic do god myd myne þrote.
 And warny men to heore note.
 Ac þu singest alle longe nyht.
 From eue þat hit is dayliht.
 7 euer lesteþ þin o song,
 250 so longe so þe nyht is long.
 7 euer croweþ þi wrecche crey.
 þat he ne swikeþ nyht ne day. |
 Mid þine pipinge þu adunest.
 þas monnes eren. þar þu wunest.
 255 7 makest þi song, so vnwiht.
 þat me ne telleþ. of þe nowiht.
 Eurych mureþe may so longe leste.
 þat heo schal liki wel vnwreste.
 for harpe. 7 pipe. 7 foweles song.
 260 Mislikeþ. if hit is to long.
 Ne beo þe song ne so murie.
 þat he ne sal þinche vnmurie.
 If he ilesteþ ouer vnwille.
 So þu myht þi song aspille.
 265 for hit is soþ Alured hit seyde.
 7 me hit. may in boke rede.
 Eurich þing may lesen his godhede.
 Mid vnmeþe and ouerdede.

.
Ðe nyhtegale in hire þouhte.
 270 Atheold al þis. 7 longe þouhte.
 hwat heo þar after myhte segge,
 vor heo ne myhte noht alege.
 þat þe vle hedde hire iseyd.
 vor ho spak boþe riht 7 red.
 275 7 hire of þuhte þat heo hadde.
 þe speche so feoruorþ iladde.
 7 wes aferd þat hire answare
 Ne wrþe nouht a riht ivare.
 Ac nopeles heo spak boldeliche
 280 vor heo is wis þat hardeliche.
 wiþ his fo berþ grete ilete.
 þat he for areþþe hit ne forlete.
 vor suych worþ bold if þu flyhst.

Du chaterest so doþ on irish pr`e´ost.
 Ich singe an eue arihte time
 240 7 soþþe won hit is bedtime.
 þe þridde siþe ad middelnihte.
 7 so ich mine song adizte.
 wone ich i so arise vorre.
 Oþer dairim oþer daisterre.
 245 Ich do god mid mine þrote.
 7 warni men to hore note.
 Ac þu singest alle longe niht.
 From eue fort hit is dailiht.
 7 eure seist þin o song.
 250 So longe so þe niht is long.
 7 eure croweþ þi wrecche crei.
 þat he ne swikeþ niht ne dai.
 Mid þine pipinge þu adunest.
 þas monnes earen þar þu wunest.
 255 7 makest þine song so unwrþ.
 þa`t´ me ne telþ of þar noht wrþ.
 Eurich murþe mai so longe ileste.
 þat ho shal liki wel unwreste.
 vor harpe 7 pipe 7 fuzeles songe.
 260 Mislikeþ 3if hit is to long.
 Ne bo þe song neuer so murie.
 þat he ne shal þinche wel unmurie.
 3ef he ilesteþ ouer unwille.
 So þu miht þine song aspille.
 265 vor hit is soþ alured hit seide.
 7 me hit mai ine boke rede.
 Eurich þing mai losen his godhede
 Mid unmeþe 7 mid ouerdede.

.
Ðe niztingale in hire þohte.
 270 Athold al þis 7 longe þohte.
 wat ho þare after mihte segge.
 vor ho ne mihte noht alege.
 þat þe hule hadde hire ised.
 vor he spac boþe riht an red.
 275 An hire ofþuhte þat ho hadde.
 þe speche so foruorþ iladde.
 An was oferd þat hire answare.
 Ne wrþe noht ariht i fare.
 Ac nopeles he spac boldeliche.
 280 vor he is wis þat hardeliche.
 wiþ is uo berþ grete ilete.
 þat he uor areþþe hit ne forlete.
 vor suich worþ bold 3if þu flizste.

þa`ť wile fleo if þu swykst. |
 If he isihþ þat þu nart areh.
 286 he wile of bore wurche bareh.
 7 for þi· þey `þe´ nyhtegale.
 Were aferd· heo spak bolde tale.
Hvle heo seyde· hwi dostu so.
 290 þu singest a wynter wolawo.
 þu singest so doþ hen asnowe.
 Al þat heo singeþ hit is for wowe.
 A winter þu singest wroþe 7 yomere.
 7 euer þu art. dumb a sumere.
 295 hit is for þine fule nyþe
 þat þu ne myht. myd vs be bliþe.
 vor þu forbernest· neyh for onde.
 hwenne vre blisse cumeþ to londe.
 þu farest so doþ þe ille.
 300 Euerich blisse him is vnwille.
 Grucching· 7· luryng. him beoþ rade.
 If he iseoþ. þat men beoþ glade.
 he wolde þat he iseye.
 Teres in eueriche monnes eye.
 305 Ne roughthe þe. þeyh flockes were.
 Imeynd bi toppes· 7 bi here.
 Also þu dost on þire syde.
 For hwanne snouh liþ pikke 7 wide.
 7 alle wihtes habbeþ sorewe.
 310 þu singest from eue to amorewe.
 Ac ich mid me alle blisse bringe.
 Ech wiht is glad· for myne þinge.
 7 blesseþ hit· hwenne ich cume.
 7 hihteþ ayeyn myne cume.
 315 þe blostme. gynneþ springe 7 sprede.
 Boþe in treo 7 ek in mede.
 þe lilie myd hire fayre wlite.
 welcomeþ me þeyh þu hit wite.
 Bid me myd hire fayre bleo. |
 þat ich schulle to hire fleo.
 321 þe rose also myd hire rude.
 þat cumeþ of þe þorne wode.
 Bit me þat ich schulle singe.
 For hire luue one skentyng.

 [V]le þu axest me heo seyde.
 326 [I]f ich con eny oþer dede.
 Bute syngen in sume tyde.
 7 bringe blisse veor 7 wyde.
 hwy axestu of craftes myne.

þat wle flo 3if þu svicst.
 285 3if he isihþ þat þu nart are3.
 He wile of bore wrchen bare3.
 7 forþi þe3 þe niztingale. |
 were aferd ho spac bolde tale
Hule ho seide wi dostu so.
 290 þu singest awinter wolawo.
 þu singest so doþ hen asnowe.
 Al þat ho singeþ hit is for wowe.
 A wintere þu singest wroþe and 3omere.
 An`d´ eure þu art dumb asumere.
 295 Hit is for þine fule niþe.
 þat þu ne mi3t mid us be bliþe.
 vor þu forbernest welne3 for onde,
 wane ure blisse cumeþ to londe.
 þu farest so doþ þe ille.
 300 Evrich blisse him is unwille.
 Grucching 7 luring him boþ rade.
 3if he isoþ þat men boþ glade.
 he wolde þat he ise3e.
 Teres in evrich monnes e3e.
 305 Ne ro3te he þe3 flockes were.
 Imeind bi toppes 7 bi here.
 Also þu dost on þire side.
 vor wanne snov liþ picke 7 wide.
 an`d´ alle wi3tes habbeþ sor3e.
 310 þu singest from eue fort amor3e.
 Ac ich alle blisse mid me bringe.
 Ech wi3t is glad for mine þinge.
 7 blesseþ hit wanne ich cume.
 7 hi3teþ a3en mine kume.
 315 þe blostme ginneþ springe 7 sprede
 Boþe ine tro 7 ek on mede.
 þe lilie mid hire faire wlite.
 Wolcumeþ me þat þu hit wte.
 Bit me mid hire faire blo.
 320 Þat ich shulle to hire flo.
 þe rose also mid hire rude. |
 þat cumeþ ut of þe þorne wode.
 Bit me þat ich shulle singe
 vor hire luue one skentyng.

H 325 ule þu axest me ho seide.
 3if ich kon eni oþer dede.
 Bute singen in sume tide.
 an bringe blisse for 7 wide.
 wi axestu of craftes mine.

330 Beter is myn on þan alle þine.
 Beter is o song of myne muþe.
 þan al þat þi kun kuþe.
 7 lust. ich telle þe hwarvore.
 wostu to hwan· mon wes ibore.
 335 To þare blisse of heueryche. |
 þar euer is song. 7 Murehþe ilyche.
 þider fundeþ euer ich man.
 þat eny þing of gode can.
 for þi me syngþ in holy chireche.
 340 7 clerekes gynneþ songes wrche.
 þat mon yþenche. bi þe songe.
 hwider he shal. 7 þar beon longe.
 þat he þe murehþe ne voryete.
 Ac þar of þenche. 7 bigete.
 345 7 nyme yeme of chirche stefne.
 hw Murie is þe blisse of heuene.
 Clerekes· Munekes· 7 canúnes.
 þar beoþ þos gode wicketunes.
 Ariseþ vp to middelnyhte.
 350 7 singeþ of þon heuene lyhte.
 7 preostes vpe londe singeþ.
 [Hwenne þe liht of daye springeþ.]
 7 ich heom helpe hwat ic may.

.
Þe Nihtegale myd sweche worde.
 355 for monymon myd speres orde.
 haueþ lutle strengþe. 7 mid his schelde.
 Ah napeles in one felde.
 þurh belde worde 7 myd ilete.
 Deþ his iuo· for arehþe swete.
 360 þe wrenne for heo cuþe singe.
 þar com in þare moreweninge.
 To helpe þare nyhtegale.
 vor heo hadde stefne smale.
 heo hadde gode þrote 7 schille.
 365 7 fale morne song a wille.
 þe wrenne· wes wel wis iholde.
 vor þeih heo nere ibred a wolde.
 heo wes itowen. among mankunne
 7 hire wisdom brouhte þenne.
 370 heo myhte speke hwar heo wolde.
 To fore þe kinge· þah heo scholde.
 lusteþ· heo queþ· leteþ me speke.
 hwat wille ye. þis pays to breke.
 7 do þan [kinge] such schome.
 375 yet nys heo nouþer ded ne lome.

330 Betere is min on þan alle þine.
 Betere is o song of mine muþe.
 þan al þat eure þi kun kuþe.
 An lust ich telle þe wareuore. |
 wostu to wan man was ibore.
 335 To þare blisse of houeneriche.
 þar euer is song 7 murþe iliche.
 þider fundeþ eurich man.
 þat eniþing of gode kan.
 vor þi me singþ in holi chirche.
 340 an clerkes ginneþ songes wirche.
 þat man iþenche biþe songe.
 wider he shal 7 þar bon longe.
 þat he þe murþe ne uorþete.
 Ac þar of þenche and biþete.
 345 An nime ʒeme of chirche steuene.
 Hu murie is þe blisse of houene.
 Clerkes munekes 7 kanunes.
 þar boþ þos gode wicke tunes.
 Ariseþ up to midelnizte.
 350 An singeþ of þe houene lizte.
 An prostes upe londe singeþ.
 wane þe lizt of daie springeþ.
 An ich hom helpe wat i mai.

.
Þe niztegale mid swucche worde.
 355 for moniman mid speres orde.
 haueþ lutle strenþe 7 mid his [s]chelde.
 Ah neopeles in one felde.
 þurh belde worde an mid ilete.
 Deþ his iuo for arehþe swete.
 360 þe wranne for heo cuþe singe.
 þar com in þare moreʒen[i]nge.
 To helpe þare niztegale.
 For þah heo hadde steuene smale.
 Heo hadde gode þrote 7 schille.
 365 An fale manne song awille.
 þe wranne was wel wis iholde.
 `Vor þeg heo nere ibred awolde.`
 Ho was itoʒen among menne.
 An hire wisdom brohte þenne.
 370 Heo mizte speke hwar heo walde.
 Touore þe king þah heo scholde.
 Lusteþ heo cwaþ lateþ me speke.
 Hwat wulle ʒe þis pes to breke.
 An do þan [kinge] swuch schame.
 375 ʒe[t] nis he nouþer ded ne lame.

hunke schal ityde harm 7 schonde.
 If we doþ gryþbruche on his londe.
 Leteþ beo and beoþ isome.
 7 fareþ riht to eure dome.
 380 7 leteþ dom þis playd to breke.
 Also hit wes erure bispeke.
 Ich vnne wel queþ þe Nihtegale.
 Ah wrenne· nouht for þine tale.
 Ac do for myre lauhfulnessse.
 385 Ic nolde þat vnrihtfulnessse.
 Me at þen ende· me ouercome.
 Ic nam of dred. of none dome.
 Bi hote ic habbe· soþ hit is.
 þat maýster Nichole. þ·is wis.
 390 Bitwihen eu deme schulle.
 7 yet ic wene þat he wulle. |
 Ah war myhte we hine fynde.
 þe wrenne sat in hore lynde.
 hwat mihte yet quaþ heo his hom.
 395 heo wunep at porteshom.
 At one tune in dorsete.
 Bi þare sée in ore vtlete.
 þar he demep mony riht dom.
 7 diht 7 wryt mony wisdom.
 400 7 þurh his muþe. 7 þurh his honde.
 hit is þe betere into scotlonde.
 To seche hyne. is lyhtlych þing.
 he naueþ buten o wunyng.
 þ·is biscopopen muchel schame.
 405 7 alle þan þ·of his nome.
 habbeþ iherd. 7 of his dede.
 hwi nulleþ hi nymen heom to rede.
 þ·he were myd heom ilome.
 vor teche heom of his wisdom.
 410 7 yeue him rente on vale stude.
 þ·he myhte ilome heom beo myde.
 Certes quaþ þe vle. þat is soþ.
 þeos riche men· Mucchele mysdoþ.
 þat leteþ þane gode man.
 415 þat of so fele þinge can.
 7 yeueþ rente wel mislyche.
 7 of him leteþ wel lyhtliche.
 wiþ heore kunne heo beoþ Mildre.
 7 yeueþ rente litle childre.
 420 so heore wit hi demep adwole.
 þ·euer abit Mayster Nichole.
 Ah vte we þah· to him fare,

Hunke schal itide harm 7 schonde.
 3ef 3e doþ griþbruche on his londe.
 Lateþ beo 7 beoþ isome. |
 An fareþ riht to ower dome.
 380 An lateþ dom þis plaid to breke.
 Al swo hit was erur bispeke.
 I ch an wel cwað þe niztegale.
 Ah wranne nawt for þire tale.
 Ah do for mire lauhfulnessse.
 385 Ich nolde þ·unrihtfulnessse.
 Me at þen ende ouerkome.
 Ich nam of drad of none dome.
 Bi hote ich habbe soþ hit is.
 þat maister nichole þ·is wis.
 390 Bituxen vs deme schulde.
 An 3ef ich wene þ·he wule.
 Ah war mihte we hine finde.
 þe wranne sat in ore linde.
 Hwat nu3te 3e cwaþ heo his hom.
 395 He wunep at porteshom.
 At one tune ine dorsete.
 Bi þare see in ore utlete.
 þar he demep manie rizte dom.
 An diht 7 writ mani wisdom.
 400 An þurh his muþe 7 þurh his honde.
 Hit is þe betere into scotlonde.
 To seche hine is lihtlich þing.
 He naueþ bute one woning.
 þ·his bischopen muchel schame.
 405 An alle þan þ·of his nome.
 Habbeþ ihert. 7 of his dede.
 Hwi nulleþ hi nimen heom to rede.
 þ·he were mid heom ilome.
 for teche heom of his wisdom.
 410 An 3iue him rente auale stude.
 þ·he mizte heom ilome be mide.
 Certes cwaþ þe hule þ·is soð. |
 þeos riche men wel mucche misdoð.
 þ·leteþ þane godemon.
 415 þ·of so feole þinge con.
 An 3iueþ rente wel misliche.
 An of him leteþ wel lihtliche.
 wið heore cunne heo beoþ mildre.
 An 3eueþ rente litle childre.
 420 swo heore wit hi demep adwole.
 þ·euer abid maistre nichole.
 Ah ute we þah to him fare.

vor þat is vnker dom al yare
 Do we þe Nihtegale seyde.
 425 Ah hwo schal vnker speche rede.
 7 telle tovore vnker dome.
 þar of ic schal þe wel iqueme
 Queþ þe vle. for al ende of orde. |
 Telle ic con. word after worde.
 430 7 if þe þinkþ þat ic misrempe.
 þu stond ayeyn and do me crempe.
 Mid þisse worde forþ hi ferden.
 Al bute here and bute verde.
 To portes ham. þer hi bcome.
 435 Ah hw heo spedde of heore dome.
 Ne can ic eu namore telle.
 her nys namore of þisse spelle.
 Explicit.

For þar is unker dom al 3are.
 Do we þe niztegale seide.
 425 ah wa schal unker speche rede.
 An telle touore unker deme.
 Þ arof ich schal þe wel icweme.
 Cwaþ þe houle for al ende of orde.
 Telle ich con word after worde.
 430 An 3ef þe þincþ þ-ich misrempe.
 þu stond a3ein 7 do me crempe.
 Mid þisse worde forþ hi ferden.
 Al bute here and bute uerde.
 To portesham þ-heo bi come.
 435 Ah hu heo spedde of heore dome.
 Ne can ich eu namore telle.
 Her nis na more of þis spelle.

XXI. THE BESTIARY

“Arundel 292, British Museum: on vellum, 200 × 130 mm.: late thirteenth century.... The Bestiary is written continuously, but the initials of the lines and, in the long metres, of the half lines are mostly rubricated.... Latin headings are in red, some are on the margin, the others at the head of their sections. As will be seen from the footnotes, the manuscript was much corrected or altered over erasures, and that after it was finished, for the substituted words do not always fill the gaps left by the scraper. The first leaves of the exemplar were probably damaged at the lower margin, since defective or difficult passages occur at regular intervals, so l. 32, ll. 89-92, 120, 121, 143, 144, 173, 200, 201.”

Line indentations, including those of ll. 504-515, are as printed. Headings are shown in red, as described above.

Natura leonis i^a.

Ð e leun stant on hille . 7 he man hunten here.
 Oðer ðurg his nese smel . Smake ðat he negge.
 Bi wilc weie so he wile . To dele niðer wenden.

5 Alle hise fet steppes . After him he filleð.
Drageð dust wið his stert . ðer he [dun] steppeð.
Oðer dust oðer deu . ðat he ne cunne is finden.
driueð dun to his den . ðar he him bergen wille.

ij^a.

A 10 n oðer kinde he haueð . wanne he is ikindled.
Stille lið ðe leun . ne stireð he nout of slepe.
Til ðe sunne haueð sinen . ðries him abuten.
ðanne reiseð his faðer him . mit te rem ðat he makeð.

ii^j^a.

15 ðe ðridde lage haueð ðe leun . ðanne he lieð to slepen.
Sal he neure luken . ðe lides of hise egen.

Significacio prime nature.

W elle heg is tat hil . ðat is heuenriche.
vre louerd is te leun . ðe liueð ðer abuuen.
20 wu ðo him likede . to ligten her on erðe.
Migte neure diuel witen . ðog he be derne hunte.
hu he dun come.
Ne wu he dennede him . in ðat defte meiden.
Marie bi name . ðe him bar to manne frame.

25 **ij^a 7 ii^j^a.**

Ð o ure drigten ded was.
7 doluen also his wille was.
In a ston stille he lai.
til it kam ðe dridde dai.
30 His fader him filstnede swo.
ðat he ros fro dede ðo.

vs to lif holden.
wakeð so his wille is So hirde for his folde.
He is hirde. we ben sep . Silden he us wille.
35 If we heren to his word . ðat we ne gon nowor wille.

Natura aquile.

Kiðen i wille ðe ernes kinde.
Also ic it o boke rede.
wu he neweð his guðhede.
40 hu he cumeð ut of elde.
Siðen hise limes arn unwelde.
Siðen his bec is alto wrong.
Siðen his | fligt is al unstrong.
7 his egen dimme.
45 Hereð wu he neweð him.
A welle he sekeð ðat springeð ai.
boðe bi nigt 7 bi dai.
ðer ouer he flegeð 7 up he teð.
til ðat he ðe heuene seð.
50 ðurg skies sexe 7 seuene.
til he cumeð to heuene.
So rigt so he cunne.
he houeð in ðe sunne.
ðe sunne swideð al his fligt.
55 7 oc it makeð his egen brigt.
Hise feðres fallen for ðe hete.
7 he dun mide to ðe wete.
Falleð in ðat welle grund.
ðer he wurdeð heil 7 sund.
60 7 cumed ut al newe.
Ne were his bec untrewē.
His bec is get biforn wrong.
ðog hise limes senden strong.
Ne maig he tilen him non fode.

65 him self to none gode.
ðanne goð he to á ston.
7 he billeð ðeron.
Billeð til his bec biforn.
haueð ðe wrengeðe forloren.
70 Siðen wið his rigte bile.
takeð mete ðat he wile.

erasure.

Significacio.

Al is man so is tis ern.
wulde ge nu listen.
75 Old in hise sinnes dern.
or he bicumeð cristen.
7 tus he neweð him ðis man.
ðanne he nimeð to kirke.
Or he it biðenken can.
80 hise egen weren mirke.
Forsaket ðore satanas.
7 ilk sinful dede.
Takeð him to ihesu crist.
for he sal ben his mede.
85 Leueð on ure loue[r]d crist.
7 lereð prestes lore.
Of hise egen wereð ðe mist.
wiles he dreccheð ðore.
His hope is al to godeward.
90 7 of his luue he lereð.
ðat is te sunne sikerlike.
ðus his sigte he beteð.
Naked falleð in ðe funt fat.
7 cumeð ut al newe.
95 buten alitel wat is tat.
his muð is get untrewē.
His muð is get wel unkuð.

74. *listlen* MS.

77. *hī* corr. out of
hu. ðis man ðanne
he on an erasure.

80. This line in
fainter brown ink.

83, 84. *Takeð ... he*
on an erasure.

87. *hise*] *i* corr. out
of *p*.

89, 90. *is hope is ...*
luue on an erasure:
l. 90 originally
began *ha after luue*
a.

wið pater noster 7 crede.
Fare he norð. er fare he suð.
100 leren he sal his nede.
bidden bone to gode.
7 tus his muð rigten.
tilen him so ðe sowles fode |
ðurg *grace* off ure drigtin.

105. On an erasure.

105 **Natura Serpentis. j^a.**

An wirm is o werlde . wel man it knoweð.
Neddre is te name . ðus he him neweð.
ðanne he is forbroken 7 forbroiden . 7 in his elde al forwurden.
Fasteð til his fel him slakeð . ten daies fulle.
110 ðat he is lene 7 mainles 7 iuele mai gangen.
he crepeð cripelande forð . his craft he ðus kiðeð.
Sekeð a ston ðat a ðirl is on.
Narwe buten he nedeð him . Nimeð vnneðes ðurg.
for his fel he ðer leteð . his fles forð crepeð.
115 walkeð to ðe water ward . wile ðanne drinken.
Oc he speweð or al ðe uenim.
ðat *in* his brest is bred . fro his birde time.
drinkeð siðen inog . 7 tus he him neweð.

ij^a.

Ð 120 anne ðe neddre is of his hid naked.
7 bare of his brest atter.
If he naked man se . ne wile he him nogt neggen.
Oc he fleð fro him . als he fro fir sulde.
If he cloðed man se cof he waxeð.
125 For up he rigteð him redi to deren.
to deren er to ded maken if he it muge forðen.
wat if ðe man war wurðe . 7 weren him cunne.
figteð wið ðis wirm . 7 f[a]reð on him figtande.

122. *neggen*] the
initial *n* on an
erasure MS.

ðis neddre siðen he nede sal.
130 makeð seld of his bodi . 7 sildeð his heued.
litel him is of hise limes . bute he lif holde.

[Significacio.]

K nov *cristene* man . wat tu *crist* higest
Atte kirke dure . ðar ðu *cristned* were.
135 ðu higtes to leuen on him . 7 hise lages luuien.
to helden wit herte . ðe bodes of holi k[i]rke.
If ðu hauest is broken.
Al ðu forbredes . forwurðes 7 forgelues.
Eche lif to wolden . Elded art fro eche blis.
140 So ðis wirm o werld is.
Newe ðe forði . so ðe neddre doð.
It is te ned.
Feste ðe of stedefastnesse . 7 ful of ðewes.
7 help ðe poure | men . ðe gangen abuten.
145 Ne deme ðe nog[t] wurdi . ðat tu dure loken.
up to ðe heueneward.
Oc walke wið ðe erðe mildelike among men.
no mod ðu ne cune . mod ne mannes vncost.
oc swic of sineginge.
150 7 bote bid tu ðe ai . boðe bi nigt 7 bi dai.
ðat tu milce mote hauen . of ðine misdedes.
ðis lif bitokneð ðe sti.
ðat te neddre ganged bi.
7 tis is ðe ðirl of ðe ston.
155 ðat tu salt ðurg gon.
Let ðin filðe fro ðe . so ðe wirm his fel doð.
Go ðu ðan to godes hus . ðe godspel to heren.
ðat is soule drink . sinnes quenching.
Oc or sei ðu in scrifte . to ðe prest sinnes tine.
160 feg ðe ðus of ði brest filde . 7 feste ðe forðward.
fast at tin herte . ðat tu firmest higtes.

160. *segðe* MS.

ðus art tu ging 7 newe.
 forðward be ðu trewe.
 Nedeð ðe ðe deuel nogt . for he ne mai ðe deren nogt.
 165 oc he fleð fro ðe . so neddre fro de nakede.
 On ðe cloðede ðe neddre is cof . 7 te deuel cliuer on sinnes.
 Ai ðe sinfule bisetten he wile.
 7 wið al mankin
 he haueð nið 7 win.
 170 wat if he leue haue of ure heuen louerd.
 for to deren us . So he ure eldere or dede.
 do we ðe bodi in ðe bale . 7 bergen ðe soule.
 ðat is ure heued geuelic . helde we it wurðlic.

Natura formice.

Ð 175 e mire is magti . mikel ge swinkeð.
 In *sumer* 7 in softe weder . So we `ofte' sen
 hauen.

176. *ofte* added in
margin MS.

In ðe heruest . hardilike gangeð.
 7 renneð rapelike . 7 resteð hire seldum.
 7 fecheð hire fode . ðer ge it mai finden.
 180 gaddreð ilkines sed.
 boðen of wude 7 of wed.

Of corn 7 of gres.
 ðat ire to hauen es.
 haleð to hire `hole' . ðat siðen hire helpeð.
 ðar ge wile ben winter | agen.

184. *hole* added on
lower margin MS.

186 caue ge haueð to crepen in . ðat winter hire ne derie.
 Mete in hire hule ðat . ðat ge muge biliuen.
 ðus ge tileð ðar wiles ge time haueð.
 so it her telleð.

188. Space before
ðar: ð rubricated
and red afterwards
erased MS.

190 oc finde ge ðe wete . corn ðat hire qwemeð.
 Al ge forleteð ðis oðer seð ðat ic er seide.
 Ne bit ge nowt de barlic beren abuten.
 oc suneð it 7 sakeð forð . so it same were.

get is wunder of ðis wirm . more ðanne man weneð.
195 ðe corn ðat ge to caue bereð . al get bit otwinne.
ðat it ne forwurðe . ne waxe hire fro.
er ge it eten wille.

Significacio.

Ð e mire muneð us mete to tilen.
200 Long liuenoðe ðis little wile.
ðe we on ðis werld wunen.
for ðanne we of wenden . ðanne is ure winter.
we sulen hunger hauen . 7 harde sures.
buten we ben war here.
205 do we forði. so doð ðis der . ðanne be we derue.
On ðat dai ðat dom sal ben . ðat it ne us harde rewe.
Seke we ure liues fod . ðat we ben siker ðere.
So ðis wirm in winter is . ðan ge ne tileð nummore.
ðe mire suneð ðe barlic ðanne ge fint te wete.
210 ðe olde lage we ogen to sunen . ðe newe we hauen moten.
ðe corn ðat ge to caue bereð . all ge it bit otwinne.
ðe lage us lereð to don god . 7 forbedeð us sinne.
It bet us erðliche bodes . 7 bekned euelike.
It fet ðe licham 7 te gost . oc nowt o geuelike.
215 vre louerd crist it lene us ðat his lage us fede.
nu 7 o domesdei . 7 tanne we hauen nede.

211. *ðe corn* on an
erasure.

213. *ben* MS.
ebriche MS.

216. *we* on an
erasure.

Natura cerui.

Ð e hert haueð kindes two.
7 forbisnes oc al so.
220 ðus it is on boke set.
ðat man clepeð fisiologet.
He drageð ðe neddre of de ston.
ðurg his nese up onon.
of ðe stoc er of ðe ston.

225 for it wile ðerunder gon.
7 sweleð it wel swiðe.
ðerof him brinneð siðen.
of ðat attrie ðing.
wiðinnen he | haueð brenning.
230 he lepeð ðanne wið mikel list.
of swet water he haueð ðrist.
he drinkeð water gredilike.
til he is ful wel sikerlike.
Ne haueð ðat uenim non migt.
235 to deren him siðen non wigt.
oc he werpeð er hise hornes.
in wude er in ðornes.
7 gingid him ðus ðis wilde der.
So ge hauen nu lered her.

236. *er* on an
erasure.

240 **Significacio. prima.**

Alle we atter dragen off ure eldere.
ðe broken drigtinnes wordðurg ðe neddre.
ðerðurg haueð mankin.
boðen nið 7 win.
245 *golsipe*. 7 giscing.
giuernesse 7 wissing.
pride 7 ouerwene.
swilc atter imene.
Ofte we brennen in mod.
250 7 wurden so we weren wod.
ðanne we ðus brennen.
bihoueð us to rennen.
to *cristes* quike welle.
ðat we ne gon to helle.
255 drinken his wissing.
it quenchet ilc siniging.
forwerpen *pride* euril[c] del.

244. After *win*, a
letter erased.

245. *kolsipe*, with *i*
on an erasure.

256. *ilc siniging* on
an erasure.

so hert doð hise hornes.
gingen us tus to godeward.
260 7 gemen us siðen forðwarð.

Natura. ij^a.

Ðe hertes hauen anoðer kinde.
ðat us og alle to ben minde.
Alle he arn off one mode.
265 For if he fer fetchen fode.
7 he ouer water ten.
wile non at nede oðer flen.
Oc on swimmeð bi forn.
7 alle ðe oðre folegen.
270 weðer so he swimmeð er he wadeð
Is non at nede ðat oðer lateð.
Oc leigeð his skinbon.
on oðres lendbon.
gef him ðat biforn teð.
275 Bilimpes for to tirgen.
Alle ðe oðre cumen mide.
7 helpen him for to her[t]ien.
beren him of ðat water grund
up to ðe lond al heil 7 sund.
280 7 forðen here nede.
ðis wune he hauen hem bitwen
ðog he an hundred to giddre ben.

277. *herien* MS.

Significacio. ij^a.

Ðe hertes costes we ogen to munen.
285 Ne og ur non oðer to sunen.
oc eurilc luuen oðer.
also he were his broder.
wurðen stedefast his | wine.

285. *to sunen* on an
erasure.

ligten him of his birdene.
290 helpen him at his nede.
god giueð ðerfore mede.
we sulen hauen heuenriche.
gef we bitwixen us ben briche.
ðus is ure louerdess lage luuelike to fillen.
295 her of haue we mikel ned . ðat we ðarwið ne dillen.

293. *ben twixen*
MS.

Natura Wulpis.

A wilde der is . ðat is ful of fele wiles.
fox is hire to name . for hire queðsipe.
husebondess hire haten . for hire harm dedes.
300 ðe coc 7 te capun.
ge feccheð ofte in ðe tun.
7 te gandre 7 te gos.
bi ðe necke 7 bi ðe nos.
haleð is to hire hole . forði man hire hatieð.
305 hatien 7 hulen . boðe men 7 fules.
Listneð nu a wunder . ðat tis der doð for hunger.
goð o felde to a furg . 7 falleð ðarinne.
In eried lond er in erðchine . forto bilirten fugeles.
Ne stereð ge nogt of ðe stede a god stund deies.
310 oc dareð so ge ded were . Ne drageð ge non onde.
ðe rauen is swiðe redi . weneð ðat ge rotieð.
7 oðre fules hire fallen bi . For to winnen fode.
derflike wiðuten dred . he wenen ðat ge ded beð.
he wullen on ðif foxes fel . 7 ge it wel feleð.
315 ligtlike ge lepeð up . 7 letteð hem sone.
gelt hem here billing
raðe wið illing.
tetoggeð 7 tetireð hem . mid hire teð sarpe.
Fret hire fille.
320 7 goð ðan ðer ge wille.

300. *ðe coc* on an
erasure.

304. *eð is to* on an
erasure.

308. *erðchine*] *erðc*
on an erasure.

313. *derflike*] *derfli*
on an erasure.

Significacio.

Twifold forbisne in ðis der.
to frame we mugen finden her.
warsipe 7 wisdom.
325 wið deuel 7 wið iuel man.
ðe deuel dereð dernelike.
he lat he ne wile us nogt biswike.
he lat he ne wile us ðon non loð.
7 bringeð us in a sinne. 7 ter he us sloð.
330 he bit us don ure bukes wille.
Eten 7 drinken wið unskil.
7 in ure skemting.
he doð raðe a foxing. |
He billeð one ðe foxes fel.
335 wo so telleð idel spel.
7 he tireð on his ket.
wo so him wið sinne fet.
7 deuel geld swilk billing.
wið same 7 wið sending.
340 7 for his sinfule werk.
ledeð man to helle merk.

Significacio.

De deuel is tus ðe [fox] ilik.
mið iuele breides 7 wið swik.
345 7 man also ðe foxes name.
arn wurði to hauen same.
for wo `so´ seieð oðer god.
7 ðenkeð iuel on his mod.
fox he is 7 fend iwis.
350 ðe boc ne legeð nogt of ðis.
So was herodes fox 7 flerd.
ðo *crist* kam into ðis middelerd.
he seide he wulde him leuen on.

346. *wurði*] ð corr.
out of another letter.
347. *so* added in
margin.

7 ðogte he wulde him fordon.

354. *e wulde* on an erasure.

355 **Natura aranée.**

355. *iranée* MS.

Seftes sop ure seppande . sene `is´ on werlde.
leiðe 7 lodlike . ðus we it leuen.
man`i´kines ðing.

357. *loldike* MS:
after we erasure of
one letter.

alle manne to wissing.

360 ðe spinnere on hire [webbe] swid[e] ge weveð.
festeð atte hus rof . hire fodredes.

360. *spinnere*] *inne*
on an erasure.
weveð] *veð* on an
erasure.

o rof er on ouese . so hire is on elde.

361. *fo dredes* MS.

werpeð ðus hire web . 7 weueð on hire wise.

363. *werpeð*] *pe* on
an erasure.

ðanne ge it haueð al idigt . ðeðen ge driueð.

365 hitt hire in hire hole . oc ai ge it biholdeð.

til ðat ðer fleges faren . 7 fallen ðerinne.

wiðeren in ðat web . 7 wilen ut wenden.

ðanne renneð ge rapelike . for ge is ai redi.

nimeð anon to ðe net . 7 nimeð hem ðere.

370 bitterlike ge hem bit . 7 here bane wurðeð.

drepeð 7 drinkeð here blod.

doð ge hire non oðer god.

bute fret hire fille

7 dareð siðen stille.

375 **Significacio.**

Ðis wirm bitokneð ðe man . ðat oðer bi`s´wikeð.
on stede er on stalle . stille er lude.

376. *biswikeð*] *keð*
on an erasure.

in mot er in market . er oni oðer wise.

he him bit . ðan he him bale selleð.

379. *him*: *him* both
corr. out of *hem*.

380 7 he drinkeð his blod . wanne he him dreueð.

380. *his* on an
erasure: *him* corr.
out of *hem*.

7 ðo fr`e´teð hem al . ðan he him iuel werkeð.

381. *freteð*] first *e*
added by rubricator.

Natura cetegrandie.

C ethegrande is a fis.
 ðe moste ðat in water is.
 ðat tu | wuldest seien get.
 386 gef ðu it so ge wan it flet.
 ðat it were á neilond
 ðat sete `one´ ðe se sond.
 ðis fis ðat is vnride.
 390 ðanne him hungreð he gapeð wide.
 vt of his ðrote it smit an onde.
 ðe swetteste ðing ðat is o londe.
 ðerfore oðre fisses to him dragen.
 wan he it felen he aren fagen.
 395 he cumen 7 houen in his muð.
 of his swike he arn uncuð.
 ðis cete ðanne hise chaeles lukeð.
 ðise fisses alle in sukeð.
 ðe smale he wile ðus biswiken.
 400 ðe grete maig he nogt bigripen.
 ðis fis wuneð wið ðe se grund.
 7 liueð ðer eure heil 7 sund.
 til it cumeð ðe time.
 ðat storm stireð al ðe se.
 405 ðanne sumer 7 winter winnen.
 ne mai it wunen ðer inne.
 So droui is te sees grund.
 ne mai he wunen ðer ðat stund.
 oc stireð up 7 houeð stille.
 410 wiles ðat weder is so ille.
 ðe sipes ðat arn on se fordriuen.
 loð hem is ded 7 lef to liuen.
 biloken hem 7 sen ðis fis
 aneilond he wenen it is.
 415 ðerof he aren swiðe fagen.
 7 mid here migt ðarto he dragen.
 sipes on festen.
 7 alle up gangen.

388. *one* substituted in margin for *o* deleted in text.

390. Before *him*, *him* deleted by rubricator.

397. *ðanne*] *ð* corr. out of *d* by rubricator.

410. *ðar* MS.
411. *fordriuen*] *driuen* on an erasure.

416. *here*] *re* on an erasure.

Of ston mid stel in ðe tunder.
420 wel to brennen one ðis wunder.
warmen hem wel 7 heten 7 drinken.
ðe fir he feleð 7 doð hem sinken.
for sone he diueð dun to grunde.
he drepeð hem alle wiðuten wunde.

423, 4. *diueð ...*
wunde on an
erasure.

425 **Significacio.**

Ðis deuel is mikel wið wil 7 magt.
So witches hauen in here craft.
He doð men hungren 7 hauen ðrist.
7 mani oðer sinful list.
430 tolleð men to him wið his onde
wo so him folegeð he findeð sonde.
ðo arn ðe little. in leue lage.
ðe mikle ne maig he to him dragen.
ðe mikle. i mene ðe stedefast.
435 in rigte leue. mid fles 7 gast.
wo so listneð deueles lore.
on lengðe it sal him rewen sore.
wo so festeð hope on him.
he sal him folgen to  helle dim. |

440 **Natura Sirene.**

In ðe se senden selcuðes manie.
ðe mereman is a meiden ilike.
on brest 7 on bodi . oc al ðus ge is bunden.
fro ðe noule niðerward . ne is ge no man like.
445 oc fis to fuliwis mid finnes waxen.
ðis wunder wuneð in wankel stede.
ðer ðe water sinkeð. sipes ge sinkeð . 7 scaðe ðus werkeð.
mirie gesingeð ðis mere . 7 haueð manie stefnes.
manie 7 sille.

443. *al ... bunden*
on an erasure.

450 oc it ben wel ille.
sipmen here steringe forgotten . for hire stefninge.
flumeren 7 slepen.
7 to late waken.
ðe sipes sinken mitte suk.
455 ne cumen he nummor up.
Oc wise men 7 warre.
agen cunen chare.
ofte arn atbrosten . mid he[re] brest ouel.
he hauen herd told of ðis mere . ðat tus uniemete.
460 half man 7 half fis.
sum ðing tokneð bi ðis.

451. *sipmen here* on
an erasure.

Significacio.

F ele men hauen ðe tokning.
of ðis forbisnede ði[n]g.
465 wiðuten weren wulues fel.
wiðinnen arn he wulues al.
he speken godcundhede.
7 wikke is here dede.
here dede is al vncuð.
470 wið ðat spekeð here muð.
twifold arn on mode.
he sweren bi ðe rode.
bi ðe sunne 7 bi ðe mone.
7 he ðe legen sone.
475 mid here sage 7 mid here song.
he ðe swiken ðer imong.
ðin agte wið swiking
ði soule wið lesing.

465. *wulues]* w corr.
out of *p*.

Natura elephantis.

480 lpes arn in Inde riche.

E on bodi borlic berges ilike.
he togaddre gon o wolde
so sep ðat cumen ut of folde.
7 behinden. he hem sampnen.
485 ðanne he sulen oðre strenen.
Oc he arn so kolde of kinde.
ðat no golsipe is hem minde.
til he noten of a gres.
ðe name is mandragores.
490 Siðen he bigeten on.
7 two ger he ðermide gon.
ðog he ðre hundred ger.
on werlde more  wuneden her. |
bigeten he neuermor non.
495 so kold is hem siðen blod 7 bon.
ðanne ge sal hire kindles beren.
In water ge sal stonden.
In water to mid side.
ðat wanne hire harde tide.
500 ðat ge ne falle niðer nogt.
ðat is most in hire ðogt.
For he ne hauen no lið.
ðat he mugen risen wið.
Hu he resteð him ðis der.
505 ðanne he walkeð wide.
herkne wu it telleð her.
for he is al unride.
A tre he sekeð to fuligewis.
ðat is strong 7 stedefast is.
510 7 leneð him trostl[i]ke ðerbi.
ðanne he is of walke weri.
ðe hunte haueð biholden ðis.
ðe him wille swiken.
wor his beste wune is.
515 to don hise willen.
Sageð ðis tre 7 under set.

o ðe wise ðat he mai bet.
 7 hileð it wel ðat he it nes war
 ðanne he makeð ðerto char.
 520 him seluen sit olon bihalt.
 weðer his gin him out biwalt.
 ðanne cumeð ðis elp unride.
 7 leneð him up on his side.
 slepeð bi ðe tre in ðe sadue.
 525 7 fallen boden so to gaddre.
 gef ðer is noman ðanne he falleð.
 he remeð 7 helpe calleð.
 remeð reufulike on his wise.
 hopeð he sal ðurg helpe `ri`sen.
 530 ðanne cumeð ðer on gangande.
 hopeð he sal him don ut standen.
 Fikeð 7 fondeð al his migt.
 ne mai he it forðen no wigt.
 Ne canne ðan non oðer.
 535 `oc` remeð mid his broðer.
 manie 7 mikle cume ðer `se`cande.
 wenen him on stalle maken.
 oc for ðe helpe of hem alle.
 ne mai he cumen so on stalle.
 540 ðanne remen he alle a rem.
 so hornes blast. oðer belles drem.
 For here mikle reming.
 rennande cumeð a gungling.
 raðe to him luteð.
 545 his snute him under puteð.
 7 mitte helpe of hem alle.
 ðis elp he reisen on stalle.
 7 tus | atbrested ðis huntet breid.
 oðe wise ðat ic haue gu seid.

521. *biwarlt* MS.

529. *risen*] *sisen*
MS., *ri* in margin.

535. *oc*] *o* MS., *oc*
in margin.
536. *sacande* MS.,
se in margin.

Dus fel adam ðurg a tre.
 vre firste fader ðat fele we.
 Moyses wulde him reisen.
 migte it no wigt forðen.
 555 After him prophetes alle.
 migte her non him maken on stalle.
 on stalle iseie. ðer he er stod.
 to hauen heuenriche god.
 He suggeden 7 sorgeden. 7 weren in ðogt.
 560 wu he migten him helpen ovt.
 ðo remeden he alle onder steuene.
 alle hege up to ðe heuene.
 for here care. 7 here calling.
 hem cam to *crist* heuen king.
 565 he ðe is ai in heuene mikel.
 wurð her man 7 tus was litel.
 drowing ðolede in ure manhede
 7 tus adam `he´ undergede.
 reisede him up 7 `al´ mankin.
 570 ðat was fallen to helle dim.

552. *firste*] *fir* on an erasure.

567. *him* in margin MS.

568. *he* added in margin MS.

569. *al* added in margin MS.

Natura turturis.

In boke is ðe turtres lif . writen o rime
 wu lagelike . ge holdeð luue al hire lif time.
 gef ge ones make haueð . fro him ne wile ge siðen.
 575 muneð wimmen hire lif . ic it wile gu reden.
 bi hire make ge sit onigt . o dei ge goð 7 flegeð.
 wo so seit he sundren ovt . i seie ðat he legeð.
 Oc if hire make were ded 7 ge widue wore.
 ðanne flegeð ge one 7 fareð . non oðer wile ge more.
 580 buten óne goð . 7 one sit.
 7 hire olde luue abit.
 In herte haueð him nig 7 dai.

so he were oliue ai.

Significacio.

L⁵⁸⁵ ist ilk lefful man her to . 7 herof ofte reche.
vre sowle atte kirke dure . ches hire crist to
meche.

585. *lesful* MS.

he is ure soule spuse luue we him wið migte.
7 wende we neure fro him ward . be dai ne be nigte.
ðog he be fro ure sigte faren be we him alle trewe.
non oðer louerd ne leue we . ne non | luue newe.
591 leue we ðat he liueð ai up on heuenriche.
7 ðeðen he sal cumen eft . 7 ben us alle briche.
for to demen alle men . oc nout on geuelike.
hise loðe men sulen to helle faren . hise leue to his
riche.

593. *to demen* on an
erasure.

595 **Natura pantere.**

Panter is an wilde der.
Is non fairere on werlde her.
he is blac so bro of qual.
mið wite spottes sawen al.
600 wit 7 trendled als a wel.
7 `itt´ bicumeð him swiðe wel.
wor so he wuneð ðis panter.
he fedeð him al mid oðer der.
of ðo ðe he wile he nimeð ðe cul.
605 7 fet him wel til he is ful.
In his hole siðen stille.
ðre dages he slepen wille.
ðan after ðe ðridde dai.
he riseð 7 remeð lude so he mai.
610 ut of his ðrote cumeð asmel.
mid his rem forð oueral.

601. *itt* added in
margin.

ðat ouercumeð haliweie.
 wið swetnesse. [ic] it gu seie
 7 al ðat eure smelleð swete.
 615 be it drie be it wete.
 For ðe swetnesse off his onde.
 wor so he walkeð o londe.
 wor so he walked. er wor so he wuneð.
 Ilk der ðe him hereð to him cumeð.
 620 7 folegeð him up one ðe wold.
 for ðe swetnesse ðe ic gu haue told.
 ðe dragunes one ne stiren nout.
 wiles te panter remeð ogt.
 oc daren stille in here pit.
 625 als so he weren of dede offrigt.

619. Before *to him*,
to him deleted MS.

Significacio.

Crist is tokned ðurg ðis der.
 was kinde we hauen told gu her.
 for he is faier, ouer alle men.
 630 so euen sterre o`uer` erðe fen.
 ful `wel` he taunede his luue to man.
 wan he ðurg `holi` spel him wan.
 7 longe he lai her *in* an hole.
 wel him dat he it wulde ðolen.
 635 ðre daies slep he al on on.
 ðanne he ded was in blod 7 bon.
 vp he ros 7 rémede i wis.
 of helle pine of heuene blis.
 7 steg to heuene *vuemest*.
 ðer wuneð wið | fader 7 holi gast.
 641 Amonges men a swete [s]mel.
 he let her of his holi spel.
 worðurg we mugen folgen him.
 into his godcundnesse fin.

630. *ouer]* *uer* in
 margin MS.

631. *wel* in margin
 MS.

632. *holi* in margin
 MS.

637. *i wis]* *in wif*
 MS.

639. *vuemest* MS.

640. 7 *holi gast* on
 an erasure.

645 7 ðat wirm ure wiðerwine.
wor so of godes word if dine.
ne dar he stiren. ne noman deren.
ðer wile he lage 7 luue beren.

Nature columbe. 7 significacio.

Ð⁶⁵⁰ e culuer haueð costes gode.
alle wes ogen to hauen in mode.
seuene costes in hire kinde.
alle it ogen to ben us minde.
ge ne haueð in hire non galle.
655 simple 7 softe be we alle.
ge ne liueð nogt bi lagt.
Ilc robbinge do we of *hac*.
ðe wirm ge leteð 7 liueð bi ðe sed.
of cristes lore we haue ned.
660 wið oðre briddes ge doð as moder.
so og ur ilk to don wið oðer.
woning 7 groning iflic hire song.
bimene we us. we hauen don wrong.
In water ge is wis of heuekes come.
665 7 we in boke wið deules nome.
In hole of ston ge makeð hire nest.
In cristes milce ure hope is best.

656. *bilagt* MS.

657. *hac*] *bac* MS.

661. Before *ilk* a
letter erased: *l* corr.
out of *h*.

XXII. GENESIS AND EXODUS

“Corpus Christi College, Cambridge, 444, former mark R 11; on vellum, 186 × 116 mm., in one hand of the end of thirteenth or of the beginning of the fourteenth century.”

JOSEPH AND HIS BRETHREN

xii. ger or ysaac was dead.

Jacobes sunes deden unred.

F Or sextene ger ioseph was old.

Quane he was into egipte sold.

5 He was iacobes gunkeste sune.

Brictest of wastme and of witter wune.

6. *waspene* MS.

If he sag hise breðere misfaren.

His fader he it gan vnhillen 7 baren.

He wulde ðat he sulde hem ten.

10 ðat he wel ðewed sulde ben.

forði wexem wið [him] gret nið.

And hate for it in ille lið.

ðo wex her hertes niðful 7 bold.

Quanne he hem adde is dremes told.

15 ðat is handful stod rigt up so ren.

And here it leigen alle hem bi foren.

And sunne 7 mone 7 sterres .xi^e.

Wurðeden him wið frigti luue.

ðo seide his fader hu mai ðis sen.

20 ðat ðu salt ðus wurðed ben.

ðat ðine breðere and ic 7 she.

ðat ðe bar sulen luten ðe. |

ðus he chidden hem bitwen.

ðoge ðhogte iacob siðe it sulde ben.

25 Hise breðere kepten at sichem.

Hirdnesse 7 iacob to sen hem.

sente ioseph to dalen ebron.

And he was redi his wil to don.

Jn sichem feld ne fond e hem nogt.

29. *fonde* MS.

30 Jn dotaym he fond hem sogt.

He knewen him fro feren kumen.

Hate hem on ros in herte numen.

Swilc nið 7 hate ros hem on.

He redden alle him forto slon.

35 Nai *quad* ruben slo we *him* nogt.
 Oðer sinne may ben wrogt.
 Quat so him dremp^te ðor quiles he slep.
 Jn ðis cisternes^se old and dep.
 Get wurð e worpen naked and cold.
 40 Quatso his dremes owen awold.
 ðis dede was don wid herte sor.
 Ne wulde ruben nogt drechen ðor.
 He gede and sogte an oðer stede.
 His erue *in* better lewse he dede.
 45 Vdas dor quiles gaf hem red.
 ðat was fulfild of derne sped.
 fro galaad men wið chafare
 Sag he ðor kumen wid spices ware. |
 Towarde egipte he gunne ten.
 50 Judas tagte hu it sulde ben.
 Joseph solde ðe breðere ten.
 for .xxx. plates to ðe chapmen.
 Get wast better he ðus was sold.
 dan he ðor storue *in* here wold.
 Ð⁵⁵ an ruben cam ðider agen.
 to ðat cisternes^se he ran to sen.
 He missed joseph and ðhogte swem.
 Wende him slagen set up an rem.
 Nile he blinnen swilc sorwe *him* cliued.
 60 Til him he sweren ðat he liued.
 ðo nomen he ðe childes srud.
 ðe iacob hadde madim *in* prud.
 Jn kides blod he wenten it.
 ðo was ðoron an rewli lit.
 65 Sondere men he it leiden on.
 And senten it iacob *into* ebron.
 And shewed it *him*. and boden *him* sen.
 Jf his childes wede it migte ben.
 Senten him bode he funden it.
 70 ðo iacob sag dat sori writ.

38. ðisternes^s MS.

39. wurðe MS.

59. *him*] *he* MS.

He gret and seide ðat wilde der.
 Hauen min sune swolgen her.
 His cloðes rent in haigre srid.
 Long grot and sorge is him bitid. |
 His sunes comen him to sen.
 76 And hertedin him if it migte ben.
 Nai nai quat he helped it nogt.
 Mai non herting on me ben wrogt.
 ic sal ligten till helle dale.
 80 And groten ðor min sunes bale.
 ðor was in helle a sundri stede
 Wor ðe seli folc reste dede.
 ðor he stunden til helpe cam.
 Til iesu crist fro ðeden hem nam.
 85 ðe chapmen skinden here fare.
 Jnto egipte ledden ðat ware.
 Wið putifar ðe kinges stiward.
 He maden swiðe bigetel forward.
 So michel fe ðor is hem told.
 90 He hauen him bogt he hauen sold.

84. *hem*] *he* MS.

90. *hauen*] *a* corr.
out of *e* MS.

.
Putifar trewið hise wiwes tale
 And haued dempt iosep to bale.
 He bad ben sperd [him] fast[e] dun.
 And holden harde in prisun.
 95 An litel stund quile he was ðer.
 So gan him luuen ðe prisuner.
 And him de chartre haueð bitagt.
 Wið ðo prisunes to liuen in hagt.
 Or for misdede or for on sagen.
 100 ðor woren to ðat prisun dragen.
 On ðat ðe kinges kuppe bed.
 And on ðe made ðe kinges bred.
 Hem drempte dremes boðen onigt.
 And he wurðen swiðe sore ofrigt.
 105 Joseph hem seruede ðor onsel.

.C.

At here drink and at here mel.
He herde hem *murnen*. he freinde for quat.
Harde dremes ogen awold ðat.
ðo seide he to ðe butuler.

107. *he hem freinde*
MS.

110 Tel me ðin drem mi broðer her. |
Queðer so it wurðe softe or strong.
ðe reching wurð on god bilong.

Me drempte ic stod at a wintre.
ðat adde waxen buges ðre.



115 Orest it blomedde and siðen bar.
ðe beries ripe wurð ic war.
ðe kinges [cuppe] ic hadde on hond.
ðe beries ðorinne me ðhugte ic wrong.
And bar it drinken to pharaon.

120 Me drempte als ic was wune to don.

Good is quað Joseph to dremen of win.
heilnesse an blisse is ðerin.

ðre daies ben get forto cumen.
ðu salt ben ut of *prisun* numen.

125 And on ðin offiz set agen.
Of me ðu ðhenke ðan it sal ben.

Bed min herdne to pharaon.
ða ic ut of *prisun* wurðe don.
for ic am stolen of kinde lond.

130 And her wrighteleslike holden *in* bond.

Quað ðis bredwrigte liðeð nu me.
me drempte ic bar bread lepes ðre.



And ðorin bread and oðer meten.
Quilke ben wune ðe kinges to eten.

135 And fugeles hauen ðor on lagt.
ðorfore ic am *in* sorge and hagt. |
for ic ne migte me nogt weren.

Ne ðat mete fro hem beren.

Me wore leuere quad Joseph.
140 Of eddi dremes rechen swep.



ðu salt after ðe ðridde dei.

ben do on rode weila wei.
 And fugeles sulen ði fleis toteren.
 ðat sal non agte mugen ðe weren.
 145 Soð wurð so ioseph seide ðat.
 ðis buteler joseph sone for gat.
 Two ger siðen was joseph sperd.
 ðor in prisun wiðuten erd.
Ðo drempte pharaon king a drem.
 150 ðat he stod bi ðe flodes strem.
 And ðeden utcomen .vii. neet.
 Euerilc wel swiðe fet and gret.
 And .vii. lene after ðo.
 ðe deden ðe .vii. fette wo.
 155 ðe lene hauen ðe fette freten.
 ðis drem ne mai ðe king for geten.
 An oðer drem cam him bi foren.
 .vii. eares wexen fette of coren.
 On an busk ranc and wel tidi.
 160 And .vii. lene rigt ðor bi.
 Welkede and smale 7 drugte numen.
 ðe ranc he hauen ðo ouercumen. |
 Tosamen it smiten and on a stund.
 ðe fette ðrist hem to ðo grund.
 165 ðe king abraid and woc in ðhogt.
 ðes dremes swep ne wot he nogt.
 Ne was non so wis man in al his lond.
 ðe kude vndon ðis dremes bond.
 ðo him biðhogte ðat buteler.
 170 Of ðat him drempte in prisun ðer.
 And of ioseph in ðe prisun.
 And he it tolde ðe king pharaun.
 Joseph was sone in prisun ðo sogt.
 And shauen 7 clad 7 to him brogt.
 175 ðe king him bad ben hardi 7 bold.
 Jf he can rechen ðis dremes wold.
 He told him quat him drempte o nigt.

No^t

173. ðo sogt]
 ðohogt MS.

And iosep rechede his drem wel rigt.
 ðis two dremes boðen ben on.
 180 God wile ðe tawnen king pharaon.
 ðo .vij. ger ben get to cumen.
 Jn al fulsum hed sulen it ben numen.
 And .vij. oðere sulen after ben.
 Sori and nedful men sulen is sen.
 185 Al ðat ðise first .vii. maken.
 Sulen ðis oðere vii. rospen 7 raken.
 Jc rede ðe king nu her bi foren.
 To maken laðes and gaderen coren. |
 ðat ðin folc ne wurð vnder numen.
 190 Quan ðo hungri gere ben forðcumen.
 King pharaon listnede hise red.
 ðat wurð him siðen seli sped.
 He bitagte iosep his ring.
 And his bege of gold for wurðing.
 195 And bad him al his lond bisen.
 And under him hegest forto ben.
 And bad him welden in his hond.
 His folc and agte 7 al his lond.
 ðo was vnder him ðanne putifar.
 200 And his wif ðat hem so tobar.
 Josep to wiue his dowter nam.
 Oðer is nu ðan ear bi cam.
 And ghe ðer him two childer bar.
 Or men wurð of ðat hunger war.
 205 first manassen and effraym.
 He luueden god he geld it hem.
 ðe .vii. fulsum geres faren.
 Josep cuðe him bi foren waren.
 ðan coren wantede in oðer lond.
 210 ðo [was] ynug vnder his hond.
Hvnger wex in lond chanaan.
 And his .x. sunes iacob forðan.
 Sente in to egipt to bringen coren.

202. ðan] quan MS.

He bilef at hom ðe was gungest boren. |
 ðe .x. comen for nede sogt.
 216 To josep and he ne knewen him nogt.
 And ðog he luttē him frigitlike.
 Anð seiden to him mildelike.
 We ben sondes for nede driuen.
 220 To bigen coren ðorbi to liuen.
 Josep hem knew al in his ðhogt
 Als he let he knew hem nogt.
 It semet wel ðat ge spies ben.
 And in to ðis lond cumen to sen.
 225 And cume ge for non oðer ðing.
 but for to spien ur lord ðe king.
 Nai he seiden euerilc on.
 Spies were we neuer non.
 Oc alle we ben on faderes sunen.
 230 For hunger doðes hider cumen.
 Oc nu ic wot ge spies ben.
 for bi gure bering men mai it sen.
 Hu sulde on man poure forgeten.
 swilke and so manige sunes bigeten.
 235 for seldum bitid self ani kinge.
 swilc men to sen of hise ofspringe.
A louerd merci get is ðor on.
 migt he nogt fro his fader gon.
 He is gungest hoten beniamin.
 240 for we ben alle of ebrisse kin. |
 Nu bi ðe feið ic og to king pharaon.
 sule ge nogt alle eðen gon.
 Til ge me bringen beniamin.
 ða gungeste broðer of gure kin.
 245 For ðo was josep sore fordred.
 ðat he wore oc ðhurg hem forred.
 He dede hem binden and leden dun.
 And speren faste in his prisun.
 ðe ðridde dai he let hem gon.



233. *Hu suld sulde*
onman MS.

244. *gure]* *pore* MS.

250 Al but ðe ton broðer symeon.
 ðis symeon bilef ðor in bond.
 To wedde under josepes hond.
 ðes oðere breðere sone on on.
 Token leue and wenten hom.
 255 And sone he weren ðeden went.
 Wel sore he hauen hem bi ment.
 And seiden hem ðan ðor bitwen.
 Wrigtful we in sorwe ben.
 for we sinigeden *quillum* or
 260 On hure broðer michil mor.
 for we werneden him merci.
 Nu drege we sorge al for ði.
 Wende here non it on his mod.
 Oc Josep al it understod.
J 265 osepes men ðor *quiles* deden.
 Also Josep hem adde beden. |
 ðo breðere seckes hauen he filt.
 And in euerilc ðe siluer pilt.
 ðat ðor was paid for ðe coren.
 270 And bunden ðe muðes ðor bi foren.
 Oc ðe breðere ne wisten it nogt.
 Hu ðis dede wurðe wrogt.
 Oc alle he weren ouerðogt.
 And hauen it so to iacob brogt
 275 And tolden him so of here sped.
 And al he it listnede in frigtihed.
 And *quan* men ðo seckes ðor unbond
 And in ðe coren ðo agtes fond.
 Alle he woren ðanne sori ofrigt.
 280 Jacob ðus him bimeneð origt.
 Wel michil sorge is me bicumen.
 ðat min two childre aren me fornumen.
 Of josep wot ic ending non.
 And bondes ben leid on symeon.
 285 Jf ge beniamin fro me don.



279. *ðanno* MS.

Dead and sorge me segeð on.
 Ai sal beniamin wið me bilewen.
 ðor quiles ic sal on werlde liuen.
 ðo quað iudas us sal ben hard
 290 Jf we no holden him non forward
Wex derke ðis coren is gon.
 Jacob eft bit hem faren agon. |
 Oc he ne duren ðe weie cumen in
 but ge wið us senden beniamin.
 295 ðo quað he quan it is ned.
 And [non] ne can no bettre red.
 Bereð dat siluer hol agon.
 ðat hem ðor of ne wante non.
 And oðer siluer ðor bi foren.
 300 forto bigen wið oðer coren.
 fruit and spices of dere pris.
 Bereð ðat man ðat is so wis.
 God hunne him eðimod us ben.
 And sende me min childre agen.
 305 ðo nomen he forð weie rigt.
 Til he ben cumen into egypte ligt.
 And quanne Josep hem alle sag.
 Kinde ðhogt in his herte was.
 He bad his stiward gerken is meten.
 310 He seide he sulden wið him alle eten.
 He ledde hem alle to Josepes biri.
 Her non hadden ðo loten miri.
 Louerd he seiden ðo euerilc on.
 Gur siluer is gu brogt agon.
 315 Jt was in ure seckes don.
 Ne wiste ur non gilt ðoron.
 Beð nu stille quad stiward
 for ic nu haue min forward |
 ðor cam ðat broðer symeon.
 320 And kiste is breðere on and on.
 Wel fagen he was of here come

303. *eði modes* MS.

for he was numen ðor to nome.
 It was vndren time or more.
 Om cam ðat riche louerd ðore.
 325 And al ðo briðere of frigti mod
 fellen bi forn ðat louerd is fot.
 And bedden him riche present.
 ðat here fader hi[m] adde sent.
 And he leuelike it understod.
 330 for alle he weren of kinde blod.
L Jueð quad he ðat fader get.
 ðat ðus manige sunes bigat.
 louerd he seiden get he liueð.
 Wot ic ðor non ðat he ne biueð.
 335 And ðis is gunge beniamin.
 Hider brogt after bode word ðin.
 ðo josep sag him ðor bi foren.
 Bi fader 7 moder broðer boren.
 Him ouerwente his herte on on.
 340 Kinde luue gan him ouergon.
 Sone he gede ut and stille he gret.
 ðat al his wlite wurð teres wet.
 After ðat grot he weis is wlitn.
 And cam ðan in and bad hem eten. |
 He dede hem wassen him bi foren.
 346 And sette hem as he weren boren.
 Get he ðhogte of his faderes wunes.
 Hu he sette at ðe mete hise sunes.
 Of euerilc sonde of euerilc win.
 350 most and best he gaf beniamin.
 Jn fulsum hed he wurðen glaðe.
 Josep ne ðoht ðor of no scaðe.
 Oc it him likede swiðe wel.
 And hem lerede and tagte wel.
 355 And hu he sulden hem best leden.
 Quane he comen in vnkinde ðeden.
 And al ðe bettere sule ge speden.

343. *peis* MS.

345. *and him* MS.

Jf ge wilen gu wið treweiðe leden.
 Eft on morwen quan it was dai
 360 Or or ðe breðere ferden awei.
 Here seckes woren alle filt wið coren.
 And ðe siluer ðorin bi foren.
 And ðe seck ðat agte beniamin.
 Josepes cuppe hid was ðorin.
 365 And quuan he weren ut tune went.
 Josep haueð hem after sent.
 ðis sonde hem ouertakeð raðe.
 And bicalleð of harme and scaðe.
 Vn seli men, quat haue ge don.
 370 Gret vnselðehe is gu cumen on. |
 for is it nogt min lord forholen.
 ða gure on haueð is cuppe stolen
 ð[o] seiden ðe breðere sikerlike.
 Vp quam ðu it findes witterlike.
 375 He slagen [be] and we agen driuen.
 Jnto ðraldom euermor to liuen.
 He gan hem ransaken on and on.
 And fond it ðor sone anon.
 And nam ðo breðere euerilk on.
 380 And ledde hem sorful agon.
 And brogte hem bi for iosep.
 Wid reweli lote and sorwe and wep.
 ðo quat iosep ne wiste ge nogt.
 ðat ic am o wol witter ðogt.
 385 Mai nogt longe me ben forholen.
 Quatsoeuere on londe wurð stolen.
 Louerd quad judas do wið me.
 Quatso ði wille on werlde be.
 Wiððan ðat ðu friðe beniamin
 390 ic ledde ut on trewthe min.
 ðat he sulde ef cumen agen.
 to hise fader and wið him ben.
 ðo cam iosep swilc rewðe upon.

392. wið on an
 erasure.

he dede halle ut ðe toðere gon.
395 And spac uned̃es, so e gret.
ðat alle hise wlite wurð teres wet. |
Jc am iosep dredeð gu nogt.
for gure helðe or hider brogt.
Two ger ben nu ðat derke is cumen.
400 Get sulen .v. fulle ben numen.
ðat men ne sulen sowen ne sheren.
So sal drugte ðe feldes deren.
Rapeð gu to min fader agen.
And seið him quike min blisses ben.
405 And doð him to me cumen hider.
And ge and gure orf al togider.
Of lewse god in lond gersen.
sulen ge sundri riche ben.
Euerilc he kiste. on ilc he gret.
410 Ilc here was of is teres wet.

Sone it was king pharaon kid.
Hu ðis newe tiding wurð bitid.
And he was bliðe in herte fagen.
ðat Josep wulde him ðider dragen.
415 for luue of Josep migte he timen.
He bad cartes and waines nimen.
And fechen wiues and childre and men.
And gaf hem ðor al lond gersen.
And het hem ðat he sulden hauen.
420 More and bet ðan he kude crauen.
Josep gaf ilc here twinne srud.
Beniamin most he made prud. |
fif weden best bar beniamin.
ðre hundred plates of siluer fin.
425 Also fele oðre ðor til.
He bad ben in is faderes wil.
And .x. asses wið semes fest.
Of alle egiptes welðhe best.
Gaf he is breðere wið herte bliðe.

413. *herte*] *h* corr.
out of *b*.

430 And bad hem rapen hem homward swiðe.
 And he so deden wið herte fagen.
 Toward here fader he gunen dragen.
 And quane he comen him bi foren.
 Ne wiste he nogt quat he woren.
 435 Louerd he seiden israel.
 Josep ðin sune greteð ðe wel.
 And sendeð ðe bode ðat he liueð.
 Al egipte in his wil cliueð.
 Jacob abraid and trewed it nogt.
 440 Til he sag al ðat welðe brogt.
 Wel me quað he wel is me wel.
 ðat ic aue abiden ðus swil sel.
 And ic sal to min sune fare.
 And sen or ic of werlde chare.
 445 Acob wente ut of lond chanaan.
 And of is kinde wel manie a man.
 Josep wel faire him vnderstod.
 And pharaon ðogte it ful good. |
 for ðat he weren hirde men.
 450 He bad hem ben in lond gersen.
 Jacob was brogt bi foren ðe king.
 for to geuen him his bliscing.
 fader dere quað pharaon.
 hu fele ger be ðe on.
 455 An hundred ger and .xxx. mo.
 Haue ic her drogen in werlde wo.
 ðog ðinkeð me ðoroffen fo.
 ðog ic is haue drogen in wo.
 siðen ic gan on werlde ben.
 460 Her vten erd mankin bitwen.
 So ðinked euerilc wis[e] man.
 ðe wot quorof man kin bigan.
 And ðe of adames gilte muneð
 ðat he her uten herdes wuneð.
 465 haraon bad him wurðen wel.

No^t

453. *derer* MS.

P in softe reste and seli mel.
 Him and hise sunes in reste dede.
 Jn lond gersen on sundri stede
 Siðen ðor was mad on scite.
 470 ðe was yoten Ramese.
 Jacob on liue wunede ðor
 Jn reste fulle .xiiij. ger.
 And god him let bi foren sen.
 Quilc time hise ending sulde ben. |
 He bad iosep hise leue sune.
 476 On ðhing ðat off e wel mune.
 ðat quan it wurð mid him don.
 He sulde him birien in ebron.
 And witterlike he it aueð him seid.
 480 ðe stede ðor abraham was leid.
 So was him lif to wurðen leid.
 Quuor ali gast stille hadde seid.
 Him and hise eldere. fer ear bi foren.
 Quuor iesu crist wulde ben boren.
 485 And quuor ben dead and quuor ben grauen.
 He dogt wið hem reste to hauen.
 Josep swor him also he bad.
 And he ðorof wurð bliðe 7 glad.
 Or ðan he wiste off werlde faren.
 490 He bad hise kinde to him charen.
 And seide quat of him sulde ben.
 Hali gast dede it him seen.
 Jn clene ending and ali lif.
 So he forlet ðis werldes strif.
 495 Osep dede hise lich faire geren.
 Wassen and richelike smeren.
 And spicelike swete smaken.
 And egipte folc him bi waken.
 xl. nigtes and .xl. daiges.
 500 swilc woren egipte lages. |
 first .ix. nigt de liches beðen.

467. *Him] He MS.*

476. *offe MS.*

And smeren and winden and bi^{que}ðen.
 And waken is siðen .xl. nigt.
 ðo men so deden ðe adden migt.
 505 And ebrisse folc adden an kire.
 Nogt sone deluen it wið yre.
 Oc wassen it and kepen it rigt.
 Wiðvten smerles seuene. nigt.
 And siden smered .xxx. daiges.
 510 Cristene folc haueð oðer laiges.
 He ben smered ðor quiles he liuen.
 Wið crisme and olie in trewðe geuen.
 for trewðe and gode dedes mide.
 ðon ben ðan al ðat wech dede.
 515 Sum on. sum. ðre. sum .vii. nigt
 Sum .xxx. sum .xii. moneð. rigt.
 And Sum euerilc wurðen ger.
 ðor quiles ðat he wunen her.
 don for ðe dede chirchegong.
 520 elmesse gifte and messe song.
 And ðat is on ðe weches stede.
 Wel him mai ben dat wel it dede
 Egipte folc aueð him waked.
 xl. nigt and feste maked.
 525 And hise sunes .xxx. daiges.
 In clene lif and ali laiges. |
 So woren forð .x. wukes gon.
 get adde jacob birigeles non.
 And pharaon king cam bode bi foren.
 530 ðat josep haueð his fader sworn.
 And he it him gatte ðor he wel dede.
 And bad him nimen him feres mide.
 Wel wopnede men and wis of here.
 dat noman hem bi weie deren.
 535 ðat bere is led ðis folc is rad
 he foren abuten bi adad.
 ful seuene nigt he ðer abiden.

526. *daiges* MS.

And bimenig for iacob deden.
 So longe he hauen ðeðen numen.
 540 To flum iurdon ðat he ben cumen.
 And ouer pharan til ebron.
 ðor is ðat liche in biriele don.
 And josep in to egipte went.
 Wid al is folc ut wið him [s]ent.
H 545 ise breðere comen him ðanne to.
 And gunnen him bi seken alle so.
 vre fader he seiden or he was dead.
 vs he ðis bodewurd seigen bead.
 Hure sinne ðu him forgiue.
 550 Wið ðanne ðat we vnder ðe liuen.
 Alle he fellen him ðor to fot.
 To beðen meðe and bedden oc. |
 And he it forgaf hem mildelike.
 And luuede hem alle kindelike.
 555 Osep an hundred ger was hold.
 And his kin wexen manigefold.
 He bad sibbe cumen him bi foren.
 Or he was ut of werlde boren.
 It sal quað he ben soð bi foren.
 560 ðat god hað ure eldere sworn.
 He sal gu leden in his hond.
 Heðen to ðat hotene lond.
 for godes luue get bid ic gu
 Lested it ðanne hoteð it nu.
 565 ðat mine bene ne be forloren.
 Wið gu ben mine bones boren.
 He it him gatten and wurð he dead.
 God do ðe soule seli red.
 Hise liche was spicelike maked
 570 And longe egiptelike waked.
 And ðo biried hem bi foren.
 And siðen late of londe boren.
 Hise oðre breðere on and on.

544. *ent* with a
 letter, apparently w,
 erased before it.

553. *gaf]* *gaff* in
 catch-word.

Page break
 shown as printed,
 at end of line 52.

Woren ybiried at ebron.
 575 An her endede to ful in wis.
 ðe boc ðe is hoten genesis.
 ðe moyses ðurg godes red
 Wrot for lefful soules ned. |
 God schilde hise sowle fro helle bale.
 580 ðe made it ðus on engel tale.
 And he ðat ðise lettres wrot.
 God him helpe weli mot.
 And berge is sowle fro sorge 7 grot.
 Of helle pine cold 7 hot.
 585 And alle men ðe it heren welin.
 God leue hem *in* his blisse spilen.
 Among engeles 7 seli men.
 Wiðuten ende in reste ben.
 And luue 7 pais us bitwen.
 590 And god so graunte amen ameN.

XXIII. KENTISH SERMONS

“Laud Misc. 471, Bodleian Library; on vellum, 188 × 130 mm.: consists of two manuscripts bound together.... The second manuscript, of the end of the thirteenth century, begins at f. 92....”

Sermo jn die epiphanie.

TULERUNT EI MUNERA

C VM natus esset ihesus *in* betleem iude *in*
diebus herodis regis ecce magi ab oriente
uenerunt ierosolimam dicentes. Vbi est qui natus
 est rex *iudeorum*. ¶ We redeth i þo holi godespelle of te dai ase
 ure louerd godalmichti 5 ibore was of ure lauedi seinte Marie i þe cite

of bethleem. þet si sterre was seauinge of his beringe. swo apierede te
þo þrie kinges of heþenesse. to janes þo sunne risindde. And al swo hi
biknewe [f. 128 v²] his beringe bi þo sterre. swo hi nomen conseil be
tuene hem þet hi wolden gon for to hyne anuri. and þet hi wolden offri
10 him· gold· and stor· and Mirre. And al swo hi hedden aparailed here
offrendes swo kam si sterre þet yede to for hem into ierusalem. Þere hi
speken to herodes and hym askede. wer was se king of gyus þet was i
bore. And herodes iherde þet o king was ibore þet solde bi king of
geus. swo was michel anud. and alle hise men. for þet he was 15 of dred
for to liese his kingriche of ierusalem. Þo dede he somoni alle þo wyse
clerekes þet kuþe þe laghe and hem askede wer crist solde bien ibore.
Hi answerden þet ine ierusalem. for hit was swo iseid and behote
hwilem bi þo profetes. And alswo herodes iherde þis. swo spac te þo
þrie kinges. and hem seide. Gop ha seide into 20 bethleem and sechez
þet child. and wanne ye hit habbeth hi funde swo anuret hit. and efter
þet cometh to me. and hic wille go and anuri hit. [f. 129 r¹] Þet ne
seide he nocht herodes for þet he hit wolde on uri ; ac for þet he hit
wolde slon. yef he hit michte finde. Þo kinges hem wenten and hi
seghen þo sterre þet yede bi fore hem. 25 alwat hi kam over þo huse.
war ure louerd was. and al swo hi hedden ifonden ure louerd ; swo hin
an urede. and him offrede hire offrendes. Gold. and. stor. and Mirre. Þo
nicht efter þet aperede an ongel of heuene in here slepe ine metinge
and hem seide and het. þet hi ne solde ayen wende be herodes. ac be
an oþer weye wende into hire 30 londes. ¶ Lordinges and leuedis þis is
si glorijs miracle. and si glorijs seywinge of ure lordes beringe. þet us
telþ þet holi godespel of te day. and ye muee wel understonde be þo
speche of þe godspelle þet me sal to dai mor makie offrinke þan an
oþren dai. and þer of us yeft ensample þo þrie kinges of heþenesse. þet
comen fram verrene 35 londes ure louerd [f. 129 r²] to seche. and him
makie offrinke. And be þe`t` hi offrede gold. þet is cuenable yeftte to
kinge ; seawede þet he was sothfast kink. and be þet hi offrede Stor.
þet me offrede wylem be þo ialde laghe to here `godes` sacrefise ;
seawede þe he was verray prest. And be þet hi offrede Mirre. þet is
biter þing. signefieth þet hi 40 hedde beliaue þet he was diadlich. þet

diath solde suffri for man ken. Nu i hiereth wet signefieth þet Gold. þet. Stor. þet Mirre. And offre we Gostliche to ure lorde. þe `t´ i offrede flesliche. Þet Gold þet is bricht and glareth ine þo brichtnesse of þo sunne. signefieth þe gode beleaue. þet is bricht ine þe gode cristenemannes herte. Si gode 45 beleaue licht and is bricht ine þo herte of þo gode Manne ase gold. Offre we þanne god almichti god gold. Be leue we stedefastliche. þet `he is´ fader and sune. and holy gost. is onlepi god. Wo so hath beleaue ine gode swo offreth him god gold [f. 129 v¹] þet Stor signefied gode werkes. for ase se smech of þe store wanne hit is ido 50 into þe uerée and goth upward to þo heuene and to gode ward Swo amuntet si gode biddinge to gode of þo herte of þo gode cristenemanne. Swo we mowe sigge þet stor signefieth þe herte. and se smech luue of gode. Bi `þet´ Mirre þat is biter. and be þo biternesse defendet þet Cors þet is mide ismered.

53. After *stor*, *e* erased.

54. *Bi*] *Li* MS.

64. *i offred* on margin.

71. *yeuus* MS.

þet no werm nel *comme* ihende ; signefiet 55 þo gode werkes þet is biter to þo yemernesse of ure flesce. Si Mirre signefiet uastinge. for þo luue of gode wakie. go ine pelrimage. uisiti þe poure. and to sike. and to do alle þe gode þet me may do for godes luue. þo ilke þinges so bieth bitere to þo wrichede flessce. Ac also si mirre loket þet bodi þet no werm ne may þer ihende come ; so us defendet 60 þo iléke þinges fram senne. and fram þe amonestement of þo dieule þet ha ne may us misdo. Lordinges nu ye habbet iherd þo signefiance of þo offrings þet maden [f. 129 v²] þo þrie kinges of heþenesse to gode. hye habbet to gode `i offred´ of yure selure. and of yure erþliche godes. Ne ne offreth him nacht on lepiliche to day. ac 65 alle þo daies i þo yere gostliche. Gold. and Stor. and Mirre. ase hic habbe itold. Gold ; fore Gode belaue. Stor ; for holy urisun. Mirre. for gode werkes. þet bieth þo offrings. þet ure louerd besekep auerichedaye þo cristenemanne. and werefore se xpistenman yef has deþ ; of seruet þo blisce of heuene. And ihesu crist þet for us wolde 70 an erþe bi bore. and anured of þo þrie kinges of painime ; he yeu[e] us his grace of þo holi gost in ure hertes werbi we moue hatie þo ileke

þinges þet he hatedh. and lete þo ileke þinges þat he forbiet. and luuie þo ilek þinkes þat he luued. and do þo ilek þinges þat he hóót. ine him so bileue and bidde and serui. þet we mowe habbe þo blisce 75 of heueriche. *Quod uobis prestare dignetur per.*

Domini[ca] secunda post octavam epiphanie. Sermo euan.

VASTI BONUM VINUM USQUE ADHUC

Nuptie facte sunt in chana [f. 130 r¹] galiléé. 7 erat mater ihesu ibi. Vocatus est autem ihesus ad nuptias 7 discipuli eius. ¶ Pet holi godspel of to day us telþ. þet a bredale 80 was imaked ine þo londe of ierusalem. in ane cite þat was icleped Cane in þa time þat godes sune yede in erþe flesliche. `ac´ To þa bredale was ure leuedi seinte Marie. and ure louerd ihesus crist and hise deciples. so iuel auenture þet wyn failede. at þise bredale. þo seide ure leuedi seinte Marie. to here sune. hi ne habbet no wyn. And ure 85 louerd answerde and sede to hire. Wat be longeth hit to me oþer to þe wyman. Nu ne dorste hi namore sigge. ure lauedi. Hac hye spac to þo Serganz þet seruede of þo wyne. and hem seyde. al þet he hot yu do ; so doþ. And ure louerd clepede þe serganz and seyde to hem. ffol vellet ha seyde. þos ydres. þet is to sigge þos Cróós. oþer 90 þos faten of watere. for þer were. vi. ydres of stone. þet ware iclepede bapieres wer þo gius hem wesse for clennesse. and for religiun. Ase þe custome [f. 130 r²] was ine þo time. þo serganz uuluelden þo faten of watere and hasteliche was i went into wyne. bie þo wille of ure louerde. þo seide ure lord. to þo serganz. Moveth togidere and 95 bereth to Architriclin. þat was se þet ferst was iserued. And also hedde idrunke of þise wyne þet ure louerd hedde imaked of þe watere ; ha niste nocht þe miracle. ac þo serganz wel hit wiste. þet hedde þet water i brocht. þo seide Architriclin to þo bredgume. Oþer men seyde he doþ forþ þet beste wyn þet hi habbep ferst at 100 here bredale. and þu hest ido þe contrarie þ`e` t þu hest i hialde þet beste wyn wath nu ; Þis was þe commencement of þo

82. flesliche ac. To MS.

miracles of ure loruerde þet he made flesliche in erþe. and `þo`
 beleuede on him ; his deciples. Ine sigge nacht þet hi ne hedden þer
 before ine him beliaue ; ac fore `þe` miracle þet hi seghe ; was here
 beliaue þe more 105 istrengþed. Nu ye habbeþ iherd þe Miracle. nu i
 hereþ þe signefiance. Þet water bitockned se euele xpisteneman.
 [f. 130 v¹] for also þet water is natureliche schald and a kelp alle þo
 þet hit drinkeþ ; so is se euele xpisteman chald of þo luue of Gode. for
 þo euele werkes þet hi doþ. Ase so is Lecherie. spusbreche. Roberie.
 110 Manslechter. husberners. bakbiteres. and alle
 opre euele deden. þurch wyche þinkes man of
 serueth þet fer of helle. Ase godes oghe mudh hit
 seid. and alle þo signefied þet water ; þet þurch
 yemere werkes. oper þurch yemer iwil liesed þo blisce of heuene. þet
 wyn þat is naturelliche hot ine him selue ; and anhet alle þo þet hit
 dranked ; 115 betekned alle þo þet bied anhéét of þe luue of ure lorde.
 Nu lordinges ure lord god almichti. þat hwylem in one stede. and ine
 one time flesliche makede of watere wyn ; yet habbeþ manitime
 maked of watere wyn ; gostliche. wanne þurch his grace maked of þo
 euele manne good man. of þe orgeilus umble. of þe lechur chaste. 120
 of þe nippinge [f. 130 v²] large. and of alle opre folies ; so ha maket of
 þo watere wyn. þis his si signefiance of þe miracle. Nu loke euerich
 man toward himseluen. yef he is win ; þet is to siggen yef he is anheet
 of þo luue of gode. oper yef he is water. þet is yef þu art chold of
 godes luue. yef þu art euel man ; besech ure lorde þet he do ine þe 125
 his uertu. þet ha þe wende of euele into gode. and þet he do þe do
 swiche werkes þet þu mote habbe þo blisce of heuene. *Quod*
uobis. prestare dignetur.

111. *Manslechtes* MS.

118. *hadeþ* MS.

123. *he he is win* MS.

Dominica tertia post octavam epiphanie.

Cvm descendisset ihesus de monte. secute sunt
 eum 130 turbe multe. Et ecce leprosus ueniens
 adorabat eum dicens. Domine si uis ; potes me
 mundare. ¶ Þet holi godspel of to dai us telþ. þet ure lord ihesus
 crist. ase he hedde iyue þo newe laghe. in one montayne. and hedde i
 maked þet formeste sarmun þet euerte made in erþe ; suo him folgede
 michel folk. Swo 135 kam a leprus. a sikman and onurede him and
 seyde. Lord. [f. 131 r¹] lord ha seide yef þu wilt ; þu me micht wel
 makie hool of mine lepre. of mine euele. And ure lord him seide and
 spredde his hond. and tok his lepre ; hic wille seide ure lord þet þu bi
 clensed. and also raþe he was iwarisd of his maladie. Nu lordinges þis
 is þe miracle 140 þet þet godspel of te dai us telþ. ac great is þe
 tokningge. Se leprus signefiez þo senuulle men. si lepre þo sennen. þet
 scab bitokned þo litle sennen. si lepre betokned þo grete sennen þet
 biedh diadliche. Ase so is lecherie. spusbreche. Gauelinge. Roberie.
 þefte. Glutunie. drunkenesse. and alle þo sennen þurch wiche me liest
 þo luue of gode 145 almichti and of alle his haleghen. þurch S`c`ab nis
 nacht man and wyman deseiuord fram mannes felarede. Ne for þo litle
 sennen. þet noman hine ne mai loki. nis noon deseurd pardurableliche
 fram gode ; ne fram holi chereche. for lepre is man deseurd of þo
 compainie of gode and of alle his angles. þat is to sigge for diadliche
 150 senne. [f. 131 r²] Nu ye habbet iherd þe miracle and wet hit be
 tokned. Nu loke we yef we bieþ clene of þise lepre. þat is to siggen of
 diadliche senne. Se [leprus] liest þe felarede of oþer men ; for se þet
 sterft inne diadliche senne ; so for liest þe compainie of gode. And yef
 ye bieþ clene ; lokeþ þet ye ne falle nocht. þet ye ne 155 bie deseurd
 fram þe felarede of gode almichti. þurch none euele werkes þurch
 none euele iwil. And yef ye bieþ leprus þurch diadliche senne. greded
 gode Merci ; þet þo leprus yaf helpe ine bodie ; þet he us yeue
 gostliche helpe. in ure saule. Comeþ to srifte for leted yure sennen and
 þer of bieþ asoiled. þanne sollie habbe þo helpe of 160 heuene. þat is lif
 with uten ende. *Quod uobis. prestare dignetur. per.*

Dominica quarta post octavam epiphanie.

MINE, SALVA NOS, PERIMUS

Ascendente ihesu in nauiculam. secuti sunt eum
discipuli eius. Et ecce motus factus est
magnus in mari. Ita 165 ut nauicula operiretur
fluctibus. Erat autem illis ; uentus contrarius.

[f. 131 v¹] ¶ We redeth i þe holi godspelle of to dai þat ure lord ihesu
crist yede one time in to ane ssipe and ise deciples mid him into þe
séé. And so hi were in þo ssipe so aros a great tempeste. of winde. And
ure lord was ileid him don to slepe. ine þo 170 ssipe. er þane þis
tempeste aróós. Hise deciples hedde gret drede of þise tempeste. so a
wakede hine. and seiden to him. lord saue us ; for we perisset. And ha
wiste wel þet hi ne hadde nocht gode beleaue ine him ; þo seide to
hem. wat dret yw folk of litle beliaue. Þo aros up ure lord and tok þane
wynd and to séé ; and also raþe hit was 175 stille. And also þo men þet
weren in þo ssipe hedde iseghe þo miracle so awondrede hem michel.
Þis is si vaire miracle þet þet godspel of te day us telþ. Þerefore sal
hure beliaue bie þe betere astrengþed. Ine swiche lorde þet siche
miracle mai do and doþ wanne he wile. Ac hit is us nyede þet se þet
sucurede hem ine þa peril ; þet 180 us sucuri ine [f. 131 v²] ure niedes.
Þet we clepie to him þet ha us helpe. and he hit wille do bleþeliche. yef
we him bisecheth merci mid good iwille also him seluen seith bi þe
holi writes. *Salus populi ego sum. 7 cetera.* Hic am ha
seip helere of þe folke. wanne hi to me clepiedh ine hire sorghen. and
ine hire niedes hic hi sucuri 185 and beneme hem al here euel withute
ende. Grede we to him merci sikerliche. yef se deuel us wille acumbri
þurch senne. Þurch prede oþer þurch anvie. oþer þurh wreþe. oþer
þurch oþer manere of diadliche senne grede we to him Merci. and
sigge we him lord saue us þet we ne perissi. and þet he us deliuri of
alle eueles. and þet ha 190 yef us swiche werkes to done in þise

wordle ; þet þo saulen of us mote bien isauued a domes dai. and gon to þo blisce of heuene. *Quod ipse prestare dignetur.*

Dominica In sexagesima. Sermo.

ET VOS IN VINEAM MEAN

Simile 195 est regnum celorum homini
patrifamilias. qui exijt primo mane *conducere*
operarios in uineam suam.

[f. 132 r¹] **H**ure lord godalmichti to us spekeþ ine þo holi
godespelle of te day. and us seaweth one forbisne.
þet yef we uilleth don his seruise. þe`t´ we sollen habbe 200 þo mede
wel griat ine heuene. For so seyth ure lord ine þo godspelle of to dai.
þet on goodman was. þat ferst uutyede bi þe Moreghen for to here
werkmen in to his winyarde. for ane peny of forewerde. and also he
hedde imad þise forewerde ; so ha sente hi into his wynyarde. so ha
dede at undren and at midday also. þo þat hit was 205 ayen þan euen ;
so ha kam into þe Marcatte. so he fond werkmen þet were idel. þo
seyde he to hem. Wée bie ye idel ; and hie answerden ; and seyde.
lord ; for we `ne´ fonden te dai þat us herde. Goþ nu ha seide se
godeman into mine wynyarde ; and hic þat richt is ; yu sal yeue. þos
yede into þise wynyarde. mid þo oþre. þo þet hi wel 210 euen. þo seide
þe lord to his sergant. Clepe þo werkmen and yeld hem here trauail.
and agyn to hem þat comen last, and go al to þo ferste. yef eue[f 132
r²]riche of hem ane peny. Se sergant dede þes lordes *commandement*.
so paide þo werkmen and yaf euerich ane peny. And so hi seggen þo
þet bi þe Morghen waren icomen. þet 215 hi þet waren last icume.
Hedden here euerich ane peny ; þo wenden hi more habbe ; þo
gruchchede hi amenges hem. and seyden. þos laste on ure habbeþ i
travailed. and þu his makest velaghes to us. þet habbeth aldeai ibye ine
þine wynyarde. and habbetþ iþoled þe berdene of þo pine. and of þo

hete of al þo daie. þo ansuerede se gode man 220 to on of hem. Frend
 ha seide ine do þe noon unricht. Wat for þingkeþ þat hic do min iwil ;
 and also ure lord hedde itold þise forbisne ; so he seide efterward. so
 sulle þo uerste bie last ; and þo laste ferst. Fele
 bieþ iclepede ; ac feaue bieþ icornéé. Nu ihereþ
 þe signefiance. þes godeman ; be tockneþ
 godalmichti ure lord. Se 225 winyard betockneþ. þe seruise of ure
 lorde. þe werkmen. be tockneþ alle þo þet doþ cristes seruise.
 [f. 132 v¹] þo tides of þo daie ; betokneþ þe time of þis world. Bie þe
 Morghen iherde ure lord werkmen into his winyarde. þo ha sente þe
 patriarches. ate begininge of þis wordl. ine is seruise. þet þurch gode
 beleauéé him seruede. and seden 230 his techinge to alle þo þet hi
 hedden hit to siggen. Also at undren. and at midday. iherede he
 werkmen into is winyarde. þo ha sente be þo time þet Moyses was and
 aaron. and i þe time of his prophetes dede he mani god man into his
 seruise ; þet þurch griate luue to him helden. and deden his seruise. To
 yenes þan euen ; godalmichti 235 ihierde werkmen into his winyarde.
 þo þat he alast of þis wordle naam fles and blod ine þe Maidene seinte
 Marie. and seauede ine þis world. þo fond he Men. þet al day hedden i
 be idel. Werefore he fond þet heþen folk þet be þo time þet was igo ;
 hedden ibe ut of godes beliaue. and of his luue. and of his seruise. Hi
 ne hedden 240 nocht ibe idel [f. 132 v²] for to done þo deueles werkes.
 Ac þerefore seith þet godspel þet hedden ibe idel ; þo þet hi nedden bi
 leued ane godalmichti. ne him louie ne him serui. For al þat is ine þis
 wordle. þet man is. bote yef ha luuie godalmichti. and him serui ; al hit
 him may þenche for lore and idelnesse. þo aresunede ure lord þe paens
 245 be ise apostles. vrefore hi hedden ibe so longe idel. þo þet hi ne
 hedden ibe in his seruise ; þo ansuerden þe paens ; þet non ne hedden
 iherd hij. þet is to sigge þet hi ne hedden neuer te iheed prophete ne a
 postle ne prechur. þet hem seaude ne hem tachte hu isolden ine gode

224. On margin, Multi
 sunt uocati ; pauci.
 235. þan] þā MS.

beleue ne him serui. Gop a seide ure lord inte mine 250 winyarde. þet is
 inte mine beleaue. and hic yw sal yeue yure peni þet is heueriche
 blisce. þo heþen men yeden be þa daghen into cristes seruise ; and we
 þet of hem bieþ icume. and habbeþ cristendom under fonge ; bieþ i
 entred in to cristes seruise þere fore we sollen habbe ure peni þet is þe
 blisce of heuene. [f. 133 r¹] also wel ase 255 þo þet comen bi þe
 Morghen. for al so we hopieþ for te habbe heueriche blisce ; ase þo
 patriarches and þo prophetes. and þo apostles and þo gode men þet
 hwilem ine þis world godalmichti serueden. So as we habbeþ i seid of
 diuers wordles. þet god almichti dede werkmen into his winyarde ; so
 we mowe sigge of þo elde of eueriche men. 260 For godalmichti deþ
 werkmen into his winyarde bi þe Morghen. Wanne ha clepeþ of swiche
 þer bieþ into his seruise ine here childhede. Wanne hi of þis world
 wendeþ. beswo þet hi ne be ine no diadlich senne. At undren ha sent
 men in to his winyarde. þet a turneþ into his seruise. of age of man. At
 Middai wanne þo dai is 265 alþer hotestd be tokned þo men of .xxx^ti.
 wyntre. oþer of furti. for þe nature of Man is of greater strengþe and of
 greater hete ine þo age. Se euen bi tockneþ. elde of Man. þet is se ende
 of þe liue. Vre lord deþ werkmen into his winyarde a genes þo
 e[f. 133 r²]uen ; Wanne fele ine here elde wendeþ ut of here senne in
 to cristes seruise. As so 270 solle hi habbe þo blisce of heuene ; ase þo
 þet ferst comen into þe winnyarde. Nocht for þan for þise griate bunte
 þet ure iord yefþ ne solde no man targi for to wende to godalmichti ne
 him to serui. for al so seid þet holi writ þet now ne wot þane dai of his
 diaþe. for Man mai longe liues wene and ofte him legheþ se wrench.
 Nu gode men 275 ye habbeþ i herd þet godspel and þe forbisne. Nu
 lokeþ yef ye bieþ with inne þo winyarde. þet is þet yef ye bieþ ine
 godes seruise yef ye bieþ with ute diadliche
 senne yef ye hatied þat he hateþ. yef ye luuieþ
 þet he luueþ. and doþ þet he hot. and but ye do ; ye bieþ hut of his
 winyarde. þe is ut of his seruise. and ye doþ þet ure lord hóót, so ye 280
 of serueþ þane peni. þet `is´ heueriche blisce. ye of serueþ þet good þet

278. he he MS.

noon herte ne may iþenche ne noon yare i here ne tunge telle. þo blisce
þet god [f. 133 v¹] halt alle þo þet hine luuieþ. þider lord granti us to
cumene. *Quod ipse prestare dignetur. per.*

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Additions are made within [square brackets], and interlineations are printed between `accents`.

Several selections were printed in parallel, on facing pages. They are given here in two forms. First, each version is shown separately, with all notes and marginal information. Then the two are shown side by side, with text only.

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